# Political Science — Master Notes

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> One running document for the whole course, organised by **Part → Lecture → readings**. Format per reading: **Résumé → ★ Heart of it → Key concepts → Section-by-section → Cases → Key terms → Exam pointers.**

## Overview — where everything is

*(Everything below is clickable — jump straight to a lecture, reading, case, or fun-facts box.)*

**Part I · Political Systems & Institutions**

- **Lecture 1: Introduction — Power, Politics & Political Science (MDJ)** — OD Ch. 1: Introduction · Ansell Ch. 1 · the chain, worked · ★ Fun facts
- **Lecture 2: The State (AUW)** — OD Ch. 2: The Modern State · OD Ch. 4: States & Identity · ★ Fun facts
- **Lecture 3: Political Regimes (FK)** — OD Ch. 3: States, Citizens & Regimes · regime taxonomy · ★ Fun facts
- **Lecture 4: Systems of Government** — OD Ch. 5: Governing Institutions · parliamentary vs presidential vs semi-presidential · ★ Fun facts
- **Lecture 5: Participation and Representation (FK)** — OD Ch. 6: Participation & Representation · what is representation? (Pitkin) · electoral systems compared · ★ Fun facts
- **Lecture 6: Institutions and Institutionalisms (AUW)** — Hall & Taylor: the 3 institutionalisms · RCI / HI / SI compared · Busemeyer & Thelen (HI example) · ★ Fun facts

**Part II · International Relations**

- **IR I: Realism (AUW)** — what is IR + collective-goods problem · levels of analysis · what realism is · ★ the realist causal chain · power & the security dilemma · balance of power & polarity · the realism family · Prisoner's Dilemma · ★ Fun facts
- **IR II: Liberalism (AUW)** — how liberalism sees the world · the two branches · ★ liberal institutionalism & its mechanisms · regimes & collective security · ★ liberal internationalism & the Kantian triangle · the democratic peace · ch.7: IOs, the UN, international law & human rights · realism vs liberalism · ★ Fun facts
- **IR III: Constructivism / Other Approaches (AUW)** — the puzzle: material fact → social meaning · ★ what constructivism is · "anarchy is what states make of it" · norms & the apartheid case · postmodernism · ★ critical theory: power & hierarchy · Marxism (Marx vs Lenin) · Gramsci · Wallerstein · postcolonialism/Said · feminist & queer IR · peace studies · ★ the four theories compared · ★ Fun facts
- **IR IV: International Security (AUW)** — ★ security is a contested concept · whose security? the referent object · types of threat · the state: protector or war-maker? · national → international → human security · IR theories & security · ★ securitisation · critical security studies · ★ causes of war: levels of analysis · types of war · conflicts of ideas & interest · ★ Fun facts
- **Foreign Policymaking (EA)** — opening the "black box" (FPA) · ★ domestic variables · neoclassical realism · ★ US foreign policy since 2017 (Trump) · transformational change (Ashbee & Hurst) · embeddedness · ★ two-level games (Putnam) · does the balance vary? · ★ Fun facts

**Part III · The European Union as a Political System**

- **EU I: The Evolution of the EU (AUW)** — what is European integration? · the EU: neither IO nor state · ★ deepening & widening · why integration began (post-WWII) · ★ the evolution timeline · ECSC → Rome · the enlargements · Maastricht & the euro · politicization & the era of crisis · Brexit: integration in reverse · ★ why integration? two theories · neofunctionalism & spillover · liberal intergovernmentalism · ★ the eurozone-crisis case · theories compared · ★ Fun facts
- **EU II: Institutions of the EU (AUW)** — where is EU authority? · governed by treaty (TEU/TFEU) · the five bodies & their interests · ★ the basic architecture · European Council · Commission · Council of the EU · Parliament · CJEU · advisory bodies (EESC/CoR) · competences · conferral · subsidiarity · proportionality · how a law is made / ★ OLP · ★ QMV · special procedures · subsidiarity "cards" · the budget · implementation · regulations · directives · decisions · positive/negative integration & Cassis · enforcement · why the architecture matters · differentiated integration · cooperation & conflict · ★ LI vs neofunctionalism · ★ Fun facts
- **EU III: The Internal Market (AUW)** — what is the single market? · beyond tariffs: non-tariff barriers · ★ the four freedoms · why integrate? economic & political logic · ★ positive vs negative integration · Cassis & mutual recognition · who builds it · ★ the 1992 relaunch (Cockfield · SEA) · ★ the evolution timeline · free movement of goods · persons & labour · ★ services (why harder) · ★ the Services Directive (Frankenstein→vampire) · posted workers & Laval · capital · the state as regulator · the digital single market · ★ LI vs neofunctionalism · ★ Fun facts
- **EU IV: EU Competition Policy (AUW)** — competition ≠ competitiveness · why the market needs competition rules · exclusive competence · ★ the toolbox (6 instruments) · ★ the "economic constitution" (ordoliberalism) · why so supranational? DG COMP · enforcement powers · cartels (Art. 101) · ★ the leniency programme · abuse of dominance (Art. 102) · merger control · ★ digital markets & gatekeepers · Google Shopping · ★ the DMA (ex-ante) · state aid · Fiat & Apple (tax as state aid) · foreign subsidies · history & political economy · ★ three theories · ★ Fun facts
- **EU V: European Citizenship and Identity (AUW)** — the core puzzle + the chain · three lenses on citizens · what EU citizenship gives you · ★ the democratic deficit · the knowledge deficit · how citizens are represented · European identity: constructed, contested, changeable · ★ multi-level identities · civic vs exclusionary Europe · identity ↔ integration · ★ permissive consensus → constraining dissensus · ★ why support or oppose? four mechanisms · hard vs soft Euroscepticism · ★ Euroscepticism vs anti-establishment (Szczerbiak & Taggart) · politicization: eurozone vs Schengen · ★ synthesis · ★ Fun facts
- **Tools 4.1: Normative Frameworks — How Should We Evaluate Political Outcomes? (AD)** — positive vs normative questions · what is a normative framework? · ★ welfarism: utilitarianism · ★ welfarism: Pareto · ★ liberalism: where is the line? · the harm principle · property · freedom · ★ egalitarianism & Rawls · equality of what? outcomes vs opportunity · ★ frameworks at a glance · back to SyRI · why reasonable people disagree · key terms · exam pointers · ★ Fun facts
- **Tools 4.2: Interests and Rational Choice — Why Do Political Actors Choose What They Choose? (AD)** — from "should" to "why" · ★ the three building blocks · actors & preferences · ★ what "rational" means · why vote? the paradox · constraints · incentives & the three levers · ★ expected value: when does cheating pay? · ★ game theory & Nash equilibrium · ★ the prisoner's dilemma · criticisms of rational choice · key terms · exam pointers · ★ Fun facts

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## PART I · POLITICAL SYSTEMS & INSTITUTIONS

# Lecture 1: Introduction — Power, Politics, and Political Science (MDJ)

**Required reading:** OD ch. 1 · Ansell (2023) ch. 1

**Core theme:** *What is politics, and how do we study it?* Two complementary lenses — OD gives you the **discipline's toolkit** (what comparative politics is + the main theory families), Ansell gives you a **single analytical engine** (political economy: self-interest → collective-action problems → the need for political "promises").

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## OD Ch. 1 — Introduction

**Book:** Orvis & Drogus, *Introducing Comparative Politics: Concepts and Cases in Context*, 5th ed. (CQ Press/SAGE, 2021)

### Chapter résumé

The opening chapter defines the field and hands you the analytical vocabulary used for the rest of the book. It answers three "meta" questions — *what* comparative politics is, *why* to study it, and *how* comparativists do research — and then lays out the **three key questions** that organize the whole discipline: **What explains political behavior? Who rules? Where and why?** Most of the chapter is a guided tour of the competing **theory families** used to answer the first two questions. It closes with the book's plan (three parts) and its method of teaching through **eleven recurring country case studies**.

> ★ **The heart of the chapter:** the whole field collapses into **three questions** — *what explains behaviour? · who rules? · where & why?* — answered with the **Interests / Beliefs / Structures** and **Pluralist / Elite** frameworks, all read through **Lukes' three dimensions of power**. Master those and you can attack any comparative-politics question.

### Key concepts / "modes" to use

These are the analytical toolkits you're expected to *apply* to cases later:

- **Three dimensions of power** (Lukes) — the lens for spotting *where* power operates.
- **Empirical vs. normative theory** — always separate "what *is*" from "what *ought to be*."
- **Research methods** — single-case study · comparative method (most-similar / most-different systems) · quantitative statistics.
- **Explaining behavior → 3 families:** Interests · Beliefs · Structures.
- **Who rules → 2 families:** Pluralist vs. Elite theory.

### Section-by-section main points

#### Comparative Politics: What Is It? / How to Study It?

***What is politics?*** *(expanded with the lecture — MDJ)*

- **OD's definition:** politics = "*the process by which human communities make collective decisions*" (any scale, village → international body). This is a **procedural** definition — it's about *how* decisions get made, not their content. Four **implications**:
  - **Group, not private, decisions** — it concerns the group.
  - **The whole community** — decisions normally bind everyone.
  - **The process** — focus is on the decision-making *process*.
  - **≠ polity / policy** — distinguish **politics** (the process) from **polity** (the rules/institutions) and **policy** (the outcomes).
- Also: the process applies **across regime types**, needn't involve **large groups**, and is **not necessarily inclusive** (decisions are often made by small, unelected groups).
- **The distributional definitions** (what OD's definition leaves out — *the distribution of resources*):
  - **Lasswell (1936):** politics = "*who gets what, when, how.*"
  - **Easton (1953):** politics = "*the authoritative allocation of values for a society.*"
  - → politics as a **distributional game**: the capacity to distribute **material and non-material resources** (who wins, who loses).
  - Two key **assumptions** behind this view: ① **scarcity** of resources (no scarcity → no distributional battle) and ② **preference heterogeneity** (people want different, often conflicting, things).
- **Comparative politics** = the subfield comparing power & decision-making *within* countries (contrast: **international relations** studies *between*/beyond states).
- **Power — the three faces / dimensions.** *This is the chapter's master concept — it recurs as the lens for every theory later, so know it cold.* The lecture runs **one example** (a parliamentary **tax increase**) through all three so the differences are clear:

| Face | Who (attribution) | Core idea | The tax example | Power = |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **1st · Decision-making** | **Dahl (1957)** | A gets B to do something B would not otherwise do — **observable** conflict & decisions | A majority in Parliament passes the tax increase despite strong opposition | **winning an observable decision** |
| **2nd · Agenda-setting** | **Bachrach & Baratz (1962)** | Power through **non-decision-making** — keeping threatening issues **off the agenda** via rules/values | Powerful actors keep the tax increase off Parliament's agenda, so no debate or vote ever happens | **controlling what gets decided** |
| **3rd · Ideological** | **Lukes (1974)** | Shaping people's **wants, perceptions & preferences** — even with *no observable conflict* | People come to see taxing the wealthy as harmful/illegitimate, so the demand never even arises | **shaping wants & preferences** |

- **The difference in one line:** the 1st face is about *winning* a visible fight; the 2nd is about *stopping the fight from happening*; the 3rd is about *making sure no one wants to fight in the first place*. Power gets **less visible** as you go down.
- **Why it's central — the recurring pay-off:** each later theory is graded by *which dimension it can see*. Rational choice & pluralists see essentially only the **1st**; rational-choice institutionalists add the **2nd**; psychological

theories, postmodern discourse, historical institutionalism and elite theory reach into the **2nd & 3rd**. Being able to say "this theory only captures the first dimension" is a core analytical move.

- **Worked example of the move (straight from the book):** *Rational choice* accepts people's preferences **as given** and only asks how they rationally pursue them — so it lives purely in the **1st dimension**, ignoring how preferences are *formed*. That is exactly why it "can't explain preferences in advance" and stumbles on the **cross-national union puzzle** (why French unions went communist while US unions chased only wages): it has no way to see the **3rd-dimensional** forces that *shaped* those preferences. **Psychological theories** and **historical institutionalists**, which do reach the 3rd dimension, are what step in to explain it. → *This is the template: name the theory, name the dimension(s) it can't see, then name a rival theory that reaches further.*

## Why Study Comparative Politics? — three benefits

1. Understand political events in specific countries (and inform foreign policy).
2. Draw **lessons** transferable from one place to another (e.g. presidential systems may worsen post-civil-war conflict — invisible if you only study the US).
3. Build **broad theories** of how politics works.

## How Do Comparativists Study Politics? — methods

- No lab: political actors *react* to being studied, so no perfect control.
- **Empirical theory** = explains what *does* occur (describe pattern → explain cause → predict). **Normative theory** = what *ought* to occur. The discipline is mostly empirical, but normative concerns shape which questions get asked (and that's legitimate).
- **Three research methods:**
  - **Single-case study** — deep dive into one case; generates/tests theory; *process tracing* links causes→effects; **deviant cases** expose theory limits. Never definitive beyond itself.
  - **Comparative method** — mimic the lab via careful case selection:
    - **Most-similar systems** — cases alike in many ways, differ on the key variable.
    - **Most-different systems** — cases differing in many ways but sharing the outcome (e.g. revolutions: France, Russia, China, Iran…).
  - **Quantitative statistical techniques** — reduce evidence to numbers, compare hundreds of cases (e.g. the civil-war & diamonds study: civil war driven more by *lootable resources* than ethnicity).
- **Scientific-method vocabulary:** theory · hypothesis · variable · **dependent** vs **independent** variable · **control**.
- Best modern scholarship *combines* methods (quant for patterns + case studies for causal depth).

## Three Key Questions in Comparative Politics

1. **What explains political behavior?** (core of all political science)
2. **Who rules?**
3. **Where and why?** (comparativists' distinctive contribution — the same explanation across different times/places?)

## Q1 — What Explains Political Behavior? → three answer-families

*The chapter's (and the exam's) core. Each family splits into competing theories — below, each with its **core idea**, its **critique**, and which **face of power** it "sees." Learn the theory names + one line each.*

### ① Interests — behaviour = actors pursuing their own preferences

| Theory | Core idea | Critique | Sees face |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Rational choice** | Rational individuals pursue self-defined **preferences** instrumentally (borrowed from economics; starts at the individual). | Can't know preferences **in advance** → weak predictive power; struggles with cross-country variation. Group-behaviour critics: **Achen & Bartels**. | 1st |
| **Psychological** | **Non-rational** factors — personal experience, **emotions**, personality — shape behaviour (**Petersen** on fear; **Hetherington & Weiler** on personality). | Its focus on the individual makes **group** behaviour hard to explain. | 3rd |

### ② Beliefs — behaviour = values & ideas

| Theory | Core idea | Critique | Sees face |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Political culture** | Shared **attitudes, values, symbols** shape behaviour. *Modernist:* clear, identifiable civic values (Almond & Verba's **civic culture**; **postmaterialist** shift, Inglehart). *Postmodernist:* culture = symbols open to interpretation in **discourse** (Foucault). | Do countries really have *one* culture? Culture may be an **effect**, not a cause; postmodernism accused of explaining nothing. | 2nd–3rd |
| **Political ideology** | A **systematic, conscious belief-set** guides action (liberalism, communism, fascism). | May just **justify** actions really driven by self-interest or culture. | 3rd |

### ③ Structures — behaviour = shaped & limited by broad structures

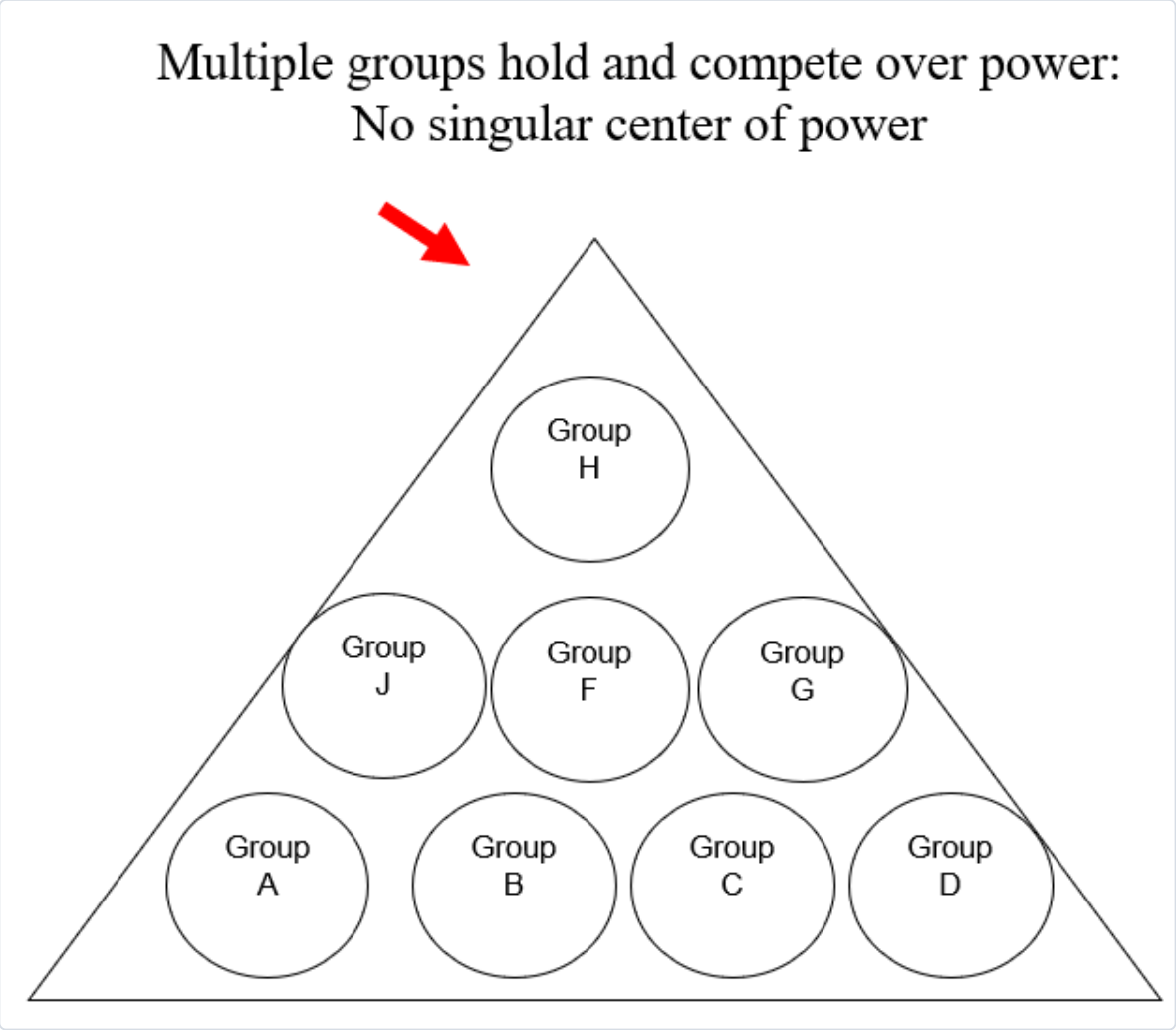
| Theory | Core idea | Critique | Sees face |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Marxism** | Behaviour explained by **class conflict** rooted in the economic system (bourgeoisie vs proletariat — **Marx**). | Overlooks **non-economic** motives (religion, nationalism) and other sources of power. | 2nd–3rd |
| **Institutionalism** | **Institutions — the "rules of the game"** — shape behaviour (*rational-choice institutionalist*, **Weingast**; *historical institutionalist*, **Haggard & Kaufman**; e.g. the US two-term tradition). | Institutions may **reflect** self-interest or culture rather than *cause* behaviour. | 2nd (RC) / all 3 (historical) |

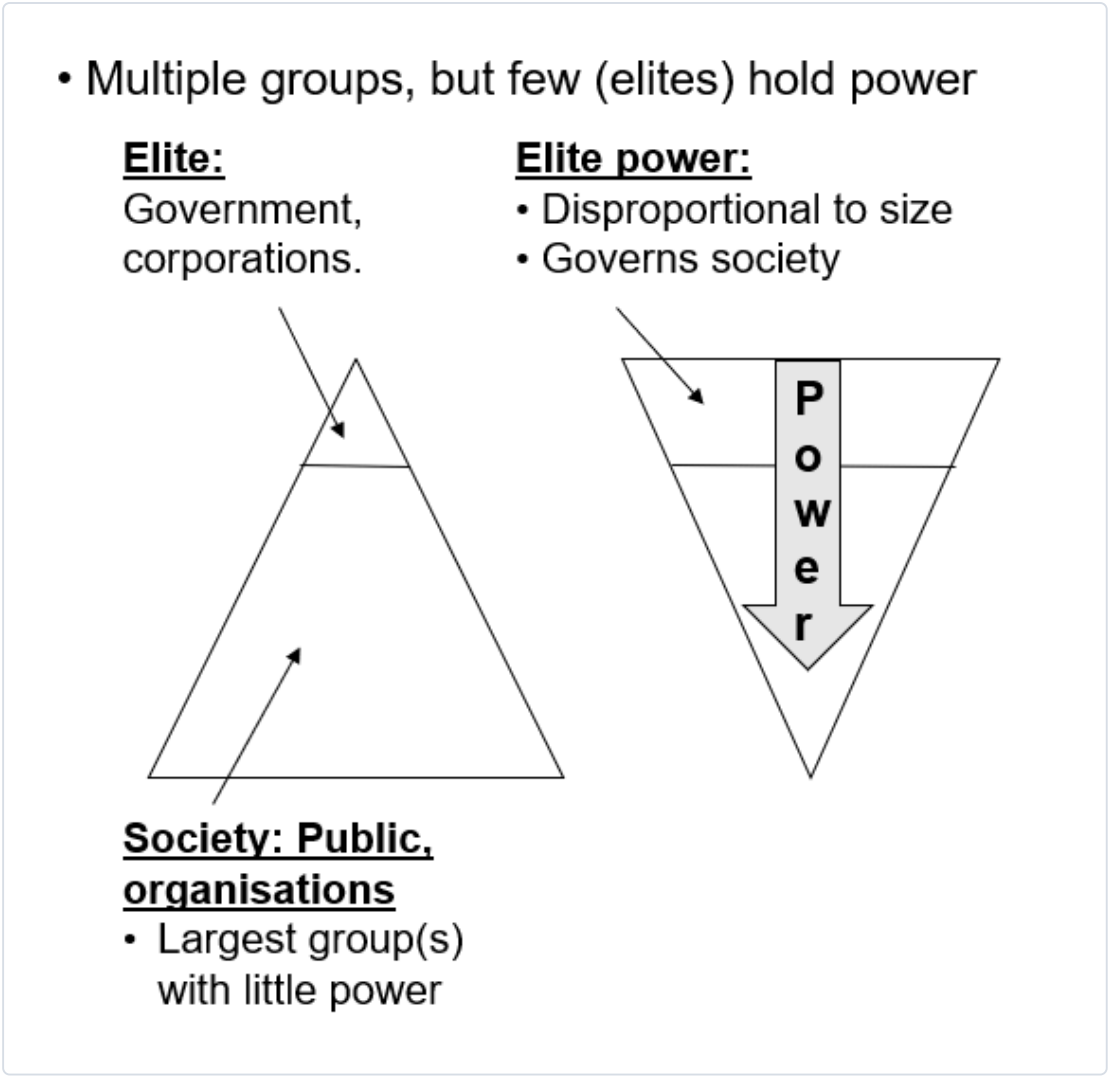
## Q2 — Who Rules? → two answer-families

- **Pluralist theories** (classic statement: **Robert Dahl**, *Who Governs?* 1961) — society = many competing groups; power *dispersed*; no group wins permanently; policy = compromise. (Thinks mostly in the **1st dimension** of power.) Claims to apply even to authoritarian states (Soviet factions; African patron–client networks).

- **Elite theories** — every society ruled by a small elite controlling ~all power (uses **2nd & 3rd dimensions**). Variants:
  - **Marxism** — ruling class = owners of the economy (bourgeoisie); state = "executive committee of the bourgeoisie."
  - **Power elite** (C. Wright Mills) — interlocking economic + political + military elites.
  - **Oligarchy** (Winters) — extreme wealth as power, used to protect wealth.
  - **Patriarchy** (feminist) — rule by men; politics/military tied to masculinity.
  - **Racial elite / "new Jim Crow"** (Alexander) — one race maintains dominance via law, wealth, discourse.
- **Test for who rules:** Who holds formal power? Who influences decisions? Who benefits? → few = elite; many = pluralist.

**Visualising it (from the lecture):**






**How to read them.** *Pluralist* (first diagram): power is **dispersed** among many competing groups — *no single centre*. *Elitist* (second): a **small elite** (government, corporations) sits at the top and holds power **disproportionate to its size**, while the **largest group — the public/society — has little power**; the inverted triangle shows **power flowing *down*** onto them. Same society, opposite claim about where power really sits.

## Q3 — Where and Why?

- Add the **comparative dimension** to Q1 & Q2: why do welfare states differ (see the Sweden vs US welfare state case)? Explanations compete — rational choice / ideology / institutions. Comparison across cases reveals patterns a single case hides.

## Plan of the Book

- **Part I** — the state (what it is, strong/weak; state–citizen–regime; state–identity).
- **Part II** — how political systems work (democratic & authoritarian institutions; participation; regime change).
- **Part III** — political economy & policy.
- **11 recurring country cases:** 4 wealthy democracies (Britain, Germany, Japan, US); 2 post-communist (China, Russia); largest enduring democracy (India); the one theocracy (Iran); 3 post-authoritarian democracies (Brazil, Mexico, Nigeria).

## Cases & examples

The concrete cases the chapter uses. Each one: *what actually happened → what it illustrates*.

- **Tunisia vs Syria (2011).** Both were swept up in the Arab Spring protests, yet the outcomes split completely: Tunisia negotiated a relatively **peaceful transition to democracy**, while Syria collapsed into a long, brutal **civil war**. → *Illustrates:* why comparison matters — understanding a country's internal dynamics has real foreign-policy stakes; it also undercuts the lazy claim that "Arab/Islamic culture" is uniformly anti-democratic (same culture-family, opposite results).
- **Post-civil-war presidentialism.** Americans treat their directly-elected presidency as *the* stable model. But in a country just out of civil war it's **winner-take-all**: only one side's candidate can win the top job, so the losers may prefer to **restart the war** than live with the result. A **power-sharing** system that gives every major group a slice of national power tends to be safer. → *Illustrates:* a lesson you simply cannot see by studying the US alone — the payoff of comparison.
- **Civil war & diamonds** (Collier & Hoeffler; **Sierra Leone**). A large **quantitative** study of hundreds of civil wars found that **ethnic division is not the main cause** people assume. War is far more likely where a group can seize a **valuable, lootable resource** — like the diamonds fuelling Sierra Leone's 1990s war. Where there's no such prize, ethnic division rarely turns violent. → *Illustrates:* the quantitative method + a genuinely counter-intuitive finding.
- **Ukraine 2014 — "is it a civil war?"** When fighting erupted in 2014 (with a Russian military presence backing one side), scholars couldn't cleanly classify it: *how much* violence, for *how long*, before it "counts" as a civil war? → *Illustrates:* the hard first step of any scientific study — **defining and measuring your variables** precisely.
- **Almond & Verba, *The Civic Culture* (1963).** They surveyed citizens across five countries and argued that stable democracies (US, UK) share a "**civic culture**" — people participate *and* defer enough to let leaders govern — whereas **Mexico** had a "**subject**" **culture** (citizens saw themselves as subjects, not participants), fitting its authoritarian rule until 2000. → *Illustrates:* the classic **modernist** political-culture claim — and the standard critique that culture may be an *effect* of institutions, not their cause.
- **US Catholics shifting Democrat → Republican.** Mid-20th-c. working-class Catholics voted **Democrat** on economic interest. As they grew affluent, they came to prioritise **moral/cultural** issues (e.g. abortion) and drifted **Republican**. → *Illustrates:* **postmaterialism** (Inglehart) — political culture *changing over time* and reshaping party alignments.
- **"Family values" (Reagan vs Clinton).** No US politician dares oppose "family values," yet the phrase has **no fixed meaning**: Reagan's Republicans used it to claim the traditional middle-class family; Clinton's Democrats **reinterpreted** it to mean single mothers and two-income families needing afterschool programmes. → *Illustrates:* the **postmodernist** point — political symbols are contested and redefined through **discourse** (a play for the 3rd dimension of power).
- **Unions: France / US / UK.** Same institution, three preference-sets: **French** unions tied themselves to the **Communist Party** and pursued broad ideological goals; **US** unions stayed "bread-and-butter" (wages & conditions), shunning socialist parties; **British** unions built their own **Labour Party**. → *Illustrates:* the puzzle for **rational choice** — it takes preferences as given, so it can't explain *why* they differ so sharply across countries (this is the worked example above).
- **US two-term tradition** (Washington → FDR). Washington voluntarily stepped down after two terms; **no president broke the norm for 150+ years** until FDR won a third term in **1940** — after which it was written into the Constitution (22nd Amendment). → *Illustrates:* an **informal institution** that shaped behaviour purely because leaders and citizens believed it *should*.

- **Chile's democratic transition (1990s).** One of the most successful exits from military rule — explained three different ways: **rational-choice institutionalists** (elites cut a strategic constitutional bargain that served their interests), **political-culture** theorists (Chilean values favoured democracy), **historical institutionalists** (Chile could revive its earlier stable democratic institutions, a legacy neighbours lacked). → *Illustrates:* how the **same event** gets three competing explanations — and the analyst's job is to weigh them.
- **Sweden vs US welfare state.** Sweden runs a large, expensive welfare state; the US spends far less. Why do two rich democracies diverge? **Interests:** strong labour won in Sweden, business overpowered labour in the US. **Beliefs:** Sweden's dominant Socialists spread social-democratic ideology; US "make it on your own" culture rejects socialism. **Institutions:** Sweden's unified labour body (LO) became central to policymaking; US unions stayed decentralised and weak. → *Illustrates:* the lead "**Where and why?**" puzzle, with one answer from each theory family.
- **US corporate power / oligarchy** (Winters). Is the US genuinely democratic if a **corporate elite** holds outsized power? Winters argues extreme wealth ("material power") lets **oligarchs** hire lawyers and lobbyists to shield their income from redistribution. → *Illustrates:* a "**Who rules?**" case pitting **elite theory** against **pluralism**.

**The 11 recurring countries** (used across the whole book): Britain, Germany, Japan, USA (wealthy democracies) · China, Russia (post-communist) · India (largest democracy) · Iran (theocracy) · Brazil, Mexico, Nigeria (post-authoritarian).

### Key terms

| Term | Meaning |
|---|---|
| Politics | Process by which communities make collective decisions (procedural; group, whole community, ≠ polity/policy) |
| Polity / Policy | The rules & institutions / the outcomes (vs *politics* = the process) |
| Distributional game | Politics as allocating resources — "who gets what" (Lasswell; Easton) |
| Scarcity / Preference heterogeneity | The two assumptions behind the distributional view of politics |
| Comparative politics | Subfield comparing power/decision-making across countries |
| Three faces of power | (1) decision-making, Dahl; (2) agenda-setting, Bachrach & Baratz; (3) ideological, Lukes |
| Empirical / Normative theory | Explains what *does* / what *ought to* occur |
| Single-case study | Deep study of one case (uses process tracing) |
| Comparative method | Careful case selection: most-similar vs most-different systems |
| Rational choice theory | Actors rationally pursue self-defined preferences |
| Political culture | Widely held attitudes/values/symbols about politics |
| Civic culture | Culture supporting stable democracy (Almond & Verba) |
| Political ideology | Conscious systematic belief-set about how politics *ought* to be |
| Institutionalism | Institutions ("rules of the game") explain behavior |
| Pluralist theory | Power dispersed among competing groups |
| Elite theory | A small elite controls virtually all power |
| Patriarchy | Rule by men |

### Exam pointers

- Be able to **apply the 3 dimensions of power** to an example, and say which theory family "sees" which dimension.
- Know the **Interests / Beliefs / Structures** trichotomy for Q1 and **Pluralist vs Elite** for Q2 — with one named theorist per box (the names are in the two tables above: e.g. Interests → *Achen & Bartels / Petersen*; Beliefs → *Almond & Verba, Inglehart, Foucault*; Structures → *Marx, Weingast*; Pluralist → *Dahl*; Elite → *Mills, Winters, Alexander*).
- Distinguish **most-similar vs most-different** systems designs with an example.
- Always flag **empirical vs normative** when a question mixes them.

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## Ansell — *Why Politics Fails*, Ch. 1

**Book:** Ben Ansell (2023), *Why Politics Fails: The Five Traps of the Modern World – and How to Escape Them*, Penguin.

> *Note:* the provided PDF is titled "**Introduction: Simple Problems, Impossible Politics**" — this is the framing chapter the syllabus lists as "chapter 1." It sets up the whole book.

## Chapter résumé

Ansell argues that our biggest challenges (climate change is the opening example) are often "**simple problems with impossible politics**": we understand the solution but can't get people to act. The reason is **political economy** — individuals are **self-interested**, and self-interest predictably collides with the collective good, producing **collective-action problems**. He introduces the **five goals** we broadly agree on — **Democracy, Equality, Solidarity, Security, Prosperity** — each of which is also a **trap**. Politics is fundamentally about making **collective promises** to each other; but promises can't be externally enforced, so they only work when made **self-enforcing** through **institutions** and **norms**. The book's project: learn to spot the five traps and escape them.

> ★ **The heart of the chapter:** one chain explains why politics fails — **self-interest → collective-action problem → tragedy of the commons → the need for self-enforcing political promises (institutions & norms)**. If you learn one thing here, learn to run that chain.

## Key concepts / "modes" to use

- **Political economy** — model individuals as self-interested utility-maximizers, then scale up to society.
- **Self-interest → preferences → constraints → trade-offs** — the micro engine.
- **Collective-action problem** — self-interested individuals undermine a shared goal.
- **Tragedy of the commons** & **externalities** (negative/positive) — the recurring failure shapes.
- **Politics as promises** — collective, unenforceable, needing **self-enforcing** design.
- **Institutions** (formal rules) & **norms** (informal expectations) — what makes promises stick.
- **The Five Traps:** Democracy · Equality · Solidarity · Security · Prosperity.

## Section-by-section main points

### Opening — Simple Problems, Impossible Politics

- Climate change: science is a century old and well understood; the road from emissions → warming is *simple*. The hard part is getting anyone to act — a **global problem with domestic politics**. No world government to enforce, so everyone free-rides.
- International attempts show politics *can* work (Paris 2015) or fail (Kyoto, Copenhagen) — success came from flexibility, vague wording, deferral.
- Climate tests all **five** goals: democracy (global consensus?), equality (should richer pay more?), solidarity (do rich nations owe poor?), security (climate refugees, enforcement?), prosperity (short-term gain vs long-term survival).

### Common ground

- **Politics** = how we make collective decisions / make promises to each other in an uncertain world. Essential for solving shared dilemmas.

- **Double-edged sword:** we need politics but hate it; we look for alternatives (markets, technology, strong leaders) but these are "**false gods**" — they still run into human disagreement.
- Disagreement is **inevitable** (elections have losers; spending is unequal; who guards the guards?). Push politics down in one place, it pops up elsewhere ("paste in the toothpaste tube").
- Despite polarization, most people **agree on five things** — which are also five **traps**.

## The five goals (each a trap)

- **Democracy** — right/ability of the mass public to choose and replace leaders. ~½ the world lives in democracies; broadly popular (86% in World Values Survey favor it) but under pressure (the "third wave" stalled; populism, referendums, attacks on media/expertise).
- **Equality** — everyone treated the same; but debate over *outcomes* vs *opportunities* and redistribution. Wide consensus that income gaps are too large (2019: only 7% disagreed), yet inequality has *risen* in rich countries since the 1980s → populist backlash ("inequality paradox").
- **Solidarity** — support for fellow citizens in hard times (illness, bad luck). Underpins popular "third-rail" policies (US Social Security, UK NHS). COVID-19 showed global health interdependence.
- **Security** — the most basic desire: to be safe. 70% prefer security over freedom (highest where war is recent). Concerns: violence *within* states, police violence ("who guards us from our protectors?"), return of interstate war (Ukraine).
- **Prosperity** — enough money to live/grow; but endless growth warms the planet → trade-off between prosperity and environmental survival.

## Political economy (the method)

- The school of thought taking seriously how individual and society interact: start with a **model of each of us** (what we want + how we plan to get it), then pan out to society and watch **best-laid plans undermined by… us**.
- **Basic model:** everyone is **self-interested** — has ordered **preferences** and tries to **maximize utility** (pick the highest-value option). Not an ethical claim — a *predictive analytical tool*.
- **Methodological individualism:** start from individuals, not classes/cultures/groups.
- **Constraints & trade-offs:** you can't have everything (physical, institutional, social limits) → every choice sacrifices an alternative (coffee vs tea; lower taxes vs social liberalism at the ballot box).
- Even **voting** is a puzzle: your single vote is unlikely to be decisive, so turnout must be partly explained by a sense of **duty**. Politicians too are self-interested (must win elections → campaign arms race).
- Studying self-interest is **liberating**, not cynical: even apparently selfless behavior often has a self-interested logic (e.g. the rich opposing public-education spending that "devalues" their kids' advantage).

## Collective-action problems

- When self-interested individuals interact, they can inadvertently wreck a shared goal.
- **Example — the Cod Wars** (Britain vs Iceland, 1950s–70s): overfishing a shared resource.
- **Tragedy of the commons:** without ownership, everyone fishes freely → stocks collapse; my self-interest hurts yours.
- **Externalities:** a market action's effect on a third party — mostly **negative** (pollution, congestion), sometimes **positive** (a neighbor's rose garden). Political life is "full of externalities."

- Root cause: we are **interdependent** — my choice affects your options — and we can't commit others (or ourselves) to "do the right thing." *The making of a tragedy.*

## Politics as a promise

- We're *smart*: we anticipate what others will do — which is exactly why collective-action problems arise (can't blame "stupidity").
- Politics = making **collective promises** (politicians→voters, allies→adversaries). A **promise** ≠ a **contract**: it **can't be legally enforced by a third party** — there's *no higher power than politics itself*.
- So political promises are **fragile and temporary**; they succeed only when **self-enforcing** — designed so that reneging is hard.
- Two tools to grant promises permanence:
  - **Institutions** — formal rules/organizations that lock in expectations (e.g. the **US Senate filibuster**: powerful, flawed, over-represents small states, hard to remove safely — shows institutions structure behavior even when dysfunctional).
  - **Norms** — informal expectations about how we should behave; invisible but powerful, vaguer and harder to enforce than rules; not every leader can invoke them.
- Because institutions & norms vary, **politics plays out differently around the world** (e.g. Nordic high-trust, inclusive systems are hard to transplant).

## The traps (close)

- Each of the five goals faces a **trap triggered by self-interest** that blocks the collective goal. Traps aren't destiny — but they're **insidious, pervasive, even enticing**.
- Two options: spot the traps "in the wild" and step around them, or — if already caught — learn to **escape**. *Only by understanding why politics fails can we make it succeed.*

**The chain, run once (worked).** This is the single argument the whole chapter builds — here it is end-to-end on the Cod Wars:

1. **Self-interest.** Every fisherman, British and Icelandic, tries to maximise his *own* catch (the political-economy starting model).
2. **→ Collective-action problem.** They're **interdependent** — fishing the *same* sea — so each one acting on self-interest undermines the shared goal (a sustainable stock). Individually rational, collectively ruinous.
3. **→ Tragedy of the commons / externality.** The sea is **unowned and hard to monitor**, so no one can be excluded → everyone overfishes → the stock collapses (**tragedy of the commons**). Put the other way: my extra catch imposes a cost on you — a **negative externality**.
4. **→ Need for political promises.** We'd all be better off with a binding catch limit, but there's **no world government** to enforce one — so the *states* must make **political promises** to each other on behalf of their fishermen.
5. **→ Institutions & norms.** A promise can't be enforced by any third party, so it only holds if it's **self-enforcing** — locked in by **institutions** (formal rules: recognised fishing limits/zones) and **norms** (informal expectations). When Iceland kept *extending* its limits, the promise broke and new ones were needed — "*politics never ends.*"

**Reusable template (works on any trap):** name the **self-interest** → show the **interdependence** that makes it a **collective-action problem** → identify the **commons/externality** failure → state the **promise** that would fix it → name the **institution/norm** that could make the promise stick.

### Key terms

| Term | Meaning |
|---|---|
| Political economy | Study of how self-interested individuals and society interact |
| Self-interest | Model assumption: people pursue their own ordered preferences |
| Utility maximization | Choosing the option that yields the highest personal value |
| Constraint / trade-off | Limits force sacrifice of one option for another |
| Collective-action problem | Self-interested individuals undermine a shared goal |
| Tragedy of the commons | Unowned shared resource gets over-exploited |
| Externality | Effect of a transaction on a third party (negative/positive) |
| Politics-as-promise | Collective promises that no third party can enforce |
| Self-enforcing | Arrangement where reneging is made costly/hard |
| Institution | Formal rule/organization locking in expectations (e.g. filibuster) |
| Norm | Informal expectation about proper behavior |
| The Five Traps | Democracy, Equality, Solidarity, Security, Prosperity |

### Exam pointers

- Memorize the **five goals/traps** (Democracy, Equality, Solidarity, Security, Prosperity) — the spine of the whole book.
- Be able to **run the chain**: self-interest → collective-action problem → tragedy of the commons/externalities → need for political promises → institutions & norms *(worked end-to-end above)*.
- Use the **Cod Wars** / **tragedy of the commons** as your go-to worked example.
- Key distinction: a **promise** (unenforceable, needs to be self-enforcing) vs a **contract** (third-party enforced).

### Bridge to OD

Both readings converge on **institutions** and on modelling actors via **interests/self-interest** (OD's "Interests" family = Ansell's political-economy engine). Ansell's "politics = collective decisions" is almost verbatim OD's definition of **politics**. Good to cite them together on *why institutions matter*.

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## ★ Fun facts & memorable details

> The sticky examples, surprising stats and quotable lines from this module — the stuff worth dropping into an essay or exam answer.

#### Memorable examples (great to cite)

- **The Cod Wars** (Britain vs Iceland, 1950s–70s): two NATO allies clashing over cod — boats rammed, one accidental death by electrocution, and Icelandic coastguards fitting **wire-cutters** to slash British trawler

nets. A perfect little tragedy-of-the-commons story. *(Ansell)*

- **Civil war & diamonds:** statistical research (Collier & Hoeffler) found civil wars are driven more by control of **lootable resources** — diamonds, e.g. Sierra Leone — than by ethnic division. *(OD)*
- **The "new Jim Crow"** (Michelle Alexander): mass incarceration reframed as a modern system of racial control. *(OD)*
- **George Washington's two-term tradition:** an *informal* institution that held for 150+ years until FDR broke it in 1940 — then it was locked into the Constitution. *(OD)*
- "**Family values**" as a contested symbol — Reagan's Republicans and Clinton's Democrats each reinterpreted it (the postmodernist point about discourse). *(OD)*

**Surprising stats**

- **86%** worldwide (World Values Survey) say democracy is a good way to run a country — and in **China, Ethiopia, Iran & Tajikistan over 90%** agree with pro-democracy statements, *more* than in the US. *(Ansell)*
- **~70%** say they'd prefer **security over freedom** — highest where war is recent. *(Ansell)*
- **~95%** across wealthy countries think government should provide healthcare — even **85% in the US**. *(Ansell)*
- **2016** was, by some counts, the **most violent year since WWII**. *(Ansell)*

**Quotable lines**

- Marx: the modern state is "*the executive committee of the whole bourgeoisie.*" *(OD)*
- Keynes: "*In the long run we are all dead.*" — on why forecasting fails. *(Ansell)*
- Ansell on the inescapability of politics: push it down in one place and it pops up in another, "*like the proverbial paste in the toothpaste tube.*"
- The **NHS** as Britain's "*national religion.*" *(Ansell)*

**Trivia**

- OD's example of why natural science can be "purer": South Korea's **Woo Suk Hwang faked stem-cell results** — but biologists don't get *normatively* attached to findings the way political scientists do.
- The $CO_2$-warming theory dates to **1861**, revived in a **1956 New York Times** piece imagining "tigers roaming… and squawking Arctic parrots." *(Ansell)*

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# Lecture 2: The State (AUW)

**Required reading:** OD ch. 2 (*The Modern State*) · OD ch. 4 (*States and Identity*)

**Theme of the lecture:** the **state** itself — first *what a modern state is* and why some are strong while others fail (ch. 2), then how **identity** (nation, ethnicity, race, class, religion, gender, sexuality) becomes the central challenge to the state and to the liberal ideal of equal citizenship (ch. 4). Ch. 2 gives you the **anatomy** of the state; ch. 4 shows the **fault lines** running through it.

**Lecture frame (AUW — Ayça Uygur Wessel).** The lecture hangs both chapters on **four questions** — use them as the skeleton:

1. **What is a state?** → the four characteristics (OD Ch. 2).
2. **Where did states come from?** → two pathways: **European (war-driven)** & **colonial**.
3. **Why are some states stronger than others?** → theories of **strength** & **weakness**.

4. **Who does the state represent?** → the **nation / identity** puzzle (OD Ch. 4).

**State ≠ Nation ≠ Regime ≠ Government** *(memorise the one-liners):*

- **State** — the *permanent administrative apparatus*.
- **Nation** — a *group of people with a shared sense of belonging*.
- **Regime** — the *fundamental rules* of the state (its type).
- **Government** — the *people who currently run* the state.

**Two exam-style puzzles the lecture poses:**

- ***What comes first?*** Is there a neat causal order **Territory → Sovereignty → Legitimacy → Bureaucracy**, or are the four **mutually reinforcing**? (Best answer: mostly mutually reinforcing — bureaucracy raises the tax that funds the army that defends the territory that grounds sovereignty…)
- ***Greenland:*** rate its characteristics — strong on **territory**, but weak **external sovereignty** (part of Denmark). Shows the characteristics come in **degrees**, not all-or-nothing.

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## OD Ch. 2 — The Modern State

**Book:** Orvis & Drogus, *Introducing Comparative Politics*, 5th ed., ch. 2.

### Chapter résumé

Defines the **modern state** — the foundational unit of comparative politics — and separates it from *country*, *nation*, *government*, and *regime*. It argues every modern state shares **four characteristics** (territory, external/internal sovereignty, legitimacy, bureaucracy) that make it an exceptionally powerful ruling apparatus. It traces the state's **historical origins** (first in Europe, 15th–18th c., then exported worldwide by colonialism, universal only by the 1960s) and explains why states vary in **strength** (the strong/weak/failed spectrum, political goods, the resource curse, quasi-states). **~Half the chapter is eleven country case studies** ranked strongest→weakest — so weight your revision toward the cases.

> ★ **The heart of the chapter:** a modern state = **four characteristics** (territory · external + internal sovereignty · legitimacy · bureaucracy); *how fully a state has them* decides whether it is **strong, weak, or failed**. Use the four as a checklist on any case.

**The red thread.** One question runs through the whole chapter: **does an entity have the four characteristics — and how fully?** That single test defines what a state *is* (the characteristics), explains where states *came from* (building the four via war & colonialism), and grades why they *differ in strength* (strong = has all four; failed = has lost them). Every case is scored on the same four.

### Key concepts / "modes" to use

- **The four characteristics of the modern state** — the analytic backbone: **territory · external & internal sovereignty · legitimacy · bureaucracy.**
- **Sovereignty split:** *external* (recognised independence from outside powers) vs *internal* (sole law-making/enforcing authority inside) — they can come apart.
- **Weber's monopoly on the legitimate use of force** — the state claims to be the only body that may legitimately coerce.

- **Weber's three types of legitimacy** — traditional · charismatic · rational-legal.
- **Strong / weak / failed state** — a *continuum* measured by whether the state supplies **political goods** (security, rule of law, infrastructure).
- **Ideal type** — no real state matches the model perfectly; use it as a yardstick.

## Section-by-section main points

### What is a state? — state vs. the rest

***Core:*** don't confuse the four — **state** (the apparatus) ≠ **government** (who runs it now) ≠ **regime** (the type of rules) ≠ **nation** (a people).

- A **state** = "an ongoing administrative apparatus that develops and administers laws and implements policies in a specific territory." **Government** = the transient occupants (US: "administrations"); **regime** = the *type* of government (liberal democracy, fascism — ch. 3); **nation** = a people with shared identity (ch. 4); **country** = too vague for analysis.

### The four characteristics of a state *(heavily emphasised)*

***Core:*** four features together make the state a uniquely powerful ruling apparatus — **the checklist you score every case on.**

- ① **Territory** — clearly defined borders; sizes range from Russia (6.5m sq mi) to micro-states under 200 sq mi. Borders still shift (Kosovo 2008, South Sudan 2011), usually to align state with nation.
- ② **External vs internal sovereignty** — *external* = recognised independence (counter-examples: colonies, Vichy France, Manchukuo — had territory/government but externally controlled); *internal* = sole authority to make/enforce law, defended against secession. A state needs *others to recognise it* (see the Somaliland case). Sovereignty ≠ omnipotence.
- ③ **Legitimacy** — the recognised right to rule; boosts sovereignty *far more cheaply than force*. **Weber's three types: traditional** (long-standing custom — divine right of kings), **charismatic** (personal virtue/heroism — early Mao), **rational-legal** (leaders chosen by accepted laws — elected under a constitution; Weber's marker of *modern* rule). In practice regimes **blend all three**. Collier: without legitimacy you get **repression, conflict, or "theater."**
- ④ **Bureaucracy** — appointed officials who implement law (collect tax, run the army, pave roads). Weak legitimacy + weak bureaucracy = the two key drivers of state weakness.

### Where did states come from? — two pathways *(moderate)*

***Core:*** the four characteristics were **built two ways** — Europe by *war & competition*, the rest by *colonial conquest* — and the route shapes later capacity.

① **European pathway — "war made the state" (Charles Tilly).** A causal flow driven by **military competition**:

> **Feudalism** (overlapping authorities) → **absolute monarchies** (consolidate territory & sovereignty; "*L'état, c'est moi*" — state not yet separate from the ruler) → **war & political competition** (15th–18th-c. rulers were "war-lords/ladies") → **taxation + armies + administration** → **efficient bureaucracies** → **stronger territorial states.**

- **Tilly's four activities** (each reinforces the state — he likens the early state to a **protection racket**): **war-making** (neutralise external rivals) · **state-making** (neutralise internal rivals) · **protection** (neutralise clients' enemies) · **extraction** (raise the **tax** to fund the first three).
- **Brandenburg-Prussia** *(worked example):* surrounded by larger powers → needed armies → needed revenue (poor economy) → heavy **taxation in return for protection** → efficient bureaucracy → high **state capacity**. Prussia was strong **not because it always won**, but because it had to fight in a **very competitive environment**, which raised the incentive to build a strong state.
- Competition cut Europe from **~500 sovereign entities in 1500 to ~50 today**. The *truly* modern state arrives once it is seen as **separate from the ruler** and liberalism turns subjects into **citizens** (Glorious Revolution 1688; French Revolution 1789). *(Premodern states elsewhere ruled **people** more than precise territory — China's Confucian bureaucracy was closest to modern, ~1,800 years early.)*

② **Colonial pathway — statehood through conquest.** European powers **exported** borders, administrative structures and international recognition — but colonial borders **ignored existing political communities**. Result: **statehood ≠ state capacity** — postcolonial states inherited legal external sovereignty but **weak internal sovereignty**, imposed institutions and divided loyalties → mostly **very weak states** (universal statehood only by the 1960s). **Main take-away: the *origins* of statehood shape how *capacity* later develops.**

## Why are some states stronger? — strong / weak / failed *(heavily emphasised)*

***Core:*** strength = **how many political goods the state actually delivers** — a *continuum* (strong → weak → failed), not three boxes, and a state can be strong on one characteristic, weak on another.

- States supply **political goods** (Rotberg: security, rule of law, infrastructure). **Strong** = provides them generally; **weak** = only partially; **failed** = loses effective sovereignty over part/all territory (Syria, DRC, Afghanistan). Strength is a **continuum** and can move *both* ways (Fukuyama: even the US state has weakened).
- **Vicious cycle of weakness:** no resources → falling legitimacy → underpaid officials → corruption → worse services → citizens turn to mafias/private justice → the monopoly on force erodes further.
- **Why states differ — theories of *strength* (name + who):**
  - **Warfare** (**Tilly**) — external threats force state-building (Prussia).
  - **Colonial legacies** (**Acemoglu, Johnson & Robinson**) — externally imposed institutions shape later state capacity (Congo, Nigeria).
  - **Elite agreements** (**North, Wallis & Weingast**) — elites trade *private violence* for **impersonal institutions & the rule of law** (England).
  - *(+ **Fukuyama's two paths:** bureaucracy-first Prussia/Germany vs democracy-first US → machine politics.)*
- **Theories of *weakness*:**
  - **Resource curse** — resource dependence weakens **accountability** and breeds corruption (mineral revenue lets rulers ignore citizens; gives rebels a prize — *not* inevitable, cf. Norway).
  - **International system** — international **recognition** props up **quasi-states** that couldn't otherwise survive (post-1945 norm against conquest; Cold War patrons).
- Measured by the **Fragile States Index** (178 states, 12 factors — the chapter questions its equal weighting).

## Cases & examples

**Why these cases are here — circle them back to the theme.** The chapter isn't telling eleven country stories for their own sake: each is a **worked example of the chapter's spine** — the **four characteristics**, the **strong**

→ **weak** → **failed** spectrum, and the **different bases of legitimacy** (Weber's three types). Read *every* case for three things: **(1) how strong, and why · (2) its basis of legitimacy · (3) any sovereignty problem.** The table maps each case to the concept it best demonstrates; the write-ups below give the story, and each closing → **line** states the tie back to the theme.

| Case | Strength | Basis of legitimacy | Best demonstrates (chapter concept) |
|---|---|---|---|
| Germany | Strongest | shifting → liberal democracy | Fukuyama's **bureaucracy-first** path; first welfare state |
| Japan | Strong | democracy (emperor symbolic) | **defensive modernisation** |
| UK | Strong | traditional → rational-legal | slow **evolution**; sovereignty is **reversible** (Brexit) |
| USA | Strong | rational-legal (written constitution) | Fukuyama's **democracy-first** path; state **built by design** |
| Mexico | Moderate | liberal democracy (post-PRI) | loss of the **monopoly on force** |
| China | Moderate | **economic performance** | legitimacy **without** democracy |
| Brazil | Moderate | cycled through all types | legitimacy can rest on **many bases** |
| India | Moderate–weak | liberal democracy | democracy surviving in a **weak** state |
| Russia | Weak | nationalism | external strength ≠ internal rule of law |
| Iran | Weak | **theocracy** | theocratic legitimacy |
| Nigeria | Weakest | contested | weak postcolonial state **+ resource curse** |
| Somaliland | *(boxed)* | — | internal vs external sovereignty are **separable** |
| ISIS | *(boxed)* | religious only | the **four characteristics** as a checklist |

- **Somaliland (internal vs external sovereignty).** After Somalia collapsed in 1991, this ex-*British* region declared independence, wrote a 2001 constitution (an elected house + a house of **clan elders**), held real elections and grew on livestock/remittances — yet **no state recognises it** (one embassy, Ethiopia's). → *Shows the two sovereignties are separable:* it has near-full internal sovereignty but zero external — and looks more state-like than recognised Somalia.
- **ISIS — "was it a state?"** From its 2014 caliphate to 2017 defeat it held Belgium-sized territory (~6m people), taxed "every bushel of wheat" and ran a bureaucracy (even a DMV). But territory was only nominal, it rejected the international system (no external sovereignty), its legitimacy was purely religious, and it failed at **security**. → *Verdict: only "partially" a state* — the four characteristics used as a diagnostic checklist. (Tilly: "*war made the state, and the state made war.*")
- **Germany — first modern welfare state (strongest of the 11).** Unified late (**1871**, Bismarck) on a merit-based **Prussian bureaucracy/military**; Bismarck built **Europe's first welfare programs** to undercut socialists. Legitimacy lurched: nationalism → Nazism → divided 1945–90 → reunified 1990, then led EU integration. → *Strong state despite a turbulent history; Fukuyama's "bureaucracy-first" path; voluntary ceding of sovereignty to the EU.*
- **Japan — determined sovereignty.** Consolidated under the **Tokugawa shogunate (1603)**; after US warships forced it open (**1853**), the **1867 Meiji Restoration** built a modern army, bureaucracy and constitution (1889) — the **first non-Western modern economy**. Militarism → WWII → US occupation

(first lost sovereignty in 400 years) → US-written pacifist democracy. → *Defensive modernisation; democracy replaces monarchy as legitimacy while the emperor stays symbolic.*

- **United Kingdom — the long evolution.** The opposite of the US: centuries of gradual change — single monarch from 1603, **Acts of Union 1707**, **Glorious Revolution 1688** starting the shift to liberal-democratic legitimacy; first to industrialise → global empire. → *Slow evolutionary state-building; sovereignty is reversible* — Scottish referendum (2014, lost 55–45) and **Brexit (2016)** reclaiming powers from the EU.
- **United States — a consciously crafted state.** Almost uniquely **created by design** (Declaration 1776 → Constitution after the failed Articles). Sovereignty tested by the **Civil War**; the Constitution built **federalism** and preserved slavery. Bureaucracy came *late* (machine politics until the **1880s Pendleton Act**). → *Rational-legal legitimacy via a written constitution; Fukuyama's "democracy-first" path; top external power but internally weakened by the legacy of slavery/racial inequality.*
- **Mexico — challenges to internal sovereignty.** A very weak first state (lost half its territory to the US, 1846–48); order under **Porfirio Díaz**, then the **Revolution (1910–20)** and **75 years of PRI rule** (electoral authoritarianism on oil + clientelism), ending with **Fox in 2000**. → *Above all, the **loss of the monopoly on force*** — drug cartels killed 75,000–100,000 in a decade.
- **China — economic legitimacy over reform.** Had a merit **Confucian bureaucracy ~1,800 years before Europe**; empire fell 1912 → **Communist victory 1949** (Mao; famine ≥20m dead) → after 1976 **Deng's** market reforms → history's fastest growth, now the #2 economy. → *Legitimacy shifts from communist ideology + Mao's charisma to **economic performance*** (a "modernising authoritarian" regime), tightening under Xi.
- **Brazil — many bases of legitimacy.** Had **more slaves than any American colony** and was the **last to abolish slavery (1888)**; gained independence peacefully as a monarchy. Cycled through charisma, **clientelism (the *coronéis*)**, Vargas's quasi-fascist Estado Novo, and military rule (1964–85) to democracy — then the **Petrobras scandal → 2016 impeachment**. → *A state that cycled through nearly every basis of legitimacy; corruption undermines the bureaucracy.*
- **India — enduring democracy in a weak state.** Territory forged by British rule; independence **1947** (Congress/Gandhi — the first successful 20th-c. anticolonial movement) amid **Partition** (largest migration in history, ≥1m dead). → *Uniquely for a postcolonial state, its legitimacy is continuous **liberal democracy***, but the state is weak — corruption, mass poverty, Hindu–Muslim tension (its worst FSI indicator).
- **Russia — strong external, weak rule of law.** Four regimes: tsarist absolutism → the **communist USSR** (Stalin's modernisation killed ~20m) → a fragile 1990s democracy (oligarchs, mafias) → **Putin's electoral authoritarianism**; the USSR split into **15 states in 1991**; **Crimea annexed 2014**. → *External strength and nationalist legitimacy **decoupled** from internal rule of law.*
- **Iran — legitimacy via theocracy.** Heir to ancient Persia; **never colonised** but dominated by Britain/Russia; the **Pahlavi** modernising-authoritarian state (1925–79) → the **1979 revolution** under **Khomeini → the first modern theocracy**. → *Legitimacy runs monarchy → modernising authoritarianism → **Islamic theocracy***; secure territory but a fairly weak state (corruption, sanctions, contested legitimacy).
- **Nigeria — an extremely weak state (weakest of the 11).** A colonial patchwork (Muslim north; Yoruba west; stateless Igbo east) under British "indirect rule"; independence 1960 → **Biafra civil war (1967–70, ~1m dead)** as oil came online; six coups; fragile democracy from 1999. → *The classic weak postcolonial state **plus the resource curse*** — oil fuels corruption and secession; sovereignty threatened by **Boko Haram**.

### Key terms

| Term | Meaning |
|---|---|
| State | Ongoing administrative apparatus making/implementing law in a territory |
| Government / Regime | The transient occupants / the *type* of government |
| Territory | Area with defined borders a state claims |
| External sovereignty | Recognised independence from outside powers |
| Internal sovereignty | Sole authority to make/enforce law inside |
| Legitimacy | The recognised right to rule |
| Traditional legitimacy | Right to rule from long-standing custom |
| Charismatic legitimacy | Right to rule from personal virtue/heroism |
| Rational-legal legitimacy | Right to rule via accepted laws/procedures |
| Bureaucracy | Appointed officials who implement the law |
| Feudal states / Absolutism | Overlapping sovereignties / single-monarch exclusive rule |
| Ideal type | Model of the purest version of something |
| Political goods | Security, rule of law, infrastructure a state provides |
| Strong / weak / failed state | Provides political goods generally / partially / loses sovereignty |
| Resource curse | Reliance on one resource lets the state ignore citizens |
| Quasi-states | Legally recognised but lacking a functioning state apparatus |
| Clientelism | Exchange of material resources for political support |

### Exam pointers

- Use the **four characteristics as a diagnostic checklist** (the ISIS box is the model answer).
- Give **Weber's three legitimacy types** with an example each, and note real states blend them *(developed under Legitimacy)*.
- Explain **strong/weak/failed** as a continuum + at least two theories of *why* (Tilly's warfare · colonial legacies (Acemoglu, Johnson & Robinson) · North-Wallis-Weingast elite bargains; weakness = resource curse · international recognition).
- Keep **external vs internal sovereignty** distinct — Somaliland (internal only) and Russia (external strong, rule of law weak) are the go-to illustrations.

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## OD Ch. 4 — States and Identity

**Book:** Orvis & Drogus, *Introducing Comparative Politics*, 5th ed., ch. 4.

## Chapter résumé

Identity politics — organised around **nation, ethnicity, race, class, religion, gender and sexual orientation** — has become the central challenge to the modern state and to the liberal ideal of **equal citizenship**. The chapter's core theoretical move is to reject **primordialism** (identities as natural/ancient) for **constructivism**: an identity's *political saliency* is **socially constructed**, shaped by elites, grievance, and above all the state (education, censuses, laws). The central normative debate is **individual vs. group rights** — is legal equality enough, or do marginalised groups need recognition, autonomy, representation and status support? Each identity type gets a case study; the chapter weights **gender/sexuality, race, and religion** most heavily.

> ★ **The heart of the chapter:** an identity's **political saliency is socially constructed, not natural** (constructivism, not primordialism) — so the real battle is **individual vs. group rights** over recognition, autonomy, representation and status.

**The red thread.** The whole chapter is *one idea applied seven times.* For **each** identity marker — nation · ethnicity · race · class · religion · gender · sexuality — ask the same **two questions**: ① **how was its political saliency constructed?** and ② **individual rights or group rights?** Every section and case below is a variation on those two questions; if you can answer them for a marker, you can answer the chapter.

**Lecture framing (AUW):** this chapter answers the lecture's 4th question — ***who does the state represent?*** A state claims a **territory**, and territory comes with "**the people**" it claims to represent — but people and territory rarely coincide neatly. Key distinction: **State** (territorial/administrative org) ≠ **Nation** (a people with shared belonging) ≠ **Nationalism** (*the political project of making the nation politically sovereign / controlling a state*). A state can contain many nations; a nation can exist without a state; nationhood is **socially constructed** (Anderson's "*imagined community*").

## Key concepts / "modes" to use

- **Political saliency** — how politically important an identity is; **created, not innate**.
- **Primordialism vs constructivism** — identities as natural/ancient vs **socially constructed** ("imagined communities," Anderson). *The chapter adopts constructivism.*
- **Nation vs ethnic group** — a nation has/seeks a **state**; an ethnic group does not (a dissatisfied ethnic group can *become* a nation).
- **Cultural vs civic nationalism** → citizenship by **jus sanguinis** (blood, Germany) vs **jus soli** (soil, France); civic seen as more democracy-friendly.
- **The four demands of identity groups** — recognition · autonomy · representation · improved social status.
- **Group-rights toolkit: consociationalism** (Lijphart — share central power) vs the **centripetal approach** (Horowitz — incentivise leaders to moderate).
- **Three forms of secularism** — **neutral state** (USA) · **laïcité** (France) · **positive accommodation** (Germany); India's variant = "**principled distance.**"
- **Assimilationist vs liberationist** strategies (feminist & LGBTQ).

## Section-by-section main points

### Understanding Identity — the chapter's core move

***Core:*** it isn't groups but their **political saliency** that's constructed — **saliency is *made*, not given.** *(This is the lead argument for any ch. 4 answer.)*

| | **Primordialism** *(almost no social scientist)* | **Constructivism** *(the chapter's choice)* |
|---|---|---|
| Identities are… | natural, ancient ("time immemorial"), **fixed** | **socially constructed** — "imagined communities" (Anderson) |
| Defined by | kinship, language, phenotype | stories, symbols, interpretation |
| Do they change? | no | **yes** — flexible; you hold **many** at once; elites **activate** whichever fits |
| Who talks this way | ethnic/national **leaders** (it legitimises their claims) | social scientists (Huntington's *Clash of Civilizations* = a sophisticated cultural version) |

**Why the chapter picks constructivism** — primordialism *cannot explain* three things constructivism can:

1. **Change over time** — the *same* difference goes dormant → deadly: ex-Yugoslavia's religious identities barely mattered under communism, then became killing lines *as* war spread.
2. **Identities appearing / splitting** — "Serbo-Croatian" fractured into three "languages" as war came; "**Asian American**" & "**Hispanic**" were *coined* in the 1960s; "Igbo" as a unified group first appears in 1930s documents.
3. **The state manufacturing identity** — via schooling ("national history"), censuses and elections the state decides which categories even exist and become salient.

→ **The move:** reject primordialism, adopt constructivism, then for each marker ask *how* its saliency was built. **Gender** is the odd one out: rarely territorial, but the "proper woman" ideal **polices the boundary of every other identity**.

## The Policy Debate — individual vs group rights *(emphasised)*

***Core:*** once an identity is salient, groups make **four demands**; the whole fight is whether to answer them with **equal individual rights** (liberalism) or **special group rights** (multiculturalism).

- **The four demands:** ① **recognition** (Taylor's "politics of recognition" — the universal one) · ② **autonomy** (self-rule over a region or personal/religious law; thwarted → secession → civil war) · ③ **representation** (may need institutional change) · ④ **improved status** (most groups start poorer).
- **FOR group rights** (Kymlicka): legal equality alone can't include culturally distinct minorities → **multicultural integration** (vs **assimilation**). Institutional form: **consociationalism** (Lijphart — each group gets a share of central power + vetoes; Switzerland, Belgium, Lebanon, Northern Ireland) — *the most common post–Cold War response.*
- **AGAINST group rights** (classic liberalism): only individuals have rights; group rights **freeze inequality** and erode the shared identity democracy needs. Alternative: the **centripetal approach** (Horowitz — electoral rules that *reward broad, cross-ethnic appeal*; Nigeria).
- **The sharp dilemma** (exam favourite): should groups pursuing *illiberal* goals — e.g. religious law limiting gender equality — get special rights?

## Nations, Nationalism & Immigration

***Core:*** the only line between a nation and an ethnic group is the **state** — a nation has or seeks one; and nations are *made*, not found.

- Nations are **modern** and often *built by states* (d'Azeglio: "*We have made Italy. Now we must make Italians.*").

- **Cultural (jus sanguinis) vs civic (jus soli)** nationalism; **immigration** is where the fight plays out (Syrian refugees, Brexit, Trump's wall). Even "civic" USA isn't so civic — **50%** think a "true American" is Christian, English-speaking, US-born.

## Ethnicity

*Core:* ethnic saliency is **switched on**, not ancient — by **leadership + grievance + resource wealth + fear.**

- "Imagined" and shiftable (Serbo-Croatian split into three languages *as* war came); wants recognition/autonomy/representation (India reorganised states on linguistic lines).

## Race *(heavily emphasised)*

*Core:* race = identity built on **physical** markers by **external imposition** (to justify domination/slavery) — the one identity that starts as *power over* a group, not self-assertion.

- Differs from ethnicity in *marking* (physical vs cultural), *origin* (imposed vs self-claimed) and built-in **power**. Genetic variation across "races" is no bigger than within them. Constructed by place: US "**one-drop rule**" vs Brazil's 12+ visual categories.

## Social Class

*Core:* the one identity still often defined by "**objective**" **criteria** — yet its **political saliency is falling.**

- Marx's classes (bourgeoisie/proletariat) fit a post-industrial economy awkwardly; constructivists see class as symbols/aspiration. Union density **~35% (1985) → ~17%**; despite rising inequality, workers moved to **nationalist/right parties** (Brexit, Trump), not class politics (Huber: leaders mobilise whichever cleavage most cheaply wins).

## Religion & the Secular State *(heavily emphasised)*

*Core:* religion's demands mirror ethnicity's (recognition + autonomy over personal law); what varies is **how the state handles religion** — three models of secularism to memorise:

| Model | Rule | Country | Flashpoint |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Neutral state** | neutral about religion, but not opposed | **USA** | school prayer, creationism |
| **Laïcité** | religion barred from the **public sphere** | **France**, Turkey, Mexico | the **veil** bans |
| **Positive accommodation** | state **supports** registered faiths | **Germany** (church tax) | recognising non-hierarchical Islam |

- India's "**principled distance**" is a fourth stance — treat groups **differently on purpose** (see the India case).
- Religion is more flexible than ethnicity (you can convert) *except* when politicised (ex-Yugoslavia marked identity despite low religiosity).

## Gender & Sexual Orientation *(the most heavily emphasised — two cases)*

*Core:* both movements pose the multiculturalism question in its sharpest form — **assimilate into existing norms, or transform them?**

- **Assimilationist** (liberal feminists / mainstream LGBTQ): win **equal rights within** existing institutions (same-sex marriage extends a heterosexual institution).
- **Liberationist** (Iris Young; radical LGBTQ): **transform the norms themselves** ("sexual citizenship"; marriage seen as patriarchal).
- Both grew from the 1960s West (**Stonewall, 1969**); the **transgender** movement now challenges the gender **binary** itself.
- Outcomes: big legal gains, not parity — women = **24% of MPs**; quotas <10 states (1980) → >100 (2010); same-sex marriage **Netherlands (2001)** → 25 countries by 2019.

## Cases & examples

Each identity type gets a case; each below: *what it shows → the concept*.

- **Northern Ireland — Good Friday Agreement (1998).** With neither unionists nor nationalists able to win, the 1998 deal built a **consociational** system: NI stays British, power devolves to a PR-elected assembly, first/deputy-first ministers shared, every member labels as unionist/nationalist/other. It has collapsed repeatedly (2002–07; since 2017). → *Consociationalism/power-sharing — ends the violence but doesn't erase the division.*
- **Nationalism in Germany.** Germany ran a **strictly cultural** nationalism (**jus sanguinis**, codified 1913), auto-granting citizenship to ethnic Germans while denying it to German-born children of ~3m Turkish "**guest workers.**" A **2000** reform opened **jus soli** (birth + residence + language); still **>40% of Turkish residents remain non-citizens**. Merkel's ~500k+ Syrian refugees (2015) revived the fight — the far-right **AfD** won 12.6% and 94 seats (2017). → *Cultural vs civic nationalism; immigration and who counts as "the nation."*
- **Ethnicity in Nigeria.** ~400 languages; the big three (**Hausa, Yoruba, Igbo**) were **constructed in the 20th century** ("Igbo" first appears in 1930s documents). A 1966 coup → anti-Igbo pogroms → **Biafra (civil war 1967–70, >1m dead)**. Nigeria then used **centripetal rules** (parties must be national; the president must win ≥25% in two-thirds of states; north/south rotation). → *Constructed/modern ethnicity + the centripetal approach + oil conflict.*
- **Racial politics in the USA** *(most detailed case)*. Race was **legally constructed** (one-drop → 1/32 under Jim Crow); "white" meant "not black," and the Irish/Italians/Jews only slowly "became white"; "**Asian American**"/"**Hispanic**" were coined in the 1960s. Persistent gaps: white wealth **>6×** black/Hispanic; **~⅓ of black men** touch the justice system. From **Obama (2008)** to **Trump (2016)** — where **racial resentment, not economics, best predicted the Trump vote** (Sides/Tesler/Vavreck). → *Social construction of race, external imposition + power, and white backlash.*
- **Class politics in the UK.** Britain openly *recognises* class; unions built their **own party (Labour, 1900)** and peaked at **just over half the workforce unionised in 1979**, before the "winter of discontent" brought **Thatcher**, who broke union power; Blair's Labour moved to the centre. The working class shrank and many backed **Brexit**. → *Objective-vs-constructed class and the **decline of class salience** — mobilisation shifted from class to nation.*
- **Secularism in India.** A plural, devout society (>80% Hindu, ~13% Muslim) built on "**principled distance**" — the state treats groups *differently*, giving Muslims more autonomy over **personal law**. **Shah Bano (1986):** the Court granted a divorced Muslim woman maintenance, then Parliament **reversed it** to restore Muslim personal law (communal rights beat individual equality). **Gujarat 2002:** ~2,000 Muslims killed. Modi/BJP push **Hindutva** against official secularism. → *Principled-distance secularism; autonomy vs uniform citizenship, fought through women's rights.*
- **Women in Iran.** A contradiction of **social gains but political/cultural repression**: Khomeini's regime mandated the hijab and stripped divorce rights, yet **1979→2002 female literacy rose 31%→69%, fertility**

**fell 6.5→2.7, and women became 60% of university students** — while holding ~2% of top posts. **Islamic feminists** claim *ijtihad* (the right to interpret texts); anti-veil protests since 2017. → *Social vs political gains; secular **and** Islamic feminism; gains are reversible under conservative rule.*

- **LGBTQ rights in Brazil.** Ended anti-sodomy law very early (**1823**), hosts the world's largest pride parade, yet is the **largest Catholic country** and elected the anti-gay **Bolsonaro (2018)**. Courts (not the legislature) delivered **civil unions (2011) and same-sex marriage (2013)** via the constitution's anti-discrimination clause — but Brazil **leads the world in transgender murders**. → *LGBTQ rights in a new democracy — real court-won recognition alongside violence and religious backlash; mostly assimilationist.*

## Key terms

| Term | Meaning |
|---|---|
| Political saliency | How politically important an identity is (created, not innate) |
| Primordialism | Identities as natural/ancient/God-given |
| Constructivism | Identities as socially constructed ("imagined communities") |
| Social construction | Ongoing process by which a society defines who "we" are |
| Nation / Nationalism | Group that has/seeks a state / the desire for one |
| Ethnic group | Cultural group *not* seeking its own state |
| Cultural / civic nationalism | Unity by shared culture / by shared political beliefs |
| Jus sanguinis / jus soli | Citizenship by blood / by soil (residence) |
| Race | Group defined on perceived *physical* markers, by external imposition |
| Social class | Group sharing status by wealth/income/work/education |
| Consociationalism | Ease conflict by giving each group a share of central power |
| Centripetal approach | Incentivise leaders to moderate & broaden appeal |
| Autonomy / Assimilation | Partial self-rule / minorities adopt the majority culture |
| Multicultural integration | Accommodate enduring ethnocultural identities |
| Neutral state / laïcité / positive accommodation | Three forms of secularism (USA / France / Germany) |
| Assimilationist / liberationist | Equal rights within norms / transform the norms |

## Exam pointers

- Lead with **constructivism vs primordialism** and *why* the chapter picks constructivism (saliency is *made*, not given) — the full argument + comparison table is worked out under Understanding Identity.
- Frame any identity conflict with the **four demands + individual-vs-group-rights debate**, then the **consociationalism (Northern Ireland) vs centripetal (Nigeria)** toolkit *(developed under The Policy Debate)*.
- Know the **three forms of secularism** with a country each, plus India's **principled distance** *(table under Religion & the Secular State)*.
- For gender/sexuality use the **assimilationist vs liberationist** split; Iran (social vs political gains) and Brazil (court wins vs backlash) are the sharpest cases.

## ★ Fun facts & memorable details

> Sticky stats, dates and quotes from Module 2 (ch. 2 & 4) — the stuff that makes an answer land.

### Quotable lines

- "*L'état, c'est moi*" ("The state, it is me") — **Louis XIV**, on the absolutist state not yet separate from the monarch. *(ch.2)*
- "*War made the state, and the state made war.*" — **Charles Tilly**. *(ch.2)*
- "*The difference between fascism and democracy is not whether the police are called, but when.*" — on the monopoly of force. *(ch.2)*
- "*We have made Italy. Now we must make Italians.*" — **d'Azeglio**, on nations as *built*. *(ch.4)*
- Thesis of ch.4: liberalism vs communism defined the 20th century, "*but nationalism won.*"

### Striking numbers

- Europe went from **~500 sovereign entities in 1500 to ~50 states today**. *(ch.2)*
- **China built a merit bureaucracy ~1,800 years before Europe** (empire united 221 BCE). *(ch.2)*
- **Mexican cartel violence:** 75,000–100,000 killed in a decade — a direct challenge to the monopoly on force. *(ch.2)*
- **India's Partition (1947):** likely the largest migration in history, ≥1 million dead. *(ch.2)*
- US **white wealth is >6×** black/Hispanic; **~⅓ of black men** pass through the justice system. *(ch.4)*
- Union density **~35% (1985) → ~17%** today; UK unions peaked at **just over half the workforce in 1979**. *(ch.4)*
- Iran **1979→2002:** literacy 31%→69%, fertility 6.5→2.7, women 60% of university students — but ~2% of top posts. *(ch.4)*

### Memorable facts

- **Tilly's "protection racket":** the early European state is basically a protection racket — rulers sold *protection* against threats they themselves partly created, funding it by **extraction** (tax). *(lecture)*
- **Brandenburg-Prussia** became a strong state **not by winning wars** but by having to fight in a brutally **competitive** neighbourhood — the pressure forced a strong tax-and-bureaucracy machine. *(lecture)*
- **Germany** built **Europe's first welfare state** (Bismarck) as a tool to undercut socialists. *(ch.2)*
- **Japan** was the **first non-Western modern economy**; US warships forced it open in 1853; the 1945 occupation was its first lost sovereignty in **400 years**. *(ch.2)*
- **Brazil** had **more slaves than any American colony** and abolished slavery **last (1888)** — yet legalised **same-sex marriage (2013)** while leading the world in **transgender murders**. *(ch.2 & 4)*
- **ISIS** reportedly ran a **DMV** and picked up garbage more efficiently than Iraq — but still failed the "state" test on security and recognition. *(ch.2)*
- **Somaliland** works as a state but has **one embassy** and **zero recognition**. *(ch.2)*
- The far-right **AfD** (2017) was the **first far-right party in the German parliament since 1960**. *(ch.4)*
- **Stonewall (1969)** turned a tiny movement into a mass one "literally overnight." *(ch.4)*
- "**Igbo**" as a unified identity first appears in documents only in the **1930s** — ethnicity as a modern construction. *(ch.4)*

# Lecture 3: Political Regimes (FK)

**Required reading:** OD ch. 3 (*States, Citizens, and Regimes*)

**Theme of the lecture (Filip Kiil):** ch. 2 asked *what a state is*; ch. 3 asks *what kind of government rules it* — the **regime** — and sorts regimes by the **ideology** that answers **who may rule and what rights citizens get.**

**Lecture frame (FK) — the State–Regime–Citizen(–Ideology) nexus**

***Core:*** four linked concepts; the **regime** sits between the permanent **state** and the current **government**, and is classified by its **ideology**.

- **State** — the ongoing administrative apparatus (ch. 2); most enduring.
- **Regime** — the formal **+ informal** institutions defining the *type* of government; more enduring than governments, less than the state. *(US: 46 administrations, one democratic regime since 1789; Nigeria: 8 regimes.)*
- **Citizen** — a member of the political community with **rights + duties** (vs a *subject*, who has only duties/obedience).
- **Ideology** — defines the **state–citizen relationship** and is how we classify regimes — but regimes often **diverge** from their ideology (informal institutions dominate, especially in weak states).

**The V-Dem / "Regimes of the World" ladder** (Lührmann, Tannenberg & Lindberg 2018) — the modern measure the lecture uses:

| Regime | Multi-party elections? | Free & fair? | Rights + checks on the executive? |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Closed autocracy** | No | — | No |
| **Electoral autocracy** | Yes | **No** (restrictions undermine fairness) | No |
| **Electoral democracy** | Yes | **Yes** | Partial |
| **Liberal democracy** | Yes | Yes | **Yes** (rights, legal equality, checks) |

**Explaining regime *change*** (the same **Interests / Beliefs / Structures** lens from Lecture 1):

| Lens | How it explains change |
|---|---|
| **Interests** | Elites expand/restrict democracy to maximise power (democratise post-1990 for aid; **backslide** when power is threatened). |
| **Beliefs** | Democratic ideals spread in 19th–20th c.; fascism/communism caused reversals; recent **populism** erodes liberal values. |
| **Structures** | Industrialisation enabled democratisation; Cold War blocs sustained autocracy; globalisation/inequality now strain democracy. |

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## OD Ch. 3 — States, Citizens, and Regimes

**Book:** Orvis & Drogus, *Introducing Comparative Politics*, 5th ed., ch. 3.

## Chapter résumé

Examines the **state↔people** relationship as embodied in different **regimes** — the formal + informal institutions defining a *type* of government. It traces the rise of the "**citizen**" (vs "subject") and of **civil society**, presents **T.H. Marshall's** three rights of citizenship (civil, political, social), then gives the chapter's core: a **taxonomy of regime types classified by ideology** — liberal democracy, communism, fascism, modernizing authoritarianism, personalist, electoral authoritarianism, theocracy. A recurring thread: **no regime works exactly as its ideology claims** — informal institutions often matter more.

> ★ **The heart of the chapter:** a **regime** = the formal + informal institutions defining a *type* of government, classified by its **ideology**. The single axis that orders them all: **how much power goes to citizens vs. the state. Liberal democracy** (limited state, broad rights) is the benchmark; every other regime tilts power toward the state and restricts full citizenship to a select group.

**The red thread.** Read the whole chapter as answers to **one question — *how is power shared between citizens and the state?*** Liberal democracy shares it widely (limited government + Marshall's rights); communism, fascism, modernizing & electoral authoritarianism, and theocracy concentrate it (in the party / a leader / a developing elite / God), restricting full citizenship to the working class / loyal nationals / the developers / the faithful. For **every** regime type ask: **who has power, and what rights do citizens get?**

## Key concepts / "modes" to use

- **State vs regime vs government** — continuous apparatus / *type* of government / current occupants.
- **Citizen vs subject** — rights + duties vs duties only.
- **Marshall's three rights** — **civil · political · social** (the yardstick for "full" citizenship).
- **Ideology-based regime taxonomy** — the seven types (below).
- **Dahl's 8 guarantees** — the working definition of liberal democracy.
- **Formal vs informal institutions** — informal rules (patronage, factions) often explain how a regime *really* works.

## Section-by-section main points

### Citizens & civil society

***Core:*** modern politics invented the **citizen** (rights + duties) out of the **subject** (obedience only) — and full citizenship needs all three of **Marshall's rights**.

- **Citizen vs subject:** 200–300 years ago Europeans were **subjects** of absolutist monarchs (no mechanism to protect "rights"); citizenship arose as sovereignty moved from the monarch to "**the people**" (after the French Revolution people addressed each other as "*citizen*").
- **Marshall (1963) — three rights: civil** (individual freedom, fair treatment) · **political** (participation, vote) · **social** (welfare, socioeconomic equality). Full citizenship needs *enough* social equality to make civil/political equality real. **Virtually no country fully provides all three.**
- **Civil society** — organised, nongovernmental, nonviolent activity by groups larger than families/firms; impossible under absolutism, enabled by religious pluralism + capitalism.
- **Popular sovereignty** — even dictators claim to rule *on behalf of* the people (theocracy claims God willed the exception). Emerging **postnational** citizenship (EU, ICC) — but core rights still sit in the **nation-state**.

## Regimes, ideologies & citizens

*Core:* regimes are classified by **ideology**, but never match it perfectly — **informal institutions** often dominate (especially in weak states).

- Liberal democracy is the **benchmark all regimes respond to: ~90% of the world's constitutions** — including authoritarian ones — mention "democracy" (Elkins et al. 2014).

## The regime taxonomy — *memorise this (the exam core)*

*Core:* seven regime types, each defined by an ideology answering **who has power** and **what citizens get**.

| Regime | Key idea | Who has power |
|---|---|---|
| **Liberal democracy** | Individuals free with natural rights; govt must preserve **life, liberty, property** | The **legislature** (elected, removable) |
| **Communism** | Historical materialism → proletarian revolution → classless, stateless society | **Vanguard party** now; the proletariat "later" |
| **Fascism** | Organic society; the **state creates the nation**; corporatism | A **supreme leader** |
| **Modernizing authoritarianism** | *Development* needs unity, so democracy must wait | A **modern (educated) elite** |
| **Personalist regime** | Claims to modernise but is really **neopatrimonial** | An **individual ruler** |
| **Electoral authoritarianism** | Blends democratic + authoritarian legitimacy | The **ruling party** (via rigged elections) |
| **Theocracy** | Rule by **divine** authority (Islamism → sharia) | **God** (via the clergy) — not the people |

## Liberal democracy

*Core:* **liberal democracy = democracy (rule by the people) + liberalism (individual rights)** — a *limited* state that protects rights and holds free, competitive elections.

- **Roots:** liberalism arose in the 16th–17th-c. religious wars; **social contract theory** (Hobbes, Locke, Montesquieu, Rousseau). **Locke:** government is legitimate only if it preserves **life, liberty, property** (Jefferson → "pursuit of happiness"). Democracy was added later; early liberals limited citizenship to **male property owners** — expanded over the 19th–20th c.
- **Dahl's 8 guarantees** (the working definition): freedom of **association** · **expression** · right to **vote** · broad **office eligibility** · leaders' right to **compete** · alternative **information** · **free & fair elections** · institutions that make policy **depend on votes**.
- **Varieties of democracy: liberal** (political rights — UK) · **social democracy** (adds economic regulation + social rights — Sweden; a variant *within* liberal democracy) · **participatory** (direct involvement beyond voting — Switzerland).

## Communism

*Core:* **Marx's historical materialism** — economic forces drive history — predicts a proletarian revolution ending in a classless, stateless utopia; in practice it produced the **totalitarian state**.

- **Feudalism → capitalism → socialism → communism.** Liberal democracy is a "shell" for capitalism; liberal rights = "*equal rights for unequal people*."
- **Stages: socialism** = collective ownership + **dictatorship of the proletariat** (a *class* dictatorship) → eventually stateless, classless **communism** (human nature itself changes).
- **Critique:** any theory promising utopia tends toward the **totalitarian state** (Russia/Stalin case).

## Fascism

***Core:*** **antiliberal *and* anticommunist** — the **state creates and embodies the nation**; the individual exists only for the state; citizens have **duties, not rights**.

- **Organic** conception of society; a **supreme leader** embodies the nation. **Corporatism:** one state-controlled organisation per sector (one union, one business association). Rejects rationality/materialism → glorifies struggle & war → **totalitarian** (Nazi Germany case).

## Modernizing authoritarianism

***Core:*** legitimacy through **development, not rights** — a **modern elite** must guide progress, and democracy would only interfere.

- **Technocratic legitimacy** rooted in **modernization theory** (postcolonial states must follow the West's path). **Four institutional forms: one-party** (civilian; postcolonial Africa/Asia — Tanzania) · **military** (coup — Brazil) · **bureaucratic-authoritarian** · **personalist**.

## Personalist regimes

***Core:*** in the **weakest states**, one leader captures everything — even the party/military that raised him — via **neopatrimonial** patron–client loyalty rather than institutions.

- Weak, unstable, unpredictable; rule of law inconsistent. Most common in Africa (Mobutu, Marcos, Abacha/Nigeria).

## Electoral authoritarianism (hybrid)

***Core:*** a **hybrid** — real opposition and elections *exist*, but the ruling party **manipulates the rules** so it never actually loses; it **proclaims itself democratic.**

- Blends liberal-democratic (elections) + modernizing-authoritarian (limits for "stability/development") legitimacy. Spread after the Cold War because open authoritarianism lost international legitimacy (Mexico/PRI case).

## Theocracy

***Core:*** **rule by religious authorities on behalf of God** — so ultimate sovereignty is **Allah's, not the people's.**

- **Islamism** (a 19th–20th-c. reaction to Western imperialism, *not* traditional): sharia should be the basis of government. Key terms: **sharia** (law) · **ijtihad** (individual interpretation) vs **taqlid** (blind acceptance) · **shura** (consultation — the opening for quasi-democracy) · **umma** (community) · **jihad** (three kinds: inner struggle [most important] → righting injustice → armed defence [least]). Iran is the world's **only true theocracy** (Iran case).

## Cases & examples

**Why these cases are here — circle them back.** Each country is a **worked example of one regime type**; read every case for **(1) which type · (2) who has power · (3) what rights citizens get.** The table maps case → type; the write-ups tell the story.

| Case | Regime type | Who has power | Freedom House |
|---|---|---|---|
| UK | Liberal democracy | Parliament (sovereign) | Free |
| Russia/USSR | Communism → (now electoral authoritarian) | Vanguard party / Stalin | Not Free |
| Germany (Nazi) | Fascism | A supreme leader | *(Free today)* |
| Brazil | Modernizing authoritarian (military) | Technocratic military elite | Free (today) |
| Nigeria (Abacha) | Personalist | One ruler (neopatrimonial) | Partly Free |
| Mexico (PRI) | Electoral authoritarian | The ruling party | Partly Free |
| Iran | Theocracy | God (via the clergy) | Not Free |
| Tanzania | Modernizing authoritarian (one-party) | A single party | — |

- **United Kingdom — "cradle of democracy."** Liberal democracy evolved **gradually, with no single written constitution** and no revolutionary break from monarchy: **Magna Carta (1215) → Glorious Revolution (1688) → Bill of Rights (1689)**; the franchise expanded only under pressure (1832 middle class ~7%; women's suffrage **1918**); recent **devolution (1997)**, a standalone **Supreme Court (2005)**. → *The first liberal democracy; power rests on **parliamentary sovereignty** (a powerful informal institution) + the slow build-up of all three Marshall rights.*
- **Russia/USSR — the first "communist" regime.** Revolution came in the "wrong country" (agrarian, not advanced-capitalist). **Lenin** added the **vanguard party** and led the **October Revolution 1917**; **Stalin** built a **totalitarian state** (rapid industrialisation, **2–20 million deaths**); **Gorbachev's** reforms → collapse **Dec 1991** into 15 states. → *Communism in practice = the totalitarian state; the regime diverged wildly from Marx's theory (Marx→Lenin→Stalin).*
- **Germany — the rise of the Nazis (fascism).** Hitler was **elected, not a coup** — the Nazis won **37% (1932)** amid depression; the **Reichstag fire (1933)** → Enabling Act → dictatorship; unions replaced by a party-controlled front (corporatism); Nazism fused fascism with **racism** → the **Holocaust (~6m Jews)**. → *Fascism + totalitarian state; its horror **delegitimised fascism globally**, though **neofascism** persists (Le Pen's National Front — 2nd in France's 2002 presidential race).*
- **Brazil — a military modernizing-authoritarian regime (1964–85).** A US-backed coup installed a **technocratic military** elite that staked legitimacy on **development + anticommunism** (National Security Doctrine); state-led industry produced the "**Brazilian Miracle**" **(1967–73)** but rising inequality. When growth stalled, unions + the Church revived civil society → **democracy restored 1985**. → *Modernizing authoritarianism in military form — legitimacy = development, so no growth = no legitimacy.*
- **Nigeria — Abacha's personalist regime (1993–98).** After the military annulled the **1993 election**, **General Abacha** seized power, gutted the courts, jailed/killed opponents (hanged poet **Ken Saro-Wiwa**), and **looted ~$3 billion** — ruling by **neopatrimonial** oil patronage. His **sudden death (1998)** ended it; wary officers delivered the **democracy in place since 1999**. → *Personalist regime — a weak state's institutions crumble around one man.*

- **Mexico — the PRI (electoral authoritarianism).** The **PRI** ruled **~71 years** via regular *but rigged* elections — a **democratic veneer** over **clientelism, corporatism and fraud** (Tlatelolco Massacre **1968**), with power rotated among factions and presidents limited to one **sexenio**. Erosion (contested **1988**) → **Vicente Fox (PAN) broke the monopoly in 2000**. → *The classic hybrid regime — informal institutions (clientelism, fraud) dominate the formal democratic shell.*
- **Iran — the Islamic Republic (theocracy). Khomeini's 1979 revolution** built the first modern theocracy: a **Supreme Leader** (a cleric with veto power) + a **Guardian Council (12 clergy)** vetting all candidates/laws, *above* an elected president & parliament (**Majlis**). The **1979 constitution** makes **Allah sovereign** and sharia the sole law. → *Theocracy — permanent tension between **theocratic authority** and **quasi-democratic** elements (shura/elections).*
- **Tanzania — Nyerere's one-party regime. Julius Nyerere** ("Africa's philosopher-king") justified a **one-party** state by claiming Africa lacked class divisions; his **ujamaa** "African socialism" ruined agriculture but achieved **near-universal literacy**; he **voluntarily resigned (1985)**. → *Civilian **one-party** modernizing authoritarianism — the "development vs democracy" trade-off.*

## Key terms

| Term | Meaning |
|---|---|
| Regime | Formal + informal institutions defining a *type* of government |
| Citizen / Subject | Member with rights + duties / person with duties (obedience) only |
| Civil / Political / Social rights | Marshall's three: freedom & fair treatment / participation / welfare & equality |
| Civil society | Organised nongovernmental, nonviolent activity beyond family/firm |
| Social contract theory | Legitimate govt = free individuals contracting to be governed |
| Liberal democracy | Democracy + liberalism; Dahl's 8 guarantees |
| Social / Participatory democracy | Adds social rights & economic control / adds direct participation |
| Parliamentary sovereignty | Parliament is supreme (UK) |
| Historical materialism | Material/economic forces drive history (Marxism) |
| Dictatorship of the proletariat | First communist stage: rule by the working class |
| Totalitarian state | Controls ~all of society, eliminates civil society |
| Vanguard party | Lenin: elite party leading the proletariat |
| Corporatism | One state-controlled organisation per social sector |
| Modernizing authoritarianism | Legitimacy from "development" by a modern elite |
| Technocratic legitimacy | Right to rule based on expertise |
| Personalist regime / Neopatrimonial | One ruler dominates / power via personal patron–client loyalty |
| Electoral authoritarianism | Hybrid: opposition + elections, but rigged |
| Theocracy / Islamism | Rule by religious authority / sharia as the basis of government |

### Exam pointers

- Nail the **state / regime / government / citizen** distinctions + **Marshall's three rights** (civil/political/social) — the framing for any answer.
- Reproduce the **seven-type regime taxonomy** (key idea + **who has power**) — and answer everything through the red thread: *how is power shared between citizens and the state?*
- Define **liberal democracy via Dahl's 8 guarantees** + the **three varieties** (liberal/social/participatory).
- Distinguish the **authoritarian types** with a case each: communism (Russia) · fascism (Germany) · modernizing (Brazil/Tanzania) · personalist (Nigeria) · electoral authoritarian (Mexico) · theocracy (Iran).
- Use the **V-Dem ladder** (closed autocracy → electoral autocracy → electoral democracy → liberal democracy) and the **Interests/Beliefs/Structures** lens to discuss *regime change*.

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## ★ Fun facts & memorable details

> Sticky stats, dates & quotes from Lecture 3 (regimes).

#### Quotable lines

- Mussolini: "*The State is all-embracing; outside of it no human or spiritual values can exist*" — and he openly embraced the label "**totalitarian.**"
- Marx: communism is "*a spectre haunting Europe*" (*Communist Manifesto*, 1848); liberal rights = "*equal rights for unequal people.*"
- Nyerere: "*When a village of a hundred people have sat and talked together until they agreed where a well should be dug, they have practised democracy.*"
- Locke's core liberties = "**life, liberty and property**" → Jefferson's "**life, liberty and the pursuit of happiness.**"

#### Striking numbers

- **~90%** of the world's constitutions — including authoritarian ones — mention "democracy."
- **Dahl** = **8** guarantees of liberal democracy.
- Deaths under **Stalin**: estimated **2–20 million**; USSR dissolved **Dec 1991** into **15** states.
- Hitler's Nazis won **37% (1932)** and he was **elected** chancellor — not a coup; **~6 million** Jews killed.
- The **PRI** ruled **71 years**, winning **98% of local/congressional elections 1946–73** (and **98.7%** of the 1976 presidential vote).
- Iran's **Guardian Council = 12 clergy**; Iran is nearly all **Shiite**, though Sunnis are **~85%** of the world's Muslims.

#### Memorable facts

- The US has had **46 administrations but one regime** (since 1789); **Nigeria has had 8 regimes**.
- "**Kremlinology**" — analysts inferred Soviet power from who stood closest to the leader at parades.
- **Abacha** (Nigeria) looted ~**$3 billion** and hanged the poet **Ken Saro-Wiwa**.
- Le Pen's **National Front** came **2nd in France's 2002 presidential election** — neofascism didn't die with 1945.
- The **three jihads**: inner struggle (most important) → righting injustice in the *umma* → armed defence (least important) — the reverse of the popular Western image.

# Lecture 4: Systems of Government

**Required reading:** OD ch. 5 (*Governing Institutions in Democracies*)

**Theme of the lecture:** the **various elements of states and systems of government** — the different types of **executive and legislative systems**, focusing in particular on **parliamentarism vs. presidentialism**.

**Lecture frame (FK).** *Why it matters:* the institutional set-up **shapes policy** with big downstream consequences for people and businesses, and explains **why democracies function so differently** (US flashpoints the lecture cites: **Citizens United**, **Roe v. Wade**, the **filibuster**). Everything below runs on Lijphart's **majoritarian ↔ consensus** framing + Tsebelis's **veto players**.

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## OD Ch. 5 — Governing Institutions in Democracies

**Book:** Orvis & Drogus, *Introducing Comparative Politics*, 5th ed., ch. 5.

### Chapter résumé

How democracies organise their governing institutions — **executive, legislature, judiciary, bureaucracy**, and the **national↔subnational** split — and why the same rules on paper produce different outcomes depending on **context** (party number/discipline, institutionalisation). The organising claim: **the executive–legislative relationship "more than anything else distinguishes different kinds of democracies,"** giving three models — **parliamentarism** (fusion, Westminster), **presidentialism** (separation, US), and **semi-presidentialism** (dual executive, France/Russia) — judged on **accountability, effective policymaking, and stability**. It sits all this on Lijphart's **majoritarian ↔ consensus** continuum (few vs many **veto players**), then covers judicial review, bureaucracy (the principal–agent problem), and **federal vs unitary** systems.

> ★ **The heart of the chapter:** the **executive–legislative relationship** is what most distinguishes democracies — **parliamentary** (powers *fused*), **presidential** (powers *separated*), or **semi-presidential** (executive *split*). Each is a different answer to **how executive power is chosen, checked, and removed** — trading off **accountability, effective policymaking and stability.**

**The red thread.** Everything hangs on one question: **how is executive power organised and held accountable?** Place each system on Lijphart's **majoritarian ↔ consensus** line (few ↔ many **veto players**): Westminster parliamentarism = most majoritarian (power concentrated, clear vertical accountability, weak horizontal check); US presidentialism = built-in separation/veto players (strong horizontal check, gridlock-prone). For any case ask: **how is the executive chosen · how is it removed · how many veto players · what's the accountability/efficiency/stability trade-off?**

### Key concepts / "modes" to use

- **Executive** split into **head of state** (symbolic, represents the country) vs **head of government** (runs policy).
- **The three systems: parliamentary** (fusion) · **presidential** (separation) · **semi-presidential** (split executive).

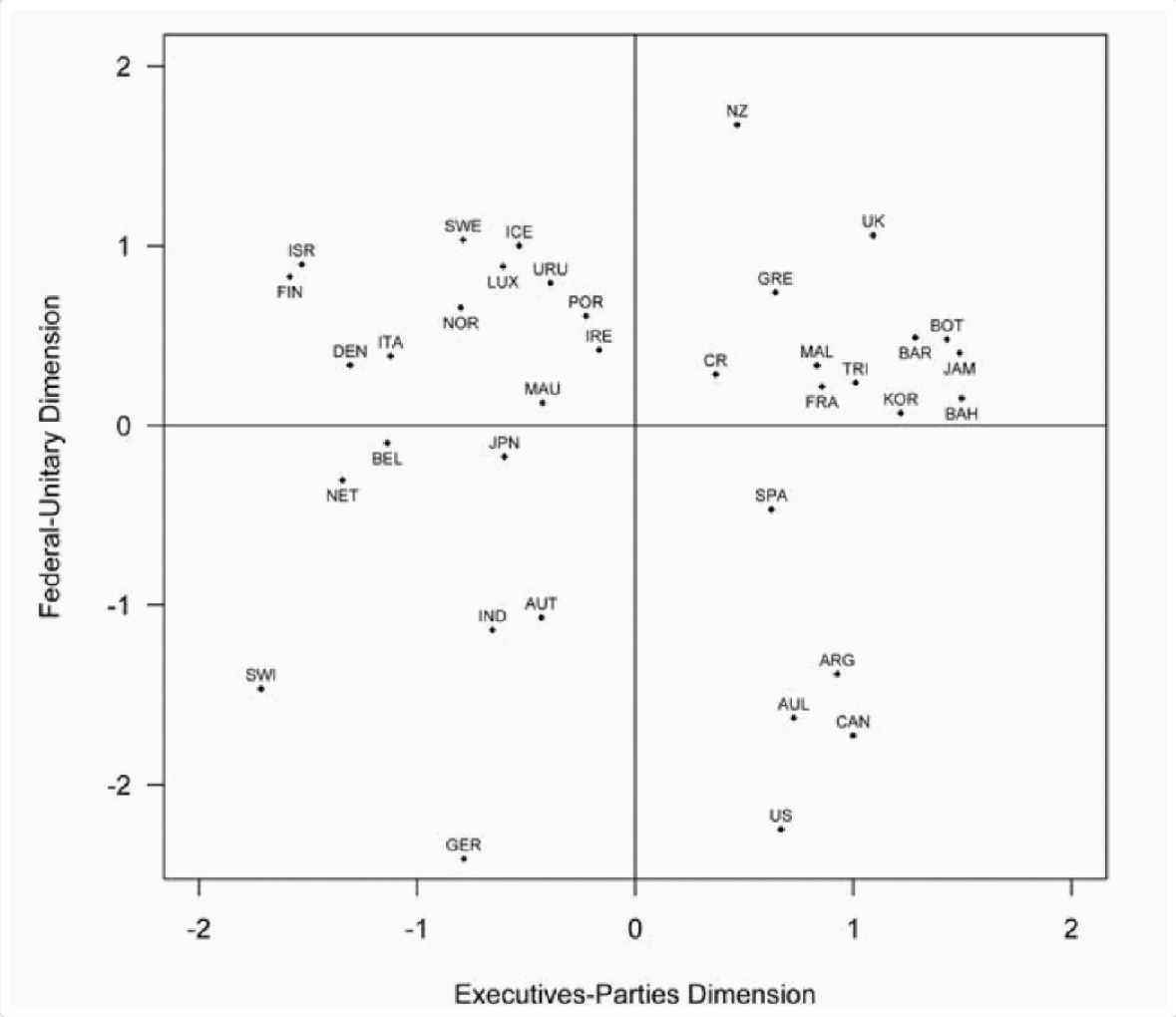
- **Majoritarian ↔ consensus democracy** (Lijphart) + **veto players** (Tsebelis) — the master frame.
- **Vertical vs horizontal accountability** (O'Donnell) — citizens→state vs state→state.
- **Judicial review** (+ common vs code law) · **principal–agent problem** (bureaucracy) · **federal vs unitary**.
- **The stability debate:** Linz's "*Perils of Presidentialism*."

## Section-by-section main points

### The framing — majoritarian vs consensus, and accountability

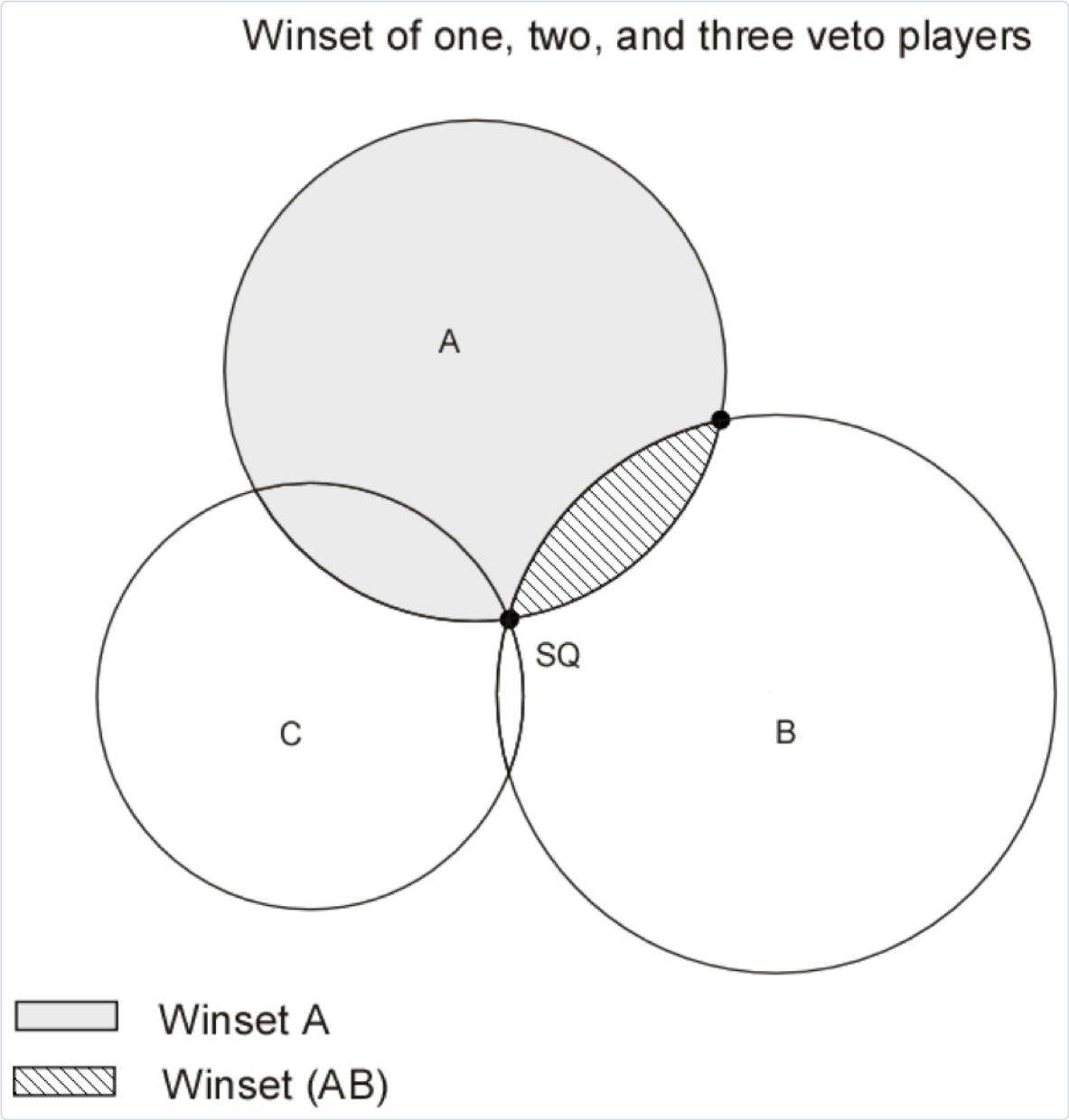
*Core:* institutions differ by **how much they concentrate vs disperse power** — Lijphart's majoritarian↔consensus line, measured by the number of **veto players**.

- **Majoritarian** (UK): single-party executive, executive dominates the legislature, unicameral, easily amended constitution → **few veto players**. **Consensus** (US/Germany): coalition executives, executive–legislative balance, bicameral, rigid constitution → **many veto players**.
- **Veto player** (Tsebelis): any actor whose agreement is needed to change policy — more of them (+ greater ideological distance) = less policy change.
- **Accountability** (O'Donnell): **vertical** = citizens hold the state accountable (elections, ch. 6); **horizontal** = state institutions check each other (this chapter). Only the **executive** is essential to all states; legislature + judiciary exist to *limit* it.




**How to read it (Lijphart).** Every democracy is a *point* on two axes. **Horizontal = Executives–Parties**: left = **consensus** (coalitions, many parties, balanced exec–legislature), right = **majoritarian** (single-party rule,

concentrated power). **Vertical = Federal–Unitary**: top = **federal/decentralised**, bottom = **unitary/centralised**. So the **UK** sits far right (pure majoritarian) but mid-high; the **US** sits right *and* very federal (bottom-right); **Switzerland/Germany** sit consensus + federal (bottom-left). The point: "majoritarian vs consensus" isn't one switch but a *position*, and the two dimensions vary independently.




**How to read it (Tsebelis, veto players).** Each circle = one veto player's set of policies it prefers to the **status quo (SQ)**. A new policy can only pass if it lies inside *every* player's circle — the **overlap (winset)**. With one player the winset is huge (all of A); add player B and it shrinks to the small hatched sliver (AB); add C and it can vanish. **More veto players (and more ideological distance between them) → smaller winset → less policy change / gridlock** — the mechanism behind presidential gridlock and "stable" consensus systems.

> ★ **Why the majoritarian/PR choice matters for redistribution** (Iversen & Soskice 2006 — from the deck): with three classes (lower/middle/upper), in a **proportional** system the **middle class sides with the lower class** to redistribute from the rich → **bigger welfare states**; in a **majoritarian** system the middle class sides with the **upper class** to avoid heavy taxes from the poor → **less redistribution**. This is a big reason PR democracies redistribute more — a bridge to Lecture 5, and it helps explain the Sweden vs US welfare puzzle.

## Executives & legislatures

***Core:*** the executive fills two roles — **head of state** (symbolic) and **head of government** (policy) — and *how those relate to the legislature* defines the three systems.

- One person can hold both roles (US president) or they can be split (UK monarch + PM). The **executive–legislative relationship** is the key variable.
- **Legislatures: unicameral** (one house) vs **bicameral** (two — the upper house usually represents states/regions; standard in federal systems). Legislatures are *more powerful in presidential systems* than in parliamentary ones — because of **separation of powers, a legislator can't also sit in the cabinet**, so members have **no ministerial promotion to earn from the executive** and stay independent. *(In a parliamentary system, ministers ARE MPs, so ambitious MPs toe the party line to be promoted into the cabinet → a weaker, executive-dependent legislature. Note: this is about chasing **cabinet (minister) posts**, not re-election to one's own seat — every legislator chases that.)*

## Parliamentarism — the Westminster model *(most emphasised)*

***Core:*** executive and legislature are **fused** — parliament elects the chief executive (**PM**), who is *both* the majority-party leader *and* a sitting legislator. The purest **majoritarian** form.

- **PM is not directly elected:** citizens vote for parliament; the majority names the PM (in practice you know each party's candidate). A **ceremonial head of state** (monarch, or an esteemed elected "president") stays out of politics.
- **Removal = vote of no confidence** → PM resigns (party picks a new leader) *or* asks the head of state to call **new elections**; PM can also **dissolve** parliament. Usually **no fixed terms**. (No-confidence votes succeed only ~5% of the time but signal weakness.)
- **Power depends on the party system:** a disciplined single majority makes the PM "*the most powerful democratic executive in the world*" (legislation passes almost automatically). **No majority → coalition government**, small parties become **veto players**, stability drops (Sweden 2018: 133 days to form a government).
- **Cabinet** of ministers (must be MPs); in coalitions the PM must share out "portfolios" — the cabinet is the main policy-bargaining site and a check on the PM.

## Presidentialism — the separation of powers

***Core:*** executive and legislature are **elected separately with separate powers** (**separation of powers**, Montesquieu). The defining feature is *separation*, not that one person is both head of state & government.

- **President is directly elected** and serves a **fixed term**; branches generally **can't remove each other** (only a hard **impeachment**). This builds in **institutional veto players** — lawmaking needs *both* president and legislative majority → checks & balances, but **gridlock** (esp. under divided government).
- **Cabinet** is freely appointed (often non-legislators, any party), subject to legislative consent — but it's a **less important** body than in parliamentary systems. The **legislature is typically more powerful** than in parliamentary systems.
- **Coalitional presidentialism:** with fragmented legislatures the president must build an informal party coalition and act "a little like a PM" (**Brazil** is the classic case).

## Semi-presidentialism — the hybrid

***Core:*** executive power is **split** between a **directly elected president** (head of state, with real powers) and a **PM** (head of government, backed by the parliamentary majority, appointed by the president, removable by no-confidence).

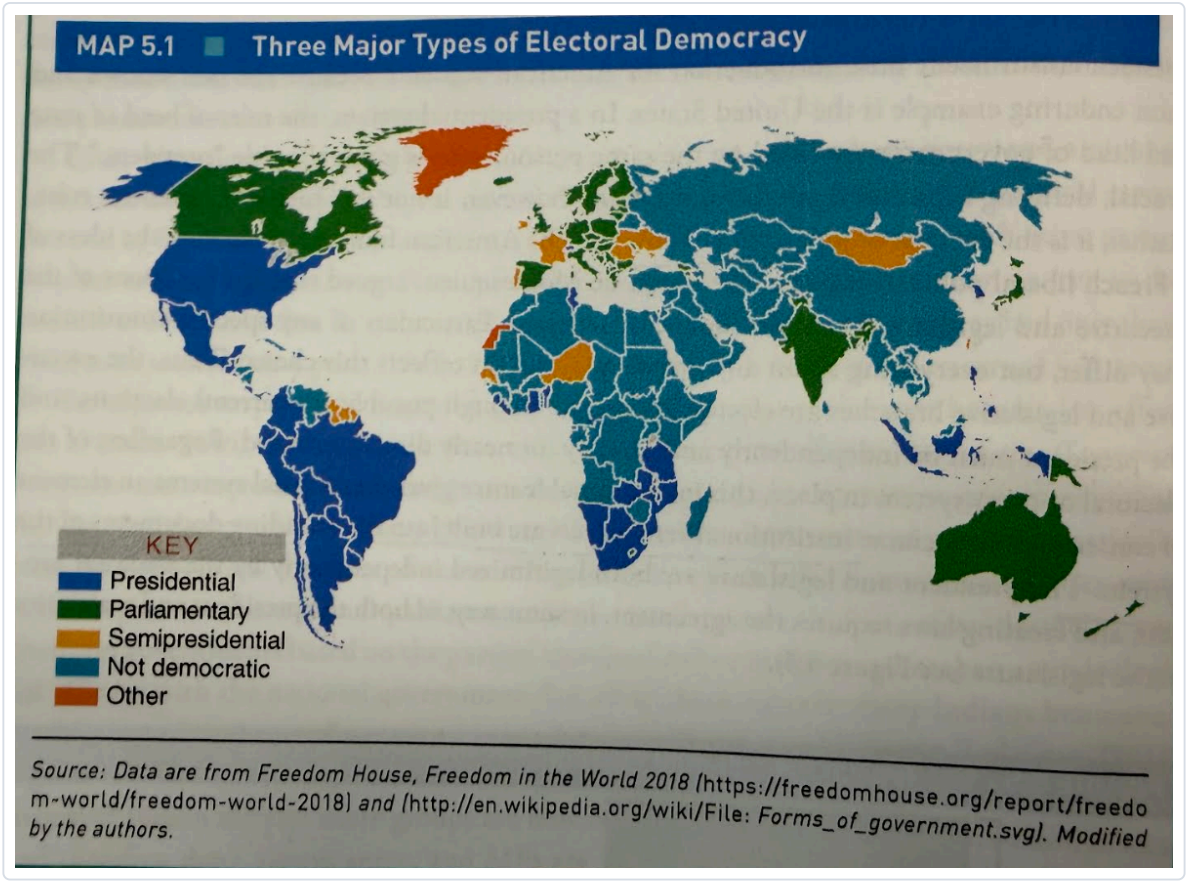
- Legislation needs the president's signature **and** PM/majority support; the powers must be **clearly divided** (often unclear in practice). Originated in **France, 1958 (de Gaulle)**.
- **Cohabitation:** president and legislative majority from **different parties** → president appoints an opposing-party PM (French norm: president runs foreign policy, PM runs domestic). Limits presidential power but can cause gridlock.
- **Elgie's key question:** *can the president dismiss the PM?* If **yes** → unstable, democracy endangered (**Russia**); if **no** → more power-sharing, no less stable than parliamentarism.

## ★ The core comparison — parliamentary vs presidential vs semi-presidential

***Core:*** learn this table cold — it's the centre of the lecture and the exam.

| Feature | Parliamentary | Presidential | Semi-presidential |
|---|---|---|---|
| Powers | **Fused** (exec from legislature) | **Separated** (elected independently) | **Split** executive (pres + PM) |
| Head of state / govt | Separate (monarch/ceremonial pres + **PM**) | **Same person** (president) | President (HoS, real powers) + **PM** (HoG) |
| Executive chosen by | **Parliament** (majority names PM) | **Directly elected** | President directly elected; PM by parliament |
| Terms | Usually **no fixed term** | **Fixed term** | Fixed presidential term; PM depends on parliament |
| How executive is removed | **Vote of no confidence** (+ PM can dissolve parliament) | Only **impeachment** (hard) | PM by no-confidence; president fixed |
| Veto players | **Few** (majoritarian) | **Built-in** (pres + legislature) | Depends (cohabitation adds them) |
| Classic cases | **UK, Germany, India** | **USA, Brazil** | **France, Russia** |

- **Accountability:** parliamentarism = clearest **vertical** (voters know whom to blame) but weak **horizontal** under a single majority; presidentialism = strong **horizontal** (separation) but can hurt policymaking.
- **Policymaking (Samuels):** presidential systems **change the status quo less** and more slowly. *Illustration:* **Thatcher (UK) reshaped economic policy far more than Reagan (US)** despite similar aims — she had a compliant majority; he faced a Democratic Congress.




**How to read it (OD Map 5.1 — three types of electoral democracy).** Colour = a country's system: **blue = presidential** (note how it dominates the **Americas** — the US model spread across Latin America), **green = parliamentary** (most of Europe and the former British Commonwealth), **yellow = semi-presidential** (France and a scatter of others), teal = not democratic, orange = other. The visual take-away: the three systems aren't evenly spread — they cluster by **colonial/constitutional heritage**, which is why the same "choice" of system is really a legacy.

## The stability debate — Linz's "Perils of Presidentialism"

***Core:*** **Linz (1990):** presidentialism is more crisis-prone because of three flaws; but critics say the *society*, not the institution, is the real problem.

- **Linz's three perils:** ① **dual legitimacy** (two independently elected branches, no democratic tie-breaker) · ② **winner-take-all** presidents over-read their mandate and won't compromise · ③ **inflexible fixed terms** (a failing president can't be removed). Danger peaks for *new* democracies under **coalitional presidentialism** (small presidential party + fragmented legislature).
- **Counter (Cheibub 2007):** presidential systems just "*tend to exist in societies where democracies of any type are likely to be unstable.*" Semi-presidentialism is empirically **no less stable than parliamentarism** — *if* the president can't override the legislature or sack the PM.

## Judiciary

***Core:*** courts interpret law and, via **judicial review**, can strike laws as unconstitutional — making them a **veto player** and a check on the majority (the "why should unelected judges decide?" problem). Only real if **institutionalised**.

- **Two legal families → two review types: common law** (Britain + colonies incl. US; judges follow **precedent**) → **decentralised + concrete** review (*any* court can rule on constitutionality, but only inside a real case); **code law** (Roman/Napoleon; written code only, precedent ignored; French/Iberian colonies) → **centralised + abstract** review (one special **constitutional court**, which can rule on a law in the abstract).




**How to read it (OD Map 5.2 — common vs code law). Blue = common law** (Britain and its former colonies — US, Canada, India, Australia): judge-made law built on **precedent** → *decentralised, concrete* review. **Green = code/civil law** (continental Europe and its colonial reach across Latin America and Africa): a written **code** is supreme, precedent ignored → *centralised, abstract* review by one constitutional court. **Teal = mixed.** Like Map 5.1, the pattern tracks **colonial heritage** — which legal family a country inherited still shapes how (and by whom) laws get reviewed today.

- **Why let unelected judges override elected majorities?** Defenders: legislatures aren't perfectly representative either; judges are *appointed by elected officials* (Dahl 1957: justices sit within the ruling coalition); courts check the other branches and *claim* to protect minorities (though studies find they more often side with the powerful).
- "**Judicialisation of politics**" (Tate & Vallinder) — courts pulled into ever more political questions; "one of the most significant trends" of recent government, as many actors turn courts into a **veto point**.
- **Independence depends on informal factors + legitimacy:** a **fragmented, competitive** political system gives courts room; judges' own beliefs matter; and because courts command neither army nor purse, hard-won **legitimacy** is what makes review real. *Example:* **Brazil's Supreme Federal Tribunal (STF)** grew confident enough to help impeach presidents and drove the *Lava Jato* anti-corruption probe — but code-law **abstract review** lets ~**70,000 cases/year** flood in (≈90% decided by a single judge), making it a clogged **veto point**.

## Bureaucracy

***Core:*** every state needs a merit-based, law-bound bureaucracy — but unelected officials with expertise create a **principal–agent problem** (agents pursue their own interests → inefficiency or corruption).

- **Professionalisation** (merit appointment) replaced **patronage** and gives bureaucrats **expertise = their own independent power** — which is exactly what creates the principal–agent gap (agents may expand budgets/turf, or take bribes).
- **Iron triangle** — a cosy, closed policy loop of **bureaucrats + legislators + business** in one sector that serves the insiders and keeps everyone else out (see the Japan case: iron triangles + *amakudari*).
- Controls: **political appointees** (US ~6–8 per department; UK ~2 per ministry), specific legislation, **legislative oversight** (committees, hearings, budgets), courts — none perfect. **New Public Management (NPM)** (Reagan/Thatcher, 1980s): privatise, add competition, "customer satisfaction," flatten hierarchies — a UK 30-year study found a **1/3 staff cut but slightly *higher* costs and slightly *worse*, less-fair service.**
- **Corruption:** two types — **bribery** + **rent-seeking** (using regulation for advantage instead of being productive); worse in **more-regulated, more-unequal** economies (rational-choice), or from postcolonial legitimacy deficits (**Ekeh's "two publics"** in Africa: a moral *primordial* public vs an amoral *civic* one). **Majoritarian** systems (clear responsibility) let voters punish it better. **Johnston's four syndromes:** *Influence Markets* (rich democracies — US, Japan) → *Elite Cartels* (middle-income — Brazil) → *Oligarchs & Clans* (Russia) → *Official Moguls* (poorest).

## Federal vs unitary systems

***Core:*** **unitary** = the centre holds sole sovereignty (local powers delegated & revocable); **federal** = sovereignty is **constitutionally shared** with subunits — a built-in way to **limit majorities and protect minorities** (more veto players).

- **Why federate:** bring government closer (big countries); divide power (bicameral upper house + judicial review); protect ethnic/religious minorities (**Belgium** = federalism + consociationalism; **541 days** to form a government in 2010).
- Real power depends on **revenue control** and **upper-house strength**, not paper rules (strong **US Senate** vs weak German **Bundesrat**). **Symmetrical** (US) vs **asymmetrical** (special powers for some units). **Devolution** = reversible decentralisation in a unitary state (UK → Scotland/Wales/N. Ireland). Riker: federalism is inherently unstable (→ centralisation or secession).
- *Examples:* **federal** = US, Germany; **unitary** = France, UK, **Denmark**. In US federalism the **national** level holds war & foreign policy, coining money, admitting new states; **states** hold schools, public welfare, local law & order (the "**Hamilton** [federal] vs **Jefferson** [states]" division).
- **Federalism is only as real as the politics behind it** (revenue + party system, not paper): **Mexico** looked federal on paper but the **PRI** centralised everything via revenue until democratisation (2000) decentralised power to governors; **India** = *centralised* federalism (the centre can redraw state borders or impose "**President's Rule**"), decentralising since 1989 as state parties bargain in national coalitions; **Russia** = a federal **shell** — Putin gutted regional autonomy (appointing governors from 2004; centre took ~85% of revenue). Weak institutions can even preserve **subnational authoritarianism** inside a national democracy (Gibson).

## Cases & examples

**Why these cases are here — circle them back.** Each country shows **one system in practice** — and how the *same rules* give different results depending on the **party system**. Read each for: *which system · how power actually flows · the accountability/stability trade-off.*

| Case | System | What it adds |
|---|---|---|
| UK | Parliamentary (Westminster) | strongest PM — until Brexit broke party discipline |
| India | Parliamentary | same rules, different outcome via the party system |
| USA | Presidential | separation of powers → gridlock; strongest legislature |
| Brazil | Coalitional presidentialism | strong formal powers ≠ effective power (30 parties) |
| France | Semi-presidential | the classic case — cohabitation makes it work |
| Russia | Semi-presidential | dominant president → electoral authoritarianism |
| Japan | (bureaucracy) | unelected bureaucratic power (iron triangles, *amakudari*) |

- **United Kingdom — Westminster parliamentarism.** With a disciplined single majority, the PM is "*the most powerful democratic executive in the world.*" But **Brexit** shattered discipline: May's deal was crushed, parliament seized the agenda, 117 of her own MPs voted no-confidence, she resigned — and **Boris Johnson became PM via a ~160,000-member party vote, no national election**. → *Parliamentarism; the majority-party mechanism (not paper rules) drives PM power; removal via no-confidence + party replacement.*
- **India — same model, different result.** India copied Westminster almost exactly, yet outcomes track its **party system**: one-party (Congress) dominance 1947–89 made PMs *less* constrained than British ones; post-1989 **coalitions** forced constant negotiation (3 PMs in the first 30 years → 12 in the next 30). → *Identical rules → different outcomes based on party number; multipartism pushes parliamentarism toward consensus.*
- **United States — presidential separation of powers.** The Framers feared a strong executive, so the president's *formal* powers are modest (veto, appointments with Senate consent, commander-in-chief); **separation of powers + weak, polarised parties → gridlock**, the norm under divided government (Senate 60-vote rule). Contested workarounds: signing statements, executive orders. → *Presidentialism; built-in veto players; the world's most powerful legislature (Congress).*
- **Brazil — coalitional presidentialism.** The 1988 constitution gives the president **more** formal power than the US president (decrees, line-item veto, budget monopoly) — yet ~**30 fragmented parties** (Bolsonaro's own held <10% of seats) force presidents to build **9-party coalitions**, trade pork for votes (often illegally), and still face impeachment (**Dilma Rousseff, 2016**). → *Strong formal powers ≠ effective power; the instability Linz warned of.*
- **France — the classic semi-presidential case.** The **Fifth Republic (1958, de Gaulle)** invented the model: a **directly elected president** (foreign policy & defence, real power) *alongside* a **PM** answerable to the National Assembly (domestic policy). It works precisely because of **cohabitation** — when the president's party *loses* the Assembly, the president must appoint a **PM from the opposing majority** and retreat to their own domain (e.g. Mitterrand with a right-wing PM, Chirac with a left-wing PM). → *Semi-presidentialism done "right": because the president **cannot** simply dismiss the PM, the two share power and the system stays as stable as parliamentarism — the mirror image of Russia (Elgie's dividing line).*
- **Russia — semi-presidentialism gone dominant.** The 1993 constitution created an exceptionally strong presidency (appoints PM — reject the nominee 3× and the Duma is dissolved; **decrees with force of law**). **Putin** used it to turn a weak democracy into an **electoral authoritarian regime**. → *Elgie's warning: a president who can dismiss the PM at will removes the incentive to compromise and endangers democracy.*
- **Japan — bureaucratic power.** Japan's elite bureaucracy (recruited from Tokyo University law) drove the postwar boom and often *wrote* the laws, via **iron triangles** (bureaucrats–politicians–business) and ***amakudari*** ("descent from heaven" — officials taking jobs in firms they'd regulated). Scandals + stagnation

eroded it; Abe's 2014 reform tripled PM appointment control. → *The principal–agent problem: unelected officials wielding real power.*

## Key terms

| Term | Meaning |
|---|---|
| Executive / Legislature / Judiciary | Implements / makes / interprets the law |
| Head of state / Head of government | Symbolic representative / runs the government |
| Majoritarian / Consensus democracy | Power concentrated (few veto players) / dispersed (many) |
| Veto player | Actor whose agreement is needed to change policy |
| Vertical / Horizontal accountability | Citizens hold state accountable / institutions check each other |
| Parliamentarism | Exec & legislature fused; parliament elects the PM |
| Vote of no confidence | Parliament's vote to remove the PM/government |
| Presidentialism | Exec & legislature elected independently, separate powers |
| Separation of powers | Constitutional division of power among branches |
| Coalitional presidentialism | Presidential system where the president must build a party coalition |
| Semi-presidentialism | Executive split between elected president + PM |
| Cohabitation | President & PM from different parties |
| Judicial review | Courts can rule a law unconstitutional |
| Common law / Code law | Precedent-based / written-code-only |
| Principal–agent problem | Agent's self-interest may not match the principal's |
| New Public Management | 1980s reform: privatise, competition, "customer" focus |
| Unitary / Federal | Sole central sovereignty / sovereignty shared with subunits |
| Symmetrical / Asymmetrical federalism | All subunits equal / some have special powers |
| Devolution | Reversible decentralisation in a unitary state |

## Exam pointers

- Reproduce the **parliamentary vs presidential vs semi-presidential comparison** cold — powers (fused/separated/split), how the executive is **chosen** and **removed**, term length, veto players, a case each.
- Explain **parliamentarism** (fusion, PM, no-confidence, dissolution) and **presidentialism** (separation, fixed terms, impeachment, gridlock) as opposite answers to *how executive power is checked.*
- Use **Lijphart's majoritarian↔consensus** + **veto players** to place any system, and **vertical vs horizontal accountability** to evaluate it.
- Deploy **Linz's "Perils of Presidentialism"** (dual legitimacy · winner-take-all · fixed terms) *and* the Cheibub counter — the set-piece stability debate.

- Show that **rules ≠ outcomes**: UK vs India (party system) and Thatcher vs Reagan (policymaking) are the go-to illustrations.
- Know **federal vs unitary** (+ devolution) as a majority-limiting / minority-protecting device.

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## ★ Fun facts & memorable details

> Sticky stats, dates & quotes from Lecture 4 (systems of government).

**Quotable / memorable**

- Linz's famous article: "**The Perils of Presidentialism**" (1990). Cheibub's rebuttal: presidential systems "*tend to exist in societies where democracies of any type are likely to be unstable.*"
- The British PM with a solid majority is "*often called the most powerful democratic executive in the world.*"
- **Kenya (2013)** switched from a British-style **parliamentary** to a US-style **presidential** system with its new constitution — a live natural experiment.

**Striking numbers**

- **Belgium 2010:** a **world-record 541 days** to form a government; **Sweden 2018:** 133 days.
- Votes of no confidence **succeed ~5% of the time.**
- **Boris Johnson** became PM chosen by **fewer than 160,000** Conservative members — no national election.
- **India:** 3 PMs in 1947–77 → **12** in 1977–2007 (multipartism = less stability).
- **Brazil:** 30 parties in the Chamber; presidential coalitions average **9 parties**; **60% of Congress under indictment** in 2016.
- **US Senate:** representatives of just over **10%** of the population can block a bill (60-vote rule); state representation ratio ≈ **66:1**.
- **Semi-presidentialism** spread from **10 (1990) → 52 (2018)** systems; 16 are former French/Portuguese colonies.
- **Federal** countries ≈ **25**, but hold **>40% of the world's population**; 7 of the 10 largest countries by area are federal.

**Thinkers to name-drop**

- Separation of powers ← **Montesquieu** · semi-presidentialism ← **France 1958 / de Gaulle** · code law ← **Napoleon** · majoritarian/consensus ← **Lijphart** · veto players ← **Tsebelis** · vertical/horizontal accountability ← **O'Donnell** · federalism-as-bargain ← **Riker.**

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# Lecture 5: Participation and Representation (FK)

**Required reading:** OD ch. 6 (*Institutions of Participation and Representation*)

**Theme of the lecture: Why do some citizens participate while others don't? Why are some interests represented while others aren't?** We examine how different **institutions — specifically electoral and party systems — shape political participation and representation.**

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# OD Ch. 6 — Institutions of Participation and Representation

**Book:** Orvis & Drogus, *Introducing Comparative Politics*, 5th ed., ch. 6.

## Chapter résumé

Looks at the three institutions through which democracies channel **participation and representation** — **electoral systems, parties/party systems, and civil society (interest groups)** — and asks which best represent ordinary and marginalised citizens. It opens with *why anyone participates at all* (a **collective-action problem**), then its analytic core: how **electoral systems** (plurality/SMD · majoritarian · PR · mixed) convert votes into seats and thereby shape the **number of parties** (**Duverger's Law**), proportionality, stability, and the representation of women & minorities. It classifies **party systems**, surveys how parties mobilise (programmatic / clientelist / populist) amid a "crisis of party democracy," contrasts **pluralist vs neocorporatist** interest-group systems, and closes on the master **trade-off (Powell): diverse representation ⇄ clear accountability.**

> ★ **The heart of the chapter: institutions decide who participates and whose interests get represented.** The **electoral system** is the master lever — **SMD/plurality** squeezes politics toward *two parties + clear accountability but wasted votes*; **PR** opens it to *many parties + proportional, diverse representation but coalition instability* (Duverger's Law). Underneath sits one unavoidable **trade-off (Powell): broad representation ⇄ clear accountability/governability.**

**The red thread.** Two questions run through the chapter. ① **Why participate (or not)?** — voting is individually "irrational" (a collective-action problem), so *institutions* raise or lower the cost (PR & simple systems → higher turnout). ② **Whose interests get represented?** — the **electoral system → party system → interest-group system** chain decides. For any case ask: **how do votes become seats · how many parties result · who gets left out (small parties, women, minorities) · and what's traded off (representation vs accountability)?**

## Key concepts / "modes" to use

- **The electoral-system menu: SMD plurality (FPTP) · majoritarian (two-round / alternative vote) · proportional representation (PR) · mixed/semiproportional.**
- **Duverger's Law** — SMD → two parties; PR → multiparty.
- **Party systems** — dominant-party · two-party · multiparty; **sociological** (cleavages) vs **institutional** (electoral rules) origins.
- **Mobilisation types** — programmatic · patronage/clientelist · populist.
- **Interest groups: pluralism** (many, neutral state — US) vs **neocorporatism** (few peak associations bargain with the state — Germany).
- **The Powell trade-off** — representation/participation ⇄ accountability/governability.

## Section-by-section main points

**Lecture frame (FK).** The lecture opens by asking *what representation even is* (**Pitkin**), then works through the institutions that produce it — **electoral systems → party systems → civil society** — and closes with **case studies** (UK, Germany, Japan, Brazil).

## What is representation? — Pitkin's four views

***Core:*** before asking *how* institutions represent, ask *what "representation" means*. **Hanna Pitkin** (*The Concept of Representation*, 1967) distinguishes **four** senses:

- **Formalistic** — the institutional arrangement that **authorises** a representative and holds them **accountable** (elections = the "before" and "after" of representing).
- **Descriptive** — the representative **resembles** the represented (shares gender, ethnicity, class) — "**standing for**" (the case for **quotas** / descriptive representation).
- **Symbolic** — the representative **stands for** the represented symbolically (a leader/flag people identify with).
- **Substantive** — the representative **acts in the interests** of the represented — "**acting for**" (the **delegate** [follow instructions] vs **trustee** [own judgment] debate).
- *Why it matters:* the electoral systems below are really machines for producing one kind of representation or another — **PR** boosts **descriptive** representation (more women/minorities); **SMD** emphasises the **formalistic** local link.

## Why participate? — the collective-action problem

***Core:*** voting is individually "**irrational**" (Downs) — one vote rarely decides anything — so participation is a **collective-action problem** that *institutions* must overcome.

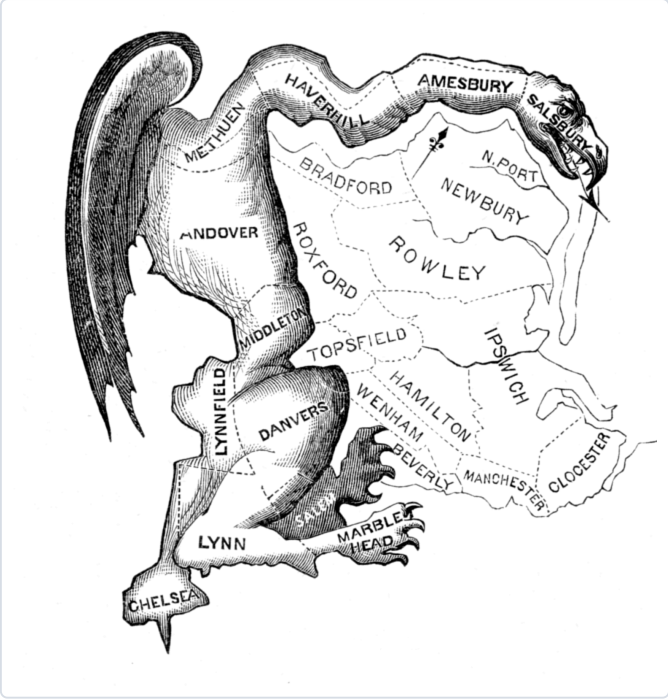
- People vote anyway for **expressive/solidaristic** reasons, charismatic leaders, and to avoid the **emotional cost** of not participating (guilt, exclusion).
- **Institutions shape turnout:** complex systems depress it among the less-educated; **PR/mixed systems raise it** (fewer "wasted votes"); parties & interest groups lower the cost of finding and acting on your interests.

## Electoral systems — *the core of the chapter* ★

***Core:*** the electoral system is the master lever — *on what basis are you represented* (a **district**, a **party/idea**, or a **group**), and *how do votes become seats?*

| System | Votes → seats | Parties (Duverger) | Proportionality | Turnout | Women/minorities | Cases |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **SMD plurality (FPTP)** | most votes in each district wins (no majority needed) | **two parties** | **low** (wasted votes) | lower | worse | UK, US, India |
| **Majoritarian** (two-round / **AV** ranked-choice) | need **50%+1** → runoff or reallocate | ~two blocs | low–medium | — | — | France |
| **Proportional (PR)** — closed/open list | seats **= vote share** (national/large districts, a **threshold**) | **multiparty** | **high** | higher | **better** | Israel, Brazil (open) |
| **Mixed / semiproportional** | SMD seats **+** party-list PR | multiparty | high (**compensatory**, Germany) / medium (**noncompensatory**, Japan) | higher | — | Germany, Japan |

- **SMD/FPTP:** *strengths* — strong voter–representative link, single-party government (efficient, accountable); defenders also invoke **virtual representation** (co-partisans elected in *other* districts speak for you). *Weaknesses* — **wasted votes**, **disproportionality** (a party can win many seats on ~35% pluralities; a broad-but-thin party wins almost none), gerrymandering, fewer women/minorities. *(Empirically the SMD "closer link" is weak — Curtice & Shively found no real advantage in voter–rep contact.)*




**How to read it (the original "Gerry-mander," 1812).** SMD only works if someone *draws the district lines* — and whoever draws them can rig outcomes. This famous cartoon mocks a Massachusetts district that Governor **Elbridge Gerry**'s party contorted into a **salamander** shape to pack/crack opponents into losing

configurations. *Gerry + salamander = "gerrymander."* It's the visual shorthand for why single-member districts are vulnerable to **manipulated boundaries** — a weakness PR (large multi-member districts) largely avoids.

- **Majoritarian — two-round runoff & the Alternative Vote.** Unlike FPTP, the winner must clear an **absolute majority (50%+1)**, so the count needs a *second step* FPTP doesn't have. Two ways to get there:
  - **Two-round system (TRS / runoff)** — *France.* **Round 1:** win outright if you get 50%+1; if not, the top candidates go to a **second-round runoff** a week or two later (top two — or in France's legislative version, *everyone above 12.5% of registered voters*), and whoever leads the runoff wins. Voters whose first choice is knocked out get to **re-choose** among those left.
  - **Alternative Vote (AV) / ranked-choice / instant-runoff** — *one ballot,* but you **rank** candidates 1-2-3… Count the 1st preferences; if nobody has 50%+1, **eliminate the last-placed candidate and transfer their ballots to each voter's next-ranked choice**; repeat until someone passes 50%. It's a runoff done "instantly" in a single election.
  - *Mini worked example (AV):* three candidates — **A 40% · B 35% · C 25%**, nobody at 50%. Eliminate **C**; C's voters' 2nd choices split (say **+18%→B, +7%→A**). New totals: **A 47% · B 53% → B wins** — even though A *led* the first count. That flip is the whole point: it rewards the **broadly acceptable** candidate over the one with the biggest *minority*.
  - *Effect:* squeezes extremes, rewards second-choice-friendly candidates, wastes fewer votes than FPTP; produces **~two blocs** but more softly than FPTP. *(Case: **Maine 2018** — first US Congress seat decided by AV; Golden won **50.5–49.5 after trailing on the first count**.)*
- **PR:** *strengths* — few wasted votes, **higher turnout**, far **more women & minorities** (lists + quotas), more information/positions, more egalitarian policy (Orellana). *Weaknesses* — no identifiable individual rep, **coalition instability**, small extremist parties gain outsized leverage; **Kedar:** PR voters even vote for *more extreme* parties on purpose, expecting post-election compromise to pull policy back to the middle.
  - **Closed vs open list — *who decides the order within a party's seats?*** Under PR you vote for a **party**, which then fills its won seats from a ranked **list of candidates**. The two variants differ in *who sets that rank*:
    - **Closed list:** the **party** fixes the order in advance; you vote only for the party, and if it wins *n* seats they go to the top *n* names on the party's list. → **more party control, party discipline, and easy use of quotas** (a party can guarantee women high spots), but voters can't pick the *individual*. *(e.g. Israel.)*
    - **Open list:** you vote for the party **and** for a **specific candidate** within it; the candidates' *own* vote totals decide who gets the party's seats. → **more voter choice over individuals**, but it makes candidates compete against their *own* party-mates → **weaker, more personalist parties.** *(e.g. Brazil — a big reason its parties are so fragmented and weak.)*
- **Mixed:** two ballots (a district candidate + a party list) — blends a personal rep with proportional fairness; **Germany's compensatory** version tops seats up to full proportionality, **Japan's noncompensatory** version keeps SMD & PR separate (less proportional). **AV/ranked-choice** wastes fewer votes than FPTP (Maine 2018 elected the first US Congress seat by AV).
  - **Is Germany still "mixed"? (2023 reform).** You can argue it's **drifting toward pure PR.** Germany's compensatory mechanism caused the Bundestag to balloon (**736 seats in 2021** via overhang + balance seats). The **2023 reform** (first used in the **2025** election) **capped the house at 630** and **abolished overhang & compensatory seats**: a party now gets **only** the seats its **second (list) vote** earns, and district winners are seated **only if their party's list vote covers them** (*Zweitstimmendeckung*) — otherwise the narrowest district winners **lose their seats** even though they won locally. So the **first vote no longer guarantees a personal representative**, and total seats are set almost entirely by the party

vote → many now call it "**personalised PR**" rather than a genuine mixed system. *(The Constitutional Court upheld the cap in 2024 but reinstated the basic-mandate/3-seat clause.)*

- **Redistribution link (Iversen & Soskice — from Lecture 4): PR → the middle class allies with the poor → bigger welfare states**; majoritarian → middle allies with the rich → less. A key reason electoral systems shape *policy*, not just seats (the Sweden vs US welfare puzzle).

**Table 1. Electoral system and the number of years with left and right governments (1945-98)**

| | | Government partisanship | | Proportion of right governments |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | Left | Right | |
| Electoral system | Proportional | 342 (8) | 120 (1) | 0.26 |
| | Majoritarian | 86 (0) | 256 (8) | 0.75 |

*Note*: Excludes centrist governments (see text below for details).

**How to read it (Iversen & Soskice).** Count the years each system spent under left vs right government (1945–98). Under **PR**, the right governed only **26%** of the time; under **majoritarian**, the right governed **75%** of the time. Same democracies, opposite tilt — hard evidence that **the electoral system biases *which* side holds power over the long run**, and hence how big the welfare state gets.

## Duverger's Law — and its limits

***Core:* SMD/plurality → two parties** (small parties get squeezed out and voters stop "wasting" votes on them); **PR → multiparty.**

- **The two mechanisms — *why* it happens (this is the heart of the law):**
  - ① **Mechanical effect** — with **one seat per district won by a plurality**, only the **top-1** converts votes → a seat. A party that comes **3rd** (or is **broad-but-thin**, spread across the country) wins **nothing** despite a real vote share → those votes are simply **wasted**. *(UKIP 2015: **12.6% of the vote → 1 seat**; SNP, geographically concentrated, fewer votes → **56 seats**.)*
  - ② **Psychological effect** — voters **know** this, so they stop "wasting" votes on no-hopers and **strategically switch** to a viable **top-2** candidate; donors and candidates desert small parties too → this **reinforces** the squeeze. **Under PR** (seats ≈ vote share) *both* pressures vanish → **multiparty survives.**
- **But not deterministic:** it holds in *established* democracies; in **new/diverse** democracies voters aren't strategic (ethnic/identity voting persists), so FPTP can still produce many parties (Moser & Scheiner) — see **India**. And it can break even in old democracies (**France 2017**: Macron's one-year-old party upended a near-two-party system).

## Party systems

***Core:*** classify a system by the **number & relative strength** of parties. First, *what parties are for*; then the three types; then where they come from.

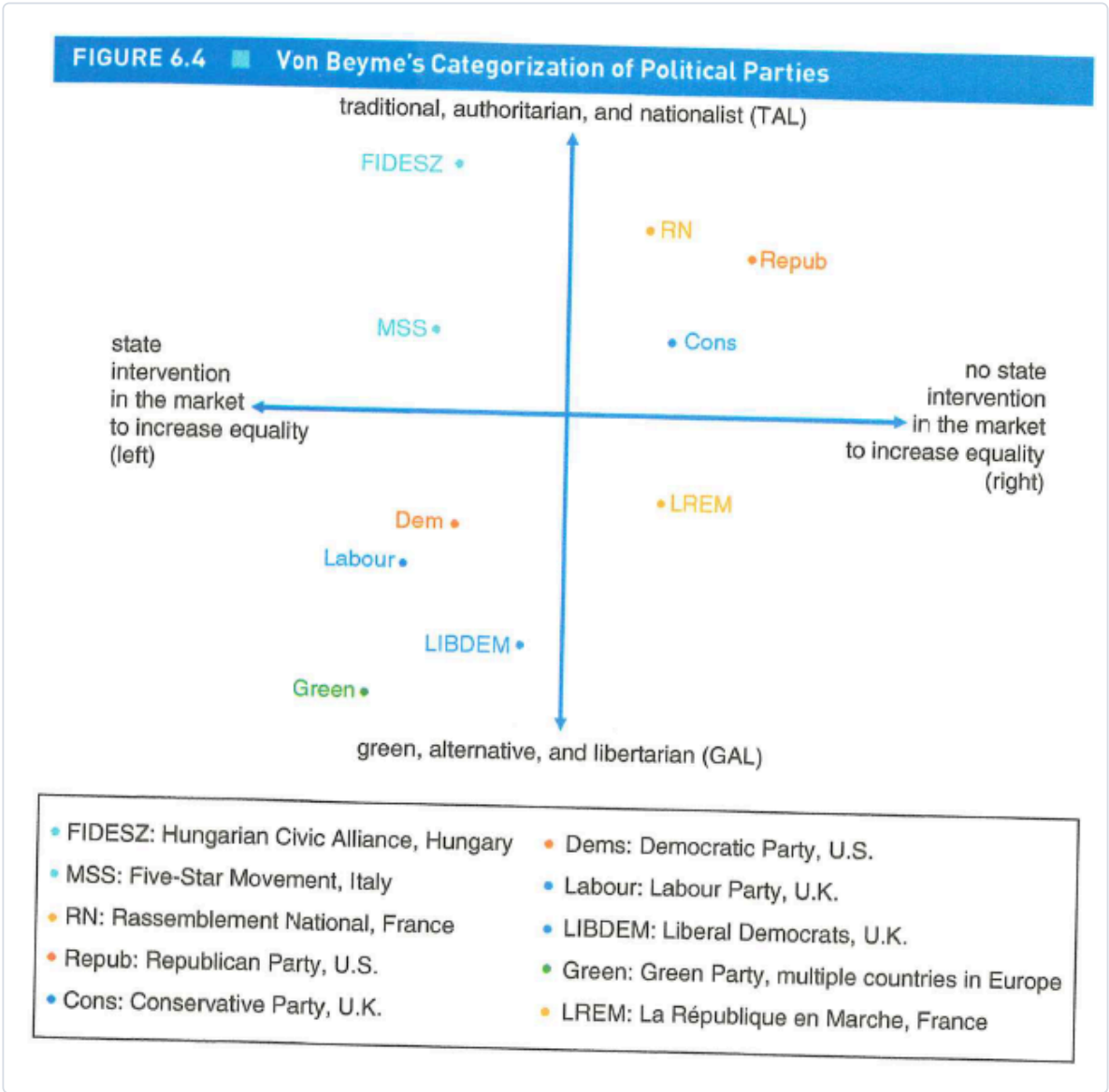
- **What parties do — five functions (FK deck):** ① **mobilise** citizens to participate · ② **recruit** the political elite (candidates/leaders) · ③ **simplify** choices (a label voters can reason with) · ④ **organise government** (form and run the executive/legislature) · ⑤ **provide opposition** (a government-in-waiting that scrutinises). *(This is what distinguishes parties from interest groups below — parties **seek office**; interest groups only seek influence.)*
- **The three types — by number & strength:**
  - **Dominant-party:** many parties compete in more-or-less free & fair elections, but **one wins *every* election** and governs continuously (**ANC**, South Africa — won all six post-apartheid elections, though its share fell to **57.5% in 2019**). **Key nuance:** the line to an **electoral-authoritarian regime** (ch. 8) is *thin* — the test is *how* the party keeps winning: by genuine **popularity** (still a democracy) vs by **manipulating the rules, using state resources, and intimidating rivals** (authoritarian).
  - **Two-party:** only **two** parties can realistically win, though more compete (**US** — no third party significant since the Republicans emerged in the 1850s; UK). Third parties (Ross Perot's Reform Party) flare up but **rarely survive more than two elections.**
  - **Multiparty: more than two** parties could win and govern → **coalitions**. Two sub-variants: **(a)** two large parties, one usually needing small partners to reach a majority (**Italy**); **(b)** three-four roughly equal parties, a majority *always* needing a coalition of ≥2.
- **Where party systems come from — two rival explanations** (the answer to "*why do some countries have 2 parties and others 6?*"):
  - **Sociological — parties grow out of social *cleavages*.** A party forms to represent a self-conscious social group, so the **number of parties mirrors how many deep social divisions a society has.** Two classic 19th-century European cleavages:
    - **Economic (capital vs labour)** — became **universal** with industrialisation: *every* country got a **business/"liberal" party** *and* a **workers' party** (socialist/social-democratic). This one cleavage alone yields **two** party families.
    - **Religious** — existed in **some** countries, not all: **Germany** has a Christian party (CDU/CSU) speaking for a Catholic minority in a Protestant country; **France**, almost entirely Catholic, never needed one.
    - **The rule:** each *additional* salient cleavage tends to add a party family → **both economic + religious salient = multiparty; only economic salient = two-party.**
  - **Institutional (Duverger) — the *electoral rules* shape the party count.** Rational politicians build whatever kind of party *wins under the given rules*, so the **system** drives the number, not just society. **Under SMD** you must come **first in a district** to win *anything*, via two mechanisms (see Duverger's Law): **(i) mechanical** — small/ideological parties get **no seats** and wither, and **(ii) psychological** — voters **stop "wasting" votes** on no-hopers → politics collapses toward **two** broad catch-all parties. **Under PR** (seats ≈ vote share) *both* pressures vanish → **multiparty survives.**
- **Bridging the "chicken-and-egg":** the institutional effect holds in **established** democracies but *not* in **new** ones, where voters aren't strategic (ethnic/identity voting persists, FPTP winners take seats on 20–30%) — Boix; Moser & Scheiner. **France** is the classic Duverger case (its two-round SMD pushed a fragmented system to ~two blocs, 82% of seats by 2012) — until **2017**, when Macron's one-year-old party blew it up.

## How parties mobilise — and the "crisis of party democracy"

***Core:*** parties win support in **three distinct ways** — how a party mobilises tells you what *kind* of party it is:

| Type | How it wins votes | Signature | Where it thrives |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Programmatic** | offers **ideas / ideology / policy** — you vote for its platform | manifestos, left–right positioning | established, richer democracies |
| **Patronage / clientelist** | trades **material benefits for votes**, delivered through local **brokers** | jobs, cash, favours, "get out the vote" machines | poorer / newer & **statist** economies |
| **Populist** | a **personalist leader** frames **"the people" vs a "corrupt elite"** | crisis rhetoric, anti-establishment, deliberate "**bad manners**" | anywhere in a "crisis of party democracy" |

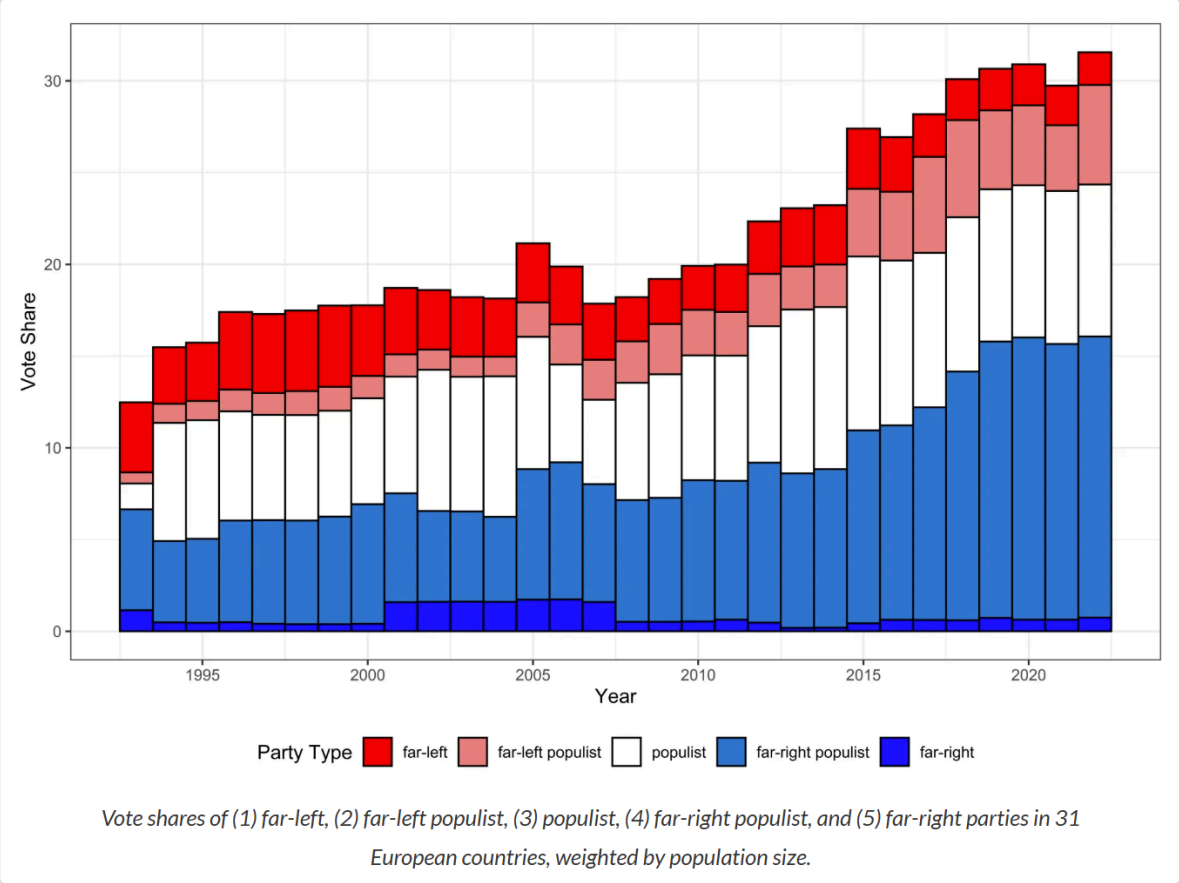
- **Where parties sit — two ideology axes (FK):** parties map onto **two** dimensions, not one — the classic **economic Left–Right** (redistribution: *state intervention to increase equality* ⇄ *no intervention*) *plus* the modern cultural **GAL–TAN** — **GAL** (Green/Alternative/Libertarian: progressive, cosmopolitan, pro-environment, individual rights) vs **TAN/TAL** (Traditional/Authoritarian/Nationalist). Today's populist/far-right parties (Farage, Salvini, AfD) mobilise mainly on the **TAN** end of this *second* axis.




**How to read it (Von Beyme, OD Fig. 6.4).** The **horizontal axis = economics** (left = *state intervention to increase equality*; right = *no intervention*); the **vertical axis = culture/values** (bottom = **GAL**; top = **TAL/TAN**).

A party's position is the *pair* of coordinates — e.g. **Labour/Dems** sit centre-left & GAL-ish, **RN (Rassemblement National)** & **FIDESZ** sit right & strongly **TAL**, **Greens** sit far GAL. The point: two parties can share an economic position yet be opposites on culture — which is exactly how the far-right mobilises on the *TAN* axis without moving economically.

- *Caveat on "programmatic":* **Achen & Bartels** ("folk theory" critique) argue voters mostly vote by **social identity**, not by carefully weighing ideas — so pure programmatic appeal is partly a myth.
- **Crisis of party democracy:** only ~**20%** trust parties (though ~80% value democracy); falling loyalty/membership/turnout, rising **electoral volatility**, single-issue/postmaterialist voting, and **far-right/anti-system** parties (nativism, post-2015 refugee crisis). Explanations: economic (globalisation, manufacturing decline); **dealignment** (voters detach from all parties) vs **realignment** (they switch); catch-all parties → "**cartel parties**" (Mair) colluding at the centre → lost efficacy.




*Vote shares of (1) far-left, (2) far-left populist, (3) populist, (4) far-right populist, and (5) far-right parties in 31 European countries, weighted by population size.*

**How to read it (The PopuList, Rooduijn et al. 2024).** Each bar = one year's **combined vote share** of anti-establishment parties across 31 European countries; the colours split them into far-left, far-left-populist, populist, **far-right-populist (blue)** and far-right. The story is the **near-doubling** from ~12% (1993) to ~31% (2022), and that most of the growth is the **blue far-right-populist** band — the empirical face of the "crisis of party democracy."

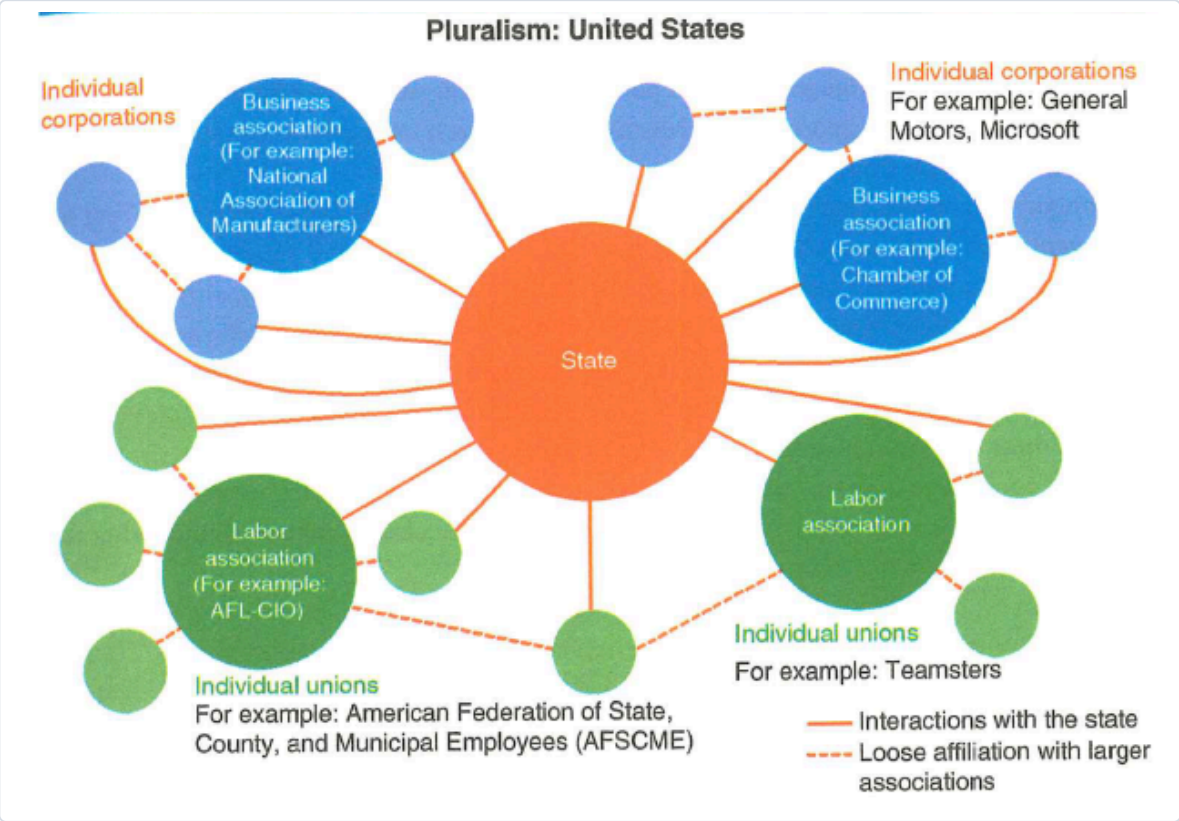
- **US exception:** not dealignment but partisan **sorting/polarisation** (Abramowitz), racial realignment, and Trump's **status-threat** populism (Mutz 2018).

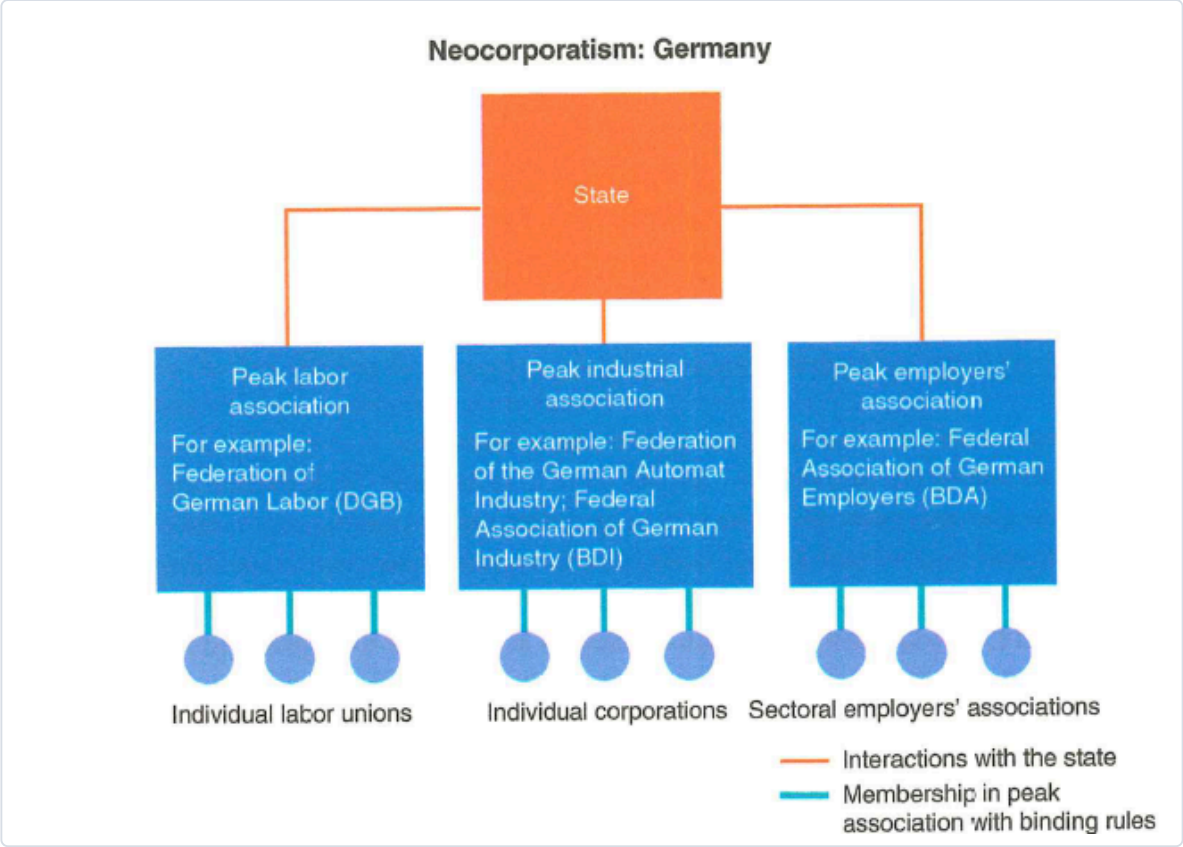
## Civil society & interest groups — pluralism vs neocorporatism

***Core:*** beyond parties, organised **interest groups** (they *don't* seek office, unlike parties) represent society — in two rival models. Groups grew sector-by-sector: first **labour, business, agriculture**, then **women/minority**

groups; in divided societies, ethnic/religious groups dominate (some, like the KKK, are internally *undemocratic* — a tension for democracy).

- **Pluralism** (US): **many** competing groups, a **neutral** state; easy entry & local control, but fragmented clout — and **business is inherently privileged** (Lindblom). **Schattschneider's** famous jab: "*the flaw in the pluralist heaven is that the heavenly chorus sings with a strong upper-class accent*" — i.e. who *gets organised* is skewed toward the well-off.
- **Neocorporatism** / societal corporatism (Germany, N. Europe): a **few large, hierarchical peak associations** the state recognises as *the* voice of each sector negotiate **binding** deals; more influence (esp. for labour countering business) but **less participatory** (little incentive to form new groups). *(State corporatism = the mandated, authoritarian version — ch. 8.)*
- **Social-capital debate:** Putnam (*Bowling Alone*) sees civic **decline**; Skocpol adds that mass-membership bodies gave way to **managed advocacy**; critics (Dalton, "**Kicking in Groups**") reply that activity just **moved to new forms** (movements, single-issue groups).






**How to read them (OD).** *Pluralism (US, first diagram):* **many** groups orbit a **neutral** state, connected by thin/loose lines — lots of competing voices, easy entry, but **fragmented** clout and no single channel. *Neocorporatism (Germany, second):* the state is formally wired to just **a few large peak associations** (peak labour DGB, peak industry BDI, peak employers BDA), each sitting *above* its own member firms/unions — fewer, **binding** channels → more influence (esp. for labour) but **harder for new groups** to break in. Same job (representing interests), opposite architecture: *many-and-loose* vs *few-and-binding*.

## The master trade-off (Powell)

***Core:*** systems open to **diversity** (PR · multiparty · pluralism) maximise **representation & participation** but blur **accountability & governability**; **majoritarian** systems (FPTP · two-party) do the reverse. *There is no free lunch — every design chooses a point on this line.* The chapter's most robust finding: **PR represents women far better than SMD** (India goes further with **reserved seats**).

## Cases & examples

**Why these cases are here — circle them back.** Each shows **one electoral/party system in action** and *who it represents vs leaves out*. Read each for: *which system · how votes became seats · who got left out.*

| Case | Electoral system | Party system | What it shows |
|---|---|---|---|
| UK | SMD/FPTP | two-party | extreme disproportionality (UKIP 12.6% → 1 seat) |
| Germany | mixed **compensatory** PR | multiparty | how mixed PR lets new parties (Greens, AfD) in |
| Japan | mixed **noncompensatory** | dominant (LDP) | more majoritarian; Duverger working haltingly |
| India | SMD/FPTP + federal | multiparty | Duverger's limits in a diverse democracy; reserved seats |
| Brazil | **open-list PR** (no threshold) | fragmented | weak-party fragmentation (30 parties) + populism |
| Israel | pure closed-list PR | hyper-multiparty | PR instability under extreme diversity |

- **UK — SMD/FPTP.** The paradigm two-party FPTP system: modest vote margins → big seat majorities → single-party government. But it's wildly **disproportional** — in **2015, UKIP won 12.6% of the vote → 1 seat**, while the **SNP won fewer votes → 56 seats** (geographically concentrated in Scotland). → *SMD/FPTP → disproportionality, wasted votes, majoritarian governance.*
- **Germany — mixed compensatory PR.** Designed after Weimar with a **5% threshold** + compensatory mixed PR → a stable multiparty system. The **Greens (1983)** got in *because* the semiproportional system let them clear the threshold (unlike Britain's Greens); by **2017** the two big parties fell to a record **54%**, and the far-right **AfD** won its first seats. **Note (2023 reform):** to stop the house ballooning (736 seats in 2021), Germany **capped it at 630** and **scrapped overhang/compensatory seats** — seats now follow the **list vote** and a district win no longer guarantees a seat, so it's arguably become **personalised PR** rather than truly "mixed." → *Mixed PR sustains a multiparty system and lets new/ideological parties gain representation — though the 2023 reform pushes it toward pure PR.*
- **Japan — mixed noncompensatory.** The **LDP dominated 1955–93** via factions & clientelism; the **1994 reform** (300 SMD + 180 PR, *noncompensatory*) pushed toward two parties — the **DPJ won 308/480 in 2009**, but the **LDP swept back in 2012** ("lucky, not popular" — a split opposition). → *Noncompensatory mixed = more majoritarian than Germany; Duverger's Law working haltingly.*
- **India — FPTP in a diverse federation.** FPTP "should" give two parties, but **huge diversity + federalism** yields many *state-level* two-party fights that aggregate into a **national multiparty** system (parties: 50 in 1952 → 342 in 2009). **BJP (Modi) 2014: 31% of the vote → 52% of seats** under FPTP. **120 of ~600** seats are **reserved** for lower castes/tribes. → *Duverger's limits in a new/diverse democracy; reserved-seat representation.*
- **Brazil — open-list PR, no threshold.** No incentive for intra-party cooperation → extreme fragmentation (**30 parties by 2018**) and weak, local parties (a third of legislators switched parties 1989–95). Recession + the "car wash" scandal → mass protests → **Rousseff impeached (2016)** → outsider populist **Bolsonaro won 2018** atop a tiny party. → *Open-list PR's weak-party fragmentation + accountability failure + populism.*
- **Israel — pure PR.** The whole country is **one district**, a 120-seat Knesset, **3.25% threshold** → ~a dozen parties win; governments = a big party + 3–6 small ones, lasting ~2 years; **2019 produced three elections in one year.** → *PR's instability under extreme diversity — the cost of maximal proportionality.*

## Key terms

| Term | Meaning |
|---|---|
| Collective-action problem | Individuals rationally don't act (vote) though all suffer if none do |
| Electoral system | Legal mechanism translating votes into offices/seats |
| Single-member district (SMD) | Each district elects one representative |
| Plurality / FPTP | Most votes wins (no majority needed) |
| Majoritarian | Winner needs an absolute majority (50%+1) |
| Two-round system (runoff) | If no 50%+1 in round 1, top candidates meet in a second-round runoff (France) |
| Alternative Vote (AV) / ranked-choice | Rank candidates; eliminate last-placed & transfer their votes until one passes 50% |
| Proportional representation (PR) | Seats = vote share (national/large districts + a threshold) |
| Closed-list PR | Vote for a party; the **party** sets the candidate order (party control, quotas) — Israel |
| Open-list PR | Vote for party **and** a candidate; candidates' own votes set the order (voter choice, weaker parties) — Brazil |
| Mixed / semiproportional | SMD seats + party-list PR (compensatory / noncompensatory) |
| Duverger's Law | SMD → two parties; PR → multiparty |
| Party system | Number & strength of parties (dominant / two-party / multiparty) |
| Programmatic / patronage / populist mobilisation | Win support by ideas / material rewards / anti-elite personalism |
| Interest-group pluralism | Many competing groups, neutral state (US) |
| Neocorporatism | Few peak associations bargain binding deals with the state (Germany) |
| Peak association | Body uniting a whole sector to negotiate with the state |
| Social capital | Networks + norms of reciprocity underpinning civil society |
| Powell trade-off | Diverse representation ⇄ clear accountability |

## Exam pointers

- Reproduce the **electoral-systems comparison** cold — how each converts votes→seats, its effect on the **number of parties (Duverger)**, **proportionality**, **turnout**, and **women/minorities** — with a case each.
- Answer both spine questions: **why participate** (collective-action problem; institutions shape turnout) and **whose interests get represented** (electoral → party → interest-group chain).
- State **Duverger's Law** *and* its limits (India; France 2017).
- Contrast **pluralism vs neocorporatism** (US vs Germany) for interest representation.
- Land on the **Powell trade-off** (representation ⇄ accountability) and the robust finding that **PR represents women better**; use **Iversen & Soskice** to link PR → more redistribution.

## ★ Fun facts & memorable details

> Sticky stats, dates & quotes from Lecture 5 (participation & representation).

**Quotable**

- Schattschneider (1942): "*Modern democracy is unthinkable save in terms of parties.*"
- Downs (1957): for most people, voting is technically **irrational** — the seed of the collective-action problem.
- Powell's master **trade-off:** representation/participation ⇄ accountability/governability.

**Striking numbers**

- **UK 2015:** UKIP won **12.6% → 1 seat**; the SNP won *fewer* votes → **56 seats.**
- **US 2012 House:** in the ten most gerrymandered states, Republicans won **7% more votes but 76% more seats.**
- **Israel:** whole country = one district; **3.25% threshold**; **three elections in one year (2019)**; governments last ~2 years.
- **India:** parties grew **50 (1952) → 342 (2009)**; **120 of ~600** seats reserved for lower castes/tribes; BJP 2014 = **31% of vote → 52% of seats.**
- **Brazil 2018:** its most fragmented legislature ever — **30 parties.**
- **Women in legislatures:** Nordic countries lead at **42.5%**; US House only **23.4%** (2019). Robust finding: **PR elects more women than SMD.**
- Only **~20%** of citizens trust parties, though ~**80%** call democracy "a very good thing."
- **Maine 2018:** first US Congress seat decided by **ranked-choice** — Golden won 50.5–49.5 after trailing on the first count.

**Memorable**

- **France:** the top two parties held **56% of Assembly seats (1973) → 82% (2012)** — then the system **collapsed in 2017** with Macron's one-year-old party.
- **~60 countries** used FPTP in 2019 — almost all former British colonies; **Belarus** was the only continental-European one.
- The social-capital debate in two titles: Putnam's ***Bowling Alone*** vs its rebuttal "**Kicking in Groups.**"

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# Lecture 6: Institutions and Institutionalisms (AUW)

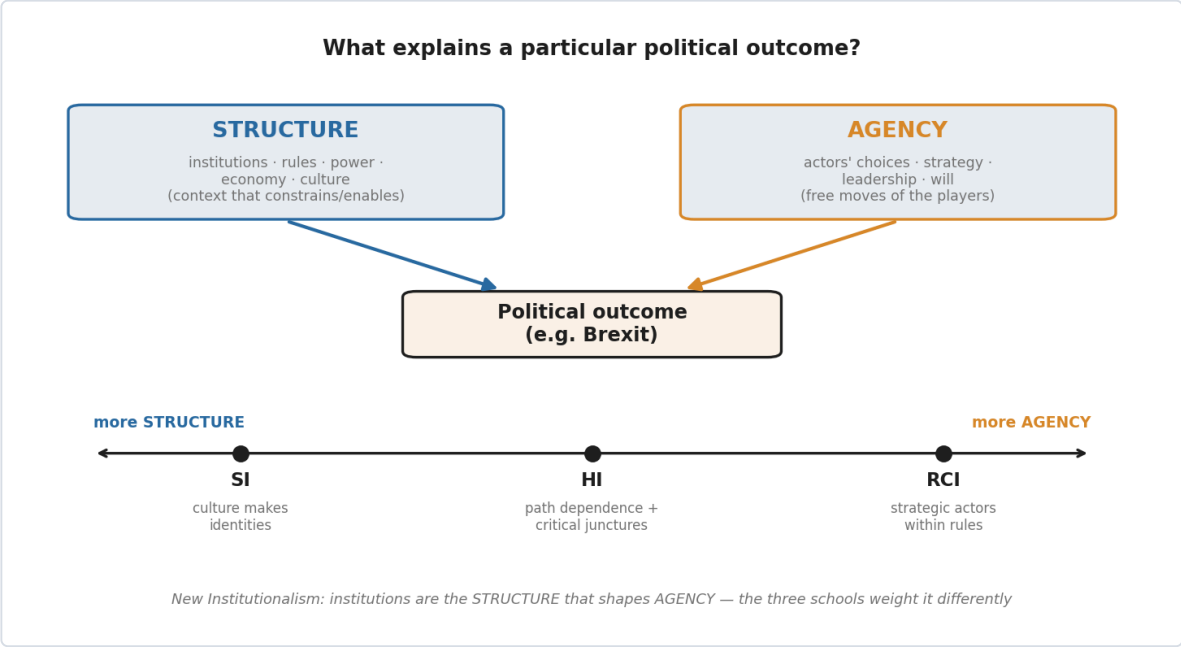
**Required reading:** Hall & Taylor (1996), *Political Science and the Three New Institutionalisms* · Busemeyer & Thelen (2020), *Institutional Sources of Business Power* (an HI example)

**Theme of the lecture:** the role of **institutions and structures** in political processes — how institutions **shape the behaviour of political actors**, and what drives institutional **change vs continuity** — focusing on the **rational-choice (RCI), historical (HI), and sociological (SI)** variants of **New Institutionalism** (with **path dependence** and **institutional legacies** as central concepts).

**Lecture frame (AUW) — the essentials before the three schools**

***Core:* institutions ≠ organizations.** Institutions are the **rules/norms that enable or constrain actors**; organizations are **groups of actors**. *(Ayca's example: the **Social Democratic Party** is an organization; the constitutional & legal rules, its internal statutes, and the unwritten norms governing it — e.g. can an MP defy the leadership and keep their job? — are institutions.)*

- **The grand debate it enters: structure vs agency** — *what explains a **particular political outcome**?* (the deck's opening question). Two pure answers:
  - **Structure** = the **context that shapes action** — institutions, rules, laws, social & economic structures, distributions of power, culture. On this view an outcome is driven by the **situation actors are in** (the "board and rules of the game"); actors are almost **carried along** by their environment.
  - **Agency** = the **capacity of actors to choose and act** independently — strategy, leadership, will. On this view an outcome is driven by **what particular people decided to do** (the "players' free moves").
  - *Why it matters:* explain **Brexit** (or any outcome) and you're implicitly taking a side — was it the deep **structures** (Britain's institutional history, its economy, EU rules) or the **agency** of key actors (Cameron calling the referendum, Johnson/Farage campaigning)? Pure structure = actors are dupes of context; pure agency = "great men" make history.
  - **New Institutionalism's answer** (the "revised" theory: behavioralism → institutionalist critique → New Institutionalism) is a **middle position: institutions are the key *structure* that *shapes* agency** — they **enable and constrain** actors without fully determining them. And the three schools sit at **different points** on the structure⇄agency line: **SI** most *structural* (culture constitutes actors' identities & preferences → least free agency), **RCI** most *agency* (strategic actors freely maximise *within* the rules), **HI** in between (path dependence & power dominate, but actors act at **critical junctures**).




**How to read it (the deck's opening framing).** The **same outcome** (e.g. Brexit) can be explained by **structure** (the constraining context — institutions, rules, power, culture) or by **agency** (what actors chose to do). Institutionalism says it's *both*, with institutions as the structure that channels agency — and the **spectrum** at the bottom is the exam-useful part: **SI** leans most structural (culture makes the actors), **RCI** leans most agency (strategic actors within fixed rules), **HI** sits in the middle (path dependence + critical junctures). Locating a school on this line is how you answer "which weights structure vs agency?"

- **Why study institutions?** They have **profound political consequences** — e.g. electoral system → party system (majoritarian → two-party; PR → multiparty — Lectures 4–5); parental-benefit design → labour-

market gender equality.

- **The definition of "institution" *widens* across the three schools** — this is the key organising idea:

| School | What counts as an institution |
|---|---|
| **RCI** (narrowest) | **"Rules of the game"** — constitutions, laws, regulations, court decisions |
| **HI** (middle) | The above **+ procedures, routines, norms, conventions** (how things are done; SOPs) |
| **SI** (broadest) | All the above **+ symbol systems, cognitive scripts, moral/discursive templates** — "frames of meaning" (role of the state, national identity, patriarchy, institutional racism…) |

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# Hall & Taylor (1996) — The Three New Institutionalisms

## Chapter résumé

Hall & Taylor show that "the new institutionalism" is **not one theory but three** — **rational-choice (RCI)**, **historical (HI)**, and **sociological (SI)** institutionalism — which arose in the 1980s–90s (all reacting against 1960s–70s **behavioralism**) yet developed **independently**, "paint quite different pictures of the political world," and rarely cited each other. They compare the three on **two questions fundamental to any institutional analysis: (1) how institutions relate to behaviour, and (2) how institutions originate and change.** Their verdict: none is wrong — each captures a **partial** truth — so they call for **cross-fertilisation.**

> ★ **The heart of the reading:** three schools answer the same question — *how do institutions shape political behaviour and outcomes?* — very differently. **RCI**: institutions are rules that structure **strategic interaction** among fixed-preference utility-maximisers ("calculus"). **HI**: institutions distribute **power** unevenly and lock in **paths** over time (eclectic). **SI**: institutions are **cultural frames of meaning** that constitute actors' very identities and preferences ("cultural"). The exam task: fill in the comparison table and use it to build *three competing explanations* for one outcome.

**The red thread.** Everything reduces to **two cross-cutting approaches** (Hall & Taylor's own device): the **calculus approach** (actors strategically maximise; institutions give certainty about others' behaviour; persist as a **Nash equilibrium**) vs the **cultural approach** (actors interpret via worldviews; institutions provide moral/cognitive templates; persist because **taken-for-granted**). **RCI = pure calculus · SI = pure cultural · HI = both.** For any theory ask: *calculus or cultural — and how does that answer "how do actors behave / what do institutions do / why do they persist"?*

## Key concepts / "modes" to use

- **The three schools: RCI · HI · SI** (+ the widening definition of "institution").
- **Calculus vs cultural approaches** — the master framework for *how institutions affect behaviour*.
- **RCI toolkit:** strategic interaction · collective-action dilemmas · gains from exchange · **Nash equilibrium**.
- **HI toolkit: power asymmetries · path dependence · critical junctures · unintended consequences**.
- **SI toolkit: frames of meaning · logic of appropriateness · isomorphism · legitimacy**.

## Section-by-section main points

### What "New Institutionalism" is — and why it's "*new*"

***Core:*** **New Institutionalism** is the family of approaches (from the **1980s**) holding that **institutions shape political behaviour and outcomes** — reviving institutions as an *explanation* after behavioralism had sidelined them. The single claim uniting all three schools: **institutions are not a neutral backdrop; they structure what actors do** (they then disagree on *how*).

- **Why "New"? — three waves of theory** (the deck's *original → counter → revised* arc):
  - ① **Original theory — "old" institutionalism** (early–mid 20th c.): the **descriptive** study of *formal* institutions — constitutions, legal codes, the machinery of government. Detailed on paper rules, but **static, atheoretical, country-by-country** — it described institutions without explaining behaviour.
  - ② **Counter theory — behavioralism** (1960s–70s): reacted *against* the old school — politics should be a **science of observable behaviour** (attitudes, voting, opinion), explained by **individuals and informal processes**. Institutions were demoted to **epiphenomena** — just the *aggregate* of individual choices, so the formal rules "don't really matter."
  - ③ **Revised theory — New Institutionalism** (1980s–90s): **brings institutions back in** — but *revised*. It concedes the behavioralist focus on action, yet insists institutions **actively shape and constrain** that action and its outcomes (not merely describe it). "Institutions back in, now doing real explanatory work" is what makes it **New**. *(This is also the structure⇄agency answer: institutions are the structure that channels agency.)*
- **What New Institutionalism studies — institutions, through three guiding questions** (deck):
  - ① **What do institutions look like?** — e.g. **Danish labour-market rules** ("flexicurity" — flexible hiring/firing + strong welfare security); **post-conflict peace-building** institutions (truth & reconciliation commissions in **Rwanda, South Africa**).
  - ② **What similarities & differences do they show across contexts?** — e.g. **neocorporatism in Sweden vs Germany**; **presidentialism in the US vs Brazil** (same type, different workings — Lecture 4).
  - ③ **Why do they show those similarities/differences across time & space?** — the question the **three schools answer differently** (RCI vs HI vs SI). *Today's reading is exactly this move:* why does **privatisation of education take three different forms** in Germany, Sweden and the USA (Busemeyer & Thelen)?
- **The pay-off for the rest of the lecture:** all three schools **agree** institutions matter and shape behaviour; they then **split two ways** — on *how* institutions work (**calculus vs cultural**) and on *what even counts* as an institution (the widening definition above). Those two splits generate the three schools below.

### The two archetypes — calculus vs cultural

***Core:*** any institutionalism must answer three questions — *how do actors behave? what do institutions do? why do they persist?* — and there are two archetypal answer-sets.

*In plain terms:* the **calculus** side sees people as **calculators** (institutions are the rules that make deals work); the **cultural** side sees people as **role-players** following scripts (institutions are the shared meanings that tell us what's "done"). This one split is the engine of the whole lecture — **RCI = pure calculus, SI = pure cultural, HI = both.**

| | Calculus approach (→ RCI) | Cultural approach (→ SI) |
|---|---|---|
| **How do actors behave?** | Instrumental, strategic **utility-maximisers**; preferences given **exogenously** | Behaviour **bounded by a worldview**; **satisficers**; choice depends on *interpretation* |
| **What do institutions do?** | Provide **certainty** about others (information, enforcement); shape **expectations** | Provide **moral/cognitive templates**; shape **identities & preferences** themselves |
| **Why do they persist?** | They're a **Nash equilibrium** — deviating makes you worse off | **Taken-for-granted**; one actor can't change a collective convention |

HI is eclectic — it uses *both*.

## ★ The three institutionalisms compared *(the exam table — from the screenshot)*

***Core:*** memorise this. To answer "why did outcome X happen?", read *across a row* for three competing explanations.

| Dimension | Rational Choice (RCI) | Historical (HI) | Sociological (SI) |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Definition of institutions** | Rules/procedures that structure **strategic interaction** (narrow) | Formal/informal **procedures, routines, norms, conventions** embedded in the polity/economy (tied to organizations) | **Symbol systems, cognitive scripts, moral templates** — "frames of meaning" (dissolves the institution/culture line) |
| **Example they study** | **US Congress** (committees, rules of procedure) | **Cross-national public policy** (welfare states, labour, corporatism) | **Organizational forms & their diffusion** (why education ministries worldwide look alike) |
| **Institutions ↔ behaviour** | **Calculus** | **Eclectic** (both) | **Cultural** |
| **How do actors behave?** | Fixed **exogenous preferences**; instrumental, strategic maximisers | Both strategic *and* worldview-shaped (strategies can **ossify into worldviews**) | Socially-constituted interpreters; **"logic of appropriateness"** — what's "rational" is itself socially constituted |
| **What do institutions do?** | Structure strategic interaction; provide info/enforcement → reduce uncertainty, enable **gains from exchange**; solve **collective-action problems** | **Structure conflict** — privilege some interests, demobilise others; distribute **power unevenly** | Confer **meaning & legitimacy**; constitute actors' **identities & preferences** |
| **Why do they persist?** | They're a **Nash equilibrium** (deviation costs you) | **Path dependence** — groups develop interests "costly to shift" | **Taken-for-granted**; can't be changed by one individual |
| **How/why do they change?** | Deductive; **voluntary agreement** / competitive selection *(weak on change — the "equilibrium paradox")* | **Critical junctures** (crisis/war) → **branching points**; otherwise path-dependent | Adopt new **templates for legitimacy** (not efficiency); **borrowing/diffusion**; can even be *dysfunctional* |
| **Particular focus** | Strategic interaction; collective-action dilemmas; gains from exchange | **Power asymmetries; path dependence; unintended consequences; ideas** | **Legitimacy; culture; isomorphism** |
| **Key concepts** | transaction costs, principal–agent, Nash equilibrium, gains from exchange | path dependence, critical junctures, unintended consequences, "mobilization of bias" | frames of meaning, cognitive scripts, logic of appropriateness, isomorphism |
| **Hall & Taylor's critique** | **Thin/"simplistic" motivation**; exogenous preferences; **functionalist** origins | Vague on the **precise causal mechanism**; too **inductive** | **"Bloodless"; "action without agents"**; misses **power** |

## Rational Choice Institutionalism (RCI) — the "calculus" school

*Core:* institutions are the **rules of the game** that let self-interested players strike deals they otherwise couldn't trust each other to keep — and they last because **breaking them would leave you worse off.**

- **In plain terms:** everyone is out for themselves and constantly *calculating*. Left alone, people get stuck in situations where they'd *all* be better off cooperating but nobody trusts anyone else to do their part.

Institutions are the **rules that make cooperation pay**, so people follow them.

- **Where it came from — the US Congress puzzle** (this is *why* the school exists): plain rational-choice theory predicted Congress could never pass stable laws. Legislators want different things on many issues, so any bill should be beaten by a new majority — endless "**cycling.**" Yet Congress *does* produce stable legislation. **Why?** Because its **rules** structure the game: agenda control limits which options get voted on, committees carve up jurisdiction, and enforcement makes **logrolling** (vote-trading) deals stick. Those rules **lower the "transaction costs" of doing deals** and let legislators capture "**gains from exchange.**" → *institutions solve the collective-action problems that would otherwise paralyse a legislature.*
- **Its four defining assumptions:**
  1. **Fixed preferences + strategic maximising.** Actors have a set menu of wants and act instrumentally to get as much as possible, via extensive calculation.
  2. **Politics = collective-action dilemmas.** Individually rational choices often produce a **collectively bad** result (classic images: the **prisoner's dilemma**, the **tragedy of the commons**) — unless an institution guarantees others will cooperate too.
  3. **Strategic interaction is central.** What you do depends on **what you expect others to do**; institutions shape those expectations by supplying **information + enforcement** that cut the uncertainty about everyone else.
  4. **Origins explained by function.** An institution exists *because of the value it delivers* to those who set it up — created by **voluntary agreement**, or selected because efficient forms **out-compete** rivals.
- **Borrowed toolkit:** the "new economics of organization" — **transaction costs** (Williamson), **property rights**, **principal–agent** (how "principals" monitor and enforce compliance on their "agents," e.g. Congress over regulatory agencies).
- **Why institutions persist — a *Nash equilibrium*** (*in plain terms:* a settled situation where **no one can do better by breaking ranks alone**, so everyone sticks with it).
- **Best at:** precise, generalisable theory; and above all **explaining why institutions *persist*.**
- **Weak at — origins & change.** Three linked charges: **functionalist** (you can't read an institution's origins off its *effects* — **unintended consequences are everywhere**); **intentionalist** (assumes founders foresaw those effects — "heroic prescience"); **voluntarist** (treats creation as equals freely contracting, **ignoring power asymmetries**). Plus the **equilibrium paradox:** if the status quo is *already* a Nash equilibrium, why would anyone agree to change it? (RCI needs a better theory of *dynamic* equilibria.)
- **Exemplars:** US Congress — **Shepsle, Weingast**; **Cox & McCubbins** (parties, not just committees); **Ostrom** (common-pool resources); **North** (economic institutions); **Tsebelis** (EU reform).

## Historical Institutionalism (HI) — power + path dependence

***Core:*** institutions **hand power to some groups and not others**, and early choices push a country down a **path** that gets costly to leave — so big change waits for rare crisis moments (**critical junctures**).

- **In plain terms:** history matters, and the playing field is **tilted**. The rules a country built long ago give some groups the upper hand and lock the country onto a track. You mostly stay on that track — until a shock (war, economic crisis) forces a switch.
- **Where it came from:** reacted against 1960s **group theory** and **structural-functionalism** (plus a neo-Marxist debate) → brought the **state** back in as an actor that *structures* group conflict rather than neutrally refereeing it. Most HI work = **cross-national comparisons of public policy** (welfare states, tax, labour movements).

- **What counts as an institution (a middle-width definition):** the **formal *and* informal procedures, routines, norms and conventions** embedded in organisations — from a constitution's rules to a bureaucracy's standard operating procedures to the conventions governing unions or bank–firm relations.
- **Its four features:**
  1. **Eclectic on behaviour — uses *both* calculus and cultural approaches.** Sometimes actors strategically calculate (Immergut: doctors' groups compromise or not depending on where they can appeal a decision); sometimes strategies "**ossify over time into worldviews**" that then shape identities (Hattam: US vs British unions developed different outlooks).
  2. **Power asymmetries (its signature move).** Institutions **distribute power unevenly** — they give some groups **disproportionate access** to decisions and "structure conflict to privilege some and demobilise others." So HI stresses that **some groups win while others lose** (this is the *2nd and 3rd faces of power* from Lecture 1). *(Steinmo on tax; Weir on which coalitions can form.)*
  3. **Path dependence + unintended consequences.** *In plain terms:* the *same* pressure produces *different* results in different countries because each inherited a different institutional track. Past policy leads groups to organise, adopt identities and build interests that become "**costly to shift**" → **lock-in**. Change is bunched at **critical junctures** — crisis/war moments that open a "**branching point**" onto a new path; between them, continuity rules. **Acknowledged weakness:** HI is weak on explaining *what triggers* a critical juncture in the first place.
  4. **Ideas belong in the causal chain.** Institutions aren't the *only* cause — ideas matter too (Goldstein: US institutions amplified some trade ideas over others; Weir: institutions set the *timing* of when Keynesian ideas caught on).
- **Why institutions persist — *path dependence / lock-in*** (*in plain terms:* the longer you're on a track, the more expensive it becomes to reverse, so you don't).
- **Best at:** the **most "commodious," realistic** school — the **bridge/pivot** between RCI and SI (its arguments translate into RCI terms yet open toward SI).
- **Weak at:** pinning down the **exact causal mechanism** (the price of being eclectic); and it leans so heavily on **induction** (digging through the historical record) that it's been **slow to build systematic, generalisable theory.**
- **Exemplars: Immergut** (health-care reform), **Steinmo** (tax), **Hattam** (US labour), **Skocpol** (welfare states & state capacity), **Thelen** (how institutions evolve). *(The school **Busemeyer & Thelen** exemplify — see below.)*

## Sociological Institutionalism (SI) — culture & legitimacy

***Core:*** institutions are **cultural frames of meaning** — the scripts, symbols and "done things" of social life — that shape not just what actors *do* but **who they think they are and what they want**; organisations adopt practices to look **legitimate**, not to be efficient.

- **In plain terms:** we do most things because they're "**the normal, proper way,**" not because we've calculated they pay off. Institutions *are* culture — they hand us the mental **scripts** for what's even thinkable, and organisations copy the **respectable** forms to fit in, **even when those forms don't actually work well.**
- **Where it came from: organization theory** in sociology (late 1970s). It challenged the Weberian assumption that organisations look alike because that's the **most efficient** design. Its counter-claim: the striking sameness across firms, schools and ministries is **culturally transmitted** — forms spread like "myths and ceremonies," adopted because they're **legitimate**, not because they're efficient.
- **Its three features:**

1. **A very broad definition of "institution."** Not just rules and norms, but **symbol systems, cognitive scripts and moral templates** — the "**frames of meaning**" that guide action. This **dissolves the line between "institutions" and "culture"** (the *cognitive turn:* culture is a web of scripts and templates, not just warm attitudes/values).
2. **How institutions shape action — the *cognitive* view.** They supply the scripts and categories you need to **interpret the world at all**; they specify not just what you *should* do but **what you can even imagine doing.** So institutions shape actors' **identities and preferences themselves** — not just constrain pre-set preferences. People act by a "**logic of appropriateness**" (*in plain terms:* asking "what fits my role / what's the done thing here?" rather than "what's my biggest payoff?"). Even what counts as "rational" is **socially defined** — people act to **express who they are appropriately**, not only to grab material gain.
3. **Origins & change = legitimacy, not efficiency.** An organisation adopts a practice because it's **valued in the wider culture** and makes the organisation look legitimate — **even if the practice is *dysfunctional*** for its real goals (Campbell: a *logic of appropriateness* vs a *logic of instrumentality*). *Where legitimacy comes from:* the **regulatory state** (by fiat), **professions** (professional standards), **discussion networks/forums** (shared "cognitive maps" of best practice), and transnational ideas of "**modernity**"/"**development.**" *(Fligstein: firms diversified because it became the valued thing in managers' professional circles; Soysal: immigration policy followed international **human-rights** norms of what's appropriate, not what was functional.)*

- **Isomorphism** (*in plain terms:* organisations in the same field **coming to look identical** — same forms, procedures, symbols — by copying the legitimate template "regardless of local conditions").
- **Why institutions persist — *taken-for-granted*.** They're so obvious no one questions them, and **no single person can change a collective convention** on their own.
- **Best at:** meaning, legitimacy, identity — and the **inefficiencies RCI can't explain** (the classic point: you still **stop at a red light with no one around** — hardly a payoff-maximising move). It even explains where RCI's "given" preferences *come from*.
- **Weak at: power & agency** — critics call it "curiously **bloodless**"; it can miss the **power struggles** in institutional change and end up looking like "**action without agents.**"
- **Exemplars: Meyer & Rowan** ("myth & ceremony"), **DiMaggio & Powell** (isomorphism / the "organizational field"), **March & Olsen** (logic of appropriateness), **Dobbin, Fligstein, Soysal**.

### Change vs continuity — each school's answer *(AUW's deck; the Brexit test)*

***Core:*** take one outcome (e.g. **Brexit**) and give **three competing explanations** — one per school.



**How to read it (the Brexit outcome the three schools explain).** The 2016 referendum: **72.2% turnout**, **51.9% Leave vs 48.1% Remain** — razor-thin — with the district map showing a **geographic split** (Scotland, London & N. Ireland Remain-blue; most of England & Wales Leave-pink). This single result is the *explanandum*: **RCI** reads it as actors' cost–benefit calculus and interests, **HI** as path dependence hitting a critical juncture, **SI** as a clash of identities/paradigms — same fact, three lenses.

| School | Explains CHANGE by… | Explains CONTINUITY by… |
|---|---|---|
| **RCI** | disrupted equilibrium; actors' **interests** (utility-max, cost–benefit); strategic action; **few veto players** (or in agreement) | policy **equilibrium**; **many veto players** (or in disagreement) |
| **HI** | **critical junctures**; unintended consequences; powerful **agenda-setters**; institutional inertia | **path dependence**; **policy lock-in**; institutional power vested in key actors |
| **SI** | **societal shifts** (materialism→post-materialism); a new **economic paradigm** (Keynesianism→neoliberalism); IR shift (multilateral→unilateral) | deep **taken-for-granted** structures; **national identities**; nested power structures |

★ **Worked example — the three schools explain Brexit**

*Core:* the exam move is to take **one outcome** and give **three competing explanations**. None is "the" answer — each spotlights a different driver, and they're strongest *combined*. Each school's Brexit account, developed:

① **RCI — Brexit as strategic actors pursuing interests.** Institutions are rules that structure the strategic game; the outcome is the aggregate of **cost–benefit calculations** by utility-maximisers.

- **Elite gamble: Cameron** called the 2016 referendum as a *rational* move to manage his own party — buy off Eurosceptic backbenchers and kill the **UKIP** threat — **expecting Remain to win**. A calculated bet (that misfired: unintended consequence, but the *decision* was strategic). Leave elites (**Johnson, Gove**) likewise made career-maximising bets.
- **Voters as calculators:** those who read themselves as **economic losers** from EU membership/immigration (job & wage competition, strained services) found Leave in their interest; **winners** (London finance, exporters reliant on the single market, the highly educated) voted Remain.
- **Rules of the game:** a **binary referendum stripped out the usual veto players** (parliament's equilibrium was bypassed), so a bare 51.9% majority could flip policy.
- *Blind spot:* takes preferences as **given** — it can't say *why* so many Britons wanted "out."

② **HI — Brexit as a critical juncture releasing a path-dependent tension.** Institutions distribute power and **lock in paths**; big change needs a **critical juncture**.

- **Path dependence:** Britain was always the "*awkward partner*" — it **stayed out of the founding EEC (1957)**, joined **late (1973)**, then negotiated **opt-outs** (no euro, no Schengen, the budget rebate). Forty years of *half-in* membership + a sovereign **Westminster** tradition jealous of pooled sovereignty + a Eurosceptic press kept **exit latent** on the path.
- **Critical juncture + timing:** the referendum landed at a specific conjuncture — **post-2008 austerity** and the **2015 refugee crisis** — that gave Leave its opening; Cameron's **2015 election pledge** (itself an unintended consequence of earlier intra-party moves) set the branching point.
- *Blind spot:* strong on *why Britain / why now*, weak on the **precise decision mechanism** on the day.

③ **SI — Brexit as a clash of identity frames.** Institutions are **cultural frames of meaning** that constitute identities; people act by the **logic of appropriateness**, and change = a shift in the taken-for-granted paradigm.

- **Identity, not calculation:** Leave mobilised a **national-sovereignty identity** ("**take back control**") against a **cosmopolitan, pro-European** one — the deep split was **older/less-educated/"left-behind" towns vs younger/urban/university-educated**. Voting Leave *expressed who people felt they were*.
- **Cultural backlash / values shift** (Norris & Inglehart): a **materialist→post-materialist** realignment in which **cultural identity trumped economic interest** — for a certain British self-understanding, being governed from Brussels simply wasn't "appropriate" to *being British*.
- *Blind spot:* strong on **meaning/identity**, weak on **power and strategic agency** (who engineered the vote).

> **Putting them together (cross-fertilisation).** They're complementary: **HI** explains *why Britain and why 2016* (the path + juncture), **SI** explains *why the identity cleavage existed to be mobilised*, and **RCI** explains *why Cameron gambled and how interests aggregated into 51.9%*. That's the model answer — locate each on the structure⇄agency spectrum (SI most structural → RCI most agency) and show how the three combine.

## Hall & Taylor's conclusion — cross-fertilise

***Core:*** each school reveals a **genuine but partial** dimension of behaviour, so they should **borrow from each other** rather than stay in isolation.

- Who does what: **RCI** = precision & persistence (weak on motivation/change); **HI** = power & history (weak on mechanism); **SI** = meaning & legitimacy (weak on power/agency). HI is the **bridge** — its arguments translate into RCI terms yet open toward SI (actors pick institutions strategically, but "from a menu made historically available").
- **Emerging syntheses they cite: Kreps** (corporate culture as an efficient supplement to monitoring); **Garrett & Weingast** (norms/ideas as "**focal points**" that select among multiple equilibria); **Scharpf** ("decision rules" [incentives] + "decision styles" [beliefs about appropriate behaviour]); **Bates & Weingast** (strategic interaction as **signalling games** needing cultural context). *(Caveat: they don't claim a full synthesis is yet possible — "there is much to be said for tenacious debate.")*

### Key terms

| Term | Meaning |
|---|---|
| Institution vs organization | Rules/norms that constrain actors vs groups of actors |
| Calculus vs cultural approach | Strategic maximising vs interpretation-by-worldview |
| RCI / HI / SI | Rational-choice / historical / sociological institutionalism |
| Nash equilibrium | Why institutions persist for RCI (deviation costs you) |
| Collective-action dilemma | Individually rational, collectively bad (RCI's image of politics) |
| Path dependence | Past choices lock development onto costly-to-reverse paths (HI) |
| Critical juncture / branching point | Crisis moment when big institutional change sets a new path (HI) |
| Unintended consequences | Ubiquitous — why you "can't deduce origins from consequences" |
| Mobilization of bias | Institutions distribute power unevenly (HI) |
| Logic of appropriateness | Act on what's socially appropriate, not calculation (SI) |
| Isomorphism | Organizations in a field converge on the same form (SI) |
| Frames of meaning | Symbol systems/scripts that constitute action (SI's institutions) |

### Exam pointers

- Reproduce the **RCI/HI/SI comparison table** — the exam's whole point (Ayca's table).
- Nail **institution ≠ organization** and the **widening definition** (RCI rules → SI frames of meaning).
- Use the **calculus vs cultural** distinction to explain *how* each school links institutions to behaviour.
- Run the **change-vs-continuity table** on one outcome — see the **worked Brexit example**: **three competing explanations** (RCI strategic gamble/interests · HI critical juncture/path dependence · SI identity-frame clash), then combine them.
- Know each school's **signature critique** (RCI thin motivation · HI vague mechanism · SI bloodless/no power).

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## Busemeyer & Thelen (2020) — Institutional Sources of Business Power *(an HI example)*

### Chapter résumé

An **exemplary Historical-Institutionalist study**: where does **business power** come from? The standard split is **structural** power (business's privileged position as investor — the exit/investment threat) vs **instrumental** power (lobbying, donations). Busemeyer & Thelen add a third, **institutional business power** — power that "results when state actors **delegate public functions to private business actors**" and, "over time, through **policy feedback and lock-in effects**," produces an **asymmetrical dependence of the state on business.** They prove it in **education/skill formation** (a "quintessentially public" area where you'd *least* expect business power) across **Germany, Sweden, and the USA.**

> ★ **The heart of the reading:** business power isn't a fixed feature of capitalism — it's **built by institutions over time**. Once the state hands parts of a public service to private actors, **policy feedback + lock-in** make the state **dependent** on them and the change **near-impossible to reverse.** This is *classic HI*: **power asymmetries compounding through path dependence.**

## Section-by-section main points

### The argument — a third kind of business power

***Core:*** to structural + instrumental power, add **institutional business power** — endogenous to **past policy-design choices**, not a generic feature of capitalism.

- **Three types: structural** (investor's exit threat — Lindblom) · **instrumental** (lobbying/donations) · **institutional** (entrenched role in delivering a **public function**). They act as "**communicating vessels.**"
- **Two conditions** set how strong institutional power is: **(1) the credibility of business's exit threat** and **(2) the depth of state dependence** (has the state lost the capacity to provide the service itself?). Both high → power strongest.
- Once entrenched, institutional power grants business insider "**quiet politics**" access (Culpepper) — so it needs far less *overt* lobbying. The three cases are deliberately "**most different**" (Esping-Andersen's three welfare worlds × Hall & Soskice's *varieties of capitalism*) to show a **common dynamic despite maximally different systems.**

### Three mechanisms → three countries

***Core:*** the *same* dynamic (state shares a public function → feedback entrenches business → lock-in) plays out three ways across maximally different systems.

| Country | Mechanism | What happened |
|---|---|---|
| Germany | **Delegation** | state consciously shares regulatory space with employers (dual apprenticeship training) |
| Sweden | **Deregulation** | state retreats from provision (school **vouchers** / for-profit "free schools") |
| USA | **Accretion** | private actors *invite themselves in* (venture philanthropy, charter schools) |

- **Germany — Delegation (dual vocational training).** Firm-based apprenticeships rest on **employer voluntarism** (~500,000 youths/year, ≈ the number entering university). **Highest** institutional power: both state dependence *and* exit threat are high. Twice (**1970s**; **red–green 1998**) governments floated a statist **training levy** + school-based alternative; both times employers threatened to cut training places and the government **backed down** — and by the 2000s **unions & Social Democrats had *reversed*** to defending firm-based training (preference **conversion via feedback**). → *Delegation + lock-in + preference change = HI.*
- **Sweden — Deregulation (school vouchers).** Early-1990s reforms broke a near-total **public monopoly**; public money now funds private "independent" schools. By 2014 **ten corporations held 30% of the market** (biggest: AcadeMedia, owned by VC firm EQT); ~85% of voucher schools are **for-profit** — a "welfare-industrial complex." The **2016 Reepalu** profit-cap proposal died after providers threatened to shut down; Reepalu himself: "*we'd be in an easier situation if this had been introduced twenty years ago*" (**lock-in spoken aloud**). → *Deregulation + self-reinforcing feedback (even unions flipped pro-privatisation).*
- **USA — Accretion (venture philanthropy & charters).** Wealthy donors (**Gates, Broad, Walton**) "invite themselves" into education, funding charter schools/CMOs. **High exit threat, lower state dependence**

(private funds *supplement*). Charters ≈6% of US enrolment but **~95% in post-Katrina New Orleans**; **Gates ranked the most influential individual in US education policy — ahead of the Secretary of Education.** In the 2014 de Blasio vs **Eva Moskowitz** fight, Walton-funded groups bused parents to Albany and Gov. Cuomo vowed "*We will save charter schools!*" → *Accretion — instrumental power converting into entrenched institutional power.*

### Why it's HI — and how RCI/SI would differ

- **HI hallmarks: power** runs through the whole study (asymmetric state↔business dependence tilting "over time"); **historical legacies** (each country a longitudinal narrative); **path dependence & lock-in** ("reclaiming lost territory becomes more difficult over time"); **policy feedback**; **critical junctures** (German 1982 government change; **Hurricane Katrina** enabling New Orleans's charterisation).
- **RCI would say:** business power = a credible **exit/holdup threat** in a principal–agent game; delegation persists because it's **efficient** (lowers state costs) — but static RCI misses the *temporal tilt* and the change in actors' preferences.
- **SI would say:** private provision spreads because it becomes **legitimate/taken-for-granted** (Germans see employer involvement as "an asset"; Swedes internalise "free choice"; Gates's role "taken for granted") — an NPM/"choice" **template diffusing** (isomorphism) — but SI under-weights the raw **power** the authors foreground.

### Exam pointers

- Use this as your **worked HI example**: name the mechanism per country (**Delegation/Germany · Deregulation/Sweden · Accretion/US**) and show **power + path dependence + lock-in**.
- Define **institutional business power** vs structural vs instrumental, and its **two conditions** (exit threat + state dependence).
- Be ready to **re-explain the same outcome in RCI and SI terms** (Ayca's exercise).

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## Informal institutions *(AUW coda)*

***Core:* informal institutions** = the "informal rules of the game" — "*socially shared rules, usually unwritten, created, communicated and enforced outside officially sanctioned channels.*" They can matter as much as formal ones (esp. in weak states) — and are **not necessarily undemocratic.**

- **Examples: *dedazo*** ("big finger", Mexico — the outgoing PRI president secretly picks his successor) · ***amakudari*** ("descent from heaven", Japan — retired bureaucrats get corporate jobs) · **clientelism** (Peronist Argentina). *Not* undemocratic: the **folkways of the US Senate** (Matthews 1959 — apprenticeship, courtesy, reciprocity, specialisation); pre-Erdoğan Turkish university-rector elections.

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## ★ Fun facts & memorable details

> Sticky bits from Lecture 6 (institutions & institutionalisms).

**Quotable**

- The framing line: "*political science today is confronted with not one but three 'new institutionalisms.'*"
- **SI's best point** (why we're not just calculators): "*anyone who has waited at a traffic light when no one else was around*" has to admit institutions work non-instrumentally too.
- **RCI's key logical error** (Hall & Taylor): "*one cannot safely deduce origins from consequences*" — because unintended consequences are everywhere.
- SI critique in three words: "*action without agents.*"
- **Reepalu (Sweden):** "*We'd be in a somewhat easier situation if much of what we're proposing had been introduced some twenty years ago*" — path dependence, out loud.
- **Cuomo (US):** "*We will save charter schools!*"

**Memorable**

- The three schools "developed **quite independently of each other**," each "assiduously burnishing its own paradigm" — a paper about theories that ignored each other.
- **Germany:** ~**500,000** start firm-based apprenticeships each year — about the same as start university.
- **New Orleans** after Katrina: **~95%** of children in charter schools — the highest of any US city.
- **Bill Gates** was ranked the **single most influential individual in US education policy — ahead of the Secretary of Education** (who, at the time, was herself a venture philanthropist).
- **Institution ≠ organization:** the Social Democratic *Party* is the organization; the rules and unwritten norms governing it are the *institutions* — the distinction the whole lecture turns on.

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**PART II · INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS**

# IR I: Realism (AUW)

**Required reading:** PG = **Goldstein & Pevehouse, *International Relations*** — **ch. 1** (*The Globalization of International Relations*) + **ch. 2** (*Realist Theories*). · Lecturer: **Ayça Uygur Wessel.**

**Theme of the lecture:** first, *what is International Relations* and why we need **theories** to explain it (the field, key actors, **sovereignty**, **levels of analysis**, the **collective-goods problem**). Then the field's oldest and most influential theory: **realism** — how, in a world with no world government, states end up in **competition** for **power** and **security**.

> ★ **The heart of the lecture:** a theory is *an explanation of patterns* in world politics (what happened → **why**). Realism's answer runs in one chain: because the international system is **anarchic** (no sovereign above states), states can't trust each other, so they must **self-help**, which means watching **relative power** — and that breeds **competition**, alliances, and war. States are treated as **unitary, rational actors** pursuing the **national interest defined as power**. *Realism isn't "war is good" — it's "given anarchy, this is the logic states are trapped in."*

**The red thread.** Everything hangs on one word: **anarchy** — *not chaos*, just "**no world police.**" Ask of any event: *how does the absence of an enforcer above states drive this?* Trust becomes risky → survival can't be outsourced → power (especially **material/military**) is the currency → and because one state's gain can shift the balance, even **cooperation** is viewed through the lens of **relative** advantage.

### Key concepts / "modes" to use

- **Theory** (explains patterns) · **levels of analysis** (individual / domestic / interstate / global).
- **Collective-goods problem** & its three solutions: **dominance · reciprocity · identity.**
- **State · sovereignty · anarchy · non-state actors** (IGOs, NGOs, MNCs).
- **Realism** — **unitary + rational** actor; **national interest = power**; classical vs structural vs offensive vs neoclassical.
- **Self-help · power** (capability vs influence; hard/soft) · **relative vs absolute gains · security dilemma.**
- **Balance of power · balancing** (internal/external) · **polarity** (uni/bi/multi) · **hegemony** & hegemonic stability.
- **Alliances** (NATO) · **deterrence/compellence** · the **Prisoner's Dilemma.**

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## A. Introducing International Relations *(PG ch. 1 — the set-up)*

### What IR is — and why we need theory

*Core:* **IR = the relationships among the world's governments**, tangled up with other actors (UN, corporations, individuals), other relationships (economics, culture), and history/geography. We need **theories** because facts don't explain themselves — a theory turns "*what happened*" into "*why.*"

- *In plain terms:* a theory is a **pair of glasses**. Realism and liberalism look at the *same* events (a war, an alliance, a trade deal) and each highlights different causes. A good theory gives you **clear assumptions** (e.g. realism assumes states are **rational**) and a **shared vocabulary**.
- IR is a **subfield of political science**; its two big halves are **international security** (war & peace) and **international political economy (IPE)** (trade, money, North–South relations).

### The collective-goods problem — the core puzzle of IR

*Core:* how can a group (of states) serve its **collective interest** when each member is tempted to put its **own** interest first? Everyone benefits from a **collective good** (clean climate, a strong alliance) *whether or not they help pay* — so each is tempted to **free-ride**, and if too many do, the good collapses.

- *In plain terms:* it's the **group-project problem** at world scale — everyone wants the good grade, nobody wants to do the work. Domestically a **government** forces contributions (taxes); internationally there's **no world government**, so the problem is especially hard.
- **Three ways to solve it** (recurring across the whole course):

| Solution | How it works | *In plain terms* | Upside / Downside |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Dominance** | a **power hierarchy** imposes order top-down (a "government without a government") | *someone's the boss — obey those above you* | order & stability / oppression & resentment |
| **Reciprocity** | **tit-for-tat** — reward cooperation, punish cheating | *I'll help you if you help me; I'll hit back if you cheat* | robust, self-enforcing / downward spirals, hard accounting |
| **Identity** | a **shared sense of "we"** makes members sacrifice for the group | *we're family, so I give without keeping score* | deep cooperation / can demonise an out-group |

*Examples:* nuclear non-proliferation runs on all three — **dominance** (the UNSC "big five" keep the bomb), **reciprocity** (the NPT bargain: you stay non-nuclear, we disarm), **identity** (Sweden/Japan chose *not* to build one). **Realism is built on the *dominance* principle.**

## Actors — states and non-state actors

***Core:*** the lead actors are **states** — a **state** = "*an inhabited territory controlled by a government that exercises **sovereignty***." But the stage is crowded with **non-state (transnational) actors.**

- **State** = territory + government + **sovereignty** (answers to no higher authority) + **recognition** by others. Careful: *state ≠ nation* (a shared identity) *≠ country*. A **nation-state** is one where the population shares a national identity — the modern state system is only **~500 years old** (before: empires, city-states, fiefs).
- **Non-state actors** (Table 1.2):

| Type | Members are… | Examples |
|---|---|---|
| **IGOs** (intergovernmental orgs) | national governments | UN, NATO, WTO, EU |
| **NGOs** (non-governmental orgs) | individuals & groups | Amnesty, Red Cross, Greenpeace |
| **MNCs** (multinational corporations) | firms across borders | ExxonMobil, Toyota, Walmart |
| **Others** | individuals, cities, networks | Bono, al-Qaeda, Iraqi Kurdistan |

*(There are **>50,000 NGOs** and **~5,000 IGOs**; there were **193 UN members** in 2018.)*

## Sovereignty & anarchy

***Core:*** **sovereignty** = a state's right to do as it likes **inside** its own borders (the **norm of non-interference**), and it's the flip side of **anarchy** — "*not chaos, but the lack of a central government that can enforce rules.*"

- *In plain terms:* **anarchy = "no world police."** No one stands above states to force them to keep promises or protect them — so, realists say, each must ultimately **look after itself** and watch others' **capabilities, not their intentions.**
- **Territorial integrity** (respect borders) and **diplomatic norms** (an embassy = home soil) are strong shared **norms** — the system is far from chaotic even without a ruler.

## Levels of analysis — the "zoom level" of an explanation

***Core:*** a **level of analysis** is the *scale* at which you look for causes. The same "why" question can be answered at several levels at once — none is *the* correct one.

| Level | You explain events by… | *In plain terms* | Example causes |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Individual** | particular people's choices/psychology | *the person* | great/"crazy" leaders, crisis decisions, assassinations |
| **Domestic** | groups *inside* a state | *the country's insides* | democracy vs dictatorship, public opinion, ethnic conflict, bureaucracies |
| **Interstate / systemic** | states interacting; the **distribution of power** | *states vs states* | balance of power, alliances, polarity, trade |
| **Global** | worldwide forces | *the whole planet* | technology, the environment, the legacy of imperialism |

*Tip:* higher levels change **more slowly** (individuals rotate through office often; the system's structure rarely shifts). **Realism lives mostly at the interstate/systemic level.**

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## B. Realism — the main theory *(PG ch. 2 + the deck)*

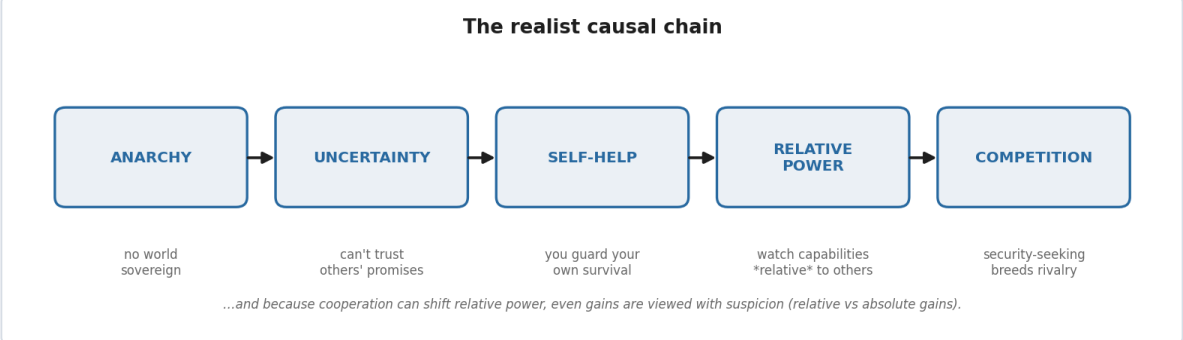
### What realism is — its assumptions

***Core:*** **realism** = "*a broad tradition that explains IR mainly in terms of **power***." It's a **family** of theories, not one theory, but they share a few assumptions.

- **The core assumptions:** ① states are the key actors; ② each is a **unitary** actor (speaks with one voice — domestic politics is a "black box"); ③ each is a **rational** actor (defines its interests and picks the option that maximises them); ④ the system is **anarchic**; ⑤ **power politics** trumps morality, ideology and economics.
- **Rational ≠ good or moral.** A rational choice is just the best cost–benefit bet given the incentives. *If a state calculates the expected costs of **not** fighting exceed those of fighting, **war can be rational.***
- **Realism vs idealism/liberalism:** where idealists see human nature as basically good and the system as a *community* that can cooperate, realists see it as **selfish** and the system as **anarchy** — and accuse idealists of studying the world as it *ought* to be, not as it *is*.
- **The lineage: Thucydides** ("*the strong do what they can, the weak suffer what they must*") · **Machiavelli** (expedient power) · **Hobbes** (the anarchic "state of nature" — cf. Hobbes in *PET Module 2*) · **Morgenthau** (modern classical realism: *national interest defined as power*).

### ★ The realist causal chain — the argument in one line

***Core:*** this is the spine of the whole lecture. **Anarchy → uncertainty → self-help → attention to relative power → competition.**



**How to read it (the causal chain).** Walk it one link at a time: **anarchy** (no world sovereign) means a state **can't trust** others to keep promises → **uncertainty**; if no one guarantees your survival you must **self-help** (arm, ally); self-help means constantly judging your **capabilities relative to others**; and everyone doing this at once produces **competition.** *A worked link (deck):* "Anarchy creates uncertainty because a state can't trust another to keep its word — e.g. **Denmark–US** under Trump's Greenland threats, which pushed DK to boost conscription and Nordic military ties even though both are NATO allies."

- **Self-help ≠ 'never cooperate'.** States *do* cooperate — but always with one eye on how the deal shifts the balance.

## Power — the currency of realism

***Core:* power** = "*the ability to influence others' behaviour.*" For realists it's mostly **material / hard power** (Lukes' **1st face** — see PS Lecture 1), and it's **relational**: *how capable am I **relative to you?***

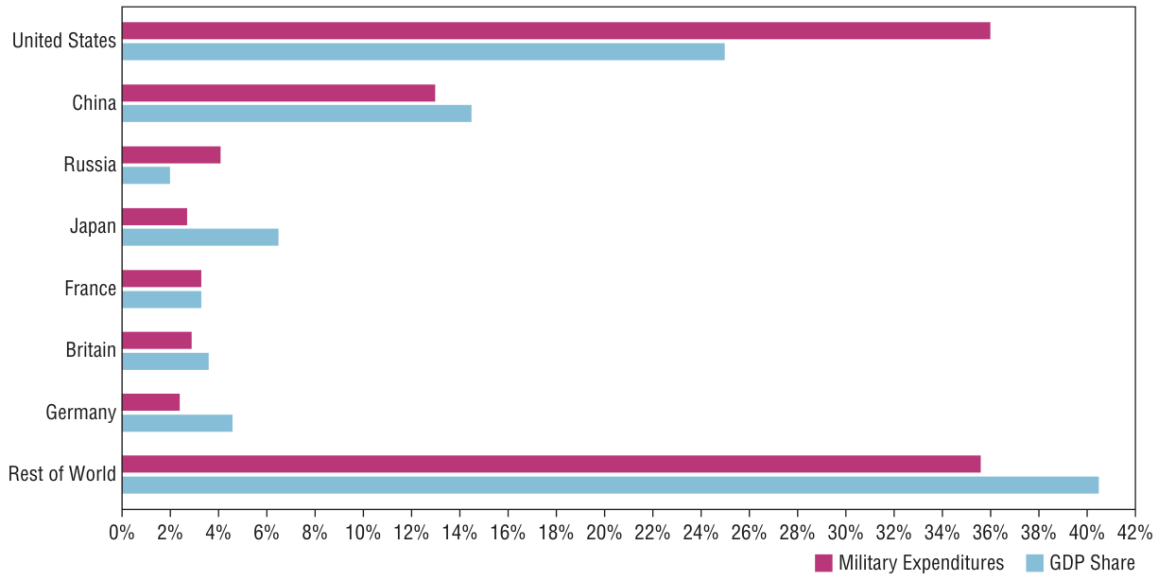
- **Two ways to think about power:**
  - **Power as influence** = getting another to do what it *wouldn't otherwise* do (but this is circular — we rarely know the "otherwise").
  - **Power as capability** = the *resources* behind influence — easier to measure. **Best single yardstick = total GDP** (bundles size, wealth, technology).
- **★ Elements of power (capabilities) — the sub-concepts.** Power-as-capability is a **bundle of resources**, and the textbook sorts them two ways: by **time horizon** (long- vs short-term) and by **tangibility** (material vs non-material).

| Time horizon | Tangible (material) | Intangible (non-material) |
|---|---|---|
| **Long-term** — change slowly; *who **will** be powerful* | total **GDP** · **population** · **territory** · **geography** · **natural resources** | **political culture** · **patriotism** · **education** of the population · **science/technology base** · **credibility / reputation** (keeping its word) · **power of ideas / soft power** |
| **Short-term** — influence *now* | **military forces** (size, composition, preparedness — the realist's #1) · **military-industrial capacity** (make weapons fast) · **quality of the bureaucracy** | **legitimacy & support** from constituents/allies · **loyalty** of the army & politicians to the leader |

- **Best single yardstick = total GDP** (bundles size + wealth + technology) — but only a *rough* estimator.
- **Fungibility** = how far one element **converts into** another. **Money is the most fungible** (it buys the rest); realists treat **military force** as the most important short-term element and rate the others by how fungible they are **into** military power.
- **Geopolitics** = using **geography** as power — "*location, location, location*": bases near a rival, control of **trade routes** & **key resources** (oil pipelines in Central Asia; new **Arctic** shipping routes as the ice melts).
- **★ Long-term beats short-term (worked example): Pearl Harbor (1941)** — Japan had the short-term **military** edge and overran the Pacific, but the US's greater **long-term** power resources (economic potential) let it build up and **overwhelm** Japan. *(Capabilities aren't just what you have now, but what you can **generate**.)*
- **★ Relative vs absolute gains (the exam favourite).** A liberal asks "*do I gain?*" (**absolute**). A realist asks "*do I gain **more than my rival?***" (**relative**) — because today's cooperation can fund tomorrow's threat. *(Deck exercise: if a deal gives you +10 but your rival +20, a realist may **refuse** — the rival's larger gain shifts the future balance.)* Examples: US–USSR nuclear parity; US–China tech race.

**Figure 2.3** Great Power Shares of World GDP, 2017, and Military Expenditures, 2016

*Data Sources:* World Bank Development Indicators, 2017; *SIPRI Yearbook,* 2016.




**How to read it (great-power capabilities).** Two bars per country — **GDP share** (blue) and **military-spending share** (magenta). The realist reads it as the **distribution of material power**: the **US** leads on *both*, **China** is a clear second, and the other five trail — a snapshot of who can bring what to bear. (This is "power as capability" made concrete.)

## The security dilemma — why arming backfires

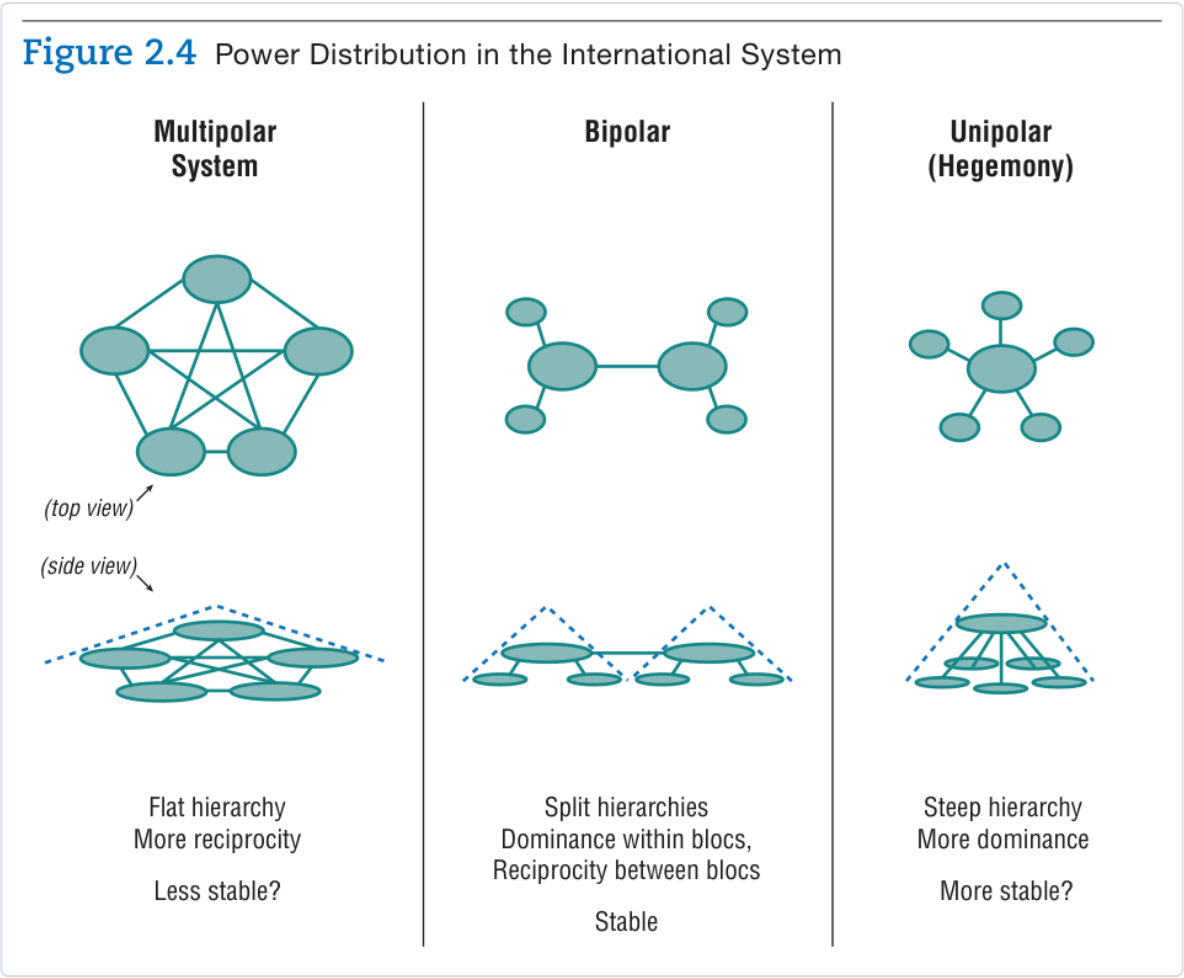
*Core:* **security dilemma** = *when a state arms to feel safer, it makes others feel **less** safe, so they arm too — and everyone ends up less secure.* A direct product of anarchy, and the engine of **arms races**.

- *In plain terms:* you buy a gun for self-defence; your neighbour sees it, feels threatened, buys two; now you're both more armed and **no safer**. Realists think it's **unsolvable** under anarchy; liberals think institutions can ease it.

## Balance of power, balancing & polarity

*Core:* **balance of power** = a distribution in which **no single state can dominate** — because when power concentrates, others have an incentive to **counter** it. It can be an **outcome**, a **process** (balancing), or a **strategy**.

- **How states balance: internal balancing** (build up *your own* capabilities) vs **external balancing** (form **alliances**). A **balancer** throws its weight against whoever is strongest (Britain in Europe for centuries).
- **Balancing vs bandwagoning:** instead of balancing the strongest, small states sometimes **jump on the bandwagon** of the winner (after WWII most joined the US bloc rather than balancing it) — and states often **balance *threats*, not raw power** (US power was greater but less threatening than the USSR's).
- **Polarity = how many "poles" (great-power centres) the system has** — and structure shapes the choices available to states:




**How to read it (polarity). Multipolar** (5–6 independent powers): a *flat* hierarchy of shifting alliances — the classic balance of power, but war-prone. **Bipolar** (two blocs, e.g. Cold War): dominance *within* each bloc, reciprocity *between* them — often judged **stable**. **Unipolar / hegemony** (one dominant state): the *steepest* hierarchy. Empirically the book reports peace is best preserved by **hegemony**, next by **bipolarity** — *not* by multipolar equality. *(Link: **power-transition theory** says the biggest wars come when a **rising** power threatens to overtake the top state — the "Thucydides Trap," e.g. US–China.)*

## Hegemony & hegemonic stability

***Core:*** a **hegemon** holds such a **preponderance of power** that it can **single-handedly set the rules** of the system (Britain in the 1800s; the US after 1945). **Hegemonic stability theory:** the system is most orderly when power is most **concentrated** — the hegemon supplies order like a stand-in government (deterring aggression, underwriting free trade, providing a reserve currency).

- *Why would the strongest enforce rules that help everyone?* Because as the **biggest trader/producer** it gains most from an open, stable system it dominates. *(Downside: weaker states may see hegemony as **infringing their sovereignty** — China uses "hegemony" as an insult.)*

## The realism family — four versions

***Core:*** realism is a **family**; the versions differ on *where* the drive for power comes from and *how much* domestic politics matters.

| Version | Key theorist | Where the power-drive comes from | States are… |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Classical** | **Morgenthau (1948)** | **human nature** + ambition; a timeless "struggle for power" | interest-maximisers |
| **Structural / Neorealism** | **Waltz (1979)** | the **anarchic structure** itself forces self-help (not human nature) | — |
| **Defensive** (structural) | **Waltz** | enough power to be **safe** | **security maximisers** → balance of power forms |
| **Offensive** (structural) | **Mearsheimer (2001)** | *more* is always safer → seek to **dominate** | **power maximisers**, never satisfied with the BoP |
| **Neoclassical** | **Zakaria, Rose (1998)** | structure **+ domestic factors** (leaders, perceptions, state–society relations) as an **intervening variable** | — |

*In plain terms:* **classical** = "it's in our nature"; **structural** = "it's the situation (anarchy), not our nature"; **defensive** = "grab enough to be safe"; **offensive** = "the only safe amount is *all* of it"; **neoclassical** = "structure pushes, but domestic politics filters the push."

- ★ **Offensive realism up close — "the best defence is offence" (Mearsheimer).** This is the concept behind "*you attack **in order to** defend yourself.*" It chains straight off **capabilities**: (1) under **anarchy** you can never be **sure** of another state's **intentions** — they can hide them, and they can change overnight — so you must judge others by their **capabilities** (the realist maxim "*watch capabilities, not intentions*"); (2) but *any* state with the **capability** to hurt you is a **potential** threat; (3) so the *only* way to be **certain** you're safe is to be **more powerful than everyone else.** Hence offensive realists say states are **power maximisers** who **expand — and will strike first (pre-emption)** — not out of greed but as the *safest* route to survival. **Defensive** realists reply that grabbing *too much* power backfires: it triggers **balancing** by others (and feeds the **security dilemma**), so the smart move is **enough** security, not domination. *(That debate — **is more power always safer, or does over-reach make you less safe?** — is the whole offensive-vs-defensive-realism split.)*

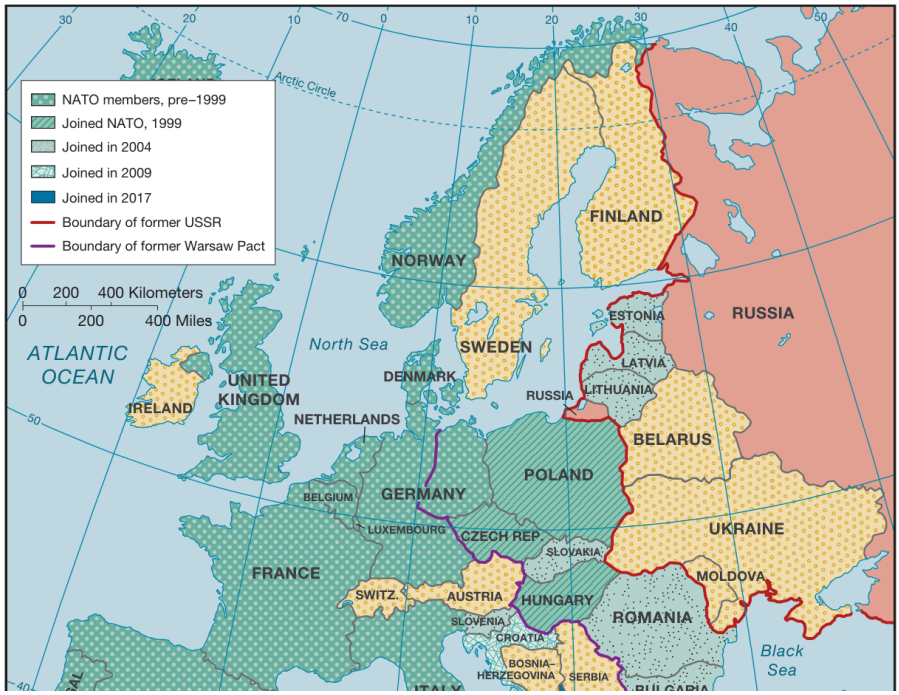
## Alliances & NATO

***Core:*** an **alliance** = a coalition of states coordinating (usually by treaty) against a **common threat.** Realists stress **fluidity** — alliances are "*marriages of convenience, not love,*" made and broken on **national interest** (*Palmerston:* "*no eternal allies… only perpetual interests*"). No element of power shifts as **fast** as an alliance.

- **NATO** (1949) = a US-led alliance built to **deter the USSR**; its Cold War rival was the **Warsaw Pact**. Its collective-defence heart, **Article V**, was first invoked *after 9/11* — **Europe defending the US**, the reverse of its original design. Post-Cold-War it **expanded east**:

**Figure 2.7** NATO Expansion

*Sources:* U.S. Department of Defense.




**How to read it (NATO expansion).** The shading shows NATO creeping **eastward** toward Russia in waves (Poland/Czech/Hungary 1999 → the Baltics + others 2004 → …). Realists read this as classic **security-dilemma** material: the West sees it as **securing democracies**; **Russia** sees encroachment on its borders — each side's "defensive" move looks **threatening** to the other. (**Burden-sharing** — who pays — is the recurring intra-alliance fight, e.g. Trump vs NATO.)

## The Prisoner's Dilemma — why rational states fail to cooperate

***Core:*** the **Prisoner's Dilemma (PD)** models why **rational actors, each pursuing self-interest, all end up worse off** than if they'd cooperated. It's realism's pessimism in a 2×2 box.

- *The story:* two prisoners are questioned separately. Each reasons "*whatever the other does, I'm better off **confessing** (defecting)*" — so both defect and get long sentences, when **mutual silence** (cooperation) would have been better.

**Figure 2.9** Payoff Matrix in India-Pakistan PD Game

| | | Pakistan: Cooperate | Pakistan: Defect |
|---|---|---|---|
| **India** | Cooperate | (3,3) | (1,4) |
| | Defect | (4,1) | (2,2) |

*Note*: First number in each group is India's payoff, second is Pakistan's. The number 4 is highest payoff, a 1 lowest.

**How to read it (the PD matrix).** Each cell = *(India's payoff, Pakistan's payoff)*; **4 = best, 1 = worst.** "Cooperate" = *don't* build the bomb; "Defect" = build it. Read India's logic: *if Pakistan builds (right column), 2 > 1 so India should build; if Pakistan doesn't (left column), 4 > 3 so India should still build.* **Defecting dominates** — so both build (2, 2), even though **mutual cooperation (3, 3) is better for both.** That's the tragedy: individually rational →

collectively worse. *(Real world: India tested 1998, Pakistan followed within weeks.)* **Deterrence** (threaten punishment so an attack never happens) and **compellence** (force someone to *act*) are the strategies states use to escape or manage it.

### The cooperation puzzle — the bridge to next lecture

***Core:*** if the system is anarchic, **why is cooperation sometimes deep and durable** (EU, WTO, NATO)? **Realist answer:** institutions ultimately just **reflect the interests and power of the strongest states. Liberal answer** (next lecture): institutions can **change the incentives** and make cooperation easier.

## Cases & examples

- **Denmark–US / Greenland (Trump) → anarchy → uncertainty**: even between NATO allies, DK couldn't fully trust US respect for its sovereignty → boosted conscription & Nordic defence ties.
- **India–Pakistan nuclear race** → the **Prisoner's Dilemma** in the flesh (both defect → both nuclear, 1998).
- **US–China → power-transition / relative gains** — a rising power unsettling the top spot; balancing in tech, trade, the South China Sea.
- **Rise of China / balancing** → as China's capabilities grow, *others* balance it (Japan's deals with South Korea & the Philippines) — not everyone balances the US.
- **NATO expansion east** → **security dilemma** (Western "securing democracies" vs Russian "encroachment").
- **Libya 2011** → power-as-capability (NATO's ~300:1 GDP edge) *and* **unintended consequences** (weapons spilling into Mali).
- **Nuclear non-proliferation** → the **three solutions** (dominance/reciprocity/identity) working together.

## Key terms

| Term | Meaning |
|---|---|
| International relations (IR) | Relations among governments + their links to other actors/forces |
| Collective-goods problem | Serving the group interest when members are tempted to free-ride |
| Dominance / reciprocity / identity | The three ways to get cooperation without a world government |
| Sovereignty | A state's right to rule inside its own borders (non-interference) |
| Anarchy | No central authority above states ("no world police") — *not* chaos |
| Levels of analysis | The scale of explanation: individual / domestic / interstate / global |
| Realism | Explains IR mainly through **power** |
| Unitary / rational actor | State acts as one voice, maximising its interests (rational ≠ moral) |
| National interest | The state's overall interest — for realists, defined as **power** |
| Self-help | Each state must provide its own security |
| Power (capability vs influence) | Resources behind influence vs getting others to act differently |
| Relative vs absolute gains | Do I gain *more than my rival* vs do I gain at all |
| Security dilemma | My arming makes you insecure → you arm → both less safe |
| Balance of power | A distribution where no state can dominate; balancing counters the strong |
| Polarity | Number of great-power centres: unipolar / bipolar / multipolar |
| Hegemony | One state preponderant enough to set the system's rules |
| Alliance / NATO | Coalition vs a common threat; NATO = US-led, anti-Soviet, now expanded |
| Prisoner's Dilemma | Rational self-interest → both defect → both worse off than cooperating |
| Deterrence / compellence | Threat to stop an action vs threat to force an action |

## Exam pointers

- Define **anarchy** correctly (**not chaos** — no enforcer) and run the **realist causal chain** cold: anarchy → uncertainty → self-help → relative power → competition.
- List realism's **assumptions** (unitary + rational actor, states, anarchy, power > morality) and stress **rational ≠ good** (war can be rational).
- Explain **power as capability vs influence**, and nail **relative vs absolute gains** (the realist refuses a deal a liberal would take).
- Explain the **security dilemma** and use **NATO expansion** as the case.
- Compare **polarity** types and state the finding that **hegemony/bipolarity** preserve peace better than multipolarity; add **power-transition theory**.
- Place the **four realisms** (classical/defensive/offensive/neoclassical) and their theorists.
- Work the **Prisoner's Dilemma** matrix (why *defect* dominates → both worse off) and connect it to arms races & deterrence.

- Use the **collective-goods problem** + **dominance/reciprocity/identity** to frame *why* cooperation is hard under anarchy.

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## ★ Fun facts & memorable details (IR I: Realism)

> Sticky bits from the realism lecture.

- **Thucydides**, ~2,400 years ago: "*the strong do what they have the power to do and the weak accept what they have to accept*" — realism's oldest one-liner.
- **Anarchy ≠ chaos.** It just means **no world police** — the system actually runs on remarkably stable **norms** (an embassy is treated as home soil; borders are respected).
- **Rational ≠ right:** for a realist, if the expected cost of *not* fighting beats the cost of fighting, **war is the rational choice** — morality doesn't enter the calculation.
- **NATO's Article V** (an attack on one is an attack on all) has been invoked **exactly once** — after **9/11**, with **Europe** coming to the defence of the **US**, the mirror image of why NATO was built.
- **The relative-gains trap:** a realist may **turn down** a deal that makes them richer (+10) if it makes a rival richer still (+20) — because the *gap* is what shapes tomorrow's balance of power.
- **Peace by inequality:** the book's counterintuitive finding — a lopsided **hegemony** (one dominant power) keeps the peace *better* than a balanced, equal, multipolar world.
- **Bandwagoning beats balancing (sometimes):** after WWII most states didn't gang up on the US — they **joined** it, puzzling pure balance-of-power theory.
- **Palmerston (1848):** "*We have no eternal allies and we have no perpetual enemies. Our interests are perpetual*" — the realist view of alliances as marriages of convenience.

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# IR II: Liberalism (AUW)

**Required reading:** PG = **Goldstein & Pevehouse, *International Relations* — ch. 3, §3.1 (*The Waning of War*) & §3.2 (*Liberal Theories*) + ch. 7 (*International Organizations, Law, and Human Rights*)**. · Lecturer: **Ayça Uygur Wessel.**

**Theme of the lecture (AUW — deck).** Liberalism as the **theoretical response to realism.** Realism explains rivalry, competition, security dilemmas and arms races — *but what about* European integration, IOs, international trade, arms-control agreements, and the democratic peace? **Liberalism's puzzle:** *if the international system is anarchic, why do states cooperate at all — and under what conditions is cooperation more or less likely?*

> ★ **The heart of the lecture:** liberalism keeps realism's starting point — **states are rational, self-interested actors under anarchy** — but reaches the opposite conclusion: **self-interest does not necessarily produce conflict.** Because some interests **overlap**, cooperation is often the rational choice: **self-interest → mutual benefits → reasoned cooperation → stable cooperation.** Two branches say how: **liberal institutionalism** — *institutions* make cooperation easier (information, reciprocity, monitoring, enforcement, the shadow of the future); and **liberal internationalism** — *domestic politics* shape what states want (the Kantian triangle: democracy + interdependence + IOs). *Liberalism ≠ being nice or naïve — it's "under what conditions is cooperation in states' own interest?"*

**The red thread.** For any case ask: *cooperation looks impossible under anarchy — so what makes it happen here?* Either the answer is **institutional** (rules/monitoring/reciprocity change the incentives) or it is **domestic** (regime type, interests, public opinion shape state preferences). Both keep the realist assumption of self-interested rational states.

**Three things liberalism is NOT (deck).** Liberalism *in IR* ≠ **economic liberalism** (free markets) ≠ **liberalism in domestic politics** (a left–right ideology). In IR it is a **theory of cooperation under anarchy.**

## ★ Liberalism at a glance — the scaffold *(same frame as realism)*

> *The whole theory on one page, named by function. Each part is unpacked in the lettered sections below — use this as the map.*

- ① **Rules / assumptions:** rational, self-interested states under anarchy (keeps realism's start) — **but** interests *overlap*, so cooperation is often the rational choice, not conflict. *(The **institutionalist** branch concedes realism's unitary/rational/anarchy; the **internationalist** branch breaks "unitary" by opening the domestic black box.)*
- ② **Branches (types):** **Liberal institutionalism** (Keohane & Nye — *international* level) · **Liberal internationalism** (Kant — *domestic* level). → §B
- ③ **Mechanisms — one chain per branch** *(the exam's core — keep them apart):*
  - **Institutionalism:** master chain **self-interest → mutual benefits → reasoned cooperation → stable**; the *final* arrow ("stable") is locked by **four mechanisms — shadow of the future · information/monitoring · reciprocity/enforcement · interdependence.** → §C
  - **Internationalism:** chain **domestic interests → (filtered by institutions) → state preferences → foreign policy → international outcome**, running through the **Kantian triangle** (democracy · interdependence · IOs). → §E
- ④ **Key concepts:** absolute gains (vs realism's relative gains) · international regime (Krasner) · complex interdependence (sensitivity vs vulnerability) · collective security · democratic peace · IGOs/NGOs/UN/international law (ch. 7). → §D, §G
- ⑤ **Why it's weak:** cooperation stays **fragile** — states still cheat & free-ride; institutions lean on a **hegemon** and **fail against great-power aggression** (the veto); interdependence raises war's price but **didn't stop 1914.**
- ⑥ **Critics: realists** — institutions just **mirror the distribution of power** (Mearsheimer), and states fear **relative** gains; **constructivists** — liberalism takes preferences as **given**: *where do they come from?* → §H realism vs liberalism

## Key concepts / "modes" to use

- **The cooperation puzzle** — why cooperate under anarchy? (the question realism can't answer well).
- **Two branches: liberal institutionalism** (Keohane, Nye — international level) vs **liberal internationalism** (Kant — domestic/unit level).
- **Neoliberal institutionalism** — concedes realism's assumptions (unitary, rational, anarchy) but shows cooperation still pays.
- **Reciprocity** & the **shadow of the future · information/monitoring/transparency · enforcement · issue linkage**.
- **International regime** (Krasner) — "principles, norms, rules, and decision-making procedures around which actor expectations converge." *(An international institution ≠ an IO.)*

- **Complex interdependence** (Keohane & Nye) — multiple channels; disruption is costly for both sides (sensitivity vs vulnerability).
- **The Kantian triangle** — democracy + economic interdependence + international organizations.
- **Democratic peace** — democracies almost never fight *each other*.
- **Collective security · IGOs/NGOs · the UN · international law · just war · human rights (ch.7).**

## Section-by-section main points

### A. How liberalism sees the world *(deck + §3.1–3.2 intro)*

*Core:* liberalism is **more optimistic** than realism about peace and progress, but it is **not** starry-eyed: states are still **rational actors pursuing self-interest** — the liberal twist is that **self-interest often points to cooperation, not conflict.**

- **The chain (deck): self-interest → mutual benefits → reasoned cooperation → stable cooperation.** Cooperation is possible **without** becoming altruistic.
- **Realism vs liberalism on the "rules of IR":** realists see power politics as **timeless**; liberals see the rules as **slowly, incrementally evolving toward peace** — through the buildup of **international organizations + reciprocity** (and secondarily changing **norms/public opinion**). Liberalism draws on the **reciprocity and identity** principles, where realism draws on **dominance**.
- **§3.1 The Waning of War (the empirical backdrop):** contrary to the media impression, this is **one of the least warlike periods ever.** Battle-deaths have fallen sharply since WWII (tens of millions → millions → hundreds of thousands); the **last great-power war ended 60+ years ago**; today's conflicts (Syria, Yemen, Ukraine) are, by historical standards, **small wars.** → *This trend is what liberalism claims to explain and realism struggles to.*

### B. The two branches of liberalism *(deck)*

*Core:* liberalism gives **two** answers to realism — one at the **international** level, one at the **domestic** level.

| | Liberal Institutionalism | Liberal Internationalism |
|---|---|---|
| **Key names** | **Keohane & Nye** | **Kant** |
| **Main question** | How can states cooperate despite anarchy? | Why do states *want* different things? |
| **Level of analysis** | **International** (systemic) | **Domestic / unit** level |
| **Core mechanisms** | Information · reciprocity · monitoring · enforcement | Regime type · institutions · interests · public opinion |
| **Simple claim** | **Institutions make cooperation easier** | **Domestic politics shape state preferences** |

*(Deck aside: liberal internationalism's focus on the domestic level mirrors what **neoclassical realism** does on the realist side — both "open up" the state rather than treating it as a black box.)*

### C. ★ Liberal institutionalism — what makes cooperation possible *(§3.2.2 + deck)*

*Core:* **neoliberal (institutionalist)** thinking says to realists: "*Even granting your assumptions — unitary, rational states under anarchy — your pessimism doesn't follow.*" States cooperate often because it's in their interest, and

**institutions** help them do it by **changing the incentives.** The engine is **reciprocity**, which enforces rules **without a world government.**

- **International institution ≠ IO (Krasner 1983).** An **international regime/institution** = "*principles, norms, rules, and decision-making procedures around which actor expectations converge*" — not just the UN or EU, but **monitoring arrangements, agreements, and platforms.** Institutions **structure repeated interaction.**
- **The four mechanisms (the deck's core — how institutions enable cooperation):**
  1. **The shadow of the future.** In a **one-shot** game, defecting is a free lunch — you grab the one-time **temptation payoff** and there is no tomorrow to pay for it. **Repeated** interaction changes the *arithmetic*: cheating once wins that bonus but **forfeits every future round of cooperation**, because the other side stops cooperating with you (tit-for-tat). So a purely selfish state weighs **one big cheat now** against **a stream of cooperative payoffs forever** — and when the future is **long enough and valued enough** (a low discount on tomorrow), the stream wins. *That* is why a **longer time horizon + more future interaction → higher cost of defection → cooperation more attractive**: cooperation becomes **self-enforcing not because states are nice, but because defection is bad maths.** *(The repeated **Prisoner's Dilemma** — see IR I — solved by **tit-for-tat**: cooperate first, then mirror.)*
  2. **Information changes the game.** Mutual cooperation is the jointly best outcome, yet each side fears the **sucker's payoff** (*I cooperate, you defect*) — and under **uncertainty** that fear makes both defect **pre-emptively**, even when both would rather cooperate. **Reporting** (what parties *say*) + **monitoring** (what they *actually do*) → **transparency** attacks the **fear, not the payoffs**: once I can verify you are complying, the risk of being suckered without recourse collapses, so I can safely **condition my cooperation on your observed behaviour.** Information also **makes reciprocity possible at all** — you cannot punish a cheat you cannot detect. *(Ex: the **European Semester** — the EU monitors member states' budgets to deter "excessive deficits.")*
  3. **Reciprocity & enforcement.** ***Reciprocity = responding in kind*** — meet **cooperation with cooperation** and **defection with punishment** (*positive* reciprocity rewards; *negative* reciprocity retaliates). It is **liberalism's answer to "who enforces the rules when there is no world government?"** — states police each other by making **defection cost you tomorrow's cooperation** (**tit-for-tat**: cooperate first, then mirror). So **cooperation ≠ harmony** — it needs bargaining and adjustment, and persists **only when defection has consequences. Why *tit-for-tat* in particular wins** (not "always cooperate," which gets exploited, nor "always defect," which kills cooperation): it is **nice** (never defects first, so two tit-for-tatters lock into mutual cooperation), **retaliatory** (punishes a defection *immediately*, so cheating never pays), **forgiving** (returns to cooperation the instant you do, so punishment does not spiral pointlessly), and **clear** (simple enough that the other side quickly *learns* the rule and sees that cooperating is in its own interest). Institutions supply the machinery to run it: **detect** (monitoring) → **respond** (reciprocity) → **raise the cost** (enforcement) → plus **issue linkage** (cooperate across issues so a concession on one trades for another). *(Ex: **rule-of-law sanctions** — the EU froze **Hungary's** funds.)* **The double edge:** the same reciprocity can spiral into **runaway hostility** — endless mutual punishment (**Israel–Palestine**).
  4. **Interdependence makes conflict costly. Complex interdependence** (≠ friendship, ≠ one-way dependence): states are tied through **trade, investment, finance, supply chains, people, and communication** across *multiple channels*. The mechanism is **opportunity cost**, and it is worth seeing why this one works *differently* from the other three. Reciprocity and the shadow of the future deter by threatening a **future punishment someone has to choose to impose**; interdependence deters **automatically.** War or sanctions **sever the ties themselves**, so the **gains from trade you would lose** are a cost **built into the relationship in advance** — it bites the moment conflict starts, with no decision required. The denser the ties, the larger that standing cost → the **stronger the incentive to negotiate** rather than fight. Two refinements: **(a)** the cost is **mutual but usually asymmetric** — the **vulnerable**

side (no good alternative: an economy dependent on one export market or one gas supplier) has far more to lose than the merely **sensitive** side (feels the disruption but can switch suppliers), so interdependence deters the **vulnerable** party more; **(b)** this is also realism's sharpest counter — interdependence was **high before 1914 and war came anyway**, so the mechanism **raises the price of conflict without making it impossible.** *(Sensitivity vs vulnerability is the textbook's distinction.)*

- **The neoliberal PD argument:** each actor can gain by defecting, but both lose if both defect; in **repeated** play, **strict reciprocity (tit-for-tat)** brings mutual cooperation. **Danger:** reciprocity can also produce **runaway hostility** — a nasty tit-for-tat of punishments (**Israel–Palestine**).
- **The EU — "a liberal-institutionalism masterpiece" (deck):** European states have **shared interests** *and* **incentives to defect**; the institutional solution — **permanent forums, common rules, monitoring, courts/enforcement, issue linkage, repeated interaction** — makes cooperation **easier and more predictable.** After centuries of war, Europe now enjoys a **stable peace.** *(Yet members still "cheat" over the years — cooperation is managed, not automatic.)*

## D. International regimes & collective security *(§3.2.3–3.2.4)*

***Core:*** two linked ideas, best kept apart. A **regime** is how liberalism operationalises cooperation in **one issue area**; **collective security** is that same logic applied to the **hardest** issue of all — stopping aggression (*all* against *any* aggressor).

**1. International regimes** *(§3.2.3)*

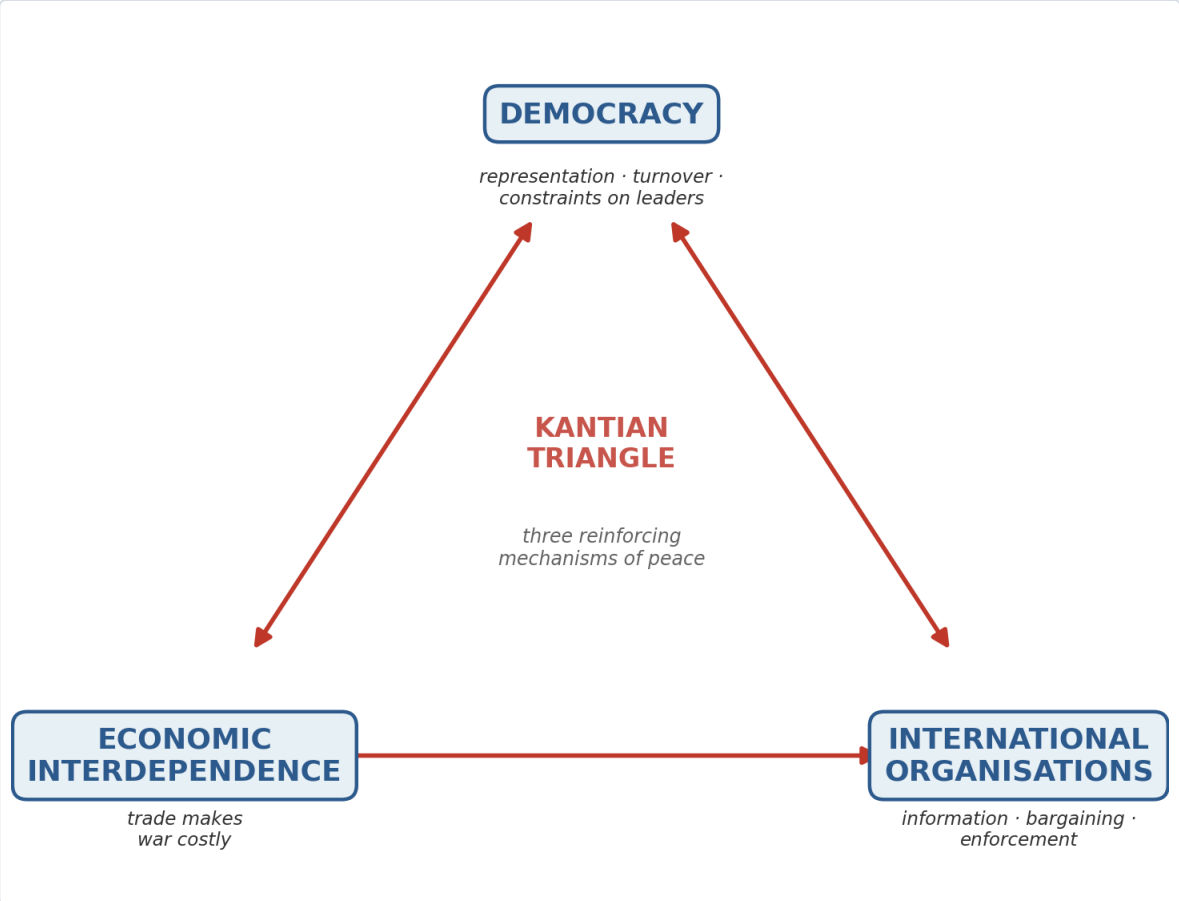
- **What it is:** the **rules, norms and procedures where state expectations converge** in a single issue area — arms control, trade, the law of the sea. *(Fuller Krasner definition in section C; a regime ≠ an IO — it's the shared rulebook, which may or may not sit inside a formal body.)*
  - ***Concrete example — the nuclear non-proliferation regime.*** Watch Krasner's four parts line up: the **principle** that spreading nuclear weapons is dangerous → the **norm** that states should not acquire them → the **rules** of the **NPT** (the treaty text) → the **decision-making procedures** of the **IAEA** (inspections, monitoring, reporting). Most states' expectations **converge** on this one rulebook *even though no world government enforces it* — and that convergence **is** the regime. Note it's **not** a single IO: the NPT (a treaty), the IAEA (a body) and the shared norm together make up the regime.
  - ***Real empirical case — Sweden and Japan had the bomb within reach and chose not to build it.*** Both had the industrial and scientific capability to go nuclear in the Cold War, yet **both stayed non-nuclear** — not because anyone forced them, but because the **NPT bargain** (give up the bomb in exchange for others doing the same + access to civilian nuclear tech) and the **non-proliferation norm** made restraint the **expected, legitimate** choice. The regime did its work: far **fewer states went nuclear than once feared**, because expectations converged on "don't build." *(This is the regime visibly **shaping behaviour** — pure power politics would have predicted capable states arming.)*
- **What it does:** a regime **empowers rather than constrains.** It raises **transparency** (cheating is riskier) and "opens up new possibilities with more favourable cost–benefit ratios," so states join because it **helps** them pursue their interests, not because anyone forces them.
- **Hegemonic stability (a realist–liberal blend):** regimes work best when power is **concentrated** — a **hegemon** willing to enforce the rules and bear the costs. *But* once expectations have converged, a regime can **outlive the hegemon that built it** ("take on a life of their own": US economic regimes survived America's relative decline in the 1970s), and it often **embeds** in a permanent institution (**UN, NATO, IMF**).

**2. Collective security** *(§3.2.4)*

- **What it is:** the **security-side application** of regime logic (Kant's federation): a **broad alliance of most major powers** that pledges to oppose **aggression by *any* state** — "all against one," unlike an ordinary alliance aimed at a *named* external enemy.
- **Two conditions to work: (1)** members actually **keep their commitments** (no free-riding when the bill comes due); **(2)** they **agree on what counts as aggression.**
- **Its built-in limit:** it **cannot act against a great power** — the **veto** (or that power's own weight) blocks any united response.
- **Evidence:**
  - **League of Nations** — *failed*: the US never joined and members would not bear the costs, so **Japan and Italy** went unchecked in the 1930s. The **UN** is its successor.
  - **Gulf War 1990–91** — *worked*: Iraq's blatant conquest of Kuwait **united** the great powers behind a UN-authorised response.
  - **Iraq 2003** — *split* the great powers (France threatened a veto; the US, UK and Australia acted anyway) — collective security failing exactly where great powers **disagree**.

## E. ★ Liberal internationalism & the Kantian triangle *(§3.2.1 + deck)*

***Core:*** liberal internationalism opens the **domestic "black box"**: what a state *wants* (its **preferences**) depends on **who has a say inside it. Kant's three answers** to "how is peace possible?" form the **Kantian triangle.**




**How to read it (the Kantian triangle).** Kant gave **three** routes to peace, and they **reinforce** each other:

- **Democracy** — republics with **legislatures that check the leader** are constrained from going to war lightly (representation, leadership turnover, accountability). *(→ the democratic peace.)*

- **Economic interdependence — trade increases wealth and mutual dependence**, so war becomes **costly** and less attractive. *(Kant's "trade promotes peace"; realists are skeptical — interdependence was high before WWI, yet war came.)*
- **International organisations** — a **federation of states** (Kant's proposal → today's **UN**) provides **information, bargaining, and enforcement**, letting states forgo short-term gains for long-term cooperation. *(→ liberal institutionalism.)*
- **The point:** each corner makes the others more effective; together they explain why, despite anarchy, the world has grown **more peaceful.**
- **The causal chain of liberal internationalism (deck): domestic institutions + interests + incentives** (who benefits? who has influence?) → **state preferences** (what does the government *want?*) → **foreign policy** (which international choice follows) → **international outcome** (cooperation, conflict, or variation across states).
- **The *how* the arrow hides — why you must open the black box.** Realism reads "the national interest" straight off a state's **position in the system**; liberal internationalism denies there *is* a single interest waiting to be read. A state is **not one actor but an arena**: exporters want open trade while import-competing firms want tariffs; defence contractors and nationalists want a harder line while consumers and internationalists want cooperation; the median voter wants something else again. Each group has a **different preferred foreign policy.** What turns this clash into *the* state preference is **institutions** — the rules deciding **whose voice counts**: who can vote, who holds a veto, whom the leader must keep happy to stay in power, which lobby has access. So the chain really runs **competing domestic interests → (filtered by institutions) → the winning coalition's preference *becomes* "the national interest" → foreign policy.** The payoff — and the whole reason to open the box — is that the **same** external situation produces **different** policies in different states (and different policies in the *same* state once the domestic coalition shifts), because the **aggregating machinery differs.** A systemic-only theory like realism cannot generate that variation, which is precisely why **neoclassical realism** later had to borrow this move.
- **Who's in the black box:** president/PM/monarch, parliament, courts, bureaucracies, business & labour, elections, interest groups, media & public opinion. → *This is why liberalism sits at the **domestic level of analysis** (contra realism's systemic focus).*

## F. The democratic peace *(§3.2.5 + deck)*

***Core:*** the **democratic peace** = the strongly-supported empirical finding that **democracies almost never fight *each other*** — though they fight authoritarian states as much as anyone. *(Democratic peace ≠ "democracies are peaceful.")*

- **Not true:** that democracies are *generally* more peaceful — they fight as many wars as autocracies (the most war-prone states of the past two centuries were **France, Russia, Britain**).
- **True:** no major historical case of two democracies going to war with each other.
- **Why (candidate mechanisms — the deck's exercise):** ① **public opinion & representation** (the public, whose support wars need, resists); ② **peaceful leadership turnover** (no need to fight to change rulers); ③ **transparency & mutual understanding** (democracies read each other's intentions); ④ **institutional constraints** (checks and balances slow the war decision). Also: democracies are usually **capitalist** with strong **trade interdependence**, and citizens **don't see other democracies as enemies.**
- **Why it matters theoretically:** the democratic peace is rooted in the **domestic** level → it **contradicts realism's** claim that the systemic level explains the most.

- **Caveats (don't oversell it): democratization/transition** may be *more* war-prone than stable regimes (e.g. Hamas elected 2006); and **democratic institutions can make cooperation harder** — legislatures raise **tariffs**, publics block IOs (US & the League of Nations; **Brexit**).

## G. The institutions themselves — IOs, the UN, international law & human rights *(ch. 7)*

***Core:*** ch. 7 is the **empirical "flesh"** on liberal institutionalism — the actual institutions through which states cooperate under anarchy. All of them are **limited by state sovereignty** (there is **no world government**), yet they **structure order** through norms, reciprocity, and legitimacy.

- **IGOs vs NGOs (§7.1): IGOs** = members are **states** (UN, OPEC, WTO, EU); **NGOs** = private/specialised (Amnesty, Greenpeace, Red Cross, religious bodies). The web of IOs has grown steadily → rising **interdependence.**
- **The UN (§7.2)** — "*the closest thing to a world government that has ever existed, but it is not a world government.*" It exists because **states created it to serve their needs** (membership = **indirect leverage**). Key organs:
  - **Security Council** — maintains peace; decisions **binding**; **5 permanent members (US, UK, France, Russia, China)** with the **veto** + 10 rotating members. A single permanent-member **veto** kills a resolution → **paralysis when great powers are involved** (Russia shielding **Syria**).
  - **Peacekeeping** ("**Chapter 6½**"; **blue helmets**) — serve at the **host's invitation**, neutral between combatants (Nobel Peace Prize 1988).
  - **General Assembly** — all **193 members, one vote each** — a "global town hall" (declarations are **not** binding law).
  - **Secretariat / Secretary-General** — administration + **neutral mediator** ("good offices").
  - **Specialised agencies** — WHO, ITU, ICAO; and the economic ones (**World Bank, IMF, WTO**).
- **International law (§7.3)** — derives **not** from a world legislature but from **tradition and agreement. Four sources: treaties** (most important; *pacta sunt servanda* — treaties must be kept), **custom**, **general principles**, **legal scholarship. Enforcement** has no world police → rests on **reciprocity + collective response** (sanctions, reprisals) → therefore **depends on power** (easy to cheat on small issues / if you're strong). The **World Court (ICJ, The Hague)** hears only **state-vs-state** cases (limited jurisdiction).
- **Law & sovereignty (§7.4): diplomatic law** (immunity; sanctity of embassies — the **Iran hostage crisis 1979**) is the bedrock. **Just-war doctrine: laws *of* war (*jus ad bellum*)** — when war is legal (**only in response to aggression**; intent must be just) — vs **laws *in* war (*jus in bello*)** — how it may be fought.
- **Human rights (§7.5):** the idea of universal human rights **clashes with sovereignty** (**universalism vs relativism**; China/Russia call criticism "interference in internal affairs"). Sources: **religion, natural-law philosophy (Locke, Kant, Rousseau), the 18th-c. revolutions. Civil-political ("negative") vs economic-social ("positive") rights.** The **UDHR (1948)** sets norms (not binding law). **R2P (responsibility to protect, 2005)** — states must protect civilians from genocide/crimes against humanity (invoked for **Libya 2011**; *failed* in **Syria**). **War crimes → the ICC** (from **Nuremberg**'s "crimes against humanity" → Yugoslavia/Rwanda tribunals → the International Criminal Court).

## Cases & examples

- **Nixon–China rapprochement (1969–72).** The US relaxed its trade embargo; three days later China released detained US citizens, then reciprocated further, culminating in Nixon's 1972 visit. → *Illustrates: **reciprocity** eliciting cooperation between rivals with no world government to enforce it.*
- **Israel–Palestinian tit-for-tat.** Reciprocity works both ways — sustained mutual punishment instead of cooperation. → *Illustrates: reciprocity's **runaway-hostility** danger (cooperation ≠ automatic).*

- **The European Union.** Shared interests + incentives to defect → an institutional solution (forums, rules, monitoring, courts, issue linkage, repeated interaction). → *Illustrates: **liberal institutionalism** at full strength — a stable peace built from institutions.*
- **Gulf War (1990–91).** Iraq's blatant annexation of Kuwait united all the great powers behind a UN-authorised response. → *Illustrates: **collective security working** — clear aggression + willingness to bear costs.*
- **Iraq War (2003).** The Security Council split (France's veto threat); the US/UK acted without UN authorisation. → *Illustrates: collective security's **limits** when the great powers disagree.*
- **R2P: Libya (2011) vs Syria (2011–).** A UN-authorised NATO campaign protected Libyan civilians; Syria's civilians got no such protection (Russian vetoes). → *Illustrates: the **norm shift** toward protecting civilians — and how **sovereignty** + **the veto** still block it.*

## Key terms

| Term | Meaning |
|---|---|
| Cooperation puzzle | Why do states cooperate under anarchy? (liberalism's central question) |
| Liberal institutionalism | Institutions make cooperation easier (Keohane & Nye; international level) |
| Liberal internationalism | Domestic politics shape state preferences (Kant; domestic level) |
| Neoliberalism | Concedes realist assumptions (unitary/rational/anarchy) but shows cooperation pays |
| Reciprocity / shadow of the future | Repeated interaction makes cheating costly → cooperation rational (tit-for-tat) |
| International regime | Rules/norms/procedures where actor expectations converge (Krasner) |
| Complex interdependence | Multiple cross-border channels; disruption costly for both (sensitivity vs vulnerability) |
| Kantian triangle | Democracy + economic interdependence + international organizations → peace |
| Democratic peace | Democracies almost never fight *each other* |
| Collective security | Broad alliance opposing aggression by any actor (League → UN) |
| UN Security Council / veto | 5 permanent members can each block any resolution |
| International law (sources) | Treaties · custom · general principles · scholarship (enforced by reciprocity) |
| Just war | *jus ad bellum* (when war is legal — response to aggression) vs *jus in bello* (how fought) |
| R2P | Responsibility to protect civilians from genocide/crimes against humanity (2005) |

## Exam pointers

- State **liberalism's puzzle** and its answer: keep the **realist assumptions** (rational self-interested states under anarchy) but show **cooperation is often rational** — and that liberalism is **not** "being nice/naïve."
- Distinguish the **two branches** (institutionalism = international/institutions; internationalism = domestic/preferences) and name their theorists (Keohane & Nye; Kant).

- Explain the **four institutionalist mechanisms** (shadow of the future, information/monitoring, reciprocity/enforcement, interdependence) — and define an **international regime** (Krasner) with the institution ≠ IO distinction.
- Draw the **Kantian triangle** and explain the **democratic peace** precisely (democracies rarely fight *each other*; the mechanisms; the caveats).
- Use **ch.7 institutions** as evidence: the **UN/Security Council + veto**, **collective security** (Gulf War vs Iraq 2003), **international law** (4 sources, reciprocity enforcement), **just war**, **human rights/R2P**.
- **Contrast with realism:** same actors, opposite conclusion — see the table below.

### ★ Realism vs Liberalism — the payoff

| | Realism (IR I) | Liberalism (IR II) |
|---|---|---|
| **Core principle** | **Dominance** (power) | **Reciprocity** (+ identity) |
| **View of anarchy** | Forces self-help & competition | Doesn't make conflict inevitable |
| **Human nature / progress** | Pessimistic, timeless | More optimistic; rules evolve toward peace |
| **Key actors & level** | Unitary states; **systemic** level | States **+ domestic** actors; institutions |
| **Cooperation** | Hard; fear of **relative gains** & cheating | Achievable via **institutions & absolute gains** |
| **Central concepts** | Power, security dilemma, balance of power, polarity | Institutions, regimes, interdependence, democratic peace |
| **Both agree on** | States are **rational actors** pursuing self-interest under anarchy | |

*The one-line contrast:* realism asks "*who has the power?*"; liberalism asks "*under what conditions is cooperation in states' own interest?*"

## ★ Fun facts & memorable details (IR II: Liberalism)

> Sticky bits from Liberalism.

- **Liberalism ≠ nice.** It keeps realism's rational, self-interested states — it just asks "**when does cooperation pay?**" The optimism is about **incentives**, not about human goodness.
- **We live in one of the least warlike periods ever** — the last **great-power war ended 60+ years ago**, and battle-deaths have fallen from *tens of millions* to *hundreds of thousands* since WWII (the "waning of war").
- **Tit-for-tat** — cooperate first, then simply mirror the other side — is enough to sustain cooperation in a **repeated** Prisoner's Dilemma. No world government required.
- **Kant distrusted democracy** (he feared "mob rule" after watching the French Revolution) — yet his *republics* argument became the **democratic peace**, liberalism's favourite finding.
- **Democracies fight plenty of wars** — just not against *each other.* The three most war-prone states of the last 200 years were **France, Russia, and Britain.**

- **The UN can't heat its own building:** in the 1990s members owed so much in back dues that the UN couldn't afford to heat its NYC headquarters — the campaign slogan became "**Great nations pay their bills.**"
- **UN peacekeeping isn't in the UN Charter** — Dag Hammarskjöld joked the **blue helmets** were authorised under "**Chapter Six and a Half**."
- **Diplomats' parking tickets:** immunity means NYC is owed ~**$16 million** in unpaid diplomatic parking fines — a tiny, vivid example of **sovereignty vs. law.**
- **Grotius returns:** the "**free seas**" principle became law when the **Dutch** (then the **British**) dominated trade and benefited from it — international law often codifies the **hegemon's** interest (cf. *Grotius, PET Module 2*).

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# IR III: Constructivism / Other Approaches (AUW)

**Required reading:** PG = **Goldstein & Pevehouse, *International Relations* — ch. 3, §3.3–3.6** (*Social Theories* [constructivism + postmodernism] · *Marxism* · *Peace Studies* · *Gender Theories*). · Lecturer: **Ayça Uygur Wessel.** Deck: "*Social constructivism & critical IR*."

**Theme of the lecture (deck).** After realism (power) and liberalism (cooperation), a third family shifts the question from **material facts to social meaning.** The deck's two questions: **(A) social constructivism** — *how do ideas, identities, norms and interaction construct interests and behaviour?* and **(B) critical IR theory** — *how do power and hierarchy shape those ideas and the international order itself?*

> ★ **The heart of the lecture:** for realism and (most) liberalism, states arrive with **interests already formed** and just pursue them. Constructivism denies this: **interests are not given — they are socially constructed** through **identities, norms and interaction** (social context → identity → interests → behaviour). Its slogan: "**anarchy is what states make of it**" (Wendt). **Critical theories** then add the question of **power**: they ask how a particular order comes to look "**natural**" — and **who benefits and who is silenced** (Marxism, Gramsci, world-systems, postcolonialism, feminist/queer IR).

**The red thread.** *Where do interests and "the way things are" come from?* Realism/liberalism take them as given; **constructivism** says they're **made through meaning**; **critical theory** says that meaning is **made through power and hierarchy.** For any event ask: *what identities and norms make this action thinkable — and whose interests does the "normal" order serve?*

## Key concepts / "modes" to use

- **Constructivism** — interests/identities are **socially constructed**, not given; draws on the **identity principle**.
- **Social facts vs material facts** — a tank/border/nuke is *material*; its **meaning** (threatening? legitimate?) is a **social fact**.
- "**Anarchy is what states make of it**" (Wendt 1992) — anarchy doesn't dictate friend-or-enemy.
- **Norms** + **logic of appropriateness** (vs realism's **logic of consequences**); **norm entrepreneurs**, NGOs, IOs.
- **Postmodernism** — texts/**discourse**, **deconstruction**, **subtext**; states as "fictions."
- **Critical theory** — denaturalise the order; **hierarchy** not just anarchy; **power over ideas/knowledge.**

- **Marxism** — class struggle; **Marx (domestic) vs Lenin (imperialism)**; **Gramsci** (hegemony = consent); **Wallerstein** (core/periphery); **postcolonialism / Said** (Orientalism).
- **Feminist & queer IR** — difference · liberal · postmodern feminism; the **masculinity of realism.**
- **Peace studies** — conflict resolution/**mediation**, **positive peace**, **structural violence**, **nonviolence**, **militarism**.

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## A. Social constructivism *(PG §3.3 + deck)*

### ★ Constructivism at a glance — the scaffold *(same frame as realism & liberalism)*

> *Use as the map; each item is unpacked in the sub-sections below.*

- ① **Core move / assumptions:** reject the premise — held by **realism and liberal *institutionalism*** — that **interests are given.** Interests are **socially constructed** through **ideas, identity & norms.** *(Liberal **internationalism** also opens the black box — but derives preferences from **material domestic interests**; constructivism derives them from **meaning**.)* Shift from **material facts → social meaning** (a tank is material; whether it's *threatening* is a **social fact**).
- ② **Sub-approaches: social constructivism** (the main one) · **postmodernism** (discourse, deconstruction, states as "fictions"). → §what it is, §postmodernism
- ③ **Mechanism:** chain **social context + interaction → identity → interests → behaviour**; "*anarchy is what states make of it*" (Wendt — same anarchy → friendship *or* enmity); norms shift via **norm entrepreneurs → legitimacy changes → interests change.** → §anarchy, §norms
- ④ **Key concepts:** social vs material facts · identity → interests · norms · **logic of appropriateness** vs logic of consequences.
- ⑤ **Why it's weak:** better at **explaining after the fact than predicting**; hard to tell a **genuine** identity from one **adopted strategically** for material gain (aid, trade, membership).
- ⑥ **Critics: realists** — norms are just **covers for interests**; **liberals** — it **neglects formal institutions.**

#### The puzzle — why does the same world produce different "realities"? (deck)

***Core:*** the system contains **material facts** (armies, territory, no world government) — but **material facts don't tell us what they mean.** Meaning is **socially constructed.**

- **The deck's puzzle:** why does the US treat **British** nuclear weapons utterly differently from **North Korean** ones? By raw military power **Britain is far stronger** than North Korea — yet no one calls British nukes a threat. Realism (capabilities) can't explain it; **shared history, alliance and identity** can. → *The **identity** of the other, not just its capabilities, decides whether it's a threat.*
- **A second puzzle:** why do practices once seen as **normal** (colonialism, racial hierarchy, conquest, piracy) later become **illegitimate**? Because the **norms** that give them meaning change.

#### ★ What constructivism is — interests are socially constructed

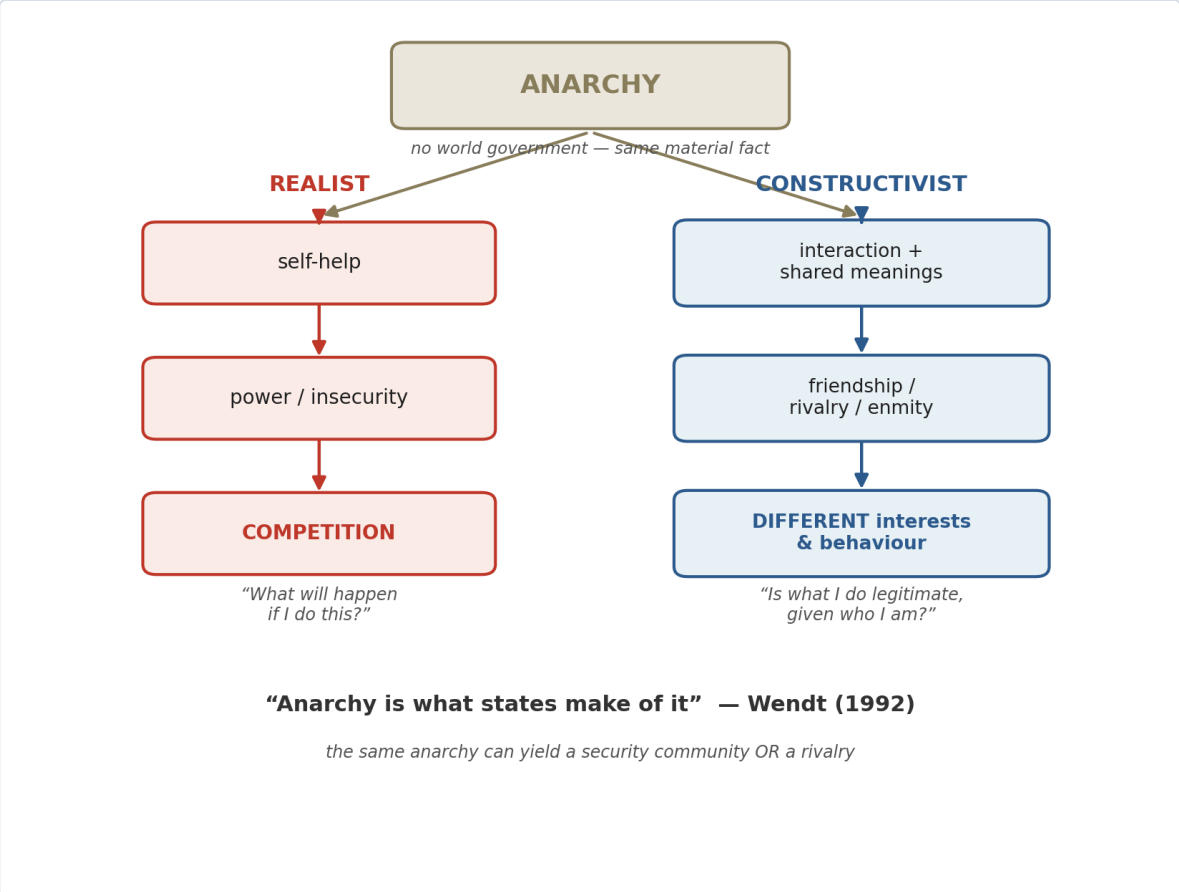
***Core:*** **constructivism** asks *how states come to understand what their interests are.* Where realism/liberalism take interests **as given**, constructivism says interests are **constituted** by **social context + interaction →**

**identities → interests → behaviour.** It's best called an **approach** (not a theory) built on the **identity principle.**

- **Material facts ≠ political meaning (deck):** a **tank, a border, a nuclear weapon** are material; **money, sovereignty, borders, diplomatic status, alliances, rights** are **social facts** — they exist only because actors **collectively recognise and act on them.** The question is never just "is there a tank?" but *"is the tank threatening? is the border legitimate?"*
- **Identity → interests (deck):** an **identity** is an actor's social understanding of **who it is in relation to others** (friend / ally / rival / enemy / neutral / "**rogue state**"). **Interests change when identities and relationships change**, and identities are **(re)shaped through interaction.** *(Chain: Who am I? → Who are you? → Are you one of us/them? → What kind of relationship? → What should I want/fear/do?)*
- **Logic of appropriateness vs logic of consequences:** realists/neoliberals assume a **logic of consequences** ("what will happen to me if I act this way?"); constructivists add a **logic of appropriateness** ("how *should* I behave, given who I am?"). *Example (PG):* the US intervened in **Somalia (1992)** — of minimal strategic value — because **norms about who deserves protection** had widened (from "Christians" in the 19th c. to a universal human-rights frame).
- **Identities change over time (PG): Europe** went from the continent of two world wars to a place where war became "**unthinkable**" (identities now tied to the EU); **pirates** went from the scourge of the seas to theme-park **mascots**; **Switzerland/Canada** value a *social* status (neutrality, peacekeeping), not just material power. *(What counts as "threatening" is neither universal nor timeless.)*

## ★ "Anarchy is what states make of it" (Wendt 1992)

***Core:*** the signature constructivist claim — **anarchy has no fixed logic.** It doesn't *tell* a state whether another is friend or enemy; that meaning is built through **interaction and shared understandings.**



**How to read it (the deck's slide 9).** Both chains start from the **identical material fact** — anarchy. The **realist** (red) reads anarchy as forcing **self-help → insecurity → competition**; the **constructivist** (blue) says anarchy is filled in by **interaction + shared meanings**, which can produce **friendship, rivalry, *or* enmity**. Same structure, opposite outcomes — because the meaning is **made**, not given. The bottom-line question flips from "*what will happen to me?*" (consequences) to "*is this legitimate, given who I am?*" (appropriateness).

| | Realist chain | Constructivist chain |
|---|---|---|
| Start | **anarchy** | **anarchy** |
| → | self-help | **interaction + shared meanings** |
| → | power / insecurity | friendship / rivalry / enmity |
| → | competition | **different** interests & behaviour |
| Question asked | *"What will happen if I do this?"* | *"Is what I do legitimate, given who I am?"* |

- **Take-away:** for realists anarchy **forces** competition; for constructivists the **same anarchy** can produce a security community (allies who'd never fight) *or* a rivalry — depending on the meanings states build. *(This is the direct answer to realism's structural claim.)*

## Norms — and how they change (the apartheid case)

***Core:*** a **norm** is a **shared expectation of appropriate behaviour** for an actor with a given identity (e.g. "states should not use certain weapons"; "respect sovereignty"; "governments should not openly defend racial supremacy"). Norms **shape legitimacy, identities, interests and behaviour** — and actors in turn **reproduce, contest and change** them.

- **How norms spread (PG): norm entrepreneurs** (individuals who travel, write, lobby elites); **social movements & NGOs** (e.g. the anti-apartheid movement building a global norm of racial equality); **IOs** (UN, NATO) diffusing standards of appropriate conduct.
- **★ South African apartheid (deck's worked case).** Racial hierarchy was once embedded in domestic *and* international order → **norm entrepreneurs/movements** challenged it → a **global norm of racial equality** strengthened → racially discriminatory rule became **hard to justify** → NGOs + IOs + states mobilised **boycotts, sanctions, diplomatic isolation. Constructivist claim:** *changing ideas about legitimate rule changed the political environment in which states calculated their interests* — power politics alone can't explain the fall of apartheid.
- **A "natural experiment" (PG):** Britain barely funded the Yugoslavia war-crimes tribunal — realists said "Britain sides with Serbia"; liberals said "free-riding." Then **Blair** replaced **Major (1997)** with *no change* in Britain's strategic interests — yet policy **flipped** (arrests, funding). → the change in **identity/leadership ideas** drove the outcome, supporting constructivism.

## Postmodernism *(PG §3.3.2)*

***Core:*** postmodernism denies a **single objective reality** and studies **texts and discourse** — how we *talk and write* about IR. It **deconstructs** realism's key move (the **unitary state actor**) and hunts for the **subtext** (hidden meanings, omissions).

- **States as "fictions":** postmodernists say states have no tangible reality — they're **stories** we tell to organise the actions of millions. Realists were **amazed** when the "unitary" **Soviet Union split into 15 pieces** — the label had masked divergent internal experiences.

- **Deconstruction & subtext:** to *deconstruct* a text is to tease apart its words to reveal what's **omitted or implicit.** Realism's subtext **omits** women/gender, classes, poor countries, non-military power — a "narrow, one-sided story" that (postmodernists say) serves **powerful actors.** *(Postmodernism set the stage for, and was largely absorbed into, constructivism.)*

> ★ **Exercise (deck) — build a constructivist explanation of Putin's war on Ukraine.** *Don't* ask whether Putin's claims are **true**; ask how Russia's leadership **constructs the meaning** of the situation, using the chain **IDENTITY → THREAT PERCEPTION → LEGITIMACY → BEHAVIOUR.** *Who is "Russia" in the narrative? Who are Ukraine / NATO / "the West"? What is presented as the threat? Which norms are invoked to make force look legitimate? How does this construction make invasion representable as **defence/protection** rather than aggression? → the point: identities and norms make some actions **thinkable and legitimate** and others not.*

- **Critics (PG):** realists say norms are just **covers for interests**; liberals say constructivists neglect **formal institutions**; both note it's hard to tell a **genuine** identity from one **adopted strategically** for material gain (aid, trade, membership).

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## B. Critical IR theory — adding power & hierarchy *(deck + PG §3.4)*

### ★ Critical theory at a glance — the scaffold *(same frame as constructivism above)*

> *Constructivism asks **how** meaning is made; critical theory adds **power** — who made the order look natural, and who's silenced? Use as the map.*

- ① **Core move:** realism & liberalism treat the world order as a **fixed stage** that states act on. Critical theory refuses that — it turns the spotlight **onto the order itself:** *who built it, whom it serves, and why it looks "natural."* The aim, in three steps: **expose domination → show the order is *made*, not inevitable (= "denaturalise") → open it to change.**
- **…so it shifts the focus** (from mainstream IR → to critical theory): from **anarchy** → to also **hierarchy** · from **power = military capability** → to **power over ideas & knowledge** · from "who acts?" → to "**who's silenced?**" · from "how does the order work?" → to "**whose order is it?**"
- ② **Strands:** Marx · Lenin · Gramsci · Wallerstein · postcolonialism/Said · feminism ×3 · peace studies *(see the menu table below)*.
- ③ **Mechanism: no single chain** — the common move is **denaturalise + ask who benefits.** Each strand supplies its own logic (class exploitation · hegemony/consent · core–periphery surplus flow · Orientalist representation · gendered hierarchy).
- ④ **Key concepts:** hegemony (Gramsci) · core/periphery (Wallerstein) · Orientalism (Said) · class/surplus (Marx/Lenin) · structural violence / positive peace.
- ⑤ **Why it's weak:** often **critique more than testable theory** — strong at diagnosing power, weaker at **prediction.**
- ⑥ **Critics:** mainstream IR — it's **normative / explanatory-thin** and hard to **operationalise or falsify.**

**The strand menu — each asks "whose order is this, and who's silenced?":**

| Strand | One-line claim |
|---|---|
| **Marx** | domestic **class struggle** — labour makes the surplus, capital captures it |
| **Lenin** | **imperialism** — colonial profits buy off the core's workers → war among empires |
| **Gramsci** | **hegemony** = rule by **consent**; dominant ideas pass as "common sense" |
| **Wallerstein** | **world-systems** — core / semi-periphery / periphery; surplus flows **inward** |
| **Said** | **Orientalism** — power through **representation** (Self/Other binaries) |
| **Feminism ×3** | **difference · liberal · postmodern** — gender structures the ideas & hierarchies of IR |
| **Peace studies** | **positive peace** removes **structural violence**, not just the absence of war |

***Core (deck):*** constructivism asks *how* realities are constructed; **critical approaches add the question of power** — *how are particular realities made to appear **natural**, and **who benefits**?* Critical theory refuses to take existing institutions, categories and power relations **for granted**: it aims to **expose domination → denaturalise the order → open possibilities for change.**

- **The major shifts (deck):** anarchy → also examine **hierarchy** · state interests → ask **how interests are produced** · power-as-capabilities → also **power over ideas & knowledge** · "who acts?" → **who is marginalised/silenced?** · "how does order work?" → "**whose order is it?**"

## Marxism & global capitalism *(PG §3.4)*

***Core:*** Marxist approaches see **both** IR and domestic politics as arising from **unequal relations between economic classes** — shifting the unit of analysis from **state ↔ state** to **class, capital, labour, production, the global economy.** Key question (deck): **who produces value, and who captures it?**

- **Class struggle:** more powerful classes **exploit** the less powerful by denying them their fair share of the **surplus** they create; ultimately this scales up to **richer vs poorer world regions** (North–South).
- **★ Marx vs Lenin (the exam distinction — LO 3.4):**
  - **Marx = a *domestic* theory of class struggle.** In industrialising Europe, labour creates the surplus; workers (the **proletariat**) should recapture it through struggle. Marx expected revolution in the **advanced** capitalist countries.
  - **Lenin = a theory of *imperialism* (the international extension).** European capitalists invest in **colonies** for big profits, then use part of those profits to "**buy off**" **the working class at home** (so no revolution there). Once the world was carved up, imperial expansion could only come at rivals' expense → **inter-imperialist war (WWI).** So revolution comes in the **poor/"backward"** periphery (Russia 1917, China 1949), not the rich core.
- **Peasants (not just proletariat):** contrary to Marx, the great 20th-c. revolutions were **peasant** rebellions (China the largest). **Trotsky** (spread revolution worldwide) lost to **Stalin** ("socialism in one country").

## The critical-theory strands the deck adds — Gramsci · Wallerstein · postcolonialism/Said

***Core:*** the deck bundles several **critical** approaches that extend the Marxist insight from *material* class to **ideas, structure and identity.**

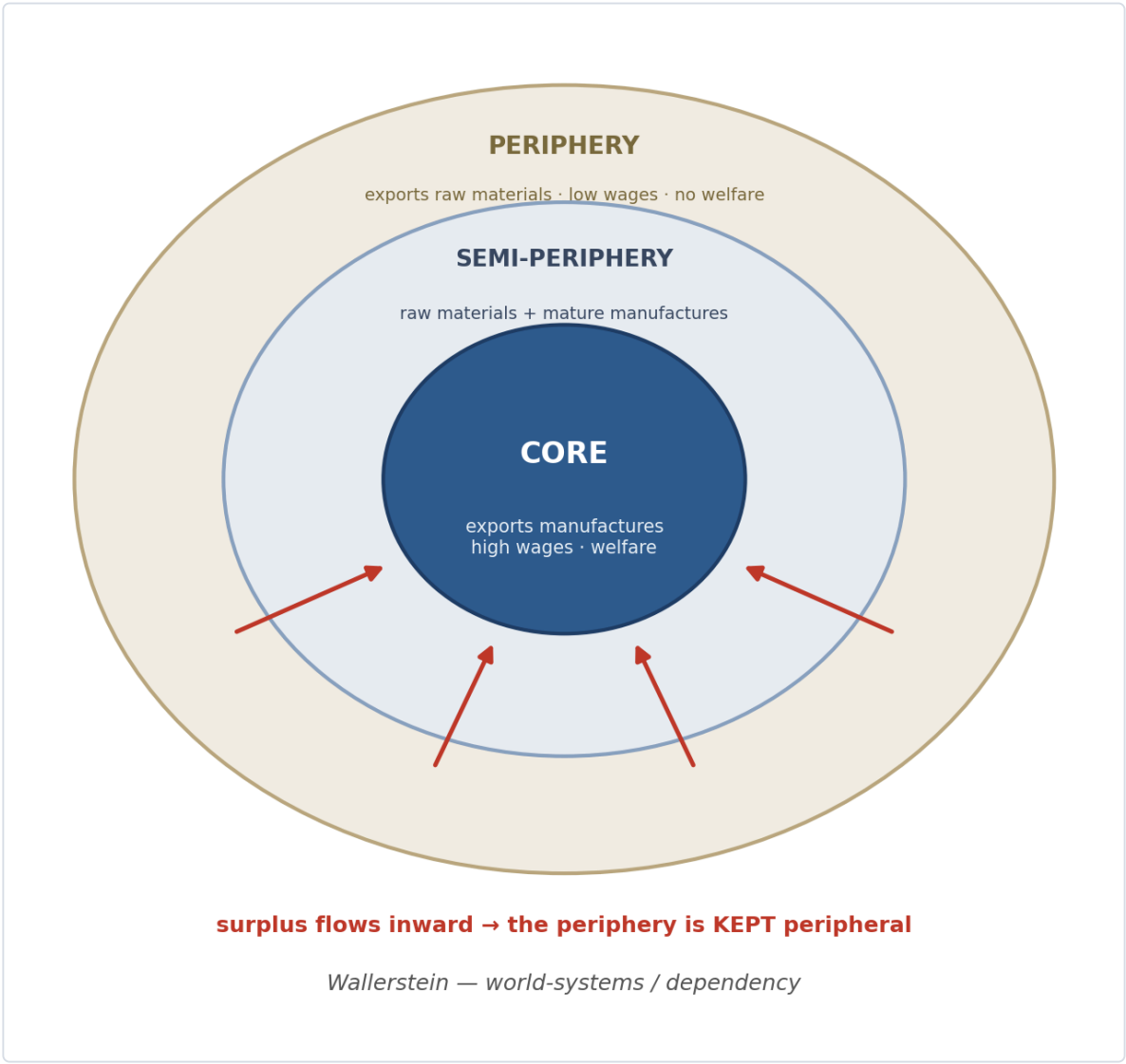
- **Gramsci — hegemony as *consent*, not just coercion. Hegemonic power** is bigger than force: it rests on **consent** — dominant ideas and institutions make a particular order look "**normal, legitimate, universal,**

**common sense**" ("this is simply how the world works"). **Critical question:** when the "rules of the game" go unchallenged, ask "**who got to write the rules?**"

- **Wallerstein — world-systems / dependency.** The global economy is a **single hierarchy** of three zones (the deck's diagram):

| Zone | Government | Production role | Wages / welfare |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Core** | democratic | imports raw materials, **exports manufactures**; high investment | high wages, welfare services |
| **Semi-periphery** | authoritarian | exports raw materials **& mature manufactures**; imports advanced manufactures | low wages, little welfare |
| **Periphery** | non-democratic | **exports raw materials**, imports manufactures | low wages, no welfare |

→ *dependency theory's claim: the periphery isn't "not yet developed" — it is **kept** poor by its structural position, which channels surplus to the core (cf. **Lenin**).*




**How to read it (Wallerstein).** The world economy is **one hierarchy**, not a ladder every country climbs. The **core** (rich democracies) exports high-value **manufactures**; the **periphery** exports **raw materials** at low wages;

the **semi-periphery** sits between. The red arrows are the key claim: **surplus flows inward**, so the periphery is not "behind" — it is **structurally kept** peripheral (the dependency/Lenin point).

- **Postcolonial theory — colonialism created *enduring* hierarchies (deck): material** (wealth, trade, borders, institutions), **knowledge** (whose history/concepts count?), and **social** (civilised/backward · developed/underdeveloped · modern/traditional · "**West / Rest**"). **Core question:** *how does the colonial past keep structuring the international present?*
- **Said — *Orientalism* & "othering."** Power works by **representation**: the West constructs "the Other" through recurring **binaries** — **Self** (modern, rational, civilised, orderly) vs **Other** (backward, irrational, uncivilised, chaotic). The mechanism: **represent difference → essentialise groups → produce hierarchy → make unequal treatment seem reasonable.** "*Representation constitutes the subjects we then act upon.*"

## Feminist & queer IR *(PG §3.6 + deck)*

***Core:* gender and sexuality aren't just traits of individuals — they structure the ideas, roles and hierarchies of IR.** Feminists ask what becomes **visible** once we stop treating *the state, war, security* as gender-neutral: **whose** security, **whose** labour, **whose** experiences, **whose** voices? All strands agree **gender matters**; they split on **how.**

| Strand | Core claim | On women in IR |
|---|---|---|
| **Difference feminism** | Realism reflects a **masculine** worldview (autonomy, separation, force = "manly"); women, on average, are **less warlike** / better at connection & peacemaking | Real change needs **many** women → would **transform** ("feminise") the system |
| **Liberal feminism** | Men and women are **equal**; "essential" differences are trivial/nonexistent | Include women in male preserves (leaders, soldiers) — they **play the game the same way**; exclusion just **wastes talent** |
| **Postmodern feminism** | Gender is **real but arbitrary & flexible** (not fixed); deconstruct the **subtext** of realist language | Reject both: don't glorify "feminine virtue" *or* just add women to war |

- **The masculinity of realism (difference feminism):** realism's **autonomy/sovereignty/anarchy** mirror a "masculine psyche" (separation over connection); the public(masculine)/private(feminine) split maps onto the international(anarchic)/domestic(ordered) split → *realism constructs IR as "a man's world."*
- **Evidence both ways:** the **overlapping bell curves** — genders differ *on average* but overlap hugely (liberal feminists stress the **overlap**: individual women perform like men; difference feminists stress the **shift**: women *as a group* differ, e.g. the ~10-point **gender gap** in support for military action). **Women state leaders** (Thatcher, Gandhi, Meir, Merkel…) were **not** more peaceful — supporting liberal feminism. **Postmodern feminists** deconstruct the sexual **subtext** of weapons talk ("It's a boy" for the H-bomb; "power/potency").

## Peace studies *(PG §3.5)*

***Core:* peace studies** shifts IR from the **systemic** level to **individual/domestic/transnational** social relations, and openly **rejects** "**objectivity**" (knowledge through **action/participation**). It reconceives both peace and war.

- **Conflict resolution — the mediation toolkit (LO 3.5): mediation** = a **third party** helps two sides settle short of violence (the **UN** is the biggest mediator). Forms: **good offices** (a neutral channel — e.g. Pakistan passing messages between the US & China, 1971); **arbitration** (both sides agree in advance to accept a third party's binding decision — e.g. the city of **Brčko** in the Dayton process); **confidence-building**

**measures** (gradually build trust); **linkage** (bundle issues so a concession on one trades for another — Yalta 1945).

- **Positive vs negative peace:** realism recognises only **negative peace** (the temporary **absence of war**); **positive peace** removes the **underlying causes** — including **structural violence** (poverty, hunger, oppression *built into* social structures, which kill more than direct violence).
- **Militarism** = the **glorification** of war (through films, toys, sport, speeches) and the **structuring of society around war** (the military-industrial complex). Less-militarised cultures (Costa Rica — **no army for 70 years**; post-war Japan) show realism's stress on force isn't **universal**.
- **Nonviolence:** a unilateral refusal of violent leverage — **Gandhi** (Indian independence), **MLK** (US civil rights), and **Gene Sharp**'s strategies (taught to **Arab Spring** activists). Practical as well as moral — often the **cost-effective** tool of the powerless.

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## ★ The four theories compared — "theory changes what we see" (deck capstone)

***Core:*** each theory is a different **pair of glasses** — it makes different things visible and asks a different core question.

| Theory | Core question | Interests are… | Key concepts |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Realism** | *Where is the **power**?* | **given** (survival, power) | anarchy, self-help, balance of power, security dilemma |
| **Liberalism** | *What enables **cooperation** / shapes preferences?* | **given** (peace, prosperity) | institutions, reciprocity, interdependence, democratic peace |
| **Constructivism** | *How did actors come to **understand** their interests this way?* | **socially constructed** | identity, norms, social facts, "anarchy is what states make of it" |
| **Critical theory** | *How did this order become **normal** — who benefits, who is marginalised?* | **produced by power/hierarchy** | hegemony, class, core/periphery, colonial & gendered hierarchies |

*The move across the row:* realism & liberalism take the world's **actors and interests as given** and ask how they behave; **constructivism** asks where those interests **come from** (meaning); **critical theory** asks whose **power** made that meaning look natural. *(This is the deck's — and the exam's — payoff: pick an event and show what each lens sees and misses.)*

### Cases & examples

- **British vs North Korean nukes.** The US fears NK's bomb, not Britain's far larger arsenal → **identity/alliance**, not capabilities, defines the threat. → *Illustrates: **constructivism** vs realism — the meaning of a material fact.*
- **South African apartheid.** Norm change (racial equality) → delegitimation → sanctions. → *Illustrates: **norms & norm entrepreneurs** reshaping states' interests.*

- **Blair's Bosnia U-turn (1997).** Same interests, new leadership/identity → opposite policy. → *Illustrates: a "natural experiment" favouring **constructivism** over realism/liberalism.*
- **US in Somalia (1992).** Intervention with no strategic payoff → the **logic of appropriateness** + widened norms of who deserves protection. → *Illustrates: **norms over cost-benefit.***
- **Lysistrata / women's peace movements.** From Aristophanes to WILPF to UNSC **Res. 1325** — the long "women as peacemakers" thread (and its limits: female leaders weren't more peaceful). → *Illustrates: the **difference-vs-liberal-feminist** debate.*

## Key terms

| Term | Meaning |
|---|---|
| Constructivism | Interests/identities are **socially constructed** through norms & interaction (identity principle) |
| Social fact vs material fact | Meaning collectively recognised (sovereignty, alliance) vs brute matter (a tank) |
| "Anarchy is what states make of it" | Wendt — anarchy has no fixed logic; friend/enemy is constructed |
| Norm / norm entrepreneur | Shared expectation of appropriate behaviour; actor who spreads it |
| Logic of appropriateness vs consequences | "How *should* I act?" vs "what will happen to me?" |
| Postmodernism / subtext | Denies single reality; studies discourse; hidden meanings/omissions |
| Marxism (Marx vs Lenin) | Domestic class struggle vs imperialism (buying off the core's workers) |
| Hegemony (Gramsci) | Rule by **consent** — dominant ideas made to seem common sense |
| World-systems (Wallerstein) | Core / semi-periphery / periphery hierarchy |
| Orientalism (Said) | Power through **representation** — Self/Other binaries → hierarchy |
| Difference / liberal / postmodern feminism | Women differ & would transform IR / women are equal, just include them / gender is real but arbitrary |
| Positive peace / structural violence | Removing the causes of war / violence built into social structures |
| Mediation / arbitration | Third party assists a settlement / third party's binding decision |

## Exam pointers

- Explain what **constructivism** adds to realism/liberalism: **interests are constructed** (social context → identity → interests → behaviour), with the **UK-vs-NK-nukes** puzzle.
- State and use "**anarchy is what states make of it**" — contrast the realist and constructivist chains.
- Show how **norms change** via norm entrepreneurs/NGOs/IOs — the **apartheid** case, and the **logic of appropriateness** (Somalia).
- **Distinguish Marx from Lenin** (domestic class struggle vs imperialism) — the LO 3.4 distinction.
- Lay out the **critical shift** (anarchy→hierarchy, "whose order?") and one strand in depth — **Gramsci**, **Wallerstein's core/periphery**, or **Said's Orientalism**.
- Compare the **three feminisms** and the **masculinity-of-realism** critique.

- Describe the **mediation toolkit** (good offices, arbitration, confidence-building, linkage) and **positive vs negative peace** (LO 3.5).
- **Run all four lenses** on one event using the **comparison table**.

**Bridge.** IR III completes the theory arc: **realism** (power) → **liberalism** (cooperation) → **constructivism** (meaning) → **critical theory** (power *behind* meaning). Realism and liberalism debate *how given actors behave*; constructivism and critical theory ask *where the actors, interests and "normal" order came from* — and who they serve.

## ★ Fun facts & memorable details (IR III: Constructivism & Critical Theory)

> Sticky bits from constructivism & critical IR.

- "**Anarchy is what states make of it**" — Alexander **Wendt's** 1992 line is the single most-quoted sentence in constructivism: the *same* anarchy can produce NATO or a knife-fight.
- **Britain's nukes don't scare Washington, North Korea's do** — even though Britain's arsenal is far bigger. Proof that in IR, **identity beats capability.**
- **Pirates went from the terrorists of their day to theme-park mascots** — the textbook's vivid reminder that "what counts as a threat" is **not timeless.** (Imagine your great-grandkids on a *terrorist*-themed ride.)
- **A natural experiment:** Tony **Blair** replacing John Major flipped Britain's Bosnia policy with **no change in national interest** — a rare "clean test" that favoured constructivism.
- **Marx vs Lenin in one line:** Marx expected revolution in the **rich** countries; **Lenin** explained why it came in the **poor** ones — the rich bought off their workers with **colonial** profits.
- **Gramsci's hegemony** = getting people to say "*this is just how the world works*" — power that never has to draw its sword.
- **Wallerstein's world-system:** you're not "**not yet** developed" — the periphery is **kept** peripheral so surplus flows to the **core.**
- **Said's *Orientalism*:** the West "knows" the East by inventing it — **representation** becomes a tool of domination.
- **Lysistrata (411 BC)** — Aristophanes had the women withhold sex to end the Peloponnesian War; it was **read aloud in 1,000 venues in 56 countries** in 2003 to protest the Iraq War.
- **"It's a boy":** the coded cable confirming the first **H-bomb** worked — postmodern feminists' favourite example of the **gendered subtext** of weapons.
- **Costa Rica has had no army since 1948** — a living rebuttal to realism's claim that military force is universal and necessary.

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# IR IV: International Security (AUW)

**Required reading: PG = Goldstein & Pevehouse, *International Relations*, ch. 5** (*International Conflict*) · **Bilgin, Pinar, "Security," in Berenskötter (ed.), *Concepts in International Relations* (2025), ch. 14.** · Lecturer: **Ayça Uygur Wessel.** Deck: "*International security.*"

**Theme of the lecture (deck).** Two moves. First, **unpack the concept of "security"** — it is *contested* and its real-world use is *political* (who gets to call something a "security" issue, and why). Then turn to **conflict and**

**war** — how and why international (and internationalised) conflicts occur, read through the **levels of analysis.**

> ★ **The heart of the lecture:** "security" is not a neutral fact about the world but a **contested, political concept.** Three questions are always in play — **whose security?** (the *referent*: state · society · individual · humanity), **which threats?** (military vs non-military), and **is the state the protector or the threat?** Calling something a "security issue" is itself a **political act** (**securitisation**) that moves it out of normal politics. The different **IR theories** each answer "what is security?" differently, and **war** has causes at three **levels** — the individual, the state/domestic, and the anarchic system.

**The red thread.** *Security for whom, from what, and provided by whom — and who decides?* Hold those questions through the concept (Bilgin), the theories, and the causes of war (PG ch.5).

### Key concepts / "modes" to use

- **Security = a contested concept** — thin agreement ("freedom from threats to core values"), deep disagreement on referent, threats, the state's role.
- **Referent object** ("whose security?") — **national/traditional** (state) · **societal** (community/identity) · **human** (individual) · **global** (humanity).
- **The state: protector (Hobbes) vs war-maker (Tilly)** — the four activities: war-making, state-making, protection, extraction ("protection racket").
- **Securitisation** (Wæver) — security as a **speech act**; framing an issue as an existential threat moves it beyond normal politics.
- **The security dilemma** (Herz) — self-help defence can be self-defeating.
- **IR theories & security** — realism (power under anarchy) · liberalism (cooperation/institutions) · constructivism (threats are constructed) · critical (security is political).
- **Causes of war — levels of analysis** (Waltz's *three images*): individual · domestic · systemic.
- **Types of war** (hegemonic/total/limited/civil/guerrilla) and **types of conflict** (ideas: ethnic/religious/ideological · interests: territorial/governmental/economic).

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## A. Unpacking "security" *(Bilgin ch.14 + deck)*

### ★ Security is a contested — and political — concept

***Core:*** there is **thin agreement** (security = *freedom from threats to core values*, for individuals and groups) but **deep disagreement** on almost everything else. And crucially, **defining something *as* a security issue is a *political* act.**

- **What's contested (deck):** the **focus of inquiry** (whose security — individual, national, international, global?); the **types of threat** (military vs non-military); the **role of the state** (security *provider*, or a *threat* to security?).
- ★ **The Kilis example (Bilgin's opener).** In 2016, rockets from IS-held northern Syria hit **Kilis, Türkiye**, killing 20+ over five months — yet the government did **not** officially call it a security threat (it portrayed the rockets as merely "falling from the sky"). This changed only in August 2016, when the government prepared a **ground incursion** into Syria and *then* declared the rockets **acts of terrorism threatening national security**. Why the change? **Politics** — initially it didn't want to be seen fighting a group with

"Islamic" in its name; once ready to act, it named the enemy "DAESH." → *Politics is key to how — and whether — governments use the concept of security.*

- **Etymology:** "security" ← Latin ***securus*** ("without worry/concern"). Ironically, early usage saw feeling *too* secure as **bad** (breeds carelessness). **Hobbes** gave it its modern political shape (a strong authority as the condition for security).

## Whose security? — the referent object

***Core:*** the biggest disagreement is over the **referent object** — *who or what is to be secured?* The answer is **not fixed**; it changes with which threats which actors prioritise, and **the same event looks different depending on whose security you centre.**

| Referent | "Security" asks… | Threat = |
|---|---|---|
| **National / traditional** (the **STATE**) | Is the state safe from **external** threats? | invasion, rival great powers |
| **Societal** (the **COMMUNITY**) | Can the group keep its **identity & way of life**? | migration, cultural erosion |
| **Human** (the **INDIVIDUAL**) | Are people safe in their **survival, well-being & rights**? | poverty, disease, their *own* government |
| **Global** (**HUMANITY**) | Are threats addressed at the level of **humanity/the planet**? | climate change, pandemics, nuclear war |

- **Worked example (deck): global warming** looks like an economic issue to one actor, an existential threat to a low-lying island state, a human-security issue to the displaced. *Whose security you centre changes what you see.*

## Types of threat — military vs non-military (and how they overlap)

***Core:*** the traditional focus is **military** threats (invasion/territorial aggression, conventional war, nuclear escalation, interstate & civil conflict, coercion/shows of force, armed rebel groups) — but real-world threats are increasingly **non-military** (health, climate, migration), and the categories **overlap.**

- **South China Sea (deck's overlap case).** A **territorial** dispute (sovereignty, Spratly Islands, Exclusive Economic Zones) is *also* **economic** (oil, gas, fisheries), **strategic** (sea lanes — **~⅓ of global shipping** passes through), and **military** (bases, radar, missile shelters — e.g. China's runways on **Fiery Cross Reef**; "show-of-force" behaviour to assert dominance **without declaring war**). → *Analytical distinctions (military/economic/strategic) are tightly knotted in the real world.*

## The state — security *provider* or *war-maker*?

***Core:*** two opposed readings of the state's relation to security.

- **Provider (Hobbesian tradition):** the individual **gives up freedom** to be more secure, handing the **monopoly of violence** to the state, which embodies **national sovereignty.** A "security threat" = something posing an **existential threat to the state** (handled by defence, intelligence, law enforcement). *(This is the classic-realist starting point.)*
- **War-maker (Charles Tilly, 1985/1992):** states **earned their statehood through war-making** — "*war made the state and the state made war*" (cf. PET/PS on Tilly); war is the state's *modus operandi*; "**no war = no**

**modern state.**" Tilly's **four activities** (he likens the early state to a **protection racket** — the deck's "Don Corleone" joke):

| Activity | = eliminating / neutralising… |
|---|---|
| **War-making** | rivals **outside** the territory |
| **State-making** | rivals **inside** the territory |
| **Protection** | the enemies of its **clients** |
| **Extraction** | acquiring the **means** (tax, men) to do the first three |

## The concept's real-world history — from national → international → human security *(Bilgin)*

*Core:* the meaning of security was **never fixed**; different uses served different **political agendas**, and the "myth of origin" (US national security) is only one strand.

- **The "myth of origin" — US national security (post-1945).** "National security" rose to prominence in US debates over the post-war role of the US (rivalry with the USSR). Policymakers found it **flexible and catchy** — useful against isolationist/small-government opponents, to keep the US globally engaged and investing in the military. **Arnold Wolfers (1952):** national security as a form of **national interest.** Embedded institutionally via the **National Security Council** and **NSC-68 (1950)** → Truman's massive military build-up (peacetime military spending, newly justified by "national security"). *Contrary to realist assumptions,* US national security was **never only** about external military threats — "**making the world safe for US economic interests**" was central (the World Bank, IMF, GATT as "part and parcel of the security project") → a **creative repackaging** of economic interest as national security.
- **National vs international vs collective security.** The **referent** distinguishes them: US "national security" → the **state** is referent (threat = the USSR); UN "international security" → the **society of states** is referent (threat = another world war). **Collective security** = aggression against one is aggression against all (global in scope; regulates relations *between* members) — *not* the same as an **alliance** like NATO (which defends *against* external threats). The League of Nations' collective security was paralysed by the **unanimity** rule; the UN fixed it with **majority** voting — but protected great powers with the **P5 veto** (so the US never has to act against its will — but any P5 can also block it). First real test: **North Korea's 1950 invasion** (the USSR was boycotting the Council, so it couldn't veto). → the "**Uniting for Peace**" mechanism lets the General Assembly recommend when the Council is deadlocked.
- **Human security — the alternative from *outside* the US.** Newly independent states, wary of superpower pacts (Nehru: "*every pact has brought insecurity*"), sought a "**third way**" focused on **sovereignty and development**, *not* a security frame (**Bandung Conference 1955**; Non-Aligned Movement; **New International Economic Order**). *(Box: **Iran 1953** — PM **Mosaddegh**, who nationalised the oil industry, was toppled by a **CIA-MI6** coup: the UK/US defended their **economic interests in the name of international security** against Iran's search for development.)* When the NIEO stalled, **non-state actors** took up the cause and made **human beings the referent** → "**human security,**" coined by **Mahbub ul Haq** ("secure human development"), embraced by the **UNDP in 1994.** Landmark: the **International Campaign to Ban Landmines (ICBL)** framed landmines as a human-security harm → the **1997 Mine Ban Treaty** + a Nobel Peace Prize (the **agency of non-state actors**).
- **The military-state frame returns (21st c.):** after **9/11**, NATO's collective-defence clause + the UN's collective-security mechanism let US national security be framed as *international* security → the **Global War on Terror.** Its flexibility let many governments re-label domestic opponents as "terrorists" (e.g. China and

**Xinjiang**). And the **privatisation of security** — **Private Military Companies** like the **Wagner Group** (Russia in Ukraine) — sell security as a marketable good ("we sell a *concept* of security").

## B. IR theories & security *(deck)*

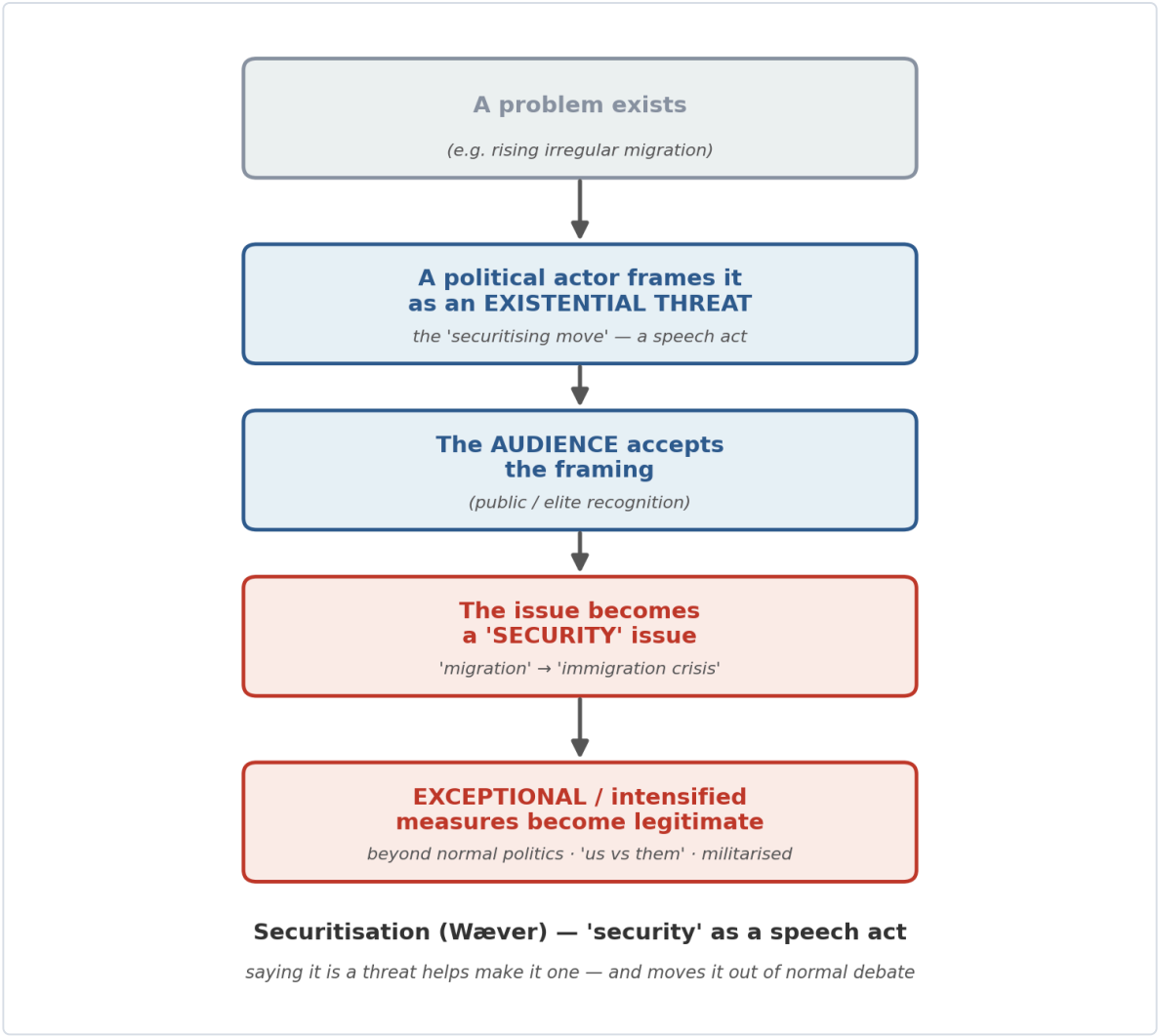
***Core:*** each theory family answers "*what is security, and how do states pursue it?*" differently — and in a crisis, each **looks for different things.**

| Theory | Security is… | The chain | In a crisis, it asks… |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Realism** | surviving under **anarchy** | anarchy → self-help → power/capabilities → **security competition** | military capabilities, alliances, relative power, strategic incentives |
| **Liberalism** | achieved through **cooperation** | self-interest → interdependence → **institutions** (info, monitoring, reciprocity) → cooperation | what **blocked** the mutual gains from cooperation? (+ domestic politics → preferences) |
| **Constructivism** | **what states make of it** | material capabilities → *(interaction + shared meanings)* → identity → threat perception → behaviour | **how did actors come to understand something as a threat?** |
| **Critical IR** | **political** | power shapes which threats/referents count | **whose** security? **who** defines the threat, and with what power? who is **protected vs marginalised**? |

- *(Deck exercise: how would each theory explain **the USA's threats against Greenland**? Realism → strategic/Arctic position & relative power; liberalism → institutional/allied damage; constructivism → identity & how "threat" is framed; critical → whose security, whose Arctic, what hierarchy.)*

### ★ Securitisation — security as a "speech act" (Wæver / Copenhagen School)

***Core:*** critics argue security **does not exist outside discourse** — an issue becomes a "security" issue only because an actor **frames** it as one. **Ole Wæver** calls this **securitisation**: *saying* something is an existential threat is also *doing* something. It is **not politically innocent** — it **removes the issue from normal political deliberation** ("beyond closed doors where experts decide"), lets governments claim **more resources** and **silence critics** in the name of unity against an "existential threat," creates an "**us vs them**" mindset, and often **militarises** the problem.




**How to read it.** The move that matters is **step 2 → 3**: a **securitising actor** *claims* existential threat, and the **audience** must **accept** it. Only then does the issue "become" security — and the payoff (step 5) is **exceptional powers** outside normal debate. Example (deck): "*increased irregular migration*" (a policy problem) vs "*immigration crisis*" (a securitised threat). **Climate change** is the live debate: securitising it could mobilise resources — but critics warn it creates a false "us vs them" (there is no "them" — *we* are the problem) and risks **militarising** a non-military issue.

## Critical Security Studies — the academic critique of realism *(Bilgin)*

***Core:*** IR's understanding of security was long dominated by a **realist** outlook (military threats *to states* from *outside*, met by military means; the state is both **referent** and **agent**). Critics — drawing on **Feminism, Frankfurt-School critical theory, post-structuralism, postcolonialism** — showed security is **socially constructed** and **political**, and re-opened *whose* security counts.

- **Wolfers' warning (1952):** national security is an "**ambiguous symbol**" — used without specification it "leaves room for more confusion than sound political counsel can afford." He split **objective** security (absence of threats to acquired values) from **subjective** (absence of *fear*) — both require judgement.
- **Common security** (Palme Commission, 1982): since there's **nowhere to hide from nuclear catastrophe**, the referent should be "**us all**" — pursue security *with* others, not against them. Rests on the **security dilemma** (Herz 1950): self-serving defence can be **self-defeating** (your build-up scares the other side → arms race → everyone less safe).

- **Gusterson:** realist security scholars not only **failed to predict the fall of the Berlin Wall (1989)** but "were unable to even entertain the possibility" — a blow to realism's authority (too much focus on military capabilities, too little on socio-political context).
- **Eurocentrism** (Barkawi & Laffey): security studied in Euro/Anglo-centric ways — **normative** (privileging EU/Western security — e.g. studying the 2015–16 Mediterranean "refugee crisis" only from Europe's side), **analytical** (Europe at the centre of the framework), **epistemological** (drawing only on the "European experience" as knowledge).
- **Feminist IR — Carol Cohn:** nuclear experts coded attention to the human costs of weapons as "**feminine**" and military might as "**strength**"; "**nuke-speak**" is abstract, gendered language that lets experts discuss weapons **without** confronting their human consequences. Realist security assessments are **not objective** but shaped by ideas of masculinity/femininity (cf. IR III).
- **Ontological security** (Mitzen, Rumelili): people/groups need a **stable identity**; a protracted conflict that threatens your *body* can **stabilise your identity** → actors whose identity is tied to fighting may **block peace** to preserve their "ontological security."
- **Relational approaches** (Bilgin): a state's "failure" to provide security is often a product of **international relations** (esp. the **colonial** legacy and the differential recognition of European vs African sovereignty), not just internal traits — so study security **relationally.**

*(Bilgin's concept web: **security** sits between its **contrast** — violence, war, insecurity, instability; its **cognate** — peace, stability; and its **supporting** concepts — threats, power, deterrence, development, and the physical/material/identity dimensions.)*

## C. Causes of war *(PG ch.5 + deck)*

### Types of war

*Core:* "war" (usually defined as ≥1,000 battle deaths) covers very different things:

| Type | What it is |
|---|---|
| **Hegemonic war** | for control of the **entire world order** (a.k.a. world/global/systemic war) — last one was **WWII**; now probably impossible without destroying civilisation |
| **Total war** | to **conquer & occupy** another state (reach the capital, replace the government) — born with the **Napoleonic Wars**; the whole enemy society becomes a legitimate target |
| **Limited war** | objectives **short of** surrender/occupation (e.g. 1991 Gulf War retook Kuwait, didn't take Baghdad); **raids** = single-action limited wars |
| **Civil war** | factions **within a state** fighting to create/prevent a government or **secede** — often the most brutal |
| **Guerrilla war** | warfare **without front lines**; irregular forces hidden among civilians — harass rather than confront; civilians suffer most |

### ★ Why does war break out? — the levels of analysis (Waltz's *three images*)

*Core:* most wars have **multiple causes at different levels.** The deck uses **Waltz's *Man, the State, and War* (1959)** "three images" — the **individual**, the **state/domestic**, and the **international system** — with **anarchy** as the *necessary* condition.

| Level | The explanation | Key names |
|---|---|---|
| **Individual** | **human nature** (power-seeking) *and* **rational cost-benefit** calculation — war can be a *reasoned* choice (leaders may not bear its full cost); "**bad decision ≠ irrational decision**"; also **deviations from rationality** (bias, groupthink) | Thucydides, Machiavelli, Hobbes; **Fearon** (rationalist explanations) |
| **Domestic** | **regime type** & decision-making structures; powerful domestic actors, norms & **ideologies** (nationalism, religion); support for **irredentism/secession**; leaders playing to two audiences at once | **Putnam** (*two-level games*); democratic peace |
| **Systemic** | not human nature but the **anarchic system** that breeds fear & suspicion: "*wars occur because there is nothing to stop them from occurring*"; power-transition; deterrence vs arms races; long cycles | **Waltz** (1959); power-transition theory |

- **Descriptive vs theoretical (PG):** a historian says "*the assassination of Franz Ferdinand caused WWI*"; a political scientist says the assassination was only the **catalyst** — the cause was **shifts in the balance of power.** The levels-of-analysis frame reminds us both (and more) operate at once.

## What states fight *about* — conflicts of ideas & of interest *(PG §5.2–5.3)*

***Core:*** PG sorts conflicts into six overlapping types — three over **ideas** (intangible: *who someone is*) and three over **interests** (tangible: *what someone has*).

- **Conflicts of IDEAS:**
  - **Nationalism** — devotion to one's nation over others; the link between **identity** and statehood. **Self-determination** (a nation should have its own state) constantly collides with **sovereignty/territorial integrity**.
  - **Ethnic conflict** — hatred between **ethnic groups**; based not on what someone *does* but **who they are.** Driven by **ethnocentrism** (in-group bias) and, at its worst, **dehumanisation** of the out-group (the step that removes the restraints on violence — e.g. animal names, WWII propaganda).
  - **Genocide** — the systematic extermination of a group; the extreme of dehumanisation.
  - **Religious conflict** — sharpest where **fundamentalist** movements reject **secular** rules (of the state and the international system) as subordinate to divine law.
  - **Ideological conflict** — often **less durable** than it looks (interests frequently drive the "ideological" clash).
- **Conflicts of INTEREST:**
  - **Territorial disputes** — over where **borders** run; especially intractable (states value home territory "fanatically"). **Irredentism** = regaining lost territory; **secession** = drawing a border around a *new* state (Kosovo 2008; South Sudan 2011).
  - **Control of governments** — over who runs an existing state.
  - **Economic conflict** — over trade, resources, money (often underlies the others — e.g. "conflict diamonds," the **Kimberley Process**).
  - *(PG's **Russia–Ukraine** example shows all of these at once: ethnic, religious, territorial (Crimea), and economic — combining rather than separate.)*

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# ★ Synthesis — the two halves in one line

***Core:*** the lecture's arc: **security is a political construction** (whose? from what? decided by whom — and *securitised* by whom), and **war has layered causes** (individual · domestic · systemic). The theories connect the halves: how you define **security** shapes what you count as a **cause of war** — a realist sees anarchy & power; a liberal sees failed cooperation; a constructivist sees threat-perceptions built through identity; a critical scholar asks whose security the whole conversation serves.

## Cases & examples

- **Kilis, Türkiye (2016)** — a lethal cross-border military attack **not** called a "security" issue until it was politically useful. → *Illustrates: **securitisation** is political; naming a threat is a choice.*
- **South China Sea** — territorial + economic + strategic + military threats knotted together. → *Illustrates: **threats overlap**; the referent/threat you pick shapes the analysis.*
- **Iran 1953 (Mosaddegh)** — a coup to defend Western oil interests **framed as international security.** → *Illustrates: security as a **creative repackaging** of economic interest; the case for **human security**.*
- **ICBL / landmines** — non-state actors reframed landmines as a **human-security** harm → treaty + Nobel. → *Illustrates: the **agency of non-state actors** and the shift of referent from state to individual.*
- **The fall of the Berlin Wall (1989)** — realist security scholars couldn't even imagine it. → *Illustrates: the **limits of a purely military, state-centric** security lens (Gusterson).*

## Key terms

| Term | Meaning |
|---|---|
| Security (contested) | "Freedom from threats to core values" — but referent, threats & the state's role are all disputed |
| Referent object | *Whose* security: national/state · societal · human/individual · global |
| Securitisation (Wæver) | Framing an issue as an existential threat (a **speech act**) → moves it beyond normal politics |
| Security dilemma (Herz) | Self-help defence can be self-defeating (your build-up frightens others → arms race) |
| Human / common security | Referent = the individual / "us all" (vs the state) |
| Collective security vs alliance | Aggression against one = aggression against all (global) vs defence against an external enemy (NATO) |
| Tilly's four activities | War-making · state-making · protection · extraction ("the state as protection racket") |
| Levels of analysis / three images | Individual · domestic · systemic causes of war (Waltz 1959) |
| Irredentism / secession | Regaining lost territory / drawing a border around a new state |
| Ethnocentrism / dehumanisation | In-group bias / stripping the out-group of humanity (removes restraints on violence) |

### Exam pointers

- Explain why **security is "contested"** and **political** — use **Kilis** to show that *calling* something security is a choice.
- Lay out the **referent-object table** (national/societal/human/global) and show the **same event** looks different by referent.
- Define **securitisation** as a **speech act** and run the 5-step chain; give the **migration** or **climate** example and the *dangers* (beyond normal politics, "us vs them", militarisation).
- Contrast the **state as protector (Hobbes) vs war-maker (Tilly)** — reproduce Tilly's four activities.
- Run the **four IR theories on security** (realism/liberalism/constructivism/critical) on one crisis.
- Use the **levels of analysis / three images** to explain the outbreak of a war (individual **Fearon** · domestic **Putnam** · systemic **Waltz/anarchy**), and the **descriptive-vs-theoretical** (Franz Ferdinand = catalyst, not cause).
- Distinguish the **types of war** and the **six conflict types** (ideas vs interests) — with **Russia–Ukraine** as the "all at once" case.

**Bridge.** IR IV pulls the theory lectures (I–III) onto a single problem — **security & war** — and shows the payoff of theory choice: your theory decides *whose* security matters, *what* counts as a threat, and *why* war happens. It also links back to **Tilly** (the war-made state, PS Lecture 2) and forward to the **use of force** (PG ch.6).

## ★ Fun facts & memorable details (IR IV: International Security)

> Sticky bits from international security.

- **"Security" once meant *carelessness*** — from Latin *securus* ("without worry"), and feeling **too** secure was considered a **flaw** (it made you drop your guard).
- **The rockets that "fell from the sky":** Türkiye refused to call a 5-month rocket barrage on **Kilis** a security threat — until it wanted to invade Syria. Same rockets, opposite label. Politics decides.
- **Tilly's one-liner:** "*war made the state, and the state made war*" — and his image of the early state as a **protection racket** (the deck jokes: not so different from **Don Corleone**).
- **The P5 veto exists because the US wanted one** — so the UN could never force it into an action it hadn't approved (the catch: any P5 can also block the US).
- **Collective security's first run was an accident:** the UN could act on **Korea (1950)** only because the **USSR was boycotting** the Security Council and wasn't there to veto.
- **"It's a boy"** and **"nuke-speak"** — Carol Cohn's evidence that even nuclear strategy is written in a **gendered** language that hides the human cost.
- **Realists didn't just miss the Berlin Wall — they couldn't imagine it** (Gusterson), which cracked realism's claim to "objective" security knowledge.
- **Climate change is "hard to securitise"** on purpose: there's **no "them"** — *we* are the threat, so the "us vs them" security reflex backfires.

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# Foreign Policymaking (EA)

**Required reading: Ashbee, E. & Hurst, S. (2020),** *"The Trump foreign policy record and the concept of transformational change,"* **Global Affairs 6(1): 5–19 · Putnam, R. (1988),** *"Diplomacy and Domestic Politics: The Logic of Two-Level Games,"* **International Organization 42(3): 427–460 (to p.435).** · Lecturer: **Eddie Ashbee.** *(Putnam is CBS-library-only, not in the folder — the two-level-game section below is built from the deck + the standard framework; the win-set detail is the assigned part.)*

**Theme of the lecture.** The IR theory lectures (I–IV) work mostly at the **international / state level** and treat what goes on *inside* a state as a "**black box.**" This session **opens the box:** foreign policy is shaped by **domestic** as well as international variables, and the two **interact** — theorised through **neoclassical realism**, **Foreign Policy Analysis (FPA)**, and Putnam's "**two-level game.**" The running case study is **US foreign policy since January 2017** — Trump and "Trumpism."

> ★ **The heart of the lecture:** foreign policy is **not** just a state responding to the international system — it is the **product of domestic politics interacting with international pressures.** IR's grand theories black-box the domestic; **FPA / neoclassical realism** open it, showing how **individuals, ideas, bureaucracies, interest groups and public opinion** shape policy. Putnam's **two-level game** models the interaction: a leader bargains **internationally (Level I)** and must get the deal **ratified at home (Level II)** at the same time. The **Trump** case tests whether a foreign-policy shift is "**transformational**" — a lasting change in **paradigm, interests, institutions and logics**.

**The red thread.** For any foreign-policy episode ask: *which domestic variables are in play, how do they interact with the international situation — and is the change **transformational** or just a passing shift?*

### Key concepts / "modes" to use

- **The "black box"** — why grand IR theory sidelines domestic politics.
- **Foreign Policy Analysis (FPA) / neoclassical realism** — systemic pressures **filtered through** domestic intervening variables.
- **Domestic variables** — individuals · ideas/ideologies · bureaucratic cultures · interest groups & constituencies · public opinion (+ **salience**).
- **Transformational change** (Ashbee & Hurst) — a lasting shift in **paradigm · interests · institutions · logics**.
- **Embeddedness** — ideas rooted in supportive **interests + institutions** (weak embeddedness → only "proto-transformational").
- **Two-level game** (Putnam) — Level I (international bargaining) + Level II (domestic ratification); **win-sets**; the **Schelling conjecture**.

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## Opening the "black box" — why Foreign Policy Analysis? *(deck)*

***Core:*** the main IR theories are **international- or state-level** — they largely **relegate or disregard** domestic processes, treating the state as a "**black box**" that responds to the system.

- **Structural realism (Waltz):** international relations are **anarchic**, trust is limited, so **any** state (autocracy *or* democracy) must **prioritise its own security & survival** and will act **if it has the capacities.** *(Domestic type*

*barely matters.)*

- **Liberal internationalism (Ikenberry):** looks a little more inside — it cares about the **character of political *systems*** (democracies tend to avoid offensive wars — answerable to the public, tied by trade **interdependence**, cooperating through **IOs**; the tongue-in-cheek "**Golden Arches** theory" — no two countries with McDonald's fight). But it still doesn't examine **internal processes** closely.
- **Foreign Policy Analysis (FPA) & neoclassical realism** open the box: foreign policy = the **interaction of international structure *and* domestic processes** — not one or the other.

### Neoclassical realism — the bridge

***Core:*** **neoclassical realism** keeps realism's **systemic** starting point (relative power, anarchy) but says those pressures are **filtered through domestic "intervening variables"** — leaders' perceptions, state–society relations, institutions — before they become policy. *(This is the neoclassical row of the realism family: "structure pushes, but domestic politics filters the push.")* → so **the same international pressure produces different policies** in different states, depending on the domestic filter. This is the theoretical warrant for spending the rest of the lecture on **domestic variables.**

## ★ Domestic variables that shape foreign policy *(deck)*

***Core:*** five families of domestic variable — each a lens, none sufficient alone.

| Variable | What it captures | Watch-outs / examples |
|---|---|---|
| **Individuals / core actors** | the "**great man theory of history**" (Carlyle: "*the history of the world is but the biography of great men*") — leaders' beliefs, style, psychology | **Trump** (impulse control, short attention span). *But* focusing on individuals **neglects structural forces** (see below) |
| **Ideas & ideologies** ("belief systems") | the **paradigm** guiding policy — what problems/goals/instruments seem legitimate | Was Trump-I "standard Republican fare" (**Reagan's "peace through strength"**) or a genuine break? *(the debate the reading settles)* |
| **Bureaucratic cultures & sub-cultures** | agencies' standing operating cultures; **coalitions & factions** inside the executive | State Dept vs Defense vs intelligence — "trade hawks" vs finance factions under Trump |
| **Interest groups & constituencies** | **lobbying, campaigning, campaign contributions, the "revolving door"** — and geographic **constituencies** (e.g. rust-belt states) | note **instrumental power** (direct lobbying) vs **structural power** (business's leverage over investment/jobs) |
| **Public opinion** | mass attitudes constraining leaders (e.g. **Vietnam** disengagement blamed on unpopularity) | ★ **salience:** except in **acute crisis or heavy losses**, public engagement with foreign policy is usually **LOW** (Durant & Diehl 1989) |

- **The structural counterweight (deck):** an individual-only focus **underestimates context.** Trump's mercurial style was *enabled* by the **relative weakness of checks & balances** in the foreign-policy arena — plus deeper trends: **party polarisation, party homogenisation**, and a **populist shift.** *(Cf. **Truman (1945–53)** leading the US into international engagement — a mix of **individual** commitment + shifts in **economic elites** + **strategic** pressure from the USSR: several variables at once.)*

# ★ Case study — US foreign policy since 2017 *(Ashbee & Hurst 2020)*

## The paradigm Trump inherited

***Core:*** to judge whether Trump is a *break*, you must know what he broke *from*. US foreign policy ran on **Liberal Internationalism (LI)** — itself the product of the **1940s transformation** — which then fragmented.

- **Liberal Internationalism (LI)** — after WWII the US committed to **open-ended international engagement + global leadership**, building the **UN, IMF, World Bank, GATT, NATO** and a domestic **national-security state** (National Security Act 1947 → DoD, Joint Chiefs, NSC, CIA). *(This is the reading's model of a completed **transformation** — see below.)*
- **Fragmentation from the 1970s:** LI split. Some (mainly **Democrats**) rejected the **use of force**; another grouping (mainly **Republicans**) rejected LI's **cooperative** side → **militant / conservative internationalism** = **primacism** (US primacy, "hard" power used **unilaterally** or in **coalitions of the willing**, sidelining the UN/multilateralism) **but** keeping a **moral purpose** — faith in **democracy & freedom** (Bush's Iraq war, democracy promotion, nation-building, regime change) and trade liberalisation. This paradigm **weakened from ~2006.**
- **2016 — MAGA:** a populist reaction to "**elite projects**" and perceived **US decline**, addressing both domestic and foreign policy.

## Trump's first term (2017–21) — the populist-nationalist break

***Core:*** Trump = **primacism + economic nationalism + "principled realism"** — i.e. conservative internationalism **minus the moral purpose.** The reading distils a **populist-nationalist paradigm** of **five propositions:**

1. **The nation is core** — defined by **ethnicity/culture**, not ideals/principles (Bannon: "a nation with a culture — and a reason for being").
2. **Zero-sum competition** — nations are locked in a **struggle for hegemony**; limited scope for cooperation (the 2017 National Security Strategy used "competition" **18 times**); the US has been "losing."
3. **Anti-"globalism"** — the nation & its people have suffered from **globalism** and global elites ("the party of Davos").
4. **Trade subordinated to the nation** — markets should serve national purposes; hostility to **NAFTA/TPP**; prefer **bilateral ("one-on-one") deals** where US preponderance wins; reject **multilateral** trade liberalisation.
5. **Moral vision abandoned** — no more Reagan's "shining city" or Bush's freedom agenda; **rejects regime change / democracy promotion** ("we are not here to lecture").

- **In practice:** challenging **China**; **transactionalism**; negotiations with **Russia & North Korea**; **unilateralism**; **burden-sharing** demands on allies; doubts about **collective security (NATO)**; **protectionism.**

## ★ Was it *transformational*? — the Ashbee & Hurst framework

***Core:*** the paper's real contribution is a **precise definition of transformational change** (drawing on **Polanyi**, historical institutionalism, Skowronek). Transformational change = a **lasting** shift across **four** linked elements — not just dramatic-but-passing change.

| Element | What must shift | LI (1940s) — the model | Trump (2017+) — the "first cut" |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Paradigm** | the framework of ideas/goals/instruments (Hall) — until new ideas become **"common sense"** | open-ended engagement & liberal world order | populist-nationalist paradigm (anti-globalism, bilateralism, no moral purpose) — **but only "common sense" to the base** |
| **Interests** | new interests grip power; **new coalitions** (Skowronek) | New-Deal coalition + "Wall Street" Republicans sideline isolationists | FP "establishment" & peak business **sidelined**; GOP base shifts to **non-college white workers** |
| **Institutions** | formal & informal institutional **re-ordering** | UN/IMF/NATO + the national-security state | withdrawals (**Paris, TPP, UNESCO, UN HR Council**), undermining the **WTO**, gutting the **State Dept**/IC — *but* core alliances **remain intact** |
| **Logics** | new **chains of events**/incentives that endure (path dependence) | enduring collective-security commitments | weakened trans-Atlanticism; allies edge toward **self-reliance**; TPP revived **without** the US |

- ★ **The verdict:** applying the framework gives a **mixed picture** — the **beginnings of transformational change, but "incipient, partial and variegated."** The **ideational** shift is the most dramatic; institutional/interest shifts are real but **incomplete**; logics are hardest to read this early.

## ★ Embeddedness — why "proto-transformational"

***Core:*** ideas only become a *lasting* transformation when they are **embedded** — i.e. **rooted in supportive *interests* and *institutions*** (so they outlive the leader). Trump's first-term primacism was **pursued inconsistently** and **weakly embedded** (he **marginalised** the national-security bureaucracy but did **not rebuild** it into a self-sustaining machine for the new paradigm) → only "**proto-transformational.**"

- **Two reasons it may not stick (reading):** (1) **populism is a "thin" ideology** (Mudde) — a **crust** on top of other ideologies, so the administration could be pulled **back** toward conservative/militant internationalism; (2) the US remains **locked into** its key post-war security institutions.

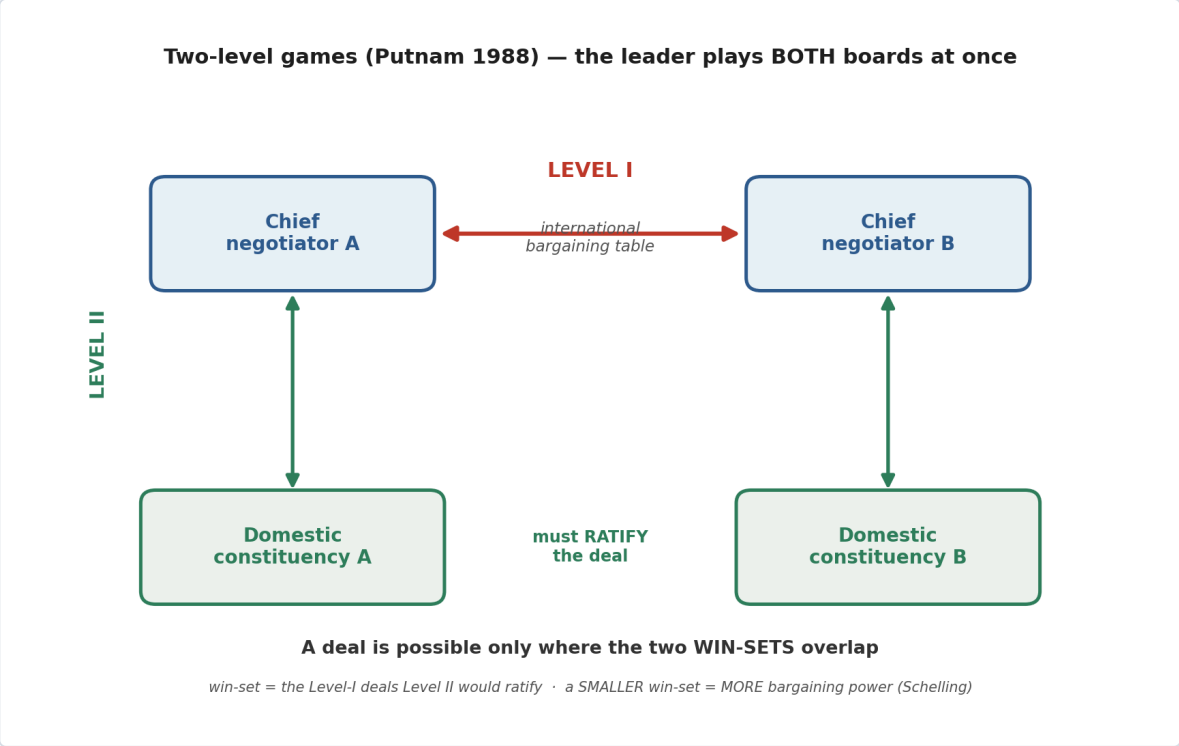
## Second term (2025+) & the Democrats *(deck)*

- **Trump II / the GOP: no single guiding ideology** — pulled between rival **ideational clusters.** But some **constants ("floating ideas")** cut across the divisions: **support for Israel** (note the role of **religious conservatism** in the party), **disdain for Europe** + support for "patriotic" forces; **2026** sees growing divisions (e.g. **Iran**).
- **Democrats: no clear foreign-policy orientation**; Biden's "**alliance of democracies**" gained limited traction; continued **opposition to China** + **support for Ukraine**; increasingly **divided over Israel/Palestine (Gaza)** (DNC vs DSA); 2028 wide open.

# ★ How do domestic & international variables interact? — the two-level game *(Putnam 1988)*

***Core:*** domestic and international variables clearly interact — but *on what terms?* (avoid analytical "**ad-hocery**"). Putnam's answer: an international negotiation is a **single game played simultaneously at two interconnected levels.**

- **Level I** = **bargaining between the negotiators** at the international table.
- **Level II** = **separate discussions inside each country** about whether to **ratify** what the negotiator brings home.
- The leader sits at **both boards at once**: a deal must be **struck internationally** *and* **ratifiable domestically.**




**How to read it.** The key concept is the **win-set** = *the set of all Level-I deals that would win ratification at Level II.* Two consequences:

- **A deal is possible only where the two win-sets *overlap*** — bigger win-sets make agreement **more likely** (but risk a deal your public dislikes).
- **★ The Schelling conjecture (the counter-intuitive bit):** a **smaller** win-set can give a negotiator **more bargaining power** — "*I'd love to accept, but my parliament will never ratify that*" forces the other side to move. Being **tied down at home** is a **bargaining asset** abroad.
- **Defection:** a deal can fail through **voluntary** defection (a rational leader reneges) or **involuntary** defection (the leader *can't deliver* because ratification fails at home). → *domestic and international politics are **entangled**, not separate.*

## Or does the balance *vary*? *(deck)*

***Core:*** an alternative to "it's always a two-level game" is that the **weight** of domestic vs international variables **varies systematically** — by:

- **Time-period** — domestic variables matter **less in acute crisis** (power centralises, the public rallies).

- **State size** — **small states** may have **fewer foreign-policy options** (more constrained by the system).
- **Regime type** — **liberal democracies** are arguably **more exposed to domestic pressures** than illiberal/authoritarian states.
- **Policy arena** — some issues draw **much more domestic engagement** — most notably **trade.**

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## Cases & examples

- **The 1940s Liberal-Internationalism transformation.** Paradigm (global leadership) + interests (New-Deal/Wall-Street coalition) + institutions (UN/IMF/NATO + national-security state) + enduring logics. → *Illustrates: a **completed** transformational change — the model Trump is measured against.*
- **Trump-era US foreign policy (2017+).** Populist-nationalist paradigm, sidelined establishment, withdrawals from agreements, gutted State Dept — but intact alliances. → *Illustrates: "**incipient, partial and variegated**" transformation; **weak embeddedness** → proto-transformational.*
- **Vietnam disengagement.** Blamed on rising unpopularity — but note **salience** (opinion bites mainly under heavy losses). → *Illustrates: **public opinion** as a domestic variable, and its limits.*
- **Truman & international engagement (1945–53).** Individual commitment + elite shifts + USSR pressure. → *Illustrates: foreign policy as **several domestic + international variables interacting.***

## Key terms

| Term | Meaning |
|---|---|
| "Black box" | Grand IR theory treats the state's internal politics as unopened — inputs (system) → outputs (policy) |
| Foreign Policy Analysis (FPA) | The study of foreign policy as a product of domestic processes + international structure |
| Neoclassical realism | Systemic pressures **filtered through** domestic intervening variables (leaders, institutions) |
| Salience | How much the public actually attends to an issue (usually **low** for foreign policy) |
| Instrumental vs structural power | Direct lobbying vs business's leverage from control over investment/jobs |
| Transformational change | Lasting shift in **paradigm · interests · institutions · logics** (Ashbee & Hurst / Polanyi) |
| Embeddedness | Ideas rooted in supportive **interests + institutions** → they endure beyond the leader |
| Primacism | US **primacy**/preponderance as the organising aim of foreign policy |
| Two-level game (Putnam) | A negotiation played simultaneously at **Level I** (international) + **Level II** (domestic ratification) |
| Win-set | The set of Level-I deals that would be **ratified** at Level II; deals need **overlapping** win-sets |
| Schelling conjecture | A **smaller** win-set (tied hands at home) can mean **more** bargaining power abroad |

### Exam pointers

- Explain the "**black box**" critique and how **neoclassical realism / FPA** open it (systemic pressure **filtered through** domestic variables).
- List and apply the **five domestic variables** — and the **salience** caveat on public opinion.
- Define **transformational change** by its **four elements** (paradigm/interests/institutions/logics) and run it on **Trump** — verdict: "**incipient, partial and variegated**"; explain **embeddedness** and why Trump-I was only **proto-transformational.**
- Set out the **two-level game** (Level I/II, **win-sets**, the **Schelling conjecture**, voluntary vs involuntary defection).
- Give the **four ways the domestic–international balance may vary** (time/crisis, state size, regime type, policy arena — esp. **trade**).

**Bridge.** This lecture is the **hinge** between IR **theory** (I–IV) and real foreign-policy **practice**: the grand theories set the *international* stage, but **who a state actually is at home** — its leaders, ideas, bureaucracies, interests and publics — decides how it plays. The **two-level game** is the model of that interaction; **transformational change** is the yardstick for whether a shift will last.

## ★ Fun facts & memorable details (Foreign Policymaking)

> Sticky bits from the foreign-policymaking lecture.

- **The "Golden Arches" theory of peace:** no two countries that both have **McDonald's** had ever fought a war (a jokey stand-in for the liberal claim that **trade interdependence** deters war).
- "**The history of the world is but the biography of great men**" (Carlyle, 1840) — the **great-man theory** the lecture uses to *set up* why leaders alone aren't enough.
- **Tied hands are a bargaining chip:** Putnam/Schelling's counter-intuitive point — "*my parliament will never ratify that*" can win you a **better** deal. Weakness at home = strength abroad.
- **The 2017 US National Security Strategy used the word "competition" 18 times** — the reading's neat evidence of the zero-sum, nationalist paradigm shift.
- **A "hostile takeover":** a departing senior diplomat described Trump's first-year State Department — "*you decapitate the leadership, you compartmentalize the power centers, you engender fear and suspicion.*"
- **Populism is a "thin" ideology** (Mudde) — a **crust** on top of other ideologies, which is why Ashbee & Hurst call Trump-I only "**proto-transformational.**"
- **Japan revived the TPP *without* the US** after Trump pulled out — a real "changed logic": the world starts building around, not through, Washington.

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**PART III · THE EUROPEAN UNION AS A POLITICAL SYSTEM**

# EU I: The Evolution of the EU (AUW)

**Required reading:** McCormick, J. (2021), *Understanding the European Union: A Concise Introduction*, Palgrave Macmillan (**pp. 45–66**) · Wiener, A., Börzel, T. & Risse, T. (eds) (2019), *European Integration Theory*, 3rd ed.,

OUP (**pp. 44–49** = neofunctionalism; **pp. 64–70** = liberal intergovernmentalism).

**Theme of the lecture.** How did **six states cooperating after WWII** become a **deeply integrated regional political system** of (up to) 28? The lecture does two things: **(1)** tells the **story** — the twin processes of **deepening** (more policy areas, more shared authority) and **widening** (more member states), through treaties, bargains and crises; and **(2)** asks the **why** — explaining that story through the two great rival theories of integration, **neofunctionalism** (integration is driven by *spillover*) and **liberal intergovernmentalism** (integration is what *states bargain for*). It opens a new Part: the EU as a **political system** in its own right — neither an ordinary international organisation nor a state.

> ★ **The heart of the lecture:** European integration has advanced along **two dimensions — DEEPENING** (authority moves to the European level in more and more policy areas) and **WIDENING** (more states join). The **central question** is *why it developed this way*, and there are two rival answers: **neofunctionalism** — integration has an **autonomous, expansive logic** (*spillover*: integrating one area creates pressure to integrate the next); vs **liberal intergovernmentalism** — integration is a **controlled series of rational state bargains** (states form domestic preferences, bargain over the gains, and build institutions to lock in the deal).
> **Red thread:** is integration a runaway process that outgrows what states intended (NF), or exactly what powerful states chose (LI)?

**Key concepts to apply:** *European integration* (Haas's definition) · *supranational vs intergovernmental* · *deepening vs widening* · *the Community method* · *the four freedoms / common market* · *spillover* (functional · political · cultivated) · *permissive consensus* → *politicization* · *national preferences* · *asymmetrical interdependence* · *credible commitments* · *pooling vs delegating sovereignty*.

## What is European integration?

***Core:*** integration is a **process** by which states **increasingly cooperate, create common rules and institutions, and exercise some authority *jointly*** — changing **where decisions are made, what states can do alone, and what they do together.** It is at once an **institutional** process (building common bodies) and a **political** one (contested, driven by interests and bargaining).

- **The classic definition — Haas (1958):** integration is "*a process whereby political actors in several distinct national settings are persuaded to shift their **loyalties, expectations and political activities toward a new centre**, whose institutions possess or demand jurisdiction over the pre-existing national states.*" → Note the three things that move to the "new centre": **loyalties, expectations, activities.** (This definition is itself *neofunctionalist* — hold that thought for the theory section.)
- **Two faces of the process:** it is **institutional** (creating shared bodies with real authority) *and* **political** (about who wants what, and who bargains hardest). The EU is "the most developed example of this process in Europe."

### The EU: neither a typical international organization nor a state (*sui generis*)

***Core:*** the EU is a **new kind of political animal** — it combines **supranational** and **intergovernmental** governance, so it fits neither box.

| | Like this… | …but unlike this |
|---|---|---|
| **vs an international organization** | member states **remain sovereign**; national governments keep major areas of authority | EU institutions **exercise real authority** where states have **transferred or pooled** it — ordinary IOs can't bind members this way |
| **vs a state** | it makes binding rules across a territory | there is **no single European sovereign government** replacing the member states |

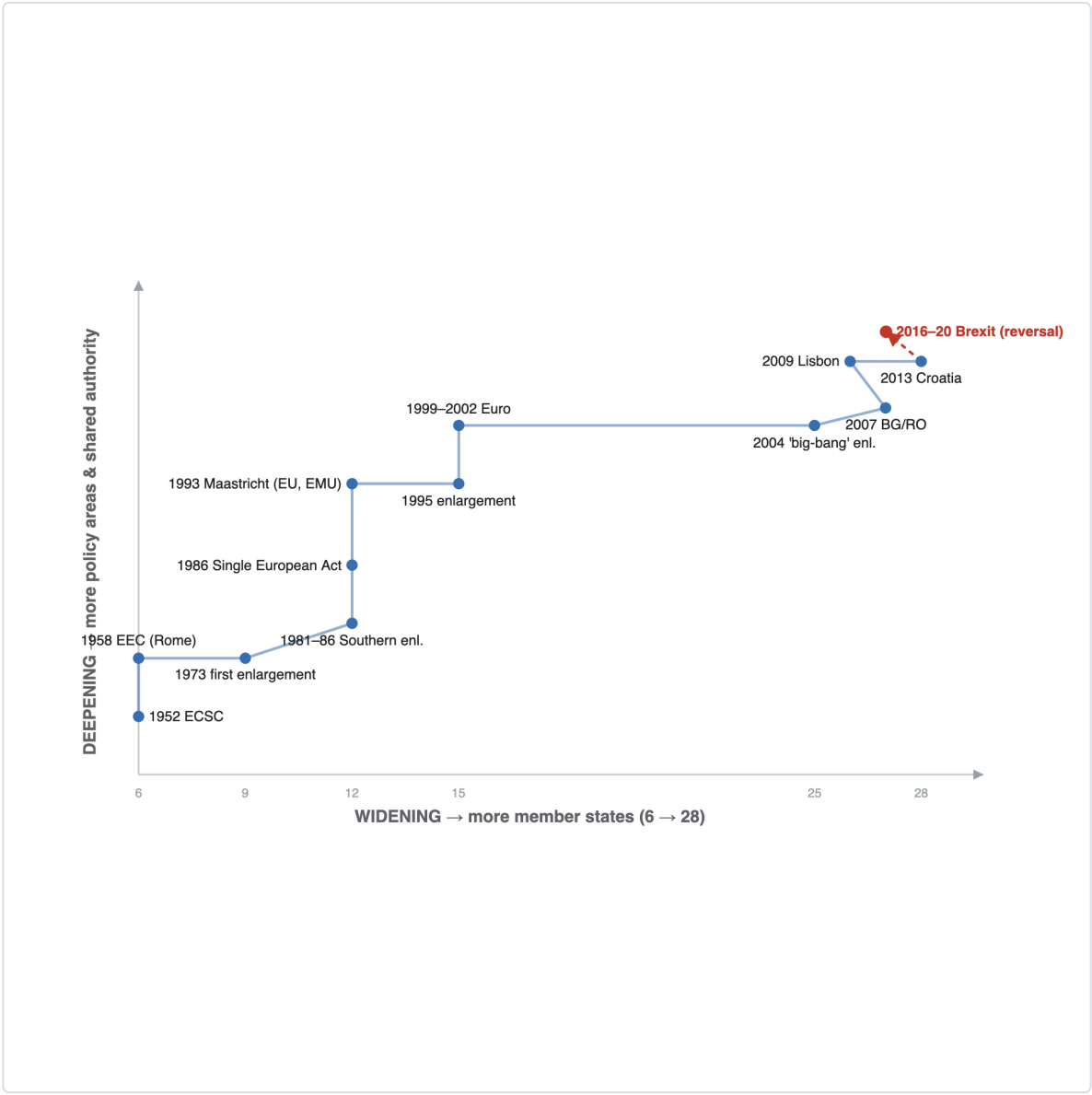
- **The two logics it combines** (the whole Part III in one distinction):
  - **Supranational** = authority **above** the states: common institutions (Commission, Court, Parliament, ECB) can make and enforce rules that bind members, sometimes by **majority** (so a state can be **outvoted**).
  - **Intergovernmental** = authority **between** the states: decisions taken by governments bargaining as sovereign equals, each keeping a **veto**.
  - *In plain terms:* in some policy areas Europe acts like a would-be federation (supranational); in others it's a club of sovereign states (intergovernmental). The EU is the **mix** — which is exactly why the two theories fight over how to read it.

## ★ Deepening & widening — the two dimensions of integration

*Core:* integration grows in **two directions at once**, and keeping them apart is the key analytical tool of the lecture (and the take-home exercise).

| | DEEPENING | WIDENING |
|---|---|---|
| **What grows** | the **scope & depth** of integration — more policy areas become European; common institutions/rules gain more authority | the **territory** — more **states join**, so EU rules cover more ground |
| **Direction** | "**vertical**" — authority moves *upward* to the European level | "**horizontal**" — the club gets *bigger* |
| **Examples** | ECSC → EEC → single market → euro; each treaty pooling more | 6 → 9 → 12 → 15 → 25 → 27 → 28 members |

- **They often happen together** — e.g. the **Single European Act** (deepening: the single-market push) coincided with **Southern enlargement** (widening). And they can pull against each other: a **wider** EU of very diverse members is harder to **deepen** (more vetoes, more varied interests) — which is why treaties like **Nice (2001)** had to *reform the institutions* so a larger Union could still function.
- **Integration can also go *backwards*** — **Brexit** is **widening in reverse** (a member leaves). So the full set of possibilities is: **deepening · widening · both · contestation · disintegration.**




**How to read it.** Each dot is a milestone plotted by **how many members** the club had (→ right = wider) and **how much authority** had moved to the European level (↑ up = deeper). The path climbs **up-and-to-the-right**: the EU got **both deeper and wider** over 60 years — but not smoothly. Long **horizontal** stretches (e.g. **2004** "big-bang" enlargement) are *pure widening* — lots of new members, no new depth that year. **Vertical** jumps (**Maastricht 1992**, the **euro**) are *pure deepening* — same members, much more shared authority. The **red arrow** is **Brexit**: for the first time the path moves **left** — integration reversed. *Use this map to answer the take-home exercise: classify each event as deepening, widening, both, or reversal.*

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## Why did integration begin after WWII? (McCormick, ch. 3)

**Reading:** McCormick, *Understanding the European Union*, ch. 3 "The Evolution of the EU" (**pp. 45–66**).

***Core:*** the EU was "**born out of the ruins of the Second World War.**" Three post-war needs drove it — **economic reconstruction, security in the Cold War, and stopping European nationalism from causing a third war** — and the linchpin of the whole project was **Franco-German reconciliation.**

- **The three needs** (McCormick's frame): **(1)** rebuild shattered economies (agricultural output had **halved**); **(2)** provide **security** as the USSR loomed and the Cold War set in; **(3) tame nationalism** — the nation-

state was "discredited by the war."

- **Franco-German reconciliation = the master key.** The belief: if the two historic enemies could be bound together, broader integration could follow. This is why the first step was **coal and steel** — "the building blocks of industry" and the base of German (Ruhr) power: pooling them made West Germany **reliant on trade with its neighbours** *and* eased **French fear** of German industrial revival.
- **The American scaffolding** (integration was "underwritten by the US"):
  - **Marshall Plan (1948–51): ~$12.5 bn** (~$132 bn in 2020 money) of US aid via the **OEEC (Paris)** — it "**encouraged European governments to work together**" and highlighted their economic **interdependence**.
  - **NATO (1949):** the security shield ("an attack on one = an attack on all") under which integration could safely proceed.
- **The false start — defence first (and why it failed).** An ambitious **European Defence Community (EDC)** + political community was proposed (1950) but **the French National Assembly rejected the EDC in 1954** (no British support; French fear of German rearmament; national humiliation at **Dien Bien Phu**). → *Lesson the founders learned:* integrate through **low-politics economics first** (Monnet's "step by step through concrete achievements"), not high-politics defence. *(This is exactly the sequence neofunctionalism theorises.)*
- **Suez (1956)** hammered the point home: Britain and France discovered they were **no longer world powers**, and Britain began to "look to Europe."

## ★ The evolution timeline — deepening & widening in action

***Core:*** the whole story on one page. Read each row as **deepening** (authority moves up) or **widening** (members join) — the diagram above plots it.

| Year | Milestone | D/W |
|---|---|---|
| **1950** | **Schuman Declaration** (9 May; now *Europe Day*) — pool Franco-German coal & steel | — |
| **1951/52** | **Treaty of Paris** → **ECSC** (the Six); first **supranational** transfer of powers | **Deepen** |
| **1957/58** | **Treaties of Rome** → **EEC + Euratom**; goal of a **common market** in 12 yrs | **Deepen** |
| **1968** | **Customs union** declared; **Common Agricultural Policy (CAP)** | **Deepen** |
| **1965–66** | **Empty-chair crisis** (de Gaulle) → **Luxembourg Compromise** affirms the **national veto** | *(stall)* |
| **1973** | **First enlargement:** UK, Ireland, Denmark (Norway says no) | **Widen** |
| **1979** | Direct elections to the **European Parliament** | Deepen |
| **1981 / 1986** | **Southern enlargement:** Greece (1981); Spain & Portugal (1986) | **Widen** |
| **1986/87** | **Single European Act** — complete the **single market** by 1992 | **Deepen** |
| **1992/93** | **Maastricht Treaty** → **the "European Union"** (pillars, EMU, citizenship) | **Deepen** |
| **1995** | Austria, Finland, Sweden join | **Widen** |
| **1999 / 2002** | **The euro** — electronic 1999, notes & coins 2002 | **Deepen** |
| **1997 / 2001** | Treaties of **Amsterdam** (Schengen into EU law) & **Nice** (institutional prep) | Deepen |
| **1993 / 2004 / 07 / 13** | **Copenhagen criteria** (1993); **"big-bang" East** (2004, 10 states); Bulgaria/Romania (2007); Croatia (2013 → **28**) | **Widen** |
| **2005 → 2009** | **Constitutional Treaty rejected** (France, NL) → salvaged as the **Treaty of Lisbon** (2009) | Deepen |
| **2016 / 2020** | **Brexit** referendum (2016) → UK leaves (2020) | **Reverse** |

## From coal & steel to a common market (1950–68)

***Core:*** integration began **narrow and sectoral** (coal + steel) and **expanded outward** into a general common market — the pattern neofunctionalists call spillover.

- **The Schuman Declaration (9 May 1950)** — drafted with **Jean Monnet**, announced by foreign minister **Robert Schuman**: place French & German coal and steel under a **common High Authority**, "a first step in the federation of Europe," making war between them "not merely unthinkable, but **materially impossible.**"
- **ECSC (Treaty of Paris 1951; began 1952).** The **Six** — **France, West Germany, Italy, Belgium, the Netherlands, Luxembourg** — created the **first supranational** body (High Authority under Monnet, + Council, Assembly, Court). Modest powers, but it "**proved a point about the feasibility of integration.**"
- **Treaties of Rome (1957) → EEC + Euratom (1958).** The same Six commit to a **common market** within 12 years (free movement of **people, money, services** + common external tariff), plus common **agriculture, trade, transport** policy. The Assembly becomes the **European Parliament** (1962).
- **The customs union (1968)** formed *ahead* of schedule, and the **CAP** created a single agricultural market with guaranteed farm prices. → *This early momentum looked like a vindication of neofunctionalism.*
- **But the state struck back:** the **1965–66 empty-chair crisis** — **de Gaulle** boycotted the Council over Commission power, voting and the budget — was resolved by the **Luxembourg Compromise**, which **affirmed the national veto.** → *The first big evidence for the intergovernmental side.*

## The enlargements — widening from 6 to 28

*Core:* the club grew in **waves**, each changing the EU's character; from the East it came with **conditionality** (the Copenhagen criteria).

- **1973 — first enlargement: UK, Ireland, Denmark.** Britain had stayed out (championing the looser **EFTA**, 1960), applied late, and was **vetoed twice by de Gaulle** (1963, 1967) — who feared British membership meant **US influence** — before finally joining after he resigned. **Norway's** electorate said no (as it would again in 1994).
- **1981/86 — Southern enlargement: Greece, then Spain & Portugal**, anchoring their **new democracies** after dictatorship. Doubling to **12** members **reduced Franco-German dominance** and shifted the internal economic balance.
- **1995 — Austria, Finland, Sweden** (rich EFTA states).
- **The Copenhagen criteria (1993)** — the conditions for (mainly Eastern) applicants: **(a)** stable **democracy**, human rights, rule of law; **(b)** a functioning **market economy**; **(c)** capacity to adopt the **acquis communautaire** (the whole existing body of EU law). → *Enlargement wasn't just adding territory; it drove **domestic change** in applicants — "conditionality."*
- **2004 "big-bang" — 10 states** (Cyprus, Malta + 8 post-communist: Czechia, Estonia, Hungary, Latvia, Lithuania, Poland, Slovenia, Slovakia); **2007** Bulgaria & Romania; **2013** Croatia → **28 members, ~500 m people.** Symbolically, the **end of the Cold War division of Europe.** (Candidates today: Albania, Montenegro, North Macedonia, Serbia, Turkey.)

## Deepening: the single market, Maastricht & the euro

*Core:* from the mid-1980s integration went **political**, not just economic — the single market, then a genuine **Union** with a **single currency.**

- **Single European Act (1986/87)** — the first big treaty change since Rome: complete the **single market by 31 Dec 1992** (scrap customs/passport controls, harmonise standards, mutual recognition of qualifications), new powers on **environment, R&D, regional** policy, and made **EMU an objective.** *(Related but separate: the **Schengen Agreement (1985)** abolished internal border controls — folded into EU law by Amsterdam.)*
- **Maastricht Treaty (1992/93) → "the European Union."** The turning point from *Community* to *Union*:
  - a **three-pillar** structure — (1) the European Community; (2) **Common Foreign & Security Policy**; (3) **Justice & Home Affairs** *(pillars 2–3 = intergovernmental; abolished by Lisbon)*;
  - the **Delors plan for Economic & Monetary Union** confirmed;
  - **EU citizenship** created; new EP powers (**codecision**).
  - Integration was now "**increasingly political as well as economic.**"
- **The euro** — electronic **1999**, notes & coins **2002**; adopted by all but **Denmark, Sweden, the UK**. Members give up **national monetary policy** and become deeply interdependent — "a clear example of **deepening.**"
- **Amsterdam (1997/99)** brought Schengen into EU law and expanded EP powers; **Nice (2001/03)** resized the institutions to **prepare for a much larger membership** — because the EU was becoming **both deeper and wider** while its institutions "had been designed for a smaller, less integrated system."
- **Constitutional Treaty → Lisbon.** A 2004 **Constitution** was **killed by referendums in France & the Netherlands (2005)** — founding members. Most of it was salvaged in the **Treaty of Lisbon (2009):** a permanent **European Council President**, a **High Representative** for foreign affairs (+ diplomatic service), **pillars abolished**, more **QMV** (but the **veto kept** for foreign/defence policy & tax), a single EU legal

personality, and — for the first time — an explicit **right to leave** (Article 50). → *The 2005 rejection shows integration "depends on **domestic political agreement** and can encounter resistance."*

### From "permissive consensus" to politicization — and the era of crisis

***Core:*** early integration was quietly **elite-driven**; from the 1990s it became **loudly contested** — and from the late 2000s the EU hit a cascade of overlapping crises.

- **The shift** (a key exam concept): the old "**permissive consensus**" — publics barely noticed, elites decided (recall neofunctionalism's assumption) — broke down after the **Danish "no" to Maastricht (1992)**. Integration became **politicized**, tied to hot issues: **economic distribution, national sovereignty, migration & borders, identity.** Enter **Euroscepticism.**
- **The "polycrisis"** (Juncker's word) / McCormick's **Seven Crises**, roughly in order:
  1. the **Constitutional Treaty** failure (2005);
  2. the **global financial crisis** (from 2007, imported from the US housing crash);
  3. the **euro / sovereign-debt crisis** (from 2009 — Greece's deficit at ~**13%** vs the 3% limit; bailouts by the EU/**ECB**/**IMF** conditional on **austerity**; riots in Athens; "Grexit" fears);
  4. the **rule-of-law crisis** (**Hungary & Poland** — judicial capture, Orbán's authoritarian turn);
  5. the **refugee crisis** (from the **Syrian war**; 2014–15 surge; west–east splits; the EU–**Turkey** deal);
  6. **Brexit** (below);
  7. the **Covid-19 pandemic** (2020) — the only crisis with no EU-internal cause, yet a severe test of united action.
- These crises "became **moments in which the scope, limits and distribution** of European cooperation were **contested**." *(Great material for the theories: each crisis can be read as spillover pressure **or** as an interstate distributional bargain.)*

### Brexit — integration in reverse

***Core:*** in **June 2016** UK voters chose to **leave** (**52%–48%**, 72% turnout); the UK formally left in **January 2020.** Brexit proves European integration is **not one-directional** — the possibilities include **deepening, widening, contestation, *and* disintegration.**

- **What it revealed** (McCormick): Leave support was **highest among older, less-educated voters**; it rode **low public knowledge of the EU** ("verifiably false claims" in the campaign) and broader forces — declining faith in government, people "left out" of integration's gains, and a **rejection of globalization.** It cost two PMs (Cameron, May) and triggered a constitutional crisis; Scotland, NI and London voted Remain.
- **Two readings:** either a **warning** of the costs of abandoning the EU (Britain "weaker outside than in") and a chance for the remaining 27 to **deepen** (e.g. defence) — *or*, more darkly (Bellamy & Castiglione), a sign of "**fragmentation and political disintegration.**"

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## ★ Why does European integration happen? — two rival theories

***Core:*** the lecture's *explanatory* half. There are **two families** of explanation, and they disagree fundamentally about **what drives integration and who is in control.**

| | Neofunctionalism (Haas) | Liberal Intergovernmentalism (Moravcsik) |
|---|---|---|
| **One-line claim** | integration is the result of **spillover** | integration is the result of **member-state governments pursuing the national interest** |
| **Who's in charge?** | elites, interest groups, firms, **supranational institutions** | **states** — "masters of the treaty" |
| **Is it automatic?** | **semi-automatic & expansive** — one step forces the next | **deliberate & controlled** — states choose each step |

*The sharpest contrast:* neofunctionalism says integration develops an **autonomous logic that pulls sovereignty upward beyond what states intended**; LI says integration is **exactly what powerful states intended** — a controlled sequence of bargains. Everything below fills in these two pictures. *(Readings: neofunctionalism ch. by Niemann, Lefkofridi & Schmitter; LI ch. by Moravcsik & Schimmelfennig — each theory presented by its own proponents.)*

## Neofunctionalism — integration through spillover (Haas 1958)

**Reading:** Wiener et al., ch. on Neofunctionalism (**pp. 44–49**). Founder: **Ernst B. Haas**, *The Uniting of Europe* (1958), written to explain the **ECSC**; revised by **Leon Lindberg**, **Philippe Schmitter**, Scheingold. Intellectual root: **functionalism (David Mitrany)**.

**Résumé.** Neofunctionalism is an "**approach**" (Haas's own word) that explains the **dynamics of integration once it has started** — deliberately *not* why it began or who joins. Its big idea: integration is **driven forward by its own consequences.** Cooperating in one sector creates problems, interests and institutions that generate **pressure to integrate further** — the process "**spills over**" from sector to sector, semi-automatically, carried by **elites and supranational bureaucrats** rather than mass publics. It is **transformative**: it changes actors' very **loyalties and expectations**, pulling them toward the "new centre."

***Core:*** integration is **incremental, elite-driven, positive-sum, and self-expanding.** Actors "**stumble**" from one decision to the next — often "under the pressure of crises and impending deadlines" — and each step creates the conditions for the next.

- **Main actors:** national **and** supranational **elites**, interest associations, firms, political parties — and crucially the "**Eurocrats**" (Commission / the ECSC's High Authority) who can become **agents of further integration.** *Not* just governments.
- **Core assumptions** (the driving forces):
  - actors are **self-interested but can *learn* and *change* their preferences** as they experience the benefits of cooperation;
  - integration is **incremental** → produces **unintended consequences** that require more integration to fix;
  - regional institutions, once created, **acquire autonomy** and push for more integration (they "**seek more autonomy**");
  - integration is **positive-sum** — the "supranational style" means no unconditional vetoes; instead an "**upgrading of common interests**" (package deals that expand the common ground);
  - growing **economic interdependence** means functional problems can't be solved within national borders.

### SPILLOVER — the master concept, in three types

***Core:*** **spillover** = the tendency for integration in one area to **create pressures to integrate in others**. Haas's "**expansive logic of sector integration**": integrating one sector "begets its own impetus toward extension of

the entire economy." It comes in **three forms** — learn to name and distinguish them:

| Type | Who/what drives it | Mechanism (how the pressure is created) |
|---|---|---|
| **Functional spillover** | the **technical interdependence** of sectors | integrating one sector creates **practical problems** solvable only by integrating the **adjacent** sector — integration expands almost mechanically outward |
| **Political spillover** | **national elites & interest groups** | actors affected by integration **shift their expectations, lobbying and loyalties** to the European level; repeated contact breeds **"bureaucratic interpenetration"** and **socialization** |
| **Cultivated spillover** | **supranational institutions** (Commission / High Authority) | the "Eurocrats" **actively broker** more integrative deals — "**splitting the difference**" and **"upgrading common interests"** — cultivating further integration |

- **Common logic:** *existing* integration generates pressures — functional, political, and cultivated — that **push the process further.** (Deck discussion: **free movement of workers** is already integrated → what new problems does it create? An Austrian professional living, working, paying taxes and retiring in **Portugal** needs integrated **social security, tax, pension, healthcare and qualification-recognition** rules → integration spills into all of those.)
- **Where it went wrong (be able to say this).** Neofunctionalism looked **vindicated** into the mid-1960s (ECSC → EEC/Euratom; the customs union formed *ahead* of schedule; the CAP). Then the "**empty chair**" **crisis (1965–66)**: French President **de Gaulle** paralysed the Community and the **Luxembourg Compromise (1966)** restored the **national veto** — directly contradicting the assumption of **automaticity.** Haas himself later called the theory "**obsolescent**" **(1976).** It **revived in the mid-1980s** with the single-market push (and is used again to explain the euro crisis — see below).

## Liberal Intergovernmentalism — states bargain (Moravcsik 1998)

**Reading:** Wiener et al., ch. on Liberal Intergovernmentalism (**pp. 64–70**). Founder: **Andrew Moravcsik**, *The Choice for Europe* (1998); roots in **Stanley Hoffmann**'s intergovernmentalism (1966). Today LI is the field's "**baseline**" **theory** — the standard everyone tests against.

**Résumé.** LI is the great **state-centric** rival. Its blunt claim: integration is "**a series of rational choices made by national leaders.**" States remain "**masters of the treaty**"; the EU is best seen as "**an international regime for policy coordination.**" But LI is **not realism** — it takes **domestic economic interests** seriously and treats institutions as useful. Its power is a clean **three-stage model** of how any integration decision is made.

***Core:*** two assumptions — **(1)** states are the **critical, unitary actors** (bargaining as sovereign equals, no central authority above them); **(2)** they are **boundedly rational** (they calculate costs/benefits and pick the option that maximises utility). From these follows the three-stage sequence, **each stage explained by a separate theory:**

| Stage | The question | The theory / mechanism |
|---|---|---|
| **1 · National preferences** | *what does each state want?* | a **liberal** theory: preferences are **issue-specific**, set by **domestic economic & societal interests** (producers vs taxpayers), *not* a single goal like "security" |
| **2 · Interstate bargaining** | *what deal gets struck, and who gains?* | an **intergovernmental** theory: **hard bargaining** over the distribution of gains; power comes from **asymmetrical interdependence** |
| **3 · Institutional choice** | *why build/empower institutions?* | a **regime** theory: institutions **lock in credible commitments** and cut transaction costs |

- **Stage 1 — national preferences (the "liberal" bit).** What a government wants is **built from the bottom up** out of domestic interests — and it's **issue-specific** (agriculture ≠ environment ≠ defence). Empirically, Moravcsik found state preferences on integration reflected **concrete economic interests** (esp. the post-war shift to intra-industry trade) far more than Cold-War security or "European ideals."
- **Stage 2 — interstate bargaining & asymmetrical interdependence (the key mechanism).** Preferences rarely match, so states **bargain hard** over how to split the gains — with **credible veto threats, side-payments, and threats of exclusion.** Bargaining power comes from **asymmetrical interdependence**: *In plain terms* — **the state that needs the deal *least* is the most powerful**, because it can most credibly walk away (its "**outside option**" is better). Big, less-dependent states dominate; outcomes tend toward the **lowest common denominator.** *(Direct shot at neofunctionalism:* LI says supranational "ideational entrepreneurs" like Monnet or Delors are **not** a fundamental cause — Commission mediation is a mere convenience, "no more than… airplanes, email, texts, or telephones.")*
- **Stage 3 — why create institutions? credible commitments.** States **pool** sovereignty (e.g. **qualified-majority voting**) or **delegate** it (to the **Commission, ECB, ECJ**) not because they lose control but to make their **commitments credible** — to stop each other **defecting** from the deal later (a **prisoner's-dilemma** fix). Institutions cut transaction costs, share information, monitor compliance. **The twist:** for LI the EU's supranational bodies are **weak and endogenous** (tiny budget, no coercion, rules enforced by *national* officials); the *real* guarantee of commitment is **domestic** — empowering national executives, courts and pro-deal groups.
- **Critiques of LI (be able to say this):** it explains the **grand treaty bargains** (Rome, SEA, Maastricht) well but is weak on **day-to-day EU politics**; it treats **institutions too thinly** (as mere instruments), underplaying how they feed back and reshape interests; and the **unitary-state** assumption flattens messy domestic pluralism.

## ★ Worked case — the eurozone / sovereign-debt crisis, explained twice

***Core:*** the deck's payoff: take **one event** — the crisis producing new European-level coordination — and show how **each theory explains the same facts differently.** This is the exam template (claim → mechanism → evidence → how the *other* theory would explain it).

| | Neofunctionalist reading | Liberal-intergovernmentalist reading |
|---|---|---|
| **What drove the response** | a **functional gap** in EMU's design created **spillover pressure** | **member states** bargained over who pays |
| **The mechanism** | monetary policy was pooled at the **supranational** level while **fiscal** policy stayed **national** — this discrepancy generated integrative pressure to close the gap | states calculated costs/benefits and did **hard bargaining** over bailouts, rescue funds and the Fiscal Compact |
| **Key actors** | **BusinessEurope** lobbied for more integration; financial markets signalled the same; the **Commission, Parliament and even the ECB** pushed for more (the ECB "breached the impartiality rule" to demand a **Banking Union**) | a **Northern vs Southern** coalition, each answering to its own citizens; the **Northern** bloc had more bargaining power |
| **The outcome** | crisis + deadlines → **incremental** deepening (Banking Union), institutions seeking **more autonomy** | the North **delayed support** to force the South to accept the **Fiscal Compact** (more monitoring) → EMU deepened via **budget control / European Semester** |

- **Why the case is powerful:** the **same deepening** (tighter EMU) is read by NF as **spillover** (the logic of EMU forced the next step) and by LI as a **distributional bargain** (the powerful creditor states extracted austerity in exchange for rescue). Neither is obviously "wrong" — which is the point of having **two theories.** *(Take-home: run the same four-step analysis on **EU defence integration**.)*

## ★ Neofunctionalism vs Liberal Intergovernmentalism — compared

| Dimension | Neofunctionalism | Liberal Intergovernmentalism |
|---|---|---|
| **Founder / key work** | Haas, *The Uniting of Europe* (1958) | Moravcsik, *The Choice for Europe* (1998) |
| **Key actors** | elites, interest groups, firms, **supranational institutions** | **states** (unitary, boundedly rational) — "masters of the treaty" |
| **What drives integration** | **spillover** (functional + political + cultivated) — incremental, semi-automatic | **rational state choices**: domestic preferences → bargaining → institutions |
| **Supranational institutions** | **autonomous engines** that reshape national interests | **endogenous instruments** to make commitments credible |
| **Logic of bargaining** | **positive-sum**, "upgrading common interests" | **distributive hard bargaining**, lowest common denominator |
| **Loyalties shift upward?** | **yes** — toward a "new centre" | **no** — states keep preeminence & legitimacy |
| **Explains well** | the **expansive early phase** (ECSC → EEC), day-to-day "creep," arguably the **euro crisis** | the **grand treaty bargains** (Rome, SEA, Maastricht) |
| **Explains badly** | the **empty-chair crisis / de Gaulle**, stagnation, the return of the veto | **everyday politics**, autonomous supranational agency, institutional feedback |

- **The takeaway for essays:** don't treat them as right/wrong but as **two lenses.** Neofunctionalism is strongest where integration seems to **outrun** what governments planned (spillover, unintended consequences, the Commission's creep); LI is strongest at the **big set-piece treaty moments** where you can see governments **bargaining hard over the terms.** A good answer names **which phenomenon** each explains best — and uses the **eurozone case** to show the same event through both.

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## ★ Fun facts & memorable details (EU I: Evolution)

> Sticky bits from the first EU lecture.

- **The EU began with *coal and steel* on purpose.** Placing the raw materials of war under a common authority (Schuman, 1950) was meant to make another Franco-German war "**materially impossible**" — peace engineered through economics.
- **Spillover means the EU "stumbles" forward.** Haas's actors don't march to a master plan — they "**stumble from one decision to another**," often "under the pressure of **crises and impending deadlines**." Integration by muddling through.
- **Haas fired his own theory.** After de Gaulle's empty chair broke the spell, the founder of neofunctionalism pronounced it "**obsolescent**" **(1976)** — only for it to stage a comeback in the 1980s.
- **Moravcsik's great put-down of the Commission:** supranational mediators are no more a *cause* of EU bargains than "**airplanes, email, texts, or telephones**" — useful logistics, not the driving force.
- **The EU is astonishingly *small* as a state-like thing:** an administration "**barely the size of a European city of a million people**," ~**2%** of European public spending, and **no coercive capacity** — most EU law is enforced by **national** officials. (LI's proof that states stay in charge.)
- "**Masters of the treaty**" — LI's memorable label for the member states: whatever Brussels does, the governments still hold the pen (they wrote the treaties and can rewrite them).
- **Brexit made a theoretical point real:** integration is **not one-directional.** The arrow can point **left.**

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# EU II: Institutions of the EU (AUW)

**Required reading:** Bulmer, Parker, Bache, George & Burns (2020), *Politics in the European Union*, 5th ed., OUP — **ch. 12, "The Institutional Architecture"** (pp. 205–237). *(Built **deck-first**, then enriched from Bulmer ch. 12 — which supplies the treaty basis (**TEU/TFEU** & the "**Union method**"), the **contested** Commission right of initiative, fuller **QMV** rules, the advisory bodies (**EESC/CoR**), the **budgetary procedure**, national parliaments' subsidiarity "**cards**", **CFSP** machinery, and **enhanced cooperation**. Marked (Bulmer) where a point is reading-only.)*

**Theme of the lecture.** This lecture maps the **institutional and legal machinery** behind the EU's **multi-level governance**: *who does what* (propose, decide, implement, enforce), *how* a decision becomes binding EU law, and *why* the shape of the architecture matters — it varies by policy area and it is exactly where the two theories from EU I (liberal intergovernmentalism vs neofunctionalism) fight it out. Three questions structure it: **Where is EU authority? · How does the EU make & enforce decisions? · Why does the architecture matter?**

> ★ **The heart of the lecture:** EU authority is **pooled, delegated and shared** across **levels** (EU ↔ member state) and across **bodies that each represent a different interest**. The "**typical**" way a law is made:

> **Commission proposes → Parliament + Council co-decide (the Ordinary Legislative Procedure, usually by Qualified Majority) → member states implement → Commission + CJEU enforce.** But this model **changes across policy areas** (some stay intergovernmental, e.g. foreign policy) and membership is **differentiated** (euro, Schengen).
> **Red thread:** the split between **supranational** bodies (Commission · Parliament · CJEU) and **intergovernmental** bodies (European Council · Council) *is* the institutional form of the **neofunctionalism-vs-LI** debate.

**Key concepts to apply:** *pooled / delegated / shared authority · supranational vs intergovernmental bodies · the right of initiative · Ordinary Legislative Procedure (co-decision) · Qualified Majority Voting (55% / 65%) · conferral · subsidiarity · proportionality · exclusive / shared / supporting competence · regulations · directives · decisions · positive vs negative integration · mutual recognition (Cassis de Dijon) · differentiated integration*.

## Where is EU authority?

***Core:*** there is **no single sovereign** in the EU. Authority to **propose, decide, implement and enforce** is **distributed** — **pooled** (states decide together), **delegated** (handed to a common body), and **shared** — across **two levels** and several bodies.

- **Two levels:**
  - **EU level: European Council · European Commission · Council of the EU · European Parliament · Court of Justice of the EU (CJEU).**
  - **Member-state level:** national **governments · legislatures · administrations · courts.**
- *In plain terms:* the EU isn't a government sitting "above" the states; it's a **system** in which the same task (making and enforcing a rule) is split among European bodies *and* national ones. This is what "**multi-level governance**" means.

### The EU is governed by treaty — TEU & TFEU *(Bulmer)*

***Core:*** the EU has **no constitution**; its authority comes entirely from **treaties** the states signed. Since the **Lisbon Treaty (in force December 2009)** there are **two**: the **TEU** (Treaty on European Union) and the **TFEU** (Treaty on the Functioning of the EU). Every EU act must cite the **treaty article** ("Treaty base") that authorises it.

| Treaty | What it sets out |
|---|---|
| **TEU** | the **broad principles** (democracy…), the **general role of the institutions**, **who may join** and **how a state may leave** (Art. 50 — new in Lisbon), and the **CFSP** *(kept largely outside the Court's jurisdiction)* |
| **TFEU** | the **detailed operation** of the institutions and **all other policy areas** — Bulmer calls this the **"Union method"** (the updated name for the old "Community method") |

- **Lisbon abolished the "three-pillar" structure** (1993–2009: (1) European Community, (2) CFSP, (3) Justice & Home Affairs). Everything except **CFSP** was merged into a single order run by the **Union method**; **CFSP stays distinctively intergovernmental** (see why the architecture matters).
- **Why it matters:** because power flows from the treaty base, *which article a proposal is built on* decides *which procedure and voting rule* apply — so the **choice of legal base is itself a site of conflict** (see the 1990 maternity-rights dispute).

## The five EU bodies — each represents a different interest

*Core:* the genius (and the tension) of the design: each institution is built to **represent a different constituency**, so EU decisions have to reconcile them. Learn this table cold — it's the backbone of the whole lecture.

| Body | Who sits there | Whose interest it represents | Core role |
|---|---|---|---|
| **European Council** | heads of state/government (27) + its President + Commission President | **national governments** — the top political level | sets **strategic direction** (not a legislator) |
| **Council of the EU** ("the Council") | national **ministers** (by policy area) | **member-state governments** | **co-legislates**; coordinates national policy |
| **European Parliament (EP)** | directly elected **MEPs** | **EU citizens** | **co-legislates** + **oversight** |
| **European Commission** | Commissioners + the EU civil service | the **Union-wide** general interest | **proposes** law; **implements**; **enforces** |
| **CJEU** | judges | the **EU legal order** | **interprets** & **adjudicates** EU law |
| *(watchdog)* **Court of Auditors** | auditors | sound use of EU money | **audits EU finances** |

- **The supranational / intergovernmental split** (keep it in view for the theory section): **Commission · EP · CJEU** are **supranational** (they serve the Union as a whole, above the states); **European Council · Council** are **intergovernmental** (they *are* the states). Every EU decision is a negotiation between these two logics.

## The basic architecture — the flow of a decision

*Core:* the bodies fit together in a **rough sequence**: direction → proposal → decision → implementation → enforcement.

```
European Council   → sets broad political direction
        ↓
European Commission → proposes legislation
        ↓
Council + European Parliament → adopt EU legislation
        ↓
Member-state administrations → implement legislation
        ↓
Commission + CJEU + national courts → monitor, interpret & enforce
```

## European Council — governments set the direction

*Core:* the **summit of national leaders.** It is the EU's **political compass**, not its legislature — it decides *where the Union is going*, and unblocks the biggest fights.

- **Who:** the **heads of state or government of the 27**, plus the **European Council President** and the **Commission President.** *(Don't confuse it with the Council of the EU — ministers — or the Council of Europe, a separate non-EU human-rights body from EU I.)*
- **What it does:** defines **broad political priorities**; provides **strategic direction**; **resolves major political disagreements** that ministers can't; gives "**political impetus**" to integration.
- **Why it's the intergovernmental heart:** it is literally the **national governments** in the room. In an LI reading, this is where the states — the "masters of the treaty" — steer.

## European Commission — the engine of EU policy

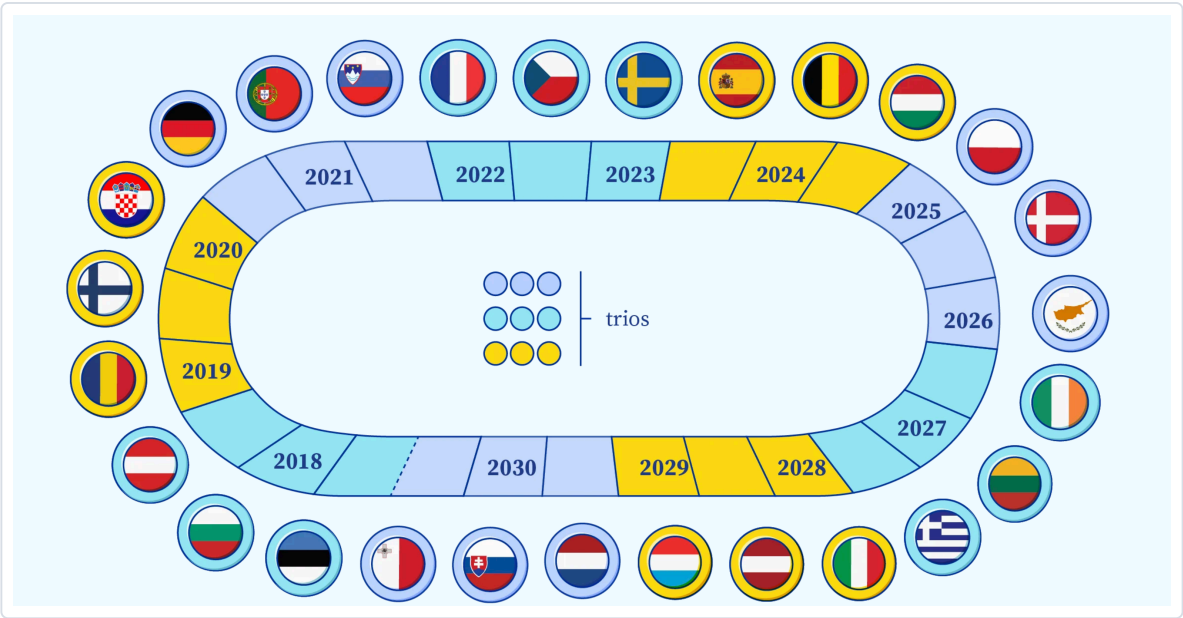
***Core:*** the EU's **executive and its motor.** Crucially, it holds the **right of initiative** — it **proposes** almost all EU legislation — and then **implements** and **polices** it. It represents the **Union-wide interest**, not any one country.

- **Four jobs** (PROPOSE · EXECUTE · ENFORCE · REPRESENT):
  1. **Proposes** — **initiates most EU legislation** and develops policy (the **right of initiative** — a huge power: it sets the agenda).
  2. **Executes** — manages EU **programmes and funding**; implements policy.
  3. **Enforces** — monitors compliance and can launch **infringement proceedings** against a state that breaks EU law.
  4. **Represents** — speaks for the EU **internationally** where it has competence (e.g. trade).
- **The right of initiative is *contested*, not absolute** *(Bulmer — a key debate)*. The Commission is *formally* the sole initiator, but the monopoly is hedged: **(1)** the **European Council** sets the strategic agenda the Commission then follows; **(2)** the **EP can request a proposal** (Art. 225 TFEU) and is hard to ignore; **(3)** the **Council can too** (Art. 241); **(4)** a **Conciliation Committee** can agree a text the Commission didn't write; **(5)** it always **consults widely** (interest groups, national experts) first. → *So "Commission proposes" is real but shared — an inter-institutional negotiation, not a dictate.*
- **Guardian of the Treaties.** Beyond proposing, the Commission is the **watchdog** that makes sure states apply EU law — via **infringement proceedings** (Art. 258 TFEU).
- **Why it's the supranational engine:** its whole job is to think for the **Union as a whole.** In a neofunctionalist reading, the Commission is the "**cultivated spillover**" actor — the Eurocrat that pushes integration forward.

## Council of the EU — member states as legislators

***Core:*** the **national ministers**, acting as the EU's **other legislative chamber** (alongside the EP). It is **not one fixed group of people** — it changes membership by topic.

- **Who / configurations: national ministers** meet in different **configurations by policy area** — Agriculture, Environment, Finance (ECOFIN), Competitiveness, etc. The relevant minister shows up for the relevant dossier.
- **What it does:** represents **member-state governments**; **co-legislates** with the EP; coordinates national policies; decides by **agreed voting rules** (usually **QMV**).
- **The rotating presidency — in "trios."** The chair of the Council rotates among member states every **6 months**, organised into **trios** of three countries that plan an 18-month programme together.




*How to read it*. The presidency isn't a person or a permanent seat — it **passes around the member states**, three at a time. Each **trio** (one colour) coordinates an 18-month agenda so priorities carry across the three six-month chairs. It's a concrete emblem of the Council's **intergovernmental, member-state-driven** character.

- **The Council is more than the ministers** (a key exam point): most of the real work happens **below** the ministers, among **diplomats and officials**, *before* ministers ever meet:

```
National ministers
      ↑  (formal adoption)
COREPER I & II   (committees of member states' permanent representatives / ambassadors)
      ↑
Working parties + national officials   (the technical bargaining)
      ↑
Council Secretariat
```

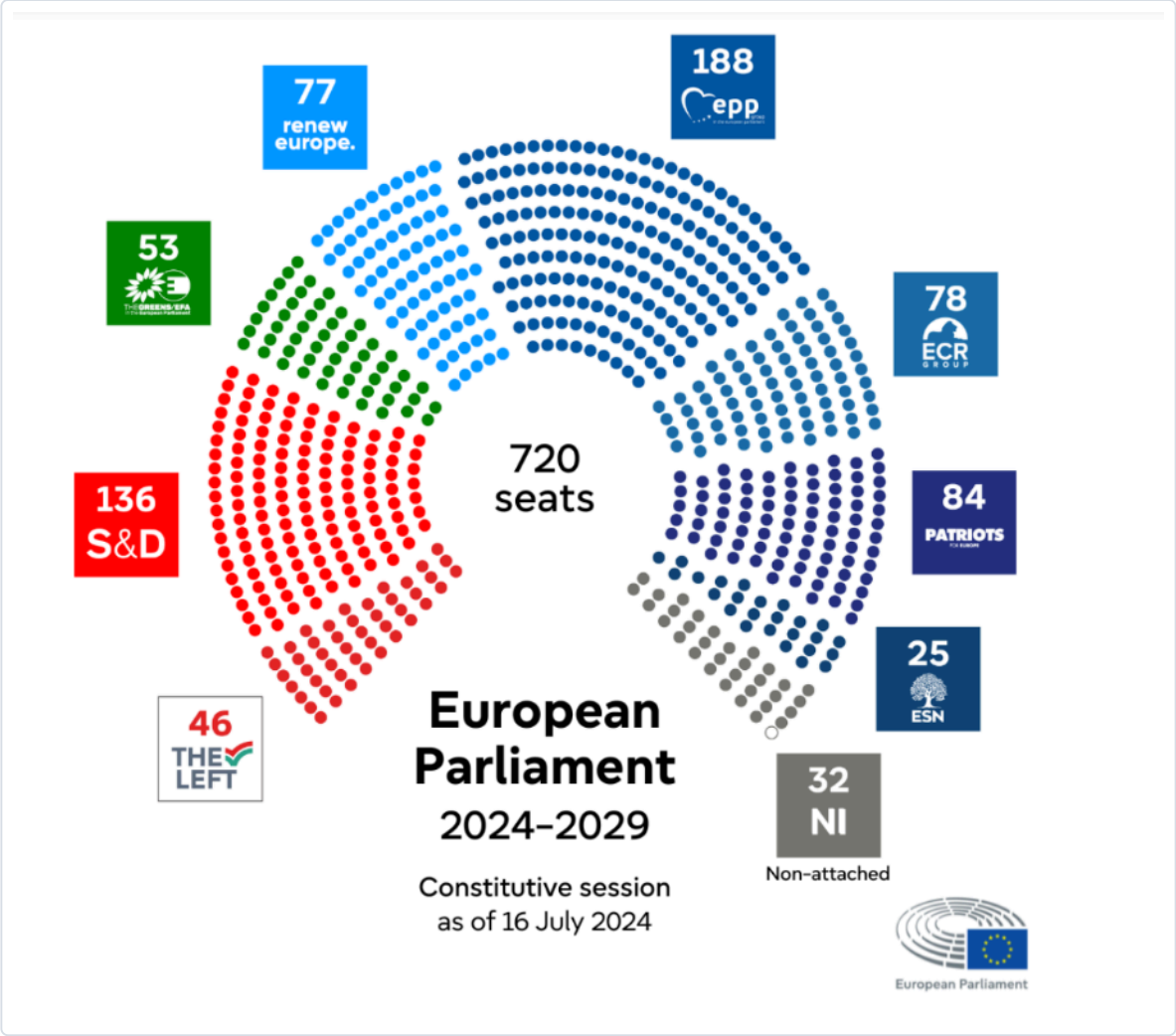
  → "**Much of the bargaining happens among diplomats before ministers meet.**" By the time ministers sign, most issues are already settled. *(This is exactly the "bureaucratic interpenetration" neofunctionalism talks about — national officials in constant contact.)*

- **In practice the Council prefers *consensus*, even when it could use QMV** *(Bulmer)*. Despite the spread of majority voting, ministers usually decide by **consensus** (Häge 2013). Governments often issue a **public statement of dissatisfaction even when they voted *for* a measure** — a way to **distance themselves at home** while keeping the consensual norm (Hagemann et al. 2019). → *The formal voting rule and the actual behaviour differ — a nuance the deck's "QMV" bullet hides.*

## European Parliament — citizens enter EU law-making

*Core:* the EU's **only directly elected** body — the citizens' chamber. Once a weak "talking shop," it has **gained real power through successive treaties** and now **co-legislates** as an equal with the Council.

- **Who: MEPs, directly elected every five years**, representing **EU citizens** (organised into cross-national **political groups**, not national delegations — a group needs ≥ **23 MEPs from ≥ 7 states**).
- **What it does: co-legislates** with the Council under the **Ordinary Legislative Procedure**; can **amend or block** legislation; **oversees** the Commission (it approves and can censure it).




*How to read it.* The hemicycle seats MEPs **left-to-right by ideology**, grouped into **transnational political families**, not by country. After the **2024** election the centre-right **EPP (188)** is the largest group, then the centre-left **S&D (136)**; the **centre holds a working majority** (EPP + S&D + Renew) but the **right** (Patriots, ECR, ESN) grew. → *Illustrates that the EP is a genuine, party-political parliament — the "citizens' interest" the deck's table names.*

## Court of Justice of the EU — authority through law

***Core:*** the EU's **supreme court.** By **interpreting the treaties and EU law**, it ensures the law means the **same thing everywhere** — and in doing so it **shapes integration** itself.

- **What it does: interprets** the treaties and EU legislation; ensures **uniform application** across all states; **resolves disputes**; and **draws the boundary** between EU and national authority.
- **Why it matters for integration:** "**courts can shape integration.**" By deciding what EU law requires, the CJEU can push integration forward without any new treaty — the neofunctionalist "integration through law." *(Not to be confused with the **European Court of Human Rights**, which belongs to the Council of Europe — see EU I.)*

## Two advisory bodies — the EESC & the Committee of the Regions *(Bulmer)*

***Core:*** beyond the five, two **consultative committees** have a **right to be consulted** on legislation (they advise, they don't decide). They matter because they bring **civil society** and the **subnational** level into the architecture.

- **European Economic & Social Committee (EESC)** — reps of **employers, workers, and "various interests"** (farmers, consumers, professions…); **329 members**, nominated by governments, sitting **in a personal capacity**. Consulted on social, single-market and related policy — but **not very influential**, **overshadowed by the elected EP**.
- **Committee of the Regions (CoR)** — reps of **regional & local government**, created by **Maastricht (1994)**. *More* influential than the EESC because it is **backed by powerful actors** — it was created at the insistence of the **German Länder**, worried their national government was signing away *their* powers to Brussels. → The CoR made itself the **champion of "multi-level governance"** (its 2009 White Paper), a natural **ally of the Commission** against central governments — a subnational echo of **cultivated spillover.**

### EU authority rests where the EU has *competence*

***Core:*** the EU has **no general power to act** — only the powers the treaties give it, and those come in **three strengths.**

| Competence | Who may legislate | Examples |
|---|---|---|
| **Exclusive** | **only the EU** | customs union · the single currency · competition rules · common commercial (trade) policy · fisheries conservation · certain international agreements |
| **Shared** | **EU *and* member states** (states act where the EU hasn't) | internal market · environment · transport · consumer protection |
| **Supporting** | member states legislate; the **EU only supports/coordinates** | culture · education · tourism *(and areas kept largely national — health systems, taxation, defence)* |

- **Bulmer's catalogue actually has *four* heads** *(Insight 12.1, from Arts. 3–6 TFEU)*: the three above **plus a distinct "policy co-ordination"** category for member states' **economic, employment and social policies** (the EU coordinates but doesn't legislate). *(CFSP sits outside this TFEU catalogue — it's in the TEU.)* Lisbon also spelt the catalogue out for the first time — partly a **German-Länder demand** to stop competence quietly drifting upward.

### Constitutional limits — conferral, subsidiarity, proportionality

***Core:*** three principles **fence in** EU power so it can't simply expand at will.

1. **Conferral** — the EU can act **only where the treaties give it competence.** No treaty basis → no EU action. *(The default is that power stays national.)*
2. **Subsidiarity** — in **non-exclusive** areas, the EU should act **only when the objective can't be adequately achieved by member states** acting alone (decisions taken as close to citizens as effective).
3. **Proportionality** — EU action must **not go beyond what is necessary** to achieve its aim (use the lightest tool that works).

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## How does the EU make & enforce decisions?

## How an EU law actually gets made — the Ordinary Legislative Procedure

*Core:* the "**typical**" model, also called **co-decision**: the **Commission proposes**, and the **Parliament and Council must *both* agree** — as co-equal legislators — before it becomes law.

- **The steps:**
  1. **Commission** — **agenda-setting**: develops and **proposes** the legislation (right of initiative).
  2. **European Parliament + Council of the EU** — examine and **amend** the proposal (each can propose changes).
  3. **Negotiation / readings** — the two co-legislators reconcile their versions (often in "trilogue" with the Commission).
  4. **Agreement** — **both** the EP **and** the Council approve the **same text**.
  5. **Adopted → implemented & enforced.**
- **The key feature: Parliament and Council co-decide as equals** — the citizens' chamber and the states' chamber must *both* say yes. Either can **amend or block.** → *This co-equal status is a major **deepening** of supranational democracy won over successive treaties (recall EU I: Maastricht's codecision, extended since).*

## Qualified Majority Voting (QMV) — how the Council decides

*Core:* in the Council, most decisions pass by **QMV, not unanimity** — a **double majority** of states *and* population. The radical implication: **a national government can be *outvoted*** and still be bound.

- **The double threshold — a proposal passes with:**
  - **55% of member states** (i.e. **at least 15 of 27**), **AND**
  - states representing **65% of the total EU population.**
- **Why the two locks:** the **55% of states** protects the **many smaller** countries (one state, one vote); the **65% of population** protects the **few large** ones (Germany, France…). A measure needs **both** kinds of majority. *(A blocking minority therefore needs at least 4 states — so no 3 big states can veto alone.)*
- **Fuller rules & history** *(Bulmer):* if the proposal is **not** from the Commission the bar is **higher — 72% of states** (still 65% of population). QMV is now the **default** — "the Council shall act by a qualified majority except where the Treaties provide otherwise" (Art. 16(3) TEU) — the end of a long march that began when the **SEA (1986)** first brought QMV to single-market laws, and that **de Gaulle had blocked** back in the 1965 empty-chair crisis. Every treaty since has **extended** QMV to more areas.
- **Unanimity still rules the sensitive areas** — **foreign & security policy, taxation, social security, common defence, operational police co-operation, enlargement, language rules, the seat of the institutions** — where **every state keeps a veto.**
- **Why it matters (the deck's exercise):** under **QMV**, a **Danish farmer**'s government can be **outvoted** by a coalition of others — influence depends on building **coalitions**, and small states punch above their weight per capita. Under **unanimity**, *every* government (however small) holds a **veto**, so the **French farmer**'s government could block anything it dislikes. → **QMV = supranational (states can lose); unanimity = intergovernmental (states stay in control).**

## The OLP is the norm — but not the only procedure *(Bulmer)*

*Core:* Lisbon made the **OLP the default**, but two "**special legislative procedures**" survive where states wanted to keep more control — the EP is weaker in both.

- **Consultation** — the Commission proposes, the **Council must *ask* the EP's opinion but can then ignore it**, and decides (often by **unanimity**). *(The CJEU's* **Isoglucose** *ruling (1980) established the Council must at least* ***wait for*** *the opinion before deciding.)* Now used in only ~20 areas.
- **Consent** (ex-"assent") — the EP **cannot amend**, but its **yes is required** — a **veto**. Main use: **international agreements**, including **accession of new members**, and the multi-annual budget framework.

## National parliaments get a say — the subsidiarity "cards" *(Bulmer)*

***Core:*** Lisbon, for the first time, let **national parliaments** police **subsidiarity** — a **subnational/national check** on the supranational legislative machine.

- **Yellow card:** if enough national parliaments (roughly **one-third**, within **8 weeks**) issue a **reasoned opinion** that a proposal breaches subsidiarity, the Commission must **review** it (and maintain, amend, or withdraw it).
- **Orange card:** a stronger version (a **simple majority** of parliaments) that, if backed by the Council or EP, can **kill** the proposal. **Never used.**
- **The yellow card has been played three times:** the **2012 "right-to-strike" (Monti II)** proposal — Commission **withdrew** it; the **2013 European Public Prosecutor** — Commission pressed on via **enhanced cooperation** (22 states); the **2016 posting-of-workers** directive — Commission found "no case," adopted it (an **East–West split**). → *A real, if limited, brake — evidence for the "subnational component" the lecture flags.*

## The other track — the EU budget *(Bulmer)*

***Core:*** alongside legislation, the EU's **money** runs on its own procedure — and it shows the **European Council's agenda-setting power** at its clearest.

- **The multi-annual financial framework (MFF)** — the EU's **~7-year** spending envelope — is proposed by the Commission but **fought out in the European Council and agreed by *unanimity***. *(The 2014–20 MFF (~€960 bn): the UK, backed by NL & Sweden, forced real-terms cuts;* ***Merkel brokered*** *the deal.)* Every state has a **veto** on the big number.
- **The annual budget** then follows an **OLP-like cycle**: the **Commission** drafts it, and the **Council + EP co-decide** (via a **Conciliation Committee** if they clash). If no budget by **1 January**, the EU runs on "**provisional twelfths**" (1/12 of last year's budget per month).
- **Discharge:** each year the **EP formally signs off** that the Commission spent the money properly — informed by the **Court of Auditors**' report. → *Money = where the intergovernmental European Council sets the ceiling and the supranational EP polices the spending.*

## After adoption — who implements? (adoption ≠ implementation)

***Core:*** the EU **makes** the rules but rarely **applies** them itself. **Implementation is mostly national** — a defining feature of the EU's "**small state**" design (recall EU I: most EU law is enforced by national officials).

```
EU organs        → adopt the legal framework
        ↓
National administrations → apply the rules in practice
        ↓
National courts / authorities → handle individual cases
        ↓
European Commission → monitors compliance
        ↓
CJEU → settles disputes over EU law
```

## Not all EU law works the same way — regulations, directives, decisions

*Core:* the EU has **three main legal instruments**, and they create **different relationships** between EU and national authority. Know the differences — a classic exam distinction.

| Instrument | Binding force | National transposition? |
|---|---|---|
| **Regulation** | **directly applicable** — becomes law in every state **as written**, automatically | **No** — no national law needed |
| **Directive** | binding as to the **result/objective**, but leaves the **means** to states | **Yes** — states must **transpose** it into national law (choosing *how*) |
| **Decision** | **binding in full** on **specific** addressees (a state, company or individual) | **No** — applies directly to whom it names |

- *In plain terms:* a **regulation** is a Union-wide law imposed identically everywhere (strongly supranational); a **directive** sets a goal but lets each state legislate its own route (a softer, more flexible tool); a **decision** is a targeted order. **Different instrument = different degree of central control.**
- **Directives transpose in *two* stages** *(Bulmer):* (1) **transposition** into national law, then (2) **application on the ground** by national administrations — and **compliance varies**, which is why the Commission polices it. **Recommendations & opinions** also exist but have **no legal force** (political weight only).
- **Legislative vs non-legislative acts** *(Lisbon):* not everything binding goes through the full legislative process — e.g. a **Commission competition ruling** fining a company is **legally binding** but non-legislative.
- **Soft law: the Open Method of Coordination (OMC)** *(Bulmer)*. Where the **EU lacks competence to legislate** (e.g. employment, social inclusion), states instead **compare and exchange best practice** and set voluntary targets — no binding law, just peer pressure and learning. *(A governance mode beyond the three legal instruments — "the EU is a very political animal.")*

## Integration through legislation *and* through courts (positive vs negative)

*Core:* the EU integrates in **two ways** — by **building** common rules (positive) and by **striking down** national barriers (negative, often via the CJEU).

- **Positive integration** — EU institutions **create common rules**: legislation, **harmonization**, common standards. *(Building a shared framework.)*
- **Negative integration** — EU law **removes national barriers**: the **CJEU** interprets the treaties so that incompatible national rules **fall away**. *(Clearing obstacles to the four freedoms.)*

- **Landmark case — *Cassis de Dijon* (1979).** Germany blocked a French blackcurrant liqueur for being below its minimum alcohol content. The CJEU ruled the barrier illegal and established the **principle of mutual recognition**: a good **lawfully sold in one member state** may in principle be **sold throughout** the EU, even without harmonized rules. → *Illustrates:* **negative integration through courts** — the CJEU removing a national barrier to **free movement of goods**, deepening the single market without any new legislation. *(A textbook neofunctionalist "integration through law.")*

### Who enforces EU rules?

*Core:* enforcement, like implementation, is **shared** between EU and national actors.

| Enforcer | Role |
|---|---|
| **European Commission** | monitors member-state compliance; brings **infringement proceedings** |
| **National authorities** | enforce EU rules **domestically** |
| **National courts** | apply EU law in **individual cases** (and can refer questions to the CJEU) |
| **CJEU** | **authoritative interpretation**; settles legal disputes |
| **European Court of Auditors** | **audits EU finances** |

- **The infringement route** *(Bulmer):* if a state breaks EU law, the Commission issues a **reasoned opinion** (Art. 258 TFEU) and, if the state still won't comply, takes it to the **CJEU** — which since **Maastricht** can impose **financial penalties** (Art. 260). Before Maastricht, a losing state faced only **moral pressure.**
- **Court of Auditors** *(Bulmer):* created **1975**, based in **Luxembourg**; **one member per state** (6-yr renewable term), ~**850 staff** (two-thirds auditors); checks that revenue and spending were **lawful and regular** and publishes an **annual report** — the basis for the EP's **budget discharge**.

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## Why does the architecture matter?

*Core:* the "typical" model (**Commission → EP + Council → law**) is **not universal.** The architecture **shifts by policy area**, and membership itself is **differentiated** — so "the EU" is really several different decision-systems at once.

- **It varies by policy area.** The standard supranational model dominates the **single market** and most regulation. But some areas stay **intergovernmental** — above all the **Common Foreign & Security Policy (CFSP)**:
  - driven by the **European Council + Council** (the member states);
  - **unanimity** generally required;
  - **more limited roles** for Commission, Parliament and CJEU. → *Where the EU is more supranational, integration can run ahead of states; where it's intergovernmental, states stay in charge. Same Union, different rules.*
- **CFSP machinery** *(Bulmer):* run by the **European Council** (strategy, by unanimity), the **Foreign Affairs Council**, and the **High Representative (HRUFASP)** — a **double-hatted** figure who is *also* a **Commission Vice-President** (Ashton → Mogherini → **Borrell**), backed by the EU's own diplomatic service, the **EEAS**. Decisions are mostly **declaratory, non-legislative**; the **CJEU is excluded**.

- **Escape valves: "constructive abstention"** (a state can abstain, not block, and isn't bound); and an **Art. 31(2) TEU safeguard** — a state pleading "**vital reasons of national policy**" stops a QMV vote, kicking it up to the European Council. *(That safeguard is essentially a **CFSP-only Luxembourg Compromise**.)*
- **But even here integration creeps:** the **EEAS** throws national and EU diplomats together (socialization), and in **2018 a group of states launched defence cooperation — PESCO** — via enhanced cooperation.

### Differentiated integration — common *and* varied

***Core:* not every member state participates in every policy the same way.** The EU can be **both common and differentiated** — a patchwork, not a uniform bloc.

- **Euro** — **not all** EU members use the single currency (Denmark opted out; others haven't joined).
- **Schengen** — **differentiated** participation in the passport-free travel area (some EU states out; some non-EU states — Norway, Switzerland — in).
- **Enhanced cooperation** — a **group of states can move ahead** in an area without the others.
- **Enhanced cooperation — the rules** *(Bulmer):* a **minimum of 9 states**, only in **non-exclusive** areas, as a **last resort**, and it must stay **open** for others to join; the resulting acts **bind only the participants** and are **not part of the *acquis*.** Real uses: the **financial-transaction ("Tobin") tax**, **cross-border divorce law**, the **EU patent** (25 states, minus Italy & Spain), and **PESCO** (defence, 2017). The **Fiscal Compact** (2012, from the euro crisis) is a cousin — a treaty binding **22 states** (the UK & Czechia stayed out), tightening budget monitoring.
- **Two more Lisbon flexibility valves** *(Bulmer):*
  - **Emergency brake** — in a few sensitive areas (social security, judicial cooperation, CFSP), a state that fears being outvoted can **suspend the procedure and appeal to the European Council** — a sovereignty escape hatch.
  - **Passerelle ("gangway") clauses** — let the Council **switch an area to QMV/OLP *without* a new treaty** (always *toward* supranationalism). Juncker called them "**lost treasure**" (2018) — but they need **unanimity + EP consent**, and **by 2019 had never been used.** → *This flexibility is how a Union of 27 very different states keeps deepening without forcing everyone to move in lockstep — recall the **deepening/widening tension** from EU I.*

## The architecture as cooperation & conflict *(Bulmer)*

***Core:*** the chapter's analytical frame — and the lecture's stated focus on "**cooperation and conflict** between the EU's supranational, intergovernmental and subnational components." The institutions are **not a clean separation of powers** but a **fusion** of shared functions, held together by cooperation and pulled apart by recurring conflict.

- "**Institutions matter**" (new institutionalism; Keohane) — the formal rules **shape** who wins, which is why the LI-vs-neofunctionalism fight plays out *over the institutions.*
- **A functional division of labour, not Montesquieu:** the **European Council** sets direction (but doesn't legislate), the **Commission** initiates + guards + implements, **Council + EP** co-legislate, **CJEU + Court of Auditors** watchdog. Powers are **shared, not separated.**
- **The European Council has risen to the "apex."** Even though it **cannot legislate**, it now **shapes the context** of nearly everything (agenda, budget ceilings, crisis deals) — "**integration without supranationalisation**" (Fabbrini & Puetter). A strongly **intergovernmental** trend.

- **Cooperation is engineered** through **inter-institutional agreements (IIAs)** and **Conciliation Committees** that keep Commission, Council and EP working together.
- **Conflict is structural** — over **who initiates** (the contested right of initiative), over **the money** (budget hawks vs doves), and over the **legal base**: e.g. in **1990** the Commission built a **maternity-rights** proposal on a **health-&-safety** article (Art. 118A) precisely because that triggered **QMV** rather than unanimity; the UK objected to the base and threatened the CJEU before settling. → *Which treaty article you choose decides the voting rule — so the choice itself is a power struggle.*
- **Formal vs informal:** this is the **formal skeleton**; the **informal** relationships (and the organized interests that lobby at every stage) do much of the real work.

## ★ Integration theories & the institutional architecture

***Core:*** the payoff — the lecture ties the machinery straight back to **EU I's two theories.** The **supranational vs intergovernmental** split among the institutions **is** the LI-vs-neofunctionalism debate made concrete.

| | Liberal Intergovernmentalism | Neofunctionalism / Supranationalism |
|---|---|---|
| **Key actors** | **member-state governments** | **supranational bodies & non-state actors** |
| **Key mechanism** | **interstate bargaining** | **spillover** |
| **Key EU bodies** | **European Council + Council** | **Commission + EP + CJEU** |
| **View of integration** | stays **under state control** | can develop **beyond** state control |

- **How to argue with it** (the deck's exercise — apply each theory to a feature):
  - **QMV in the Council** → *LI:* states **agreed** the rules and still bargain (and kept unanimity for the sensitive stuff); *NF:* accepting you can be **outvoted** is states **losing control** to a supranational majority.
  - **Commission's right of initiative** → *LI:* a convenient agenda-setter serving state-agreed goals; *NF:* the engine of **cultivated spillover**, shaping outcomes.
  - **CJEU + *Cassis de Dijon*** → *NF:* **integration through law**, courts removing barriers autonomously; *LI:* states tolerate it because it serves their **collective** interest in a working market.
  - **CFSP + unanimity** → *LI:* proof states keep the **veto** where sovereignty is dearest; *NF:* the **limit** of spillover — an area still "**encapsulated**."
- **The takeaway:** you can read the **same institution** two ways. The architecture is contested terrain precisely because **whether the supranational or the intergovernmental bodies dominate a policy area** decides whether integration is **state-controlled or self-propelling.**

## ★ Fun facts & memorable details (EU II: Institutions)

> Sticky bits from the institutions lecture.

- **Three "Councils," endlessly confused** — the **European Council** (leaders, sets direction), the **Council of the EU** (ministers, legislates), and the **Council of Europe** (a *separate* non-EU human-rights body, from EU I). Mixing them up is the classic exam slip.
- **The Commission has the "right of initiative"** — almost **no EU law can start without it.** Whoever sets the agenda has quiet power; that's why neofunctionalists call the Commission the **engine.**

- **A government can be *outvoted* and still bound** — under **QMV**, lose the vote and the law still applies to you. That single fact is the sharpest evidence that the EU is **more than** an ordinary international organisation.
- **The real deals are cut by diplomats, not ministers** — by the time ministers meet, **COREPER** ambassadors and working parties have usually pre-cooked the agreement. The photographed handshake is often theatre.
- **The presidency is a relay baton, not a throne** — it **rotates every six months** in **trios**; no country "runs" the EU.
- ***Cassis de Dijon* — a blackcurrant liqueur** that quietly built the single market: from a squabble over French crème de cassis came **mutual recognition**, one of the most important integration principles, made by **judges**, not legislators.
- **A regulation vs a directive** — a regulation is the same law everywhere the day it passes; a directive just sets the **goal** and lets 27 parliaments each find their own way there. Same Union, very different grip.
- **National parliaments have a "yellow card"** — and they've played it: in **2012** enough of them killed a proposal touching the **right to strike**, and the Commission **withdrew** it. The stronger "**orange card**"**? Never used.**
- **Passerelle clauses are "lost treasure"** — Juncker's phrase (2018) for the Lisbon buttons that could switch areas to majority voting **without a new treaty.** Nobody has ever pressed one.
- **A blackcurrant liqueur built the single market** — *Cassis de Dijon* (1979) gave the EU **mutual recognition**, made by **judges**, not legislators.
- **The choice of *article* is a weapon** — in 1990 the Commission dressed up **maternity rights** as a **health-&-safety** measure just to get **majority voting** instead of a national veto. Which treaty base you pick decides who can block you.

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# EU III: The Internal Market (AUW)

**Required reading:** Bulmer, Parker, Bache, George & Burns (2020), *Politics in the European Union*, 5th ed., OUP — **ch. 19, "The Single Market."** · Jensen, M. D. & Nedergaard, P. (2012), "**From 'Frankenstein' to 'toothless vampire'? Explaining the watering down of the services directive**," *Journal of European Public Policy* 19(6): 844–862.

**Theme of the lecture.** The **Single European Market (SEM)** — the EU's core economic project — from its early years, through the eurozone crisis, to today. It rests on the **four freedoms** (free movement of **goods, services, capital, people**) and is built by **two engines** — **removing** national barriers (*negative* integration) and **making** common EU rules (*positive* integration). The key argument: a single market is **not just economics but politics** — it develops through **political bargaining**, and it **constrains what national governments can do.** The **Services Directive** is the case that proves it. Throughout, watch the two theories from EU I: is the market built by **states bargaining** (LI) or by **supranational entrepreneurship & spillover** (neofunctionalism)?

> ★ **The heart of the lecture:** the hard part of market integration **begins after tariffs disappear** — the real obstacles are **non-tariff barriers** (different standards, licences, qualifications, rules). You dismantle them two ways: **negative integration** (remove barriers — often via the **Court**, e.g. *Cassis de Dijon* → **mutual recognition**) and **positive integration** (harmonise — make common rules, e.g. the **1992 programme**). Goods flow relatively easily; **services are far harder** because a service is often inseparable from the person providing it — which is why the **Services Directive** became a political firestorm.

> **Red thread:** the single market is an **institutional & political project**, not an automatic economic one — and it **changes the role of the state** from gatekeeper to rule-taker.

**Key concepts to apply:** *single market vs customs union · tariffs · quotas · non-tariff barriers · the four freedoms · negative vs positive integration · harmonization vs mutual recognition (Cassis de Dijon) · the 1992 programme / Cockfield White Paper / SEA · country-of-origin vs host-country principle · social dumping · posted workers · market-making vs market-correcting ("Social Europe").*

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## What is the single market?

*Core:* the **puzzle** — how can **27 sovereign states** with different governments, laws and regulators create **one market**? The answer: **free movement + removal of barriers + common rules where necessary**, so that crossing a national border no longer adds cost to economic activity.

- **The core question:** what makes a market genuinely "**single**" rather than "**fragmented**"? A single market is **more than a free-trade area or a customs union** — it attacks the *hidden* barriers that survive even after tariffs are gone.
- **The problem it solves:** a firm selling into another EU country still meets **different product standards, licensing, service rules, tax/admin systems, and professional qualifications.** The goal is to **remove the extra cost created simply by crossing a border.**

### A market is more than the absence of tariffs

*Core:* integration has **three layers of barrier**, and the **difficult part begins after tariffs disappear.**

| Barrier | Status in the EU |
|---|---|
| **Tariffs** (taxes on imports) | **largely removed** inside the **customs union** |
| **Quantitative restrictions** (quotas/limits) | **prohibited** |
| **Non-tariff barriers (NTBs)** — national regulations, standards, licences, admin requirements, discriminatory practices | **much harder to remove** — *this is the real work of the single market* |

### The four freedoms

*Core:* the single market turns "one market" into **concrete rights** — the free movement of **four** things across borders:

| Freedom | Right |
|---|---|
| **Goods** | sell products across borders |
| **Services** | provide services across borders |
| **Capital** | move & invest capital across borders |
| **People / labour** | move, work & establish businesses across borders |

→ *The four freedoms are the backbone of the lecture; each is developed below. They are* **not** *equally complete — goods are furthest along, services the least (see why services are harder).*

### Why integrate markets? — economic & political logic

***Core:*** two rationales run in parallel.

- **Economic logic:** a **larger integrated market** → more customers → more **competition** → more **specialization** → **economies of scale & scope.** (Bigger market = more efficient, more productive.)
- **Political logic:** economic integration → **fewer incentives for protectionism** → **stronger interdependence** between European economies. The broader ambition: a large European market able to support **prosperity and European economic power.**
- **A wider 1980s shift:** the SEM grew alongside a broad turn to **market liberalization** — **privatization** of state firms, **deregulation (and *re*-regulation)** of industries, and rising **globalization** pressure. The state's role shifted from owner/gatekeeper toward **regulator.**

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## How do you build an integrated market?

***Core:*** the lecture's central analytical tool — there are **two ways to integrate a market**, and the EU uses **both**.

| | Negative integration | Positive integration |
|---|---|---|
| **What** | **remove barriers** | **create common rules (harmonization)** |
| **How** | prohibit discrimination, strike down restrictions, enforce free-movement rights, **challenge national rules** | common standards, common regulations, common institutions & enforcement |
| **Chief agent** | often the **CJEU** (courts remove barriers) | the **Commission + Council + EP** (legislation) |

→ *Integration means* ***both taking rules away and creating rules at EU level.*** *(Recall the same distinction from EU II.)*

### *Cassis de Dijon* — the Court helps build the market

***Core:*** the landmark case (met already in EU II), here as the engine of **negative integration**: the CJEU didn't just settle a dispute — it **defined what market integration requires.**

- ***Cassis de Dijon* (1979):** Germany blocked a French blackcurrant liqueur for not meeting its **minimum-alcohol** rule. The CJEU struck the barrier down and established **mutual recognition**: a product **lawfully marketed in one member state** should generally be **allowed onto the market of another.**
- **Why it matters:** the Court was **actively removing a barrier** to free movement of goods — **integration through law**, without any new legislation.
- **Harmonization vs mutual recognition** (the two strategies for the same goal — *make national rules stop fragmenting the market*):
  - **Harmonization** — **replace** different national rules with **common EU rules.** *(Pro: a genuinely level playing field; Con: slow, politically hard, one-size-fits-all.)*
  - **Mutual recognition** — **keep** different national rules, but each state **recognizes** goods/services meeting **another** member state's rules. *(Pro: fast, respects diversity; Con: can trigger fears of a "race to the bottom" — whoever regulates most loosely wins.)*

### Who actually builds the single market?

*Core:* the SEM is an **institutional project** — the same cast as EU II, each with a role:

- **Commission** → **proposes** and **monitors** the rules;
- **Council + Parliament** → **adopt** the legislation;
- **Member states** → **transpose** (directives) and **implement** the rules;
- **CJEU** → **interprets** and **enforces** EU law;
- **Businesses & individuals** → **use and test** the rules (litigating brings cases like *Cassis*).

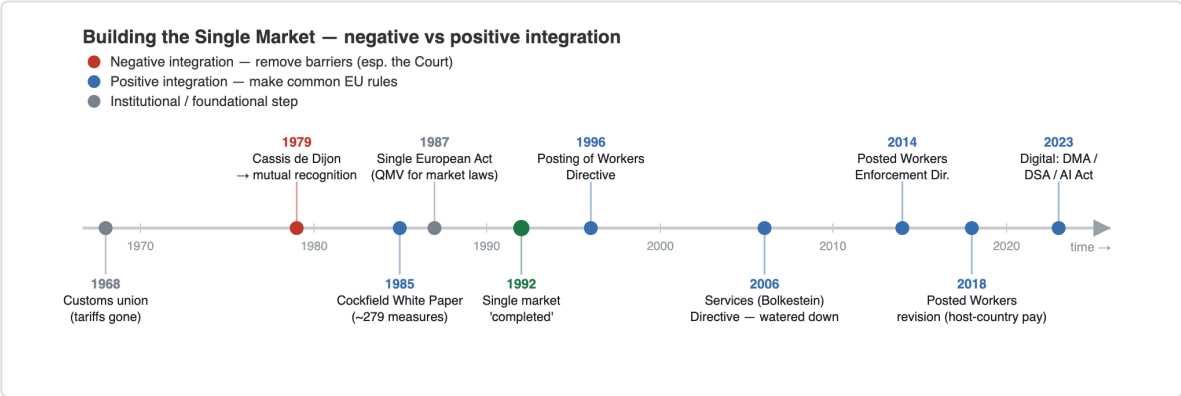
### The 1992 relaunch — why it made the difference

*Core:* the SEM stalled through the 1970s ("eurosclerosis," NTBs everywhere). The **relaunch of the mid-1980s** — "**Project 1992**" — is what finally delivered it, and it needed **both an idea and a way to decide.**

- **Project 1992:** the **1985 Delors Commission** → the **Cockfield White Paper** listing **~279 measures** to remove remaining barriers → a hard deadline: **31 December 1992.**
- **The crucial institutional change:** the **Single European Act (1987)** expanded **Qualified Majority Voting** for market-related laws — so single-market measures could no longer be **vetoed** by one state. → *The single market needed not just an economic idea but a **way of making collective decisions** about it (recall QMV). This is why the SEA mattered so much.*

### ★ The evolution of the single market

*Core:* the arc from customs union to the digital market — read it through the **two engines** (negative = the Court removing barriers; positive = the EU making common rules).




*How to read it.* Blue dots are **positive integration** (the EU legislating common rules), the red dot is **negative integration** (the **Court** removing a barrier — *Cassis*), grey/green are **institutional** milestones. Notice the shape: an early **Court-led** breakthrough (1979) → a burst of **institutional** relaunch (1985–92) → then a long run of **positive** law-making, much of it **social/corrective** (the Posted Workers directives) and, latterly, **digital**. The single market is never "finished" — it keeps re-opening as the economy changes.

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## The four freedoms in detail (Bulmer ch. 19)

*Core:* the four freedoms are **not equally complete. Goods** is the model (furthest along); **capital** was largely freed early; **labour** is held back by non-recognition of qualifications; **services** is the **hardest and least**

**complete.** The **1985 White Paper** attacked **three kinds of barrier**: **physical** (border checks), **fiscal** (tax differences), and **technical** (product standards, etc.).

## Free movement of GOODS — the model freedom

***Core:*** goods are the **template** for the whole market, solved by the "**new approach**": combine **mutual recognition** (from *Cassis*) with **minimum EU harmonization** only on health & safety.

- **Three barriers, three fixes: physical** (end border checks), **fiscal** (harmonize VAT & excise — only *partly* done), **technical** (national product standards — the hard one).
- **The "new approach" to standards** (avoids having to harmonize *everything*): by default, **mutual recognition** — a product legal in one state is legal in all — with the **only exception being health & safety.** For those, the EU sets **minimum standards** via two standards bodies, **CEN / CENELEC**; a product meeting them earns the "**CE" mark** and can't be barred anywhere.
- **Enforcement is still patchy** where **no harmonized EU standard exists** — firms report goods being hit with extra national tests "**especially in France and Germany**," and **public procurement** contracts still rarely go to non-national firms.

## Free movement of PERSONS & LABOUR

***Core:*** workers can move and work anywhere — and the right has been **extended beyond workers** — but **recognition of qualifications** remains a real block.

- **Workers** move freely; the White Paper **extended residence rights to the economically inactive** (students, the retired, the unemployed) and guaranteed **non-discrimination in social & welfare benefits.**
- **The main barrier: non-recognition of professional & educational qualifications** — a nurse or architect qualified in one state may not be recognized in another, limiting real mobility.
- **The welfare tension** (which explodes in the Services Directive): free movement of labour rubs against national **wage and welfare standards** — whose rules apply when a worker crosses a border to provide a service?

## Free movement of SERVICES — why it's so much harder

***Core:*** services are the **least complete** freedom — by **2005 only ~20% of services** were traded across borders. The reason is fundamental: **a service is often inseparable from the person or organization providing it.**

- **Why services ≠ goods:** providing a service across a border often requires **people, professional qualifications, local licences, establishment in the other country, and interaction with national regulators** — you can't just ship it in a box. There's also far more **information asymmetry / trust** involved.
- **The core dilemma — home-country vs host-country rules** (the deck's Polish-consultancy discussion): a Polish firm legally established in Poland wins a job in Denmark and wants to provide the service **temporarily** under **its Polish rules**; Denmark wants to impose **its own** requirements. → **Which country should regulate cross-border economic activity?** *(Home-country = frictionless but risks a "race to the bottom"; host-country = protects standards but re-fragments the market.)* This exact question is what the Services Directive fought over.
- **Sub-cases the EU liberalized slowly** (Bulmer): **telecommunications** (relatively successful — helped by US deregulation pressure and business lobbying) and **energy** (harder — "the public service argument,"

French defence of **EdF / Gaz de France**, union job fears). Both show services being prised open **sector by sector**, often over national-monopoly resistance.

### Free movement of CAPITAL

***Core:*** capital barriers "**had already started to disappear**" and were largely freed by the White Paper — but **integrating capital *markets*** is still unfinished business.

- The White Paper freed cross-border **securities, loans, and access to foreign stock exchanges** (three directives).
- Later deepening: the **Financial Services Action Plan (1999)** and, under Juncker, the **Capital Markets Union** — integrate Europe's **stock & share markets** (partly to **emulate the US**, channel citizens' savings into **SMEs**, and compensate for the **constrained fiscal capacity** of eurozone states after the crisis).

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## ★ The Services Directive — "from Frankenstein to toothless vampire" (Jensen & Nedergaard 2012)

***Core:*** the case that proves the lecture's thesis — **the single market develops through political bargaining, not just economic logic.** A radical liberalizing proposal (the "**Frankenstein directive**") was **watered down** into a "**toothless vampire**." The prize question: *why?*

**The proposal (2004).** Commissioner **Frits Bolkestein** (Prodi Commission) proposed a directive to finally build a **single market in services** (a huge share of EU GDP, barely traded across borders). Its explosive core: the **country-of-origin principle** — a firm providing services abroad could operate under its **home-country rules** (a service extension of *Cassis* mutual recognition, endorsed at the 2001 Stockholm summit).

**Why it detonated.** The country-of-origin principle raised the spectre of "**social dumping**" — firms from **low-wage** member states (especially after the **2004 eastern enlargement**) undercutting high-wage states by importing their cheaper home rules. Bulmer's vivid example: a **British firm building a house in Germany with British workers on British employment terms.** The fear crystallized in national folk-devils — the **French "Polish plumber" (*le plombier polonais*)**, Polish workers in German slaughterhouses, the Swedish **Laval** case. **Trade unions mobilized** hard; in France it was nicknamed the "**Frankenstein directive**" (pun on Bolke-*stein*). It became entangled with the **2005 French & Dutch Constitution referendums.**

**What changed (the dilution).** The final directive (adopted **12 Dec 2006**, EP vote **394–215–33**) was far tamer:

- the **country-of-origin principle was removed**, replaced by a vaguer "**freedom to provide services**" clause (leaving lots of room for **CJEU** interpretation later);
- **host-country labour law was preserved** (directly answering "social dumping");
- **whole sectors excluded** — healthcare, audiovisual, gambling, temporary work agencies, public transport, postal, some social services;
- a **screening / oversight system** was added.

**Why was it watered down? (Jensen & Nedergaard's explanation — actor-centred rational-choice institutionalism).** *Prima facie* the **European Parliament** was decisive (it wrote the adopted text) — but look closer:

- **The German pivot.** A newly elected **German "grand coalition" (CDU/CSU–SPD, Nov 2005)** used its ties to **both** big party groups (EPP & PES — both then led by Germans) to broker an internal compromise — a

**lowest-common-denominator** text that a huge EP majority could accept **and** that pre-empted any open **Council** opposition.

- **Interest-group asymmetry (Olson). Unions won the framing war** because their costs were **concentrated** (strong incentive to mobilize); **consumer groups** (who'd gain diffuse benefits) didn't organize. Counter-intuitively, the **states with the *most* barriers opposed the *most*** — because their threatened domestic actors mobilized best.
- **Two-level games (Putnam) + "shadow of QMV."** France & Germany bargained hard by pointing to **small domestic win-sets** (referendum/election pressure). No formal vote was needed — the deal was struck "**in the shadow of the vote**" (a credible **blocking minority**). CEE states had **large win-sets** (they'd accept anything better than the status quo), so they took the low common denominator — but won the **screening system** as a **second-dimension "bargaining chip"** to sell back home.
- **Endogenous preferences:** the **constitutional crisis** itself reshaped positions and pushed everyone toward compromise (losing *both* the Constitution and the Services Directive would have been too costly).

→ **KEY TAKEAWAY (the deck's):** *the Single Market develops through **political bargaining**, not simply economic logic.* And the "toothless vampire" **may yet regrow teeth** — the vague "freedom to provide services" hands power to the **CJEU** (see Laval).

## Posted workers — one market creates new governance problems

***Core:*** the unresolved remainder of the services fight. A **posted worker** is "an employee **temporarily sent** by an employer to another EU member state to provide a service" — and a single cross-border job now tangles **three rule-systems** at once.

- **The governance knot:** one posting = **home-country employment relationship** + **host-country workplace** + **EU free-movement rules.** *Which rules apply, and who enforces them?*
- **The Laval / Vaxholm case (2007).** A **Latvian** construction firm renovated a school in **Sweden** using Latvian workers on **Latvian** pay; Swedish unions blockaded the site. The **CJEU** sided (largely) with the **firm's freedom to provide services** over the unions' collective action — a shock to **Nordic wage-setting systems** (which rely on collective bargaining, not statutory minimum wages). *(With Viking, the classic case that market freedoms can **trump** national labour rights — the neoliberal-bias critique below.)*
- **The EU's response — from "market opening" to "fair mobility":** the **Posting of Workers Directive (1996)** → the **Enforcement Directive (2014)** → a **2018 revision** strengthening **host-country pay** ("equal pay for equal work in the same place") and distinguishing **short- vs long-term** postings. Posted workers **help firms fill short-term skill shortages** (esp. construction, border regions) — **but enforcement across borders is genuinely hard** (different rules, monitoring difficulties, abuse risk).

## The single market changes the role of the state

***Core:*** integration **reshapes what national governments can legitimately do.** The state doesn't disappear — but it turns from a **gatekeeper** into a **rule-taker** operating inside EU constraints.

| **Before integration, a government could largely decide…** | **With an integrated market, national decisions are constrained by…** |
|---|---|
| who **enters** the market | EU **free-movement** rules |
| which **standards** apply | EU **competition** rules |
| which firms get **support** | **common standards** |
| which services are **protected** | **CJEU** case law + EU **state-aid** rules |

→ *This is the deep political stakes of the single market: it isn't just about **relocating decisions** from the national to the European level (and to courts and regulators).*

## The contemporary single market — beyond the crisis & into the digital age

***Core:*** the single market keeps **re-opening** as the economy changes. The **problem has evolved** from tariffs/quotas/product rules to **digital platforms, data, and network effects.**

- **After the eurozone crisis (2009):** a substantial drop in intra-EU trade revived fears of **economic nationalism.** The **Monti report (2010)** urged renewed integration → the **Single Market Act I (2011) & II (2012).**
- **Juncker-era priorities: Capital Markets Union**; the **Digital Single Market** (mobile **roaming charges abolished, 2017**); and a "**Better Regulation**" agenda (impact assessments from 2015).
- **Today — digital markets:** the response to platforms/data is the **Digital Markets Act (DMA)**, **Digital Services Act (DSA)**, and **AI Act**, backed by **competition policy** *(the next lecture)*.

## ★ Is the single market "neoliberal"? — the normative debate (Bulmer)

***Core:*** beyond *explaining* the market, scholars **argue over whether it's good or bad.** The core fault line: is the SEM an efficient **regulatory** achievement, or a vehicle for **neoliberalism** that erodes Europe's social models?

- **The pro-market view — Majone:** the SEM makes the EU a "**regulatory state**" that delivers an efficient European marketplace. Delegating regulation to "**non-majoritarian**" **institutions** (Commission, courts, agencies) — away from vote-seeking national politics — **maximizes market efficiency**, a widespread welfare good. On this "**output legitimacy**" view, the EU has **no democratic deficit.**
- **The critical political-economy view — Scharpf, Cafruny & Ryner, van Apeldoorn:** the SEM embeds a **US-led neoliberal turn** — privatization, welfare retrenchment, liberalized corporate governance — often at the bidding of business (the **ERT**). Scharpf's key charge: a **structural asymmetry** that privileges **negative over positive integration** — *market-making* races ahead while *market-correcting* (social) rules lag, because the **Court** can strike down national social protections (**Laval, Viking, 2007**) but the EU struggles to legislate a "**Social Europe**" in their place.
- **The constructivist middle — Hay & Wincott:** both sides **overstate the structural imperatives.** The market is **not fully** "**depoliticized**" — it's contestable (witness the Services Directive) and some CJEU rulings **protected** national social prerogatives; welfare-capitalist **diversity persists** across members.

- **Postfunctionalism: popular dissatisfaction** with the EU may act as a **brake** on further market integration. *(This debate went political in the UK: "**Lexiteers**" argued the single market forces neoliberalism on Britain — a left-wing case for Brexit.) → Great exam hinge: link the negative/positive integration distinction to Scharpf's asymmetry — the SEM is strong at **removing** barriers (courts, mutual recognition) but weak at **building** a common social floor.*

## ★ Integration theories & the single market

***Core:*** the capstone — the deck's closing question: **is the single market mainly states pursuing their interests (LI), or can the integration process generate further integration (neofunctionalism)?** Apply the two lenses to three episodes.

| Episode | Liberal Intergovernmentalism | Neofunctionalism / supranationalism |
|---|---|---|
| **Project 1992** | changing national **preferences** + **interstate bargaining** (France/Germany/UK converge) | **Commission entrepreneurship** (Delors, the ERT) + institutional momentum |
| **Cassis de Dijon** | states **created the legal framework** the Court works within | the **CJEU** develops integration through **supranational action** |
| **Services Directive** | domestic **preferences + bargaining** (the German-brokered compromise) | supranational **ambitions meet political resistance** (Commission overreached) |

- **Bulmer's fuller "map" of the debate** (useful nuance): the **original common-market decision** fits **LI** (small-state elites, no ECSC spillover); the **1960 acceleration** looked **neofunctionalist** (Lindberg: French industry reversed, Commission "cultivated" spillover); the **1992 relaunch** is **genuinely contested** (Delors/ERT entrepreneurship *vs* Moravcsik's LI — the White Paper as a **member-state mandate**); and the **momentum after 1992** is best read through **historical institutionalism** (the SEA changed the rules, presidencies competed on delivery, the CJEU entrenched free-market readings).
- **The takeaway:** no single theory wins. The single market is where **all** the EU theories are tested — and the honest answer is that **states set the frame, but courts, the Commission and institutional momentum keep pushing it further than any single bargain intended.**

## ★ Fun facts & memorable details (EU III: The Internal Market)

> Sticky bits from the internal-market lecture.

- **The hard part starts *after* tariffs vanish.** Anyone can scrap a tariff; the real single-market battle is over **invisible** barriers — a German bottle-shape rule, a French test certificate, a licensing form. "**Non-tariff barriers**" are where markets quietly re-fragment.
- **A liqueur wrote the rulebook — twice.** *Cassis de Dijon* (1979) gave goods **mutual recognition**; then the Commission tried to copy that logic onto **services** (country-of-origin) — and set off a political explosion.
- **The "Frankenstein directive."** France's nickname for the Bolkestein services proposal — a pun on ***Bolke-stein*** — a "monster" that would destroy jobs. It ended up so defanged that scholars called the result a "**toothless vampire.**"
- **The Polish plumber** became the face of "**social dumping**" fears — a folk-devil who, the story went, would undercut French tradesmen. He was mostly a myth, but he helped sink the Constitution referendum.

- **~279 measures, one deadline.** Lord Cockfield's 1985 White Paper turned "complete the market" into a **checklist** with a hard date — **31 December 1992** — and **95%** of it was actually agreed on time.
- **The "CE" mark** on your electronics is the single market in miniature: meet EU **minimum health-&-safety** standards (CEN/CENELEC) and no country can keep you out.
- **Courts can beat parliaments.** In **Laval/Viking (2007)** the CJEU let a firm's freedom to provide services **override** Nordic collective-bargaining rights — the sharpest evidence for Scharpf's "**negative beats positive integration**" thesis.
- **Roaming charges died in 2017** — the most tangible thing the "Digital Single Market" ever did for ordinary citizens.

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# EU IV: EU Competition Policy (AUW)

**Required reading:** Wilks, S. (2014), "Competition Policy: **Defending the Economic Constitution**," in H. Wallace, M. A. Pollack & A. R. Young (eds), *Policy-Making in the European Union*, 7th ed., OUP, ch. 6.

**Theme of the lecture.** Competition policy is the lecture's **worked example of "EU institutions in action"** — and it's a special one: arguably the **most developed, most supranational** common policy underpinning the Single Market. After the basics (what competition policy is, its instruments, why it's so supranational), the lecture zooms in on **high-profile recent cases** — **Google Shopping** (abuse of dominance in digital markets → the DMA) and **Fiat/Apple** (tax breaks as illegal state aid), plus **foreign subsidies**. Throughout, three theoretical lenses compete to explain it: **liberal intergovernmentalism, supranationalism/neofunctionalism, and ideas (constructivism).**

> ★ **The heart of the lecture:** competition policy keeps the market's playing field **level** — stopping **firms** (cartels, abuse of dominance, anti-competitive mergers) *and* **governments** (state aid, foreign subsidies) from rigging competition. It is the EU's **most supranational** policy: an **exclusive competence** where the **Commission (DG COMP)** makes, enforces, and adjudicates the rules — investigator, prosecutor and judge in one. Wilks's thesis: this makes competition policy the EU's "**economic constitution**" — the foundational, quasi-constitutional rules that entrench a competitive market order.
> **Red thread:** why is the Commission *so* powerful here — and is competition policy just being *adapted* to digital markets, or is the EU *redefining what competition means*?

**Key concepts to apply:** *the economic constitution / ordoliberalism · competition vs competitiveness policy · exclusive competence · antitrust (Art. 101 cartels · Art. 102 abuse of dominance) · merger control · state aid (Arts. 107–109) · DG COMP · the European Competition Network (ECN) · leniency · gatekeepers · ex-post vs ex-ante regulation (the DMA) · foreign subsidies* · the three lenses (*LI · supranationalism · ideas*).

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## What is competition policy? (competition ≠ competitiveness)

***Core:*** a crucial distinction the lecture opens on. **Competition** policy and **competitiveness** policy sound alike but are opposites in method.

| | Competition policy | Competitiveness policy |
|---|---|---|
| **Question** | how do we maintain **effective competition *between firms*** in the EU market? | how do we make **European firms/the economy** more productive & globally competitive? |
| **Method** | **referee** — police and constrain firms & governments | **booster** — support and promote industry |

- **The puzzle:** *when should public authorities intervene in markets to protect competition?* The flashpoints: **cartels, market dominance, state aid, digital gatekeepers, foreign subsidies.**

### Why the single market needs rules of competition

***Core:*** open markets create incentives to **compete** — but also incentives to **escape** competition. Competition policy exists to stop four kinds of rigging.

- **The basic problem:** actors have incentives to **reduce** competition (it's more profitable not to compete). EU competition policy tries to prevent:
  1. **firms restricting competition** (cartels);
  2. **dominant firms abusing** market power;
  3. **governments distorting** competition through **state aid**;
  4. **anti-competitive mergers.**
- → *Competition rules are the **complement** to the single market: EU III removes state barriers to trade; competition policy stops **private** actors (and subsidies) from rebuilding those barriers.*

### An exclusive competence

***Core:*** competition is one of the EU's few **exclusive competences** (Art. 3 TFEU) — *only the EU* sets the competition rules needed for the internal market. This is why it's so supranational.

- Because it's exclusive, **supranational authorities** hold substantial responsibility for the whole chain: **making the rules → enforcing them → developing the policy.** (Contrast the *shared/supporting* competences from EU II.)

## ★ The competition policy toolbox

***Core:*** six instruments — **four traditional pillars** plus **two new frontiers** — all wielded by the **European Commission / DG COMP.**

| # | Instrument | Purpose | Treaty base |
|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | **Cartels** | stop firms **colluding** | **Art. 101 TFEU** |
| 2 | **Abuse of dominance** | stop dominant firms **excluding** rivals | **Art. 102 TFEU** |
| 3 | **Merger control** | block mergers that **substantially harm** competition | Merger Regulation |
| 4 | **State aid** | stop governments **selectively distorting** competition | **Arts. 107–109 TFEU** |
| 5 | **Digital-market regulation** *(new)* | pre-empt anti-competitive behaviour by **gatekeepers** | the **DMA** |
| 6 | **Foreign-subsidies regulation** *(new)* | curb **non-EU** subsidies distorting the EU market | Foreign Subsidies Regulation |

→ *Pillars 1–4 are the classic core; 5–6 are the EU's response to **digital platforms** and **geopolitical** competition (China). The rest of the lecture walks each one.*

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## ★ The "economic constitution" — Wilks's central argument

***Core:*** Wilks's thesis and the chapter's title — competition policy is not just another policy; it is **constitutional.** The competition rules are the EU's "**economic constitution**": the foundational, quasi-constitutional principles that **guarantee a competitive market order**, disciplining **firms *and* governments.**

- **The ordoliberal idea.** "**Economic constitution**" (*Wirtschaftsverfassung*) comes from German **ordoliberalism**: the state's core job is to **set and defend a legal framework that guarantees competition** — protecting the competitive order from **both** private power (cartels, monopolies) **and** state distortion (subsidies).
- **The ECB analogy (memorable):** *just as the **ECB** guarantees a sound currency and low inflation, the **competition rules** guarantee a free market and economic efficiency* — together an "**economic constitution**" for Europe.
- **Why "constitutional":** as the EU's **treaties function like a constitution**, their **economic provisions become constitutional principles** that structure the whole economy — and *frame other policies* (R&D, environment, telecoms, media). Every economic actor must accept the market order the rules define. This is why competition policy can **discipline national governments**, not just companies.
- **Three edges Wilks draws out:** (1) it makes **DG COMP** "**doubly insulated**" — exceptionally independent; (2) "**juridification**" — the economy is increasingly run through **law and courts** (economic rights protected, but at the cost of legal process); (3) it **embeds a particular, arguably *neoliberal*, market model** — raising the political stakes (the **social-market/"Rhenish"** vs **Anglo-Saxon** debate — see history).
- **It was contingent, not inevitable:** this free-market vision became dominant only via the **1980s neoliberal turn + the 1992 single market**, and was **consolidated by the collapse of communism** and **eastern enlargement** (new members swallowed it whole as part of the *acquis*).

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## How does the EU enforce competition rules?

***Core:*** competition policy is **the** most supranational EU policy because the market **needs** uniform rules — and the **Commission (DG COMP)** is a uniquely powerful enforcer combining **economic analysis + legal authority + enforcement** in one house.

- **Multi-level, but Commission-led:**
  - **EU level:** common rules · **Commission enforcement** · **CJEU** review.
  - **National level: National Competition Authorities (NCAs)** enforce within member states, coordinated through the **European Competition Network (ECN).**
- **The Commission's role has *expanded*** — from merely **proposing** common rules to running the whole enforcement chain: **investigation → enforcement → remedies → fines.** It has become "an increasingly **autonomous** competition regulator" — effectively **investigator, prosecutor, and judge** in one (a key debate — see the due-process critique).
  - Enforcement teeth: **dawn raids** (surprise inspections), heavy **fines** (up to **10% of global turnover**, paid into the **EU budget**), **commitments/remedies**, and — for cartels — the **leniency programme.**
- **DG COMP — "perhaps the most powerful competition authority in the world"** *(Wilks)*. A **small** directorate (~720 staff) but exceptionally **autonomous** — ranked among the five "elite" global agencies (with the US FTC & DOJ). Its **administrative model** (officials investigate *and* decide) is a global alternative to the US **court-based** model.
- **Modernization — Regulation 1/2003** *(Wilks)*. A "once-in-a-generation" reform that **decentralized** antitrust enforcement to the **NCAs** (under Commission supervision), coordinated through the **European Competition Network (ECN)**. It **replaced national laws with EU law** for cross-border cases and **mobilized NCA resources** — vital, since DG COMP is chronically **understaffed** (~436 senior officials policing 450m+ consumers).
- **The "prosecutor, judge and jury" critique** *(Wilks — a key legitimacy debate)*. In the Art. 101 process one **rapporteur** investigates, negotiates *and* prosecutes, then DG staff **decide and set the fine** — all inside one organization ("policeman, arbitrator, prosecutor, judge, jury *and* prison officer"). Hence recurring calls for an **independent European Cartel Office** — and the **General Court** has pushed back (it overturned the Commission in *Airtours* 2002 for "manifest errors"). → *the accountability problem grows sharper as DG COMP grows more powerful (see debates).*

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## Pillar 1 — Cartels (Article 101 TFEU)

***Core:*** the classic sin: **competitors agreeing not to compete.** Art. 101 prohibits **agreements and concerted practices** that prevent, restrict or distort competition.

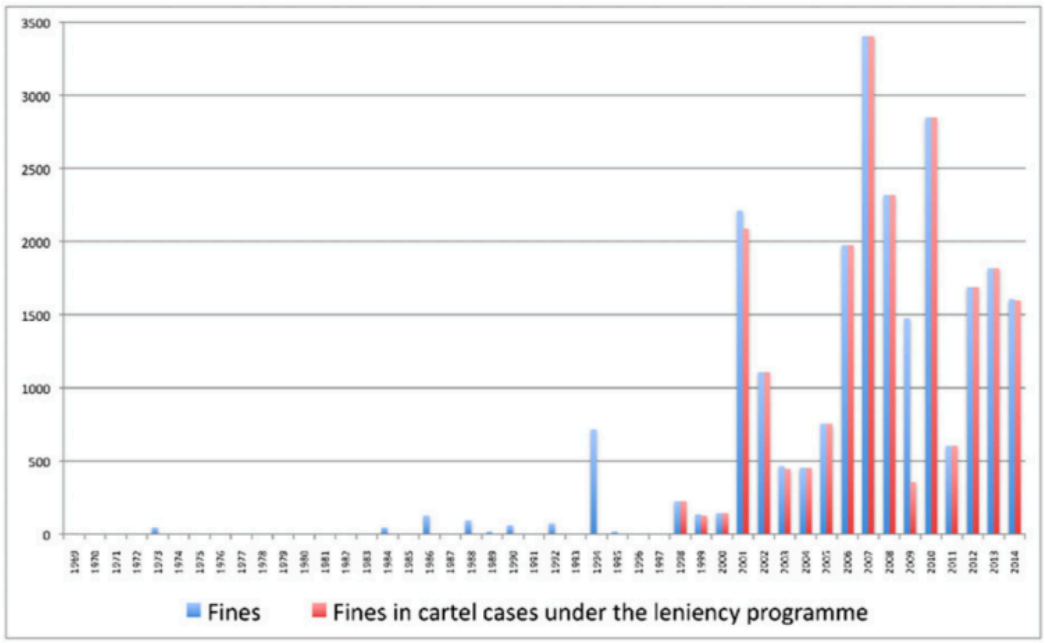
- **Typical cartel conduct: price-fixing · market-sharing · production limits · restrictions on technical development (R&D).**
- **The car-emissions cartel** (Daimler, BMW, VW): the firms held technology that could cut harmful **nitrogen-oxide (NOx)** emissions — and **agreed *not* to compete** on developing/deploying it. → *Illustrates:* a cartel can suppress not just price competition but **innovation itself** — colluding to keep a cleaner technology off the market. *(A striking answer to "why would firms agree not to innovate?": innovation is costly, and not competing protects everyone's margins.)*

### The leniency programme — the Commission's best cartel-buster

***Core:*** cartels are secret, so the EU turns members against each other: the **first** conspirator to **confess** and hand over evidence gets **total immunity** (or a big discount). A **whistleblower** tool that makes cartels unstable from within.

- **How it works:** self-report → **full exemption** for the first mover; **reduced fines** for later cooperators. Because each member fears a rival will defect first (a **prisoner's dilemma** turned against the cartel), it **destabilizes** cartels and cracks open cases the Commission could never prove alone.

Figure 1: Total fines per year (1962–2014. Constant millions of euros 2010)




*How to read it.* Two things jump out: **(1)** enforcement was **tiny until ~2000**, then **exploded** — the Commission grew into a heavyweight regulator (peaks ~**€3.4 bn in 2007**, ~€2.8 bn in 2010); **(2)** most of the biggest years are **red** — **cartel fines under the leniency programme** — showing how central leniency became to modern enforcement. → *Visual proof of the deck's "increasingly autonomous regulator": the Commission's competition muscle is a recent, dramatic development.*

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## Pillar 2 — Abuse of a dominant position (Article 102 TFEU)

***Core:*** the crucial nuance — **being dominant is *not* illegal.** What's banned is **abusing** dominance to squeeze out competitors.

- **Dominance ≠ abuse:** a firm can lawfully grow big and win the market. Art. 102 bites only when it **abuses** that position. Typical abuses:
  - **exclusive purchasing** requirements (lock customers in);
  - **predation** (price below cost to kill rivals, then raise prices);
  - **refusal to supply** an input rivals need to compete;
  - **excessive pricing** — e.g. the **Aspen** case (a pharma firm hiking prices of off-patent drugs).

- → *The hard question is always **where dominance ends and abuse begins** — which is exactly what Google Shopping tests in digital markets.*

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## Pillar 3 — Merger control (Wilks)

***Core:*** the "**dramatic face**" of competition policy — the Commission can **block or condition** mergers that would create a dominant position. A "**one-stop shop**" for Europe's biggest deals.

- **Legal basis:** the **Merger Regulation** (Reg. **4064/89 → 139/2004**, in force 1990) — Sir **Leon Brittan's** triumph that made DG COMP **globally pre-eminent.** *(Note: merger control was **not** in the original Treaty — it had to be added in 1989.)*
- "**One-stop shop":** the Commission handles the **largest** mergers (aggregate turnover above a **€5 bn** threshold — **~300/year**); smaller deals go to national authorities. Firms **prefer** it — **fast, transparent, one approval** instead of 28.
- **Two phases: Phase 1** (most cleared within a month) → **Phase 2** (in-depth). **Outright blocks are rare** (only **~4 in 2003–12**); the norm is **approval with conditions** (e.g. **divestitures**).
- **The test:** originally "**dominance**"; the **2004 reform** added "**significant impediment to effective competition**" (SIEC), nudging toward the US/UK "substantial lessening of competition" standard — but it stays an **economic** test, not a public-interest one.
- **Subsidiarity valves:** the "**German clause" (Art. 9)** lets a case be sent *down* to a national authority; the "**Dutch clause" (Art. 23)** lets a state ask the Commission to take a case *up*.
- **The 2001–02 shock** (why the "more economic approach" happened): the Commission **blocked GE/Honeywell (2001)** — a US firestorm over "arrogance/poor economics" — then in **2002 *lost*** its first-ever appeal (**Airtours**, "manifest errors of assessment"), plus **Schneider** and **Tetra Laval.** Response: it **beefed up economics** — a new **chief economist** post (2003), Monti's "economic interpretation."
- **Extraterritorial reach:** the Commission blocked **Deutsche Börse/NYSE Euronext** *despite* US approval — fuelling the recurring US charge that the EU "protects **competitors**, not **competition**."

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## Digital markets — what happens when market power changes?

***Core:*** digital platforms **break** the traditional competition model. Their economics make **concentration self-reinforcing**, so a dominant platform is far harder to dislodge than a dominant factory.

- **Why digital markets tip to monopoly:**
  - **network effects** — more users → more value → still more users;
  - **economies of scale** — near-**zero marginal cost** to serve one more user;
  - **data advantages** — more users → more data → better service → more users;
  - **ecosystems** — bundled services reinforce each other. → **Result:** concentration **reinforces itself** — a winner-takes-most dynamic.
- **From dominance to *gatekeeping*.** The old question — *is a dominant firm abusing its position?* — gives way to a structural one: *does the platform **control access** to users and markets?* A **gatekeeper** is "a platform that controls access to a large group of users." Its risks: **lock-in · barriers to entry · self-preferencing · data advantages.**

### Google Shopping — when the platform competes with its own users

*Core:* the flagship digital abuse-of-dominance case. **Google gave its own comparison-shopping service more prominent placement** in search results than rivals'. **Is that just competition, or abuse of market power?**

- The Commission ruled it **abuse of dominance** (self-preferencing) — Google used its **search near-monopoly** to advantage its own downstream service, foreclosing rival shopping comparison sites. *(A huge fine followed.)* → *Illustrates:* Art. 102 stretched into digital markets — but slowly, **case by case**, which is precisely the problem the DMA tries to fix.

### The Digital Markets Act — regulation *before* the abuse (ex-ante)

*Core:* the key shift. Traditional antitrust is **ex-post** (spot conduct → investigate → decide → fine) — but **digital markets change faster than enforcement can act.** The **DMA** goes **ex-ante**: set **rules in advance** for designated **gatekeepers.**

| | Traditional antitrust (ex-post) | The DMA (ex-ante) |
|---|---|---|
| **Logic** | *did this firm abuse dominance?* — after the fact | *what obligations must a powerful gatekeeper follow* — in advance |
| **Timing** | slow, case-by-case, reactive | pre-emptive rules of conduct |

- **DMA obligations on gatekeepers: no self-preferencing · fairer access · interoperability · data-sharing/portability obligations · limits on combining data** across services.
- **The bigger question (deck):** is the EU merely **adapting** competition policy to new markets — or **changing its very idea of what a competitive market requires** (from *police abuses after they happen* to *regulate structure up front*)? → *This links straight to Wilks's "economic constitution": the EU is writing new constitutional rules for digital capitalism.*

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## Pillar 4 — State aid: when *governments* distort competition

*Core:* the uniquely-EU pillar. Competition can be rigged not just by firms but by **governments** favouring their own companies. EU **state-aid** control forbids members from **selectively tilting the playing field.**

- **Forms of state aid: subsidies · tax advantages · preferential loans · government guarantees · preferential access** to goods/services.
- **The EU principle:** member states must **not selectively** advantage particular firms/sectors in a way that distorts competition. *(This is remarkable — the EU polices its own **member governments**' economic choices, not just companies. A major constraint on national industrial policy.)*

### Tax rulings as state aid — Fiat & Apple

*Core:* the syllabus's **Fiat** case (and its twin, **Apple**): the Commission attacked **sweetheart tax deals** as **illegal state aid.**

- **Fiat (FFT) in Luxembourg** and **Apple in Ireland:** national tax authorities gave the companies **favourable tax rulings** allowing them to pay very little tax. The Commission argued these were **selective advantages** = **illegal state aid**, and ordered the money **recovered** (Apple: **€13 bn**). → *Illustrates:* state-aid rules reaching into **national tax sovereignty** — hugely controversial (the member states involved often *fought*

the Commission, not wanting the back-taxes). *(The courts have gone both ways on these — the legal boundary is contested.)*

### The new frontier — foreign subsidies

***Core:*** a **regulatory gap** the EU recently closed. EU state-aid rules bind **EU** governments — but what about a **non-EU** government (e.g. China) subsidizing a firm that then competes in the EU?

- **The gap:** an EU member's subsidy gets **EU scrutiny**; a **non-EU** government's subsidy to a firm competing in the EU market previously had **no equivalent instrument.**
- **The Foreign Subsidies Regulation** fills it: the Commission can investigate **large mergers, big public-procurement bids**, and other situations **on its own initiative (*ex officio*)**, and respond with **commitments, remedies, or outright prohibition** of a deal/contract.
- **Bulgarian train procurement (2024):** the Chinese state-owned **CRRC Qingdao Sifang** bid ~**€610 m** for 20 electric trains + maintenance. → *The dilemma:* should Bulgaria take the **cheaper** offer if the bidder was **foreign-subsidized**? Cheaper trains now vs a **level playing field** and long-term EU industry — the politics of the new tool in a nutshell.

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## History & political economy — how competition policy became so powerful (Wilks)

***Core:*** competition policy went from a **marginal, distrusted idea** to the EU's **most powerful supranational regime** — and it remains **ideologically contested.**

- **Three roots: US antitrust** (late-19th-century — protect "**the little man**" from the industrial "**trusts**"); German **ordoliberalism** (the economic constitution); and the **Treaty of Rome** common-market vision (1958). Competition was once seen as **wasteful and destructive** — **cartels were legal** in Europe until the **late 1960s**, and postwar industrial policy ran on **nationalization, planning and** "**national champions.**"
- **The neoliberal turn:** the free-market vision became dominant only with the **1980s neoliberal revolution + the 1992 single market**, then **consolidated** by the fall of communism and the **2004/07 enlargements.**
- **The "more economic approach" (the "turn to economics"):** after the **2001–02 merger defeats**, DG COMP shifted from formalistic legal categories to **effects-based economic analysis** and a "**consumer welfare**" standard — an **Americanization** criticized for embedding **Anglo-Saxon neoliberalism** over the continental "**social-market**"/**Rhenish** model, and for **favouring big transnational firms** (who lobbied for it).
- **Key Commissioners: Sutherland** (state-aid "name & shame," late 80s) · **Brittan** (the Merger Regulation) · **Monti** (the €497m **Microsoft** fine; created the chief-economist post) · **Kroes** (the crisis "temporary framework") · **Almunia** (Google; modernization).
- **Competition vs industrial policy** — the enduring tension: **recessions revive** the appeal of state support and **national champions** (France/Germany/Italy protective). DG COMP's fortunes **ride the economic cycle** (boom → more mergers, less resistance; recession → interventionist voices win).
- **The financial-crisis test (the big one).** After **Lehman (2008)**, an "**avalanche**" of **bank bailouts** and calls (Sarkozy) to **suspend** state-aid rules. Commissioner **Kroes did *not* suspend** — she enacted a "**temporary framework**" **(Dec 2008)** allowing **rescue aid under conditions** aimed at eventually restoring competition. The scale was staggering: ~**€1.6 tn** of bank aid *used* (**13% of EU GDP**), **€5.1 tn approved** (**40% of 2011 GDP**); **Ireland** approved aid worth **365% of its GDP.** → **Wilks's verdict:** the regime "**bent but did not**

**buckle**" — either a "**mild triumph**" that defended the economic constitution, *or* a **return to the status quo** that reproduced the very oligopolies and banks that caused the crisis. **None of the forecast threats** (protectionism, a swing to the Rhenish model) **materialized** — the Commission **defended the economic constitution.**

- **The accountability debate** (recap): the "prosecutor, judge and jury" critique, **corporate-lobbying** influence, and the **legitimacy** question — which **Majone** answers by "**output legitimacy**" (expertise + efficiency + due process, not democratic control — see theories).

## ★ Three theories of EU competition policy

***Core:*** the deck's framing — **three lenses on the same outcomes** (the Commission's growing power; Google → the DMA; the Foreign Subsidies Regulation). Ask **what each theory looks for.**

| Lens | Core claim | Looks for… |
|---|---|---|
| **Liberal Intergovernmentalism** | member states had **different preferences** about competition policy | **bargaining · who wanted what · bargaining power** |
| **Supranationalism / neofunctionalism** | the **Commission** acquired **expertise & enforcement authority** | **Commission autonomy · spillover · new competences** |
| **Ideas (constructivism)** | **understandings** of the proper role of state & market **changed** | **changing norms** about legitimate markets |

- **Apply them (the deck's grid):**
  - **Commission becomes more powerful** → *LI:* who **agreed**? · *Supra:* how did **autonomy** develop? · *Ideas:* what became **legitimate**?
  - **Google → DMA** → *LI:* what did **governments** want? · *Supra:* did **regulatory gaps** create spillover? · *Ideas:* how did **ideas about competition** change?
  - **Foreign Subsidies Regulation** → *LI:* which **states** pushed for it? · *Supra:* why did **EU authority** expand? · *Ideas:* what does "**fair competition**" now mean?
- **Wilks's own lens — Majone's "regulatory state":** competition policy is the **classic example** of EU "**non-majoritarian**" **regulation** — legitimized not by majority vote but by **expertise, due process and objective efficiency** ("output legitimacy"). It's **law-driven policy-making**, run through courts and a network of agencies. *(This is the EU III neoliberal debate in its purest institutional form.)*
- **The takeaway:** no single theory wins — but competition policy is the **strongest case for supranationalism** (an autonomous Commission that expanded its own authority), *framed* by a powerful **idea** (the market/economic constitution) that member states then **had** to accept.

## ★ Fun facts & memorable details (EU IV: Competition Policy)

> Sticky bits from the competition-policy lecture.

- **The ECB for markets.** Wilks's image: just as the **ECB** guards the currency, the competition rules guard the **free market** — an "**economic constitution**" for Europe.
- **DG COMP is tiny. ~720 staff** (about 436 decision-makers) police a market of **450 million** people — the member states reportedly **keep it understaffed** on purpose, as one of the few ways to **rein it in**.

- "**Policeman, arbitrator, prosecutor, judge, jury — and prison officer.**" The memorable jibe about the Commission doing *everything* in a competition case inside one building.
- **The "nuclear option" has never been fired.** Since 2003 the Commission *can* force a company to **break itself up** (divestiture) — "the antitrust equivalent of a nuclear strike" — but has **never** done it.
- "**The Full Monti.**" When Commissioner Mario Monti fined **Microsoft €497 m** (2004) for bundling Media Player, the *FT* headline wrote itself. Microsoft's total hit reached **€1.6 bn** by 2013.
- **Leniency is a prisoner's dilemma weapon.** The first cartel member to confess walks free — so nobody trusts anyone. In **2012** there were **60 leniency applications** but only **5 cartel decisions.**
- **Fines fund the EU.** Competition fines — **€7 bn over 2009–13** — go straight into the **EU budget.** A **€1.47 bn** single-cartel fine (TV tubes, 2012) set a record.
- **Ireland guaranteed bank aid worth 365% of its GDP** during the crisis — the most extreme state-aid commitment in EU history.
- **Cartels can conspire *not to innovate*.** The car-makers agreed to hold back **cleaner emissions tech** — a reminder that competition drives not just prices but progress.

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# EU V: European Citizenship and Identity (AUW)

**Required reading:** McCormick, J. (2021), *Understanding the European Union: A Concise Introduction*, ch. "The EU and its Citizens," pp. 88–109 · Szczerbiak, A. & Taggart, P. (2024), "Euroscepticism and anti-establishment parties in Europe," *Journal of European Integration* 46(8), pp. 1171–1191.

**Theme of the lecture.** After four lectures on the EU's history and machinery, this one turns to its **people**: has decades of integration actually produced a **European identity** — and does it matter? The lecture runs a chain — **formal citizenship → identity → public attitudes → political consequences** — stressing that *one does not automatically lead to the next*. Along the way it tackles the **democratic deficit**, how citizens are represented, *why* individuals come to support or oppose the EU (four mechanisms), and the rise of **Euroscepticism** and the **politicization** of European integration.

> ★ **The heart of the lecture:** the EU's future "depends on the support of its citizens, not just its elites" — so citizen **attitudes** are now a real constraint on integration. But the links are loose: holding an **EU passport** (formal citizenship) does not make you **feel** European (identity), which does not determine whether you **support** the EU (attitudes), which in turn shapes what leaders can do (consequences). Europe has moved from a **permissive consensus** (leave it to the elites) to a **constraining dissensus** (a politically contested project).
> **Red thread:** what kind of political community are EU citizens citizens of — and when do citizens' identities get *activated* to reshape integration?

**Key concepts to apply:** *EU citizenship (rights + the Art. 20 "additional, not replacement" limit) · the democratic deficit · the knowledge deficit · federation vs confederation (the Moravcsik–Franklin debate) · indirect / direct / engagement channels of representation · second-order elections · identity as constructed, contested, changeable · nested / cross-cutting / marble-cake identities · civic vs exclusionary construction of Europe · the two-way identity ↔ integration relationship · permissive consensus → constraining dissensus · the four attitude mechanisms (utility · identity · cues · benchmarking) · hard vs soft Euroscepticism · Euroscepticism vs anti-establishment politics (Szczerbiak & Taggart's five clusters; the "fungible issue") · politicization of identities*.

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## The core puzzle, and the citizenship → identity → attitudes → consequences chain

*Core:* you are a **national citizen** *and* a **European Union citizen** — but what does that actually mean, and does it tell us anything about whether you *feel* European or *support* the EU?

- **The puzzle:** the EU **is not a state**, so what kind of political community are EU citizens citizens *of*? EU citizenship exists **alongside** national citizenship and grants rights tied to membership of the Union.
- **The lecture's chain:** *formal citizenship → identity → public attitudes → political consequences.* **Main idea:** one layer does **not** automatically produce the next; there are multiple layers of interaction between them.
- **Why this is political:** the future of integration "depends on the support of its citizens, not just its elites." **Public opinion actively constrains leaders** — so understanding citizen attitudes is essential to understanding the EU's future challenges.

### Three theories, three ways of thinking about citizens

*Core:* the three integration theories from earlier lectures each frame the citizen differently — keep them as lenses throughout.

| Lens | How it sees the citizen |
|---|---|
| **Liberal intergovernmentalism** | citizens → **domestic preferences** → national governments → **interstate bargaining** |
| **Supranationalism / neofunctionalism** | **spillover**: integration creates institutions, rules and actors that develop **their own dynamics** |
| **Constructivism** | **identity, norms and socialization shape interests** — and integration can **reshape identities** |

## What does EU citizenship actually give you? (more important, yet less than it seems)

*Core:* EU citizenship is a real bundle of rights, but by treaty it is an **add-on** to national citizenship, not a replacement — "both more important and yet less than it seems" (McCormick).

**The rights it grants (deck):**

- **Free movement and residence** across the Union.
- **Vote (and stand) in European Parliament elections.**
- **Vote in local/municipal elections where you reside** (but **not** national elections).
- **Consular protection** from any other member state when outside the EU and your own state has no representation.
- The right to **petition the EU institutions** (Parliament, the Ombudsman).

**The limits:**

- **Additional, not a replacement.** Maastricht created EU citizenship; the **Lisbon Treaty, Art. 20** states it "shall be additional to and not replace national citizenship." You remain a citizen of your **home state**.

- **Social and psychological barriers** to real free movement remain — language, customs, laws, road rules, banking, local products. "There is a limit to how much common EU laws will help" an Italian settling in Estonia.

### Background: citizenship, and the "people's Europe"

- **What normally distinguishes a citizen from a non-citizen** (McCormick, via Joppke): the right to **vote and run for office**, jury service, eligibility for the **armed forces**, protection from forcible removal, consular protection abroad, right of **re-entry**, recognition by other states, and a **sense of belonging**. Many ordinary rights (equality before the law, property, free speech, minimum welfare) are enjoyed by **non-citizens too** — which is why EU citizenship is thinner than it sounds.
- It took leaders **30+ years** to attend to how ordinary Europeans related to integration. The **Adonnino Committee** (1984–85) proposed the symbols of a "**people's Europe**": the burgundy **European passport** (from 1986), the **flag** (12 gold stars on blue, borrowed from the **Council of Europe, 1955** — the number is *not* the number of members), **Europe Day** (9 May, the Schuman Declaration anniversary), and the **anthem** (the "Ode to Joy," Beethoven's Ninth).
- The **Single European Act** eased **free movement of people** (provided one had health insurance and enough income not to be a "burden"); a **1991 directive** introduced **mutual recognition of professional qualifications** (3+ years of training).

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## ★ The democratic deficit

***Core:*** the **democratic deficit** is "the gap between the actions taken by the EU institutions and the ability of ordinary Europeans to **directly influence** those actions" (McCormick).

- **The deck's framing:** the **Commission (unelected)** proposes legislation and governs areas of **exclusive supranational competence**; treaty changes have often been negotiated **among elites**. *But* the EU also combines **direct and indirect** democratic channels — so the charge is contested.
- **Evidence critics cite (McCormick):** few of the EU15 held referendums on joining; **Maastricht and Lisbon** were negotiated largely behind closed doors; the Commission faces little direct accountability; **Council and COREPER** mostly meet **in secret**; the **EP cannot raise revenue or initiate laws**; citizens have **no say over Court appointments**; and formal citizen rights are modest.

### The key move: it depends whether you treat the EU as a federation or a confederation

***Core:*** McCormick's central argument — "*everything depends on how the EU is understood.*"

- As a **federation**, its democratic credentials would be **weak**.
- As a **confederation**, representation is *expected* to be **indirect** (national governments answer to voters and represent them in the EU's chambers) — so its procedures are "almost everything we could expect." The irony: to satisfy critics, the EU would have to **become the federation they oppose**.
- **The scholarly debate: Franklin (1996)** — the lack of accountability is a "**crisis of legitimacy**." **Moravcsik (2002)** — EU institutions are hemmed in by checks (narrow mandates, fiscal limits, super-majorities, separation of powers), so EU policy-making is "**clean, transparent, effective and politically responsive**."
- **Useful data point:** trust in the **EU has consistently outstripped trust in national governments**; and **2018 was the first year ever** that a majority of Europeans felt their **voice counts** in the EU.

### The knowledge deficit

*Core:* a second, "more fundamentally troublesome" deficit — most Europeans simply **don't understand how the EU works**, which makes opinion unstable and leaves a gap "into which Eurosceptics have walked."

- **Stats:** in **2004**, **55%** thought the EU was created just after WWI and **50%** did not know the EP was directly elected; by **2019**, **70%** knew the EP is elected, but **31% had never heard of the Council of the EU**.
- **Consequence:** referendums are often decided on **other** grounds — the **2005 French** vote (≈75% admitted knowing little about the treaty; many voted on Chirac) and **Brexit 2016** (false claims; votes driven by the government of the day, the economy and immigration).
- **Exam tip (deck):** distinguish "**I/many people dislike a decision**" from "**the decision-making process is insufficiently democratic**." Only the second is a genuine democratic-deficit claim.

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## How are EU citizens represented?

*Core:* three routes, running from arm's-length to hands-on.

| Channel | How it works | Bodies / tools |
|---|---|---|
| **Indirectly** | through your **national government** | European Council · Council of the EU |
| **Directly** | through your **elected EU representatives** | European Parliament |
| **Through engagement** | participation and active citizenship | referendums · EU-level interest groups · the **European Ombudsman** · the **European Citizens' Initiative (ECI)** |

- **European elections** (every 5 years since 1979, by **PR**) are the one directly democratic channel — but they are "**second-order**" **elections** (Reif & Schmitt 1980): fought on **national** issues, used to send messages to national governments, with **low turnout** (from 63% in 1979 down to ~43% in 2009/2014, recovering to ~51% in 2019).
- **Referendums** on EU questions have multiplied (**46 votes, 37 since 1992**; Ireland 8, Denmark 7). Two types: on **membership** and on **treaties**. Denmark was the **first to reject a treaty** (Maastricht, 1992, by 50.7%); France and the Netherlands **killed the Constitutional Treaty in 2005**. The **euro** was put to a vote only in **Denmark and Sweden — both said No** — so no euro government has dared ask.
- **Interest groups** (e.g. **BusinessEurope**, the **ETUC**) cluster in Brussels and **help offset the deficit** by giving citizens a channel that **bypasses national governments**.
- **European Ombudsman:** handles complaints of **maladministration** by EU bodies (except the Courts); the **Commission** draws most complaints.
- **European Citizens' Initiative (ECI):** a Lisbon innovation — **1 million citizens from at least 7 member states** can invite the Commission to propose legislation.

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## European identity: who are "we"?

*Core:* European identity is **not a fact to be measured** — it is a set of **contested ideas** about who "we" are, which values define Europe, who belongs, and where Europe ends.

- In **social constructivism**, identities are **constructed, contested and changeable** — not fixed or natural.

### Multi-level identities: one identity does not replace another

*Core:* national and European identities **coexist**; there are three ideal-typical ways they fit together.

| Type | Image | Meaning |
|---|---|---|
| **Nested** | Russian doll | smaller collective identities **sit inside** larger ones |
| **Cross-cutting** | overlapping circles | different identity markers **overlap** with no single hierarchy |
| **Blended** | marble cake | national and European identities **interact and change one another** |

### Civic vs exclusionary constructions of Europe

*Core:* "Europe" is something political actors **construct** — and they build it in opposite ways.

| | Civic construction | Exclusionary construction |
|---|---|---|
| **Basis** | shared **civic values** | **essentialist** cultural markers |
| **Content** | freedom, democracy, equality, human rights, rule of law | Europe as a **bounded cultural community** |
| **Stance** | inclusive, values-based | threatened by **migration, enlargement, outside influence** |
| **Example** | the **Lisbon Treaty preamble** ("universal values… freedom, democracy, equality and the rule of law") | the **Front National (2007)** on Turkey ("an Asian country… does not have its place in Europe") |

### The two-way relationship: identity ↔ integration

*Core:* constructivism's key claim — causation runs **both ways**.

- **Identity shapes integration:** what actors consider **desirable or legitimate** depends on socially shared identities, values and norms.
- **Integration shapes identity:** membership, institutions, **socialization** and shared experiences change how actors understand themselves.

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## ★ From permissive consensus to constraining dissensus

*Core:* the politics of integration has flipped — citizens used to be bystanders; now they are a brake.

| | Permissive consensus | Constraining dissensus (Hooghe & Marks) |
|---|---|---|
| **Citizens** | "leave Europe to the elites"; largely **accepted or ignored** integration | Europe is **politically contested** |
| **Effect on leaders** | free hand | **public opinion increasingly constrains** what leaders can do |

- **The turning point was Maastricht (1992):** the **Danish No**, the UK's forced **ERM exit**, and the French "**petit oui**" put integration on the public radar and began to erode the permissive consensus (McCormick).

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## ★ Why does one citizen support the EU and another oppose it? Four mechanisms

***Core:*** attitudes toward the EU are driven by four overlapping logics — **utility, identity, cues, benchmarking**. Learn to apply all four to a single voter.

| Mechanism | The question | Core logic |
|---|---|---|
| **Utility** | "What's in it for me?" | weigh **costs vs benefits** of membership |
| **Identity** | "Who are we?" | belonging, values, perceived **cultural threat** |
| **Cues** | "What do people I trust tell me?" | **shortcuts** from parties and media |
| **Benchmarking** | "Compared with what?" | judge the EU **against an alternative** |

### Utility — "what's in it for me?"

- Citizens weigh **benefits** (trade, mobility, investment) against **costs** (adjustment, regulation, redistribution, perceived loss of control).
- **Individual level:** the "**winners**" **of integration** (higher education, income, skills) are more supportive — the **elite–mass gap**.
- **National level:** citizens in countries that **benefit** (through trade or redistribution) are more supportive.

### Identity — "who are we?"

- A **strong attachment to the nation does not by itself** imply opposition to the EU.
- But where national identity is **exclusive** (hostile to other cultures), Europe is easily framed as a **threat to** "**us**" → more likely to oppose the EU.

### Cues — "what do trusted actors tell me?"

- Most citizens **do not follow EU politics closely** (information asymmetry), so **parties and media provide shortcuts**. Voters of **pro-EU parties** are more likely to be pro-EU — the cues matter even when the issue is not intrinsically important to the voter.

### Benchmarking — "compared with what?"

- **Democratic benchmark:** citizens in **high-quality national democracies** may be **less** supportive of the EU.
- **Contrast / scapegoat:** citizens **dissatisfied with their national government** may become **more** supportive, seeing the EU as an alternative.
- **Economic benchmark:** citizens in **less affluent** states judge the EU on **economic** performance; those in **more affluent** states judge it on **political/democratic** criteria.

- **Worked case (deck):** a young Danish voter *benefits economically* from EU mobility and thinks Denmark would struggle outside (**utility → support**), *but* identifies strongly as Danish (**identity → oppose**) and follows a Eurosceptic party (**cues → oppose**) — the mechanisms pull in **different directions**.

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## Euroscepticism: opposition to what?

***Core:*** Euroscepticism is **not monolithic** — it runs from wanting reform to wanting out. Taggart & Szczerbiak's classic split:

| | Hard Euroscepticism | Soft Euroscepticism |
|---|---|---|
| **Object** | opposition to EU integration **in principle** | opposition to the **current direction / pace / extent** |
| **Endpoint** | can mean leaving — opposition to **membership itself** | membership **still accepted** in principle |
| **Framing** | **system** opposition | **policy** opposition |

- McCormick: the term was coined in **mid-1980s Britain**; arguments vary by issue, time and country and are often "**less about hostility to integration than about immigration**." Eurosceptic parties made large gains in the **2019 EP elections**. Yet the **Spring 2019 Eurobarometer** found **59%** of Europeans wanted **more** decisions taken at EU level (only 32% opposed).

## ★ Is Euroscepticism the same as anti-establishment politics? (Szczerbiak & Taggart 2024)

***Core:*** **No — there is no *necessary* link.** Classifying **77 parties in 30 countries** (expert-informed, 2018–19), the authors find Euroscepticism is a "**fungible issue**" that domestic politics frames differently; **anti-establishment** must be treated as a party feature **in its own right**.

- **Anti-establishment ≠ anti-system ≠ populism.** Anti-**system** (Sartori) rejects democracy itself; **anti-establishment** accepts the system but attacks the **entrenched elite**. It varies on two dimensions: **scope** (political / economic / cultural; left or right) and **action** (revolutionary → reformist → merely disruptive).
- **The five clusters:**

| Cluster | Relationship | Examples |
|---|---|---|
| **1. Anti-establishment, NOT Eurosceptic** | see the EU as **part of the solution** to bad national elites; mostly **CEE** ("return to Europe") | En Marche (FR) · Save Romania Union |
| **2. Eurosceptic, NOT anti-establishment** | object to the EU **project**, not "the elite"; often **governing** parties | UK Conservative Party |
| **3. Strong association (largest)** | domestic + EU elites seen as **entwined** — possible **"EU-isation"** | National Rally · AfD · Five Star · The League · Fidesz · Syriza · Swiss People's Party |
| **4. Both, but little interaction** | the two run on **separate tracks**; mostly **CEE** | Law and Justice (PL) · Austrian Freedom Party · Vox |
| **5. Anti-establishment, Euroscepticism not salient** | the EU is a **"touchstone of dissent"** (Taggart 1998) — a "**box to be ticked**," not the appeal | Sweden Democrats · Sinn Féin · Podemos |

- **Central thesis:** "Euroscepticism is a very **fungible issue**, and the structures of **domestic politics** play a crucial role in framing the national reception of European integration."
- **Take-home exercise (deck):** for the **Danish People's Party, Fidesz, Five Star, En Marche / Renaissance**, ask what each really opposes — EU integration? a specific policy? EU institutions/elites? **domestic** elites? national identity/cultural change? (often several at once).

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## ★ Politicization: crises activate identities

*Core:* a crisis does **not automatically** lower EU support. **Politicization** is the process by which **political elites (parties, movements) activate/mobilize identities**, which then feed back into political processes. It turns on three questions: **solidarity** (who should help whom?), **responsibility** (who should fix it?), and **borders & belonging** (who belongs, and who decides?).

| | Eurozone crisis | Schengen / migration crisis |
|---|---|---|
| **Type** | economic | cultural and political |
| **Driving question** | *how much solidarity?* | *who belongs in Europe?* |
| **Focus** | disputes over **responsibility** and financial support | **borders and belonging** |
| **Outcome** | Europeans **largely favoured European solutions**; **limited** "us vs them" framing | **Open Europe vs "Fortress Europe"**; **stronger mobilization of national identity** |

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# ★ Synthesis — citizens shape integration, integration reshapes politics

*Core:* the chain runs **both ways**, and **identity is the hinge**.

- **Citizens can shape integration:** domestic preferences, political constraints, electoral incentives and pressure on national governments (the **LI** lens).
- **Integration can reshape politics:** new institutions, rights, **socialization** and new political conflicts (the **supranationalism** lens).
- **Identity links the two:** identities shape interests, while political processes reshape identities (the **constructivism** lens). This is why the opening chain — *formal citizenship → identity → attitudes → consequences* — never runs in only one direction.

## Cases & examples

- **The young Danish voter** — the four mechanisms (utility/identity/cues/benchmarking) pull in different directions (deck).
- **French 2005 referendum** — rejected the Constitutional Treaty; ~75% admitted knowing little, many voted on Chirac (knowledge deficit).
- **Brexit 2016** — the first whole country to vote to leave; driven by views of the government, the economy and immigration more than the EU itself.
- **Greenland (1982)** — the first territory to leave the Community.
- **The symbols of a "people's Europe"** — passport, flag (12 stars), Europe Day, "Ode to Joy" (Adonnino).
- **Lisbon preamble vs Front National (2007) on Turkey** — civic vs exclusionary constructions of Europe.
- **Eurozone vs Schengen crises** — solidarity framing vs borders-and-belonging framing.
- **Party cases (Szczerbiak & Taggart)** — En Marche (anti-establishment, pro-EU); UK Conservatives (Eurosceptic, not anti-establishment); Five Star / National Rally / Fidesz (both, entwined).

## Key terms

| Term | Meaning |
|---|---|
| EU citizenship | Rights tied to Union membership, **additional to** (not replacing) national citizenship (Lisbon Art. 20) |
| Democratic deficit | Gap between EU actions and citizens' ability to **directly influence** them |
| Knowledge deficit | Most citizens don't understand how the EU works, making opinion unstable |
| Federation vs confederation | The yardstick for judging the deficit (Moravcsik: as a confederation, the EU is responsive enough) |
| Second-order elections | EP elections fought on **national** issues, low turnout (Reif & Schmitt) |
| European Citizens' Initiative | 1 million citizens from 7+ states can invite a Commission proposal |
| Constructed / contested / changeable | How constructivism treats identity |
| Nested / cross-cutting / blended | The three ideal types of multi-level identity |
| Civic vs exclusionary Europe | Values-based vs culturally-bounded constructions of "Europe" |
| Permissive consensus | Citizens leave integration to elites |
| Constraining dissensus | Public opinion now limits what leaders can do (Hooghe & Marks) |
| Utility / Identity / Cues / Benchmarking | The four mechanisms behind EU support or opposition |
| Hard / Soft Euroscepticism | Opposition in principle (→ exit) vs opposition to the current direction |
| Anti-establishment | Opposition to an entrenched elite; varies by **scope** and **action**; ≠ anti-system, ≠ populism |
| Touchstone of dissent | The EU as a marker of a party's oppositional **identity**, not its appeal (Taggart) |
| Fungible issue | Euroscepticism as malleable, framed differently across domestic contexts |
| Politicization | Elites **activating identities** around solidarity, responsibility, borders & belonging |

## Exam pointers

- **Run the chain** *formal citizenship → identity → attitudes → consequences*, and stress that **each link is loose** (an EU passport does not make you feel or vote European).
- **Apply the four mechanisms** (utility · identity · cues · benchmarking) to a concrete voter and show them **pulling in different directions** (the Danish-voter case).
- **Democratic deficit:** give **one argument for and one against**, hinging on **federation vs confederation** (Franklin vs Moravcsik); and distinguish "I dislike a decision" from "the process is undemocratic."
- **Hard vs soft Euroscepticism** with examples, and the key twist: **Euroscepticism ≠ anti-establishment** — cite Szczerbiak & Taggart's **five clusters** and the "**fungible issue**" thesis.
- **Civic vs exclusionary** identity (Lisbon preamble vs Front National) and the **three multi-level** types.
- **Politicization:** contrast the **eurozone** (solidarity) and **Schengen** (borders & belonging) crises, and note a crisis does **not** automatically cut EU support.

- Keep the **three lenses** (LI · supranationalism · constructivism) ready to read citizens, identity and attitudes.

## ★ Fun facts & memorable details (EU V: Citizenship & Identity)

> Sticky bits from the citizenship-and-identity lecture.

- **The flag's 12 stars mean nothing numerical.** The ring of **12 gold stars** was adopted from the **Council of Europe (1955)**; it stands for completeness/unity, **not** the number of member states (a common exam trap).
- **Greenland left in 1982.** Its ~53,000 voters made it the **first territory to leave** the Community — decades before Brexit made Britain the first whole country.
- "**It is far to Oslo, but further to Brussels.**" A 1972 Norwegian slogan capturing how EU opposition can be an extension of opposition to one's own capital elite.
- **The euro has never won a referendum.** It was put to a public vote only in **Denmark and Sweden — both said No** — so none of the 19 euro governments dared ask their citizens.
- **2018 was a first.** For the first time ever, a **majority** of Europeans said their **voice counts** in the EU — and trust in the EU has long run **higher** than trust in national governments.
- **In 2004, 55% thought the EU was founded just after WWI.** A vivid illustration of the **knowledge deficit** — and why Eurosceptics found an open goal.
- "**Quintessentially anti-establishment.**" Szczerbiak & Taggart's label for Italy's **Five Star Movement**; France's National Rally coined "**l'UMPS**" for the mainstream parties it accused of colluding with Brussels, and **La France Insoumise** called for a "**Sixth Republic**" to sweep away an establishment "fused with the EU elite."
- **Ireland has voted on Europe eight times.** A constitutional duty to hold treaty referendums gives a country of ~4 million the power to stall treaties for the whole EU (as with Nice and Lisbon).

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**PART IV · TOOLS FOR POLITICAL ANALYSIS**

# Tools 4.1: Normative Frameworks — How Should We Evaluate Political Outcomes? (AD)

**Required reading: Bueno de Mesquita**, *Political Economy for Public Policy*, **ch. 1 "Normative Frameworks"** · *Optional:* **Van Bekkum & Zuiderveen Borgesius**, "Digital welfare fraud detection and the Dutch **SyRI** judgment," *European Journal of Social Security* 23(4) 2021, pp. 323–340. *(Lecturer: Anna Denisenko — deck "4.1 Normative Frameworks." Part IV uses Bueno de Mesquita; Part V (Business & Politics) uses Baron.)*

**Theme of the lecture.** Political analysis has **two halves**: explaining **what *is*** (positive) and judging **what *should be*** (normative). This lecture equips you for the second. A **normative framework** is a **set of criteria for judging whether a policy, outcome or institution is good** — and the same policy can look **excellent under one framework and terrible under another.** We study **three**: **welfarism** (the goal is *wellbeing*), **liberalism** (the goal is *liberty*), and **egalitarianism** (the goal is *equality*). The running case is **SyRI**, the Dutch welfare-fraud algorithm a court struck down for violating privacy — a policy each framework judges differently.

> ★ **The heart of the lecture — three lenses, often three verdicts.**
> • **Welfarism (wellbeing):** judge a policy by its **consequences for wellbeing.** Two versions — **utilitarianism** (maximise the *sum* of utility) and **Pareto** (improve wellbeing *without harming anyone*).
> • **Liberalism (liberty):** judge a policy by whether it **intrudes on the private sphere.** The whole debate is **where to draw the line** between private and public — by **harm** (Mill), **property/self-ownership** (Locke, Nozick), or **freedom** (Berlin: freedom *from* vs freedom *to*).
> • **Egalitarianism (equality):** judge a policy by whether it **reduces unjust inequality** — but **equality of what?** formal rights, **opportunity**, or **outcomes**. **Rawls**: choose the rules behind a **veil of ignorance** → the **difference principle** (inequality is just only if it helps the worst-off).
> • **The payoff:** *not all good things go together.* There are real **trade-offs** between efficiency, freedom and equality — so the same facts yield **different verdicts**, and naming your framework is what makes an argument honest.

**Red thread:** *(1) Is this a positive or a normative question? (2) By which criterion are we judging — wellbeing, liberty, or equality? (3) What does each framework say about the same policy, and where do they trade off?*

**Key concepts to apply:** *positive (what is?) vs normative (what should be?) questions · normative framework = criteria for judging* · **welfarism:** *utility (Bentham) · the utilitarian optimum (maximise the sum) · the veil of ignorance (Harsanyi) · measurement/interpersonal-comparison problem · the "monster"/"Philistine" objections · trolley & transplant · discounting across generations · partiality/relationships · Pareto improvement · Pareto efficiency* · **liberalism:** *the private/public sphere · the harm principle (Mill) · harm vs offense · self-ownership & property (Locke, Nozick) · negative vs positive liberty (freedom from / freedom to — Berlin)* · **egalitarianism:** *equality of formal rights vs opportunity vs outcomes · Rawls' original position, veil of ignorance, equal-liberty & difference principle (maximin) · decreasing marginal utility & redistribution · leveling down · the equality–efficiency (incentives) trade-off · Cohen's three equalities of opportunity (bourgeois · left-liberal · socialist)* · *three sources of disagreement: information · self-interest · values.*

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## Positive vs normative questions

***Core:*** political science asks **two kinds of question** — and this lecture is about the second.

| | Positive (explanatory) | Normative (evaluative) |
|---|---|---|
| Asks | *what **is**?* | *what **should be**?* |
| SyRI example | *Why did the Netherlands build a fraud-detection algorithm?* | *Was that algorithm a **good** policy?* |
| Settled by | facts, data, evidence | criteria/values — **not by facts alone** |

→ *Quick test:* "**Who gains and who loses** from US tariffs on Danish exports?" = **positive.** "Would imposing **retaliatory** tariffs be a **good** policy?" = **normative.**

## What is a normative framework?

***Core:*** a **normative framework** is a **set of criteria for judging whether a political outcome, policy or institution is good.** The same policy can look **excellent under one and terrible under another** — so the framework you pick largely decides the verdict.

The three we study:

| Framework | The goal of public policy is to promote… |
|---|---|
| **Welfarism** | **wellbeing** |
| **Liberalism** | **liberty** |
| **Egalitarianism** | **equality** |

⚠️ **"Liberalism" means several different things** — don't mix them up:

| Sense | Claim | Example |
|---|---|---|
| **IR liberalism** | states cooperate via institutions & trade | the EU; democratic peace (IR II) |
| **Philosophical liberalism** (this lecture) | policy should protect individual **liberty** | the Hague court: SyRI violated privacy |
| **Economic liberalism** | free markets, limited state | free trade, deregulation |
| **"Liberal" in US talk** | left-leaning, pro–social-programme | backs Obamacare |

*(In Denmark, **Venstre** and **Liberal Alliance** are centre-right — "liberal" in the **economic** sense.)*

**The running case — SyRI (System Risk Indication).** The Dutch government combined data from many agencies (tax, benefits, housing, employment) into an algorithm flagging people at **high risk of welfare/tax fraud** for investigation. In **2020 a Dutch court ruled the SyRI law violated the right to privacy** (Art. 8 ECHR). We'll judge it through each framework.

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## ★ Welfarism I: Utilitarianism

***Core:*** welfarism judges policy by its **consequences for wellbeing.** The classic version — **utilitarianism** — says the best policy **maximises the *sum* of utility (wellbeing) in society.**

- **Utility (Bentham):** "that property in any object whereby it tends to produce benefit… pleasure… or happiness." Utilitarianism **adds up** everyone's utility and picks the policy with the **highest total.**
- **The utilitarian optimum:** look **only at the total** (the height of the "wellbeing" bar). **Distribution doesn't matter to the verdict** — a policy can shrink one group's share and still win if the **sum** is largest.

**Why be a utilitarian?**

- **Treats everyone's happiness as equally important** — each person's utility counts once (Bentham).
- **It gives an answer to trade-offs** — by adding and comparing, it always ranks the options (most frameworks struggle to).
- **The veil of ignorance (Harsanyi):** if you chose society's rules *not knowing who you'd be* (rich or poor), you'd pick the arrangement with the highest **expected utility** = the highest **average** utility = **utilitarianism.** *(Rawls uses the same device to reach the **opposite** conclusion — see §egalitarianism.)*

**Problems for utilitarianism** (the classic objections):

- **Measurement / interpersonal comparison.** To add utility you must **measure, aggregate and compare** wellbeing *across people* — a demanding, maybe impossible, informational requirement.

- "**Monsters.**" If a **sadist** gets enormous pleasure from others' pain, and his pleasure outweighs their suffering, utilitarianism says it's *good* — because it didn't **weigh all affected parties**' utilities against that conclusion. Alarming.
- "**Philistines.**" If people get more utility from crude tastes (reality TV) than from art, should policy cater to that? Utility counts *whatever* its source.
- **Trolley & transplant.** Utilitarianism says divert the trolley to kill 1 instead of 5 — and, more disturbingly, that a surgeon should kill 1 healthy patient to harvest organs saving 5. The transplant verdict clashes hard with moral intuition.
- **Across generations.** Treating all generations equally forces **discounting the future** (how much is a benefit in 50 years worth today?) — central to climate cost-benefit analysis, and deeply contested.
- **Relationships / partiality.** Strict utilitarianism is **impartial**, but we feel special duties to our **own** children and friends — "Ethan's very cute kids." Impartial maximising can't capture that.

## ★ Welfarism II: Pareto

***Core:*** a more cautious welfarism that **never makes anyone worse off.** Its goal: **increase wellbeing without harming anyone.**

> PARETO IMPROVEMENT
>
> a move from y to x is a **Pareto improvement** if: (1) at least one person is **strictly better off**, and (2) **no one is worse off**

*Reads:* a change counts as an improvement **only if it helps someone and hurts no one.** · A policy is **Pareto efficient** if **no** Pareto improvement is possible from it (you can't help anyone without hurting someone).

- **Why Pareto? Nobody is harmed**, and you **don't need to compare wellbeing across people** (sidesteps utilitarianism's measurement problem).
- **Key concerns:** it is often **indeterminate** — many policies are efficient, and it can't rank them; and it **privileges the status quo**, because almost every real policy creates **some** losers (so almost nothing is a pure Pareto improvement).

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## ★ Liberalism: the goal is liberty

***Core:*** (philosophical) liberalism judges policy by whether it **protects individual liberty** — by "separating a public and private sphere and rigorously resisting the use of policy to infringe on the **private sphere**" (Judith Shklar).

### The key question: *where is the line?*

Liberals split life into a **private sphere** (your own business — religion, friends, what you read; the state stays out) and a **public sphere** (where policy is allowed — traffic, taxes). **All** liberals agree the line exists; they disagree on **where to draw it.** Three ways:

**(1) The harm principle (J.S. Mill, *On Liberty*, 1859).** "The only purpose for which power can be rightfully exercised over any member of a civilised community, against his will, is to **prevent harm to others.** His own

good… is not a sufficient warrant."

- *The problem — harm or mere **offense**?* Hateful posts (protected US free speech vs Germany's 2017 law requiring deletion), **flag/holy-book burning** (US-protected 1989; Denmark banned Qur'an burning 2023), going to work with a contagious flu (your choice — but not during COVID). The line between **harm** and **offense** is where liberals fight.

**(2) Property / self-ownership (Locke; Nozick, 1970s).** You **own your own body** → you own **what your work produces** → so **taxing it needs a strong justification.** (A libertarian reading that shrinks the public sphere.)

**(3) Freedom — but *which* freedom? (Isaiah Berlin, 1968).**

- **Freedom *from*** (negative liberty): nobody stops you. "Congress shall make no law…" → implies a **small state** that stays out of the way.
- **Freedom *to*** (positive liberty): you actually have the **means** to act. Tax-funded schools and healthcare give people the means → implies a **larger state.**
- *The provocation:* is a **homeless person** "**free**" to rent a flat in Copenhagen? Negatively yes (no law stops them); positively no (no means). *(Obamacare's insurance mandate: a welfarist asks "does it raise wellbeing?"; a liberal asks "may the state **compel** you to buy insurance?")*

**Liberalism — pros & cons.** *Pros:* you own your life and choices; governments can be **wrong** about what's good for you; people with **different values** can live together in peace. *Cons:* the private/public **line is hard to draw**; it can **block welfare-raising policies**; *who* counts as freely choosing (children?); and it can **permit large inequality.**

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## ★ Egalitarianism: the goal is equality

***Core:*** egalitarianism judges policy by whether it **reduces unjust inequality.** The hard question is "**equality of *what*?**" (Amartya Sen).

### Equality of what?

| Type | Everyone has the same… | Example |
|---|---|---|
| **Formal rights** | rights & liberties | equality before the law |
| **Opportunity** | **starting chances** to live a good life | free university |
| **Outcomes** | end-state quality of life | equal income/wealth |

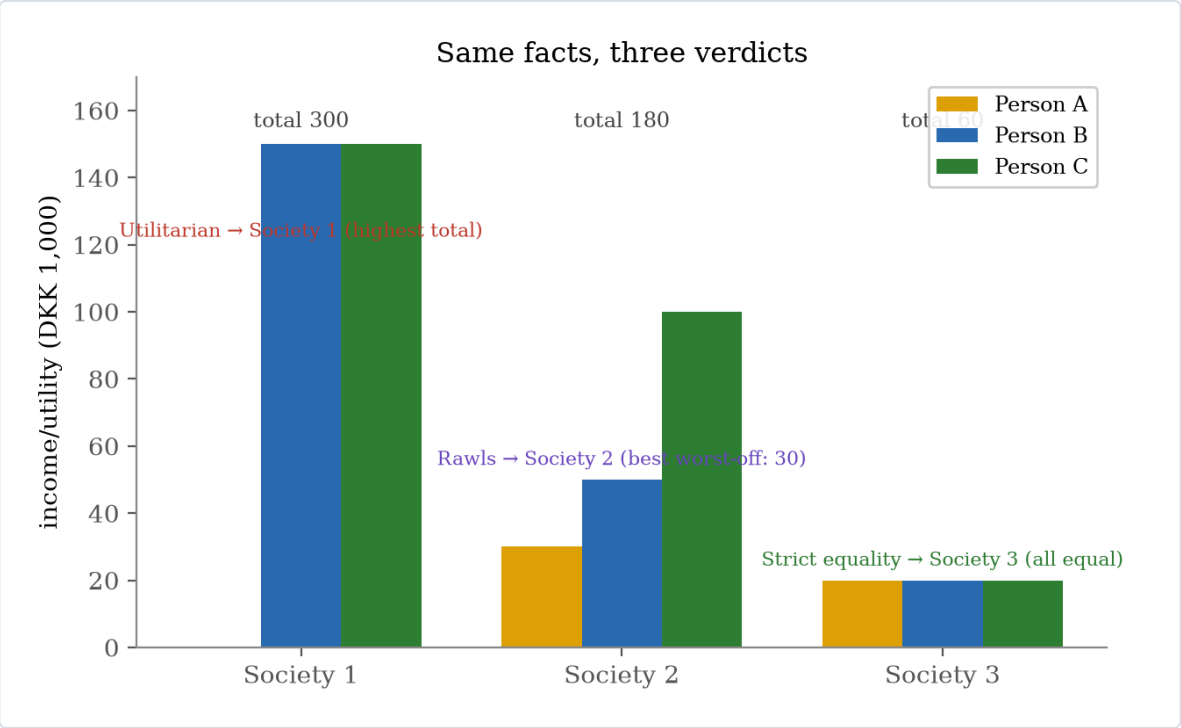
*(Brazil's **race-based university quotas** push **equality of opportunity/outcomes** — but risk **equal formal rights** and efficiency.)*

### Rawls — how to choose fair rules

Our views on fairness are **biased by our position** (the rich favour low taxes; the poor favour redistribution). Rawls' fix: imagine choosing society's rules from an **original position, behind a veil of ignorance** — not knowing your class, gender, race, talents or values. From there, he argues we'd choose:

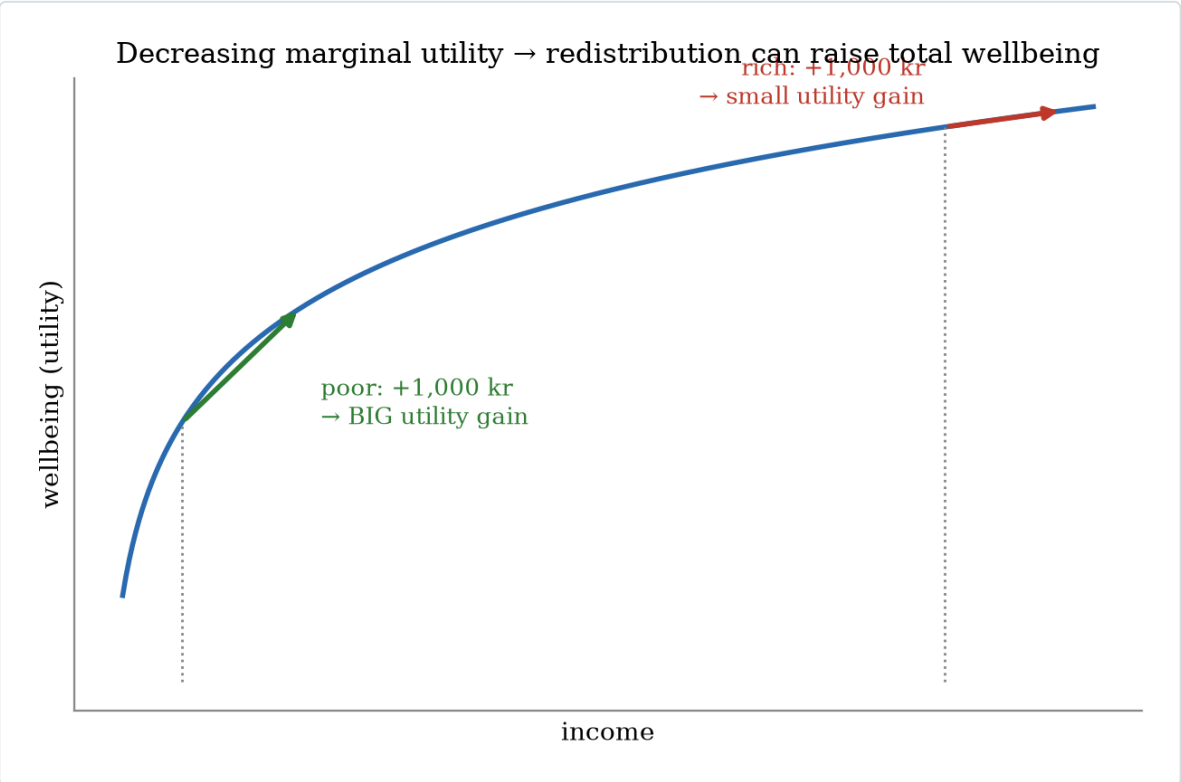
1. **Equal Liberty Principle** — everyone gets equal basic liberties (speech, vote, equality before the law).

2. Inequalities are allowed **only if** (a) positions are **open to all** under fair equality of opportunity, **and** (b) they **benefit the least advantaged** — the **Difference Principle** (a *maximin* rule: maximise the position of the worst-off).




**How to read it.** Same three people, three societies. **Utilitarian → Society 1** (highest **total**, 300 — never mind that Person A gets 0). **Rawls → Society 2** (the **worst-off** person does best there: 30 > 20 > 0). **Strict equality of outcomes → Society 3** (everyone equal at 20, though the total is lowest). *Same facts, three verdicts — this is why frameworks matter.*

## Why redistribution can raise total wellbeing (egalitarians & welfarists agree here)



**How to read it.** The curve is **decreasing marginal utility**: each extra krone adds **less** wellbeing than the one before. It's **steep for the poor, flat for the rich.** So moving 1,000 kr from a rich person (small utility loss) to a poor person (big utility gain) **raises the total** — a **utilitarian argument *for* some equality.**

### Egalitarianism vs the other frameworks

- **With welfarists:** they **agree** on redistribution **when it raises total wellbeing** (the decreasing-marginal-utility argument).
- **With liberals:** they **agree** on equal **formal rights**, but clash on **redistribution** — **Nozick**: justice is about **process**; if holdings were acquired and transferred **justly**, the result is just *however unequal*.

**More from the chapter (equality of outcomes vs opportunity):**

- **Leveling down** — strict equality can be reached by making everyone **worse off** (a flaw); and strict equality can gut **incentives** to work/invest (the **equality–efficiency trade-off**).
- **Cohen's three equalities of *opportunity*: (1) Bourgeois** — remove formal/legal barriers (race, gender, class); **(2) Left-liberal** — also remove disadvantages of **birth/upbringing** (wealth, schooling, networks); **(3) Socialist** — also neutralise **natural** differences (talent, intelligence). Each is more radical than the last.
- **Key concerns:** do equal-outcome policies **violate equal rights**? how to **trade off equality vs efficiency**? and always — **equality of *what*?**

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## ★ Frameworks at a glance

| Framework | Core value | The key question it asks |
|---|---|---|
| **Utilitarian** | total wellbeing | *Does it raise the **sum** of wellbeing?* |
| **Pareto** | efficiency | *Does it help someone **without hurting anyone**?* |
| **Liberal** | freedom, rights | *Does it **intrude on the private sphere**?* |
| **Egalitarian** | equality, fairness | *Does it **reduce unjust inequality**?* |

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## Back to SyRI — one policy, three verdicts

Applying the lenses to the Dutch fraud algorithm:

- **Welfarist:** does SyRI make society **better off overall** — does catching more fraud (protecting public funds) outweigh the costs, including the chilling effect and wrongful flags? A sum-of-wellbeing calculation.
- **Liberal:** does it **intrude on the private sphere** — mass data-combination and surveillance of citizens? *This is the lens the Hague court used:* SyRI violated the **right to privacy** (Art. 8 ECHR). A welfare gain **cannot** justify crossing the private-sphere line.
- **Egalitarian:** does it fall **unequally** — disproportionately flagging poor neighbourhoods and minorities, entrenching disadvantage? Equal **treatment** and fairness, not just aggregate welfare.

→ *Each framework highlights a different problem (and a different possible justification) for the exact same policy.*

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## Why do reasonable people disagree?

*Core:* a practical payoff — **diagnosing** a disagreement is the first step to managing it. People disagree for **three distinct reasons**:

| Source | What differs | How to address it |
|---|---|---|
| **Information** | different beliefs about the **facts** | **data, analysis, evidence** |
| **Self-interest** | different **stakes** in the outcome | appeal to **shared principles** (e.g. the veil of ignorance) |
| **Values** | different **normative frameworks** | **cannot be settled by facts alone** |

→ **Key lesson:** political analysis asks **both** *what is* and *what should be*; welfarism, liberalism and egalitarianism can give **different verdicts on the same policy**; **not all good things go together** (efficiency vs freedom vs equality); use the frameworks to **clarify your own position** and to **understand those who disagree.**

## Key terms

| Term | Meaning |
|---|---|
| Positive vs normative | *what is* (explanatory) vs *what should be* (evaluative) |
| Normative framework | a set of criteria for judging whether a policy/outcome is good |
| Welfarism | judge policy by its consequences for **wellbeing** |
| Utilitarianism | maximise the **sum** of utility; distribution doesn't matter to the verdict |
| Utility | wellbeing/pleasure/benefit (Bentham) |
| Veil of ignorance | choose rules not knowing who you'll be (Harsanyi → utilitarianism; Rawls → maximin) |
| Pareto improvement | ≥1 person better off, **no one** worse off |
| Pareto efficient | no Pareto improvement is possible |
| Liberalism (philosophical) | judge policy by whether it protects **liberty** / the private sphere |
| Harm principle | the state may restrict you only to prevent **harm to others** (Mill) |
| Self-ownership | you own your body → own what your labour produces (Locke, Nozick) |
| Negative vs positive liberty | freedom **from** interference vs freedom **to** (having the means) — Berlin |
| Egalitarianism | judge policy by whether it reduces **unjust inequality** |
| Equality of what? | formal rights · opportunity · outcomes |
| Difference principle | inequality is just only if it benefits the **least advantaged** (Rawls) |
| Decreasing marginal utility | each extra krone adds less wellbeing (grounds redistribution) |
| Leveling down | achieving equality by making everyone worse off |

## Exam pointers

- **Classify a question** as positive or normative — the first move in any analysis.
- **State each framework's core value & key question** (the glance table) and apply all three to one policy (do it on SyRI).
- **Utilitarianism:** define the utilitarian optimum, give the **veil-of-ignorance** argument *for* it, and **two** classic objections (monsters/transplant/measurement/partiality).
- **Pareto:** define improvement & efficiency and its two weaknesses (indeterminate; status-quo bias).
- **Liberalism:** the private/public line and the **three ways to draw it** (harm · property · freedom), plus **negative vs positive liberty.**
- **Egalitarianism:** equality of what; **Rawls'** veil → **difference principle**; and why **decreasing marginal utility** links equality to welfare.
- **Diagnose a disagreement** as information, self-interest or values.

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## ★ Fun facts & memorable details (Tools 4.1: Normative Frameworks)

> The sticky bits from the normative-frameworks lecture.

- **Same policy, opposite grades.** SyRI is "efficient fraud-catching" to a welfarist, a "privacy violation" to a liberal, and "discrimination against poor neighbourhoods" to an egalitarian — one algorithm, three verdicts.
- **The veil of ignorance cuts both ways.** Harsanyi uses it to *prove* utilitarianism (maximise expected utility); Rawls uses the *same* thought experiment to *reject* it (protect the worst-off). Same device, opposite conclusions.
- **The utility monster.** Push utilitarianism hard enough and a sufficiently gleeful sadist's pleasure can "outweigh" his victims' pain — the reductio that haunts "just add up the happiness."
- **Is a homeless person free to rent a flat?** Berlin's distinction in one question: negatively yes (no law forbids it), positively no (no means). Your answer reveals how big a state you want.
- **"Liberal" is a trap word.** In the US it means left-wing; in Denmark (Venstre, Liberal Alliance) it means economically *right*-wing. Always ask *which* liberalism.
- **Leveling down.** You can make a society perfectly equal by dragging everyone to the bottom — which is why "equality" alone, with no efficiency check, isn't obviously good.
- **Decreasing marginal utility is the bridge.** The one idea where egalitarians and *utilitarians* shake hands: a krone means more to the poor than the rich, so some redistribution raises the total pie of wellbeing.

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# Tools 4.2: Interests and Rational Choice — Why Do Political Actors Choose What They Choose? (AD)

**Required reading: Bueno de Mesquita**, *Political Economy for Public Policy*, **ch. 2.1** · *Optional:* **Kenneth Shepsle**, *Analyzing Politics: Rationality, Behavior, and Institutions*, **ch. 2**. *(Lecturer: Anna Denisenko — deck "4.2 Interests and*

*Rational Choice.")*

**Theme of the lecture.** Lecture 4.1 asked the **normative** question (which outcomes are *good*); this one asks the **positive** question (**why** actors choose what they choose, and how those choices **add up to outcomes**). The tool is **rational choice**: *political and business outcomes emerge from actors pursuing their goals under constraints.* Build any analysis from **three blocks** — **actors, preferences, constraints** — and you can predict behaviour, see why "good-on-paper" policies fail, and know **which lever** (goals, incentives, or available actions) actually changes an outcome. When one actor's best move depends on others', we add **game theory** and the **Nash equilibrium** — and meet the **prisoner's dilemma**, where individually rational choices produce a collectively bad result.

> ★ **The heart of the lecture — outcomes = actors pursuing goals under constraints.**
> • **Three building blocks: actors** (who chooses?), **preferences** (a ranking of *outcomes*, written x > y), and **constraints** (which options are actually feasible — resources, institutions, information).
> • **"Rational" = complete + transitive preferences** — *not* selfish, not only about money, not all-knowing, not "smart." Just a consistent ranking, pursued as best one can given beliefs and constraints.
> • **To change behaviour, change incentives** (or the available actions) — *not* people's goals. An **incentive** is anything that shifts the costs/benefits of an outcome, and **institutions shape incentives.**
> • **Strategic situations → game theory.** When your best choice depends on what others do, find the **Nash equilibrium**: a strategy profile where everyone is best-responding, so no one wants to deviate. The housing reform and the trade war are both **prisoner's dilemmas** — individually rational, collectively bad.

**Red thread:** *(1) Who are the actors, what do they want, and what constrains them? (2) Which lever changes the outcome? (3) When choices are interdependent, what's the stable (Nash) result — and is it good?*

**Key concepts to apply:** *rational choice (outcomes from goals + constraints) · actors · preferences (ranking over **outcomes**, x > y) · constraints (resources · institutions · information) · rationality = **complete + transitive** · what rationality is **not** · the paradox of voting · expressive/duty voting · incentives · the three levers (goals · incentives · actions) · Mayhew (re-election-seeking politicians) · Niskanen (budget-maximising bureaucrats) · **expected value** & when cheating pays · game theory: players · strategies · timing · payoffs · payoff matrix · best response · **Nash equilibrium** · the **prisoner's dilemma** (individually rational → collectively bad; not Pareto efficient) · (critiques) bounded rationality (Simon) · loss aversion / status-quo bias (Kahneman & Tversky) · preferences taken as given · "model as map."*

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## From "should" to "why"

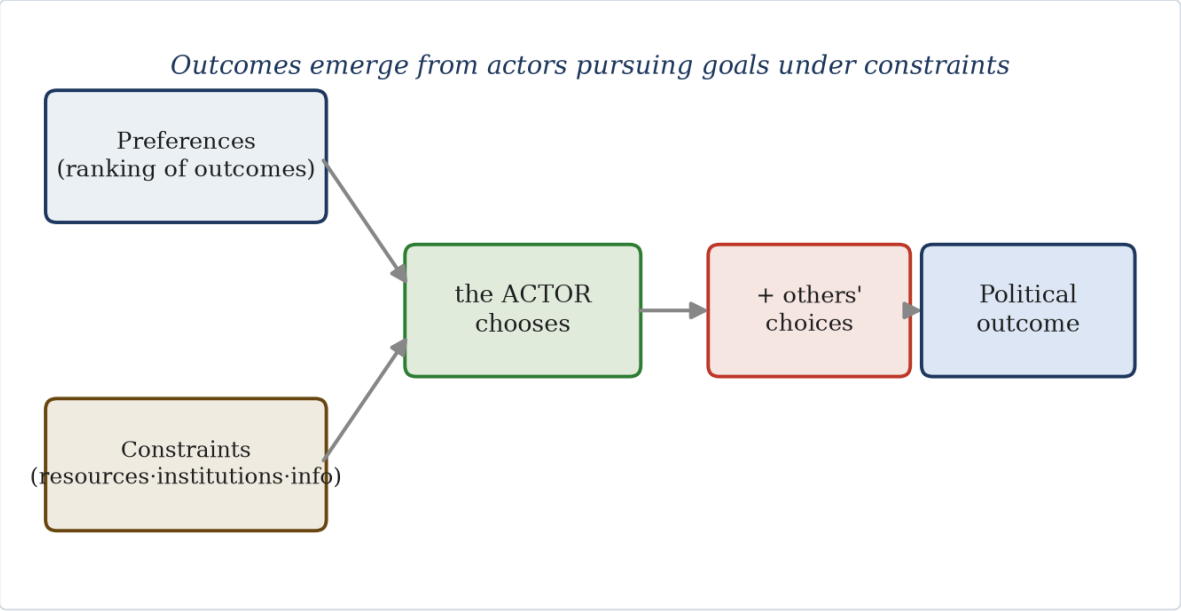
***Core:*** normative frameworks tell us which outcomes are **good**; they do **not** tell us which outcomes will **actually happen.** Rational choice fills that gap.

The lecture's motivating **puzzles** — all answerable with one tool:

- Your single vote **almost never** decides an election — so **why do millions vote**?
- Why do **firms break rules** even when fines are large?
- Why might **abolishing a height limit fail** to fix a housing shortage?
- Why do countries **raise tariffs** when they know free trade makes everyone better off?

## ★ The three building blocks

***Core:*** *political/business outcomes emerge from actors pursuing their goals under constraints.* Build any analysis from three pieces.




**How to read it.** An **actor** ranks outcomes (**preferences**) and faces **constraints** (what's feasible); from those they make a **choice**; that choice **plus others' choices** produces the **political outcome.** Change any block and you change the prediction.

1. **Actors** — who is making the choice?
2. **Preferences** — what outcomes do they want?
3. **Constraints** — what options are actually available?

## Actors & preferences

***Core:*** we name the actor, assume a **simple goal**, and write their **ranking of outcomes.**

| Typical actor | Assumed preferences |
|---|---|
| **Voters** | good policy, low taxes, a party they like |
| **Politicians** | winning (re-)election, power |
| **Bureaucrats** | budget, autonomy, career |
| **Firms** | profit |
| **Interest groups** | policy wins for their members |

- Sometimes we treat a **group** (a city, firm, country) as a **single actor** — a simplification we should **flag.**
- **Preferences = a ranking of possible outcomes.** Write **x ≻ y** = "the actor prefers x to y." E.g. a voter: *carbon tax ≻ green subsidies ≻ do nothing.*
- **Preferences are about outcomes, not actions.** (You don't prefer "voting"; you prefer the *outcome* voting helps bring about.) What shapes them: **goals, identity, values, incentives, information.**

## ★ What "rational" means

***Core:*** a precise, modest definition — **not** the everyday sense of "clever" or "selfish."

Preferences are **rational** if they are:

- **Complete** — the actor can compare *any* two outcomes (x > y, or y > x, or indifferent).
- **Transitive** — the ranking is consistent: if x > y and y > z, then **x > z.**

**What rationality does *not* mean: not selfish** (you can prefer helping others — altruism, fairness, duty); **not only about money** (can be identity or ideology); **not all-knowing** (actors can hold *wrong* beliefs); **not "smart" or "good"** (it's about **consistency**, not wisdom).

> RATIONAL CHOICE
>
> acting to achieve one's **most-preferred outcome**, given one's **constraints** and **beliefs**

*Reads:* given a **complete + transitive** ranking, the actor picks the **feasible action** they believe will lead to the **best** outcome.

## Why vote? (the paradox of voting)

***Core:*** the first puzzle — if the *only* goal is to change the result, voting looks **irrational**, yet turnout is high. Resolving it shows preferences are about more than the result.

- The chance a single vote decides a US presidential election is **~1 in 60 million** (Gelman, Silver & Edlin), and voting costs time/effort — so purely *instrumentally* it doesn't pay.
- Yet **~2/3 of eligible Americans voted in 2024**, and **~84% of Danes** in the 2022 Folketing election.
- **Why it can still be rational:** people value **more than** changing the result — the **act itself** (expressing identity/values, doing one's **duty**, participating). Rational choice accommodates this: these are real entries in the preference ranking. *(Preferences over outcomes ≠ "only the election result.")*

## Constraints

***Core:*** actors choose the **best feasible** option — so the **constraint set** often decides the outcome.

Types of constraint:

- **Resources** — money, time, seats in parliament.
- **Institutions** — laws, constitutions, electoral rules, EU treaties.
- **Information** — what you know about options and consequences.

**→ Same preferences + different constraints → different choices.** (Some actions are simply off the table — e.g. *voting twice is illegal.*) This is why **institutions matter**: they set what's feasible.

## Incentives & the three levers

***Core:*** we can't choose *for* people — we can only change **what shapes their choices.** There are exactly **three levers.**

| Lever | How it works | Feasibility |
|---|---|---|
| **1. Change goals** | persuade people to *want* different things | slow and hard |
| **2. Change incentives** | shift the **costs/benefits** of outcomes | the usual policy tool |
| **3. Change available actions** | alter the **constraint set** (ban/allow options) | institutional design |

- An **incentive** = anything that changes the **costs or benefits** of an outcome. **Institutions shape incentives:** electoral rules shape what politicians promise; budget rules shape what bureaucrats ask for; **fines and inspections** shape whether firms comply.
- **Useful simplifying assumptions about actors:** politicians as "**single-minded seekers of re-election**" (Mayhew 1974) — explains spending aimed at swing voters and blame-avoidance before elections; bureaucrats as **budget-maximisers** (Niskanen 1971) — explains "use it or lose it" year-end spending. *These are useful if they **predict**, not because they're literally true of everyone.*

## ★ Expected value: when does cheating pay?

***Core:*** to predict a choice under risk, compare the **expected** costs and benefits. This is how you design a rule that actually works.

**The firm problem.** A firm can secretly break an environmental rule: extra profit from breaking it = **1 million kr**; fine if caught = **5 million kr**; chance of being caught = **1 in 10.**

EXPECTED COST OF CHEATING

$$\mathrm{E[fine]} = \text{probability} \times \text{fine} = 0.1 \times 5{,}000{,}000 = \mathbf{500{,}000\ kr}$$

*Reads:* on average, cheating costs **500,000 kr** — but it *gains* **1,000,000 kr.** Since the gain (1m) **exceeds** the expected fine (0.5m), a profit-maximiser **cheats.**

**How the government flips the decision** — raise the expected cost above the gain, via either lever:

- **bigger fine:** need fine × 0.1 > 1m → **fine > 10m**; or
- **more inspections:** need prob × 5m > 1m → **prob > 0.2** (1 in 5).

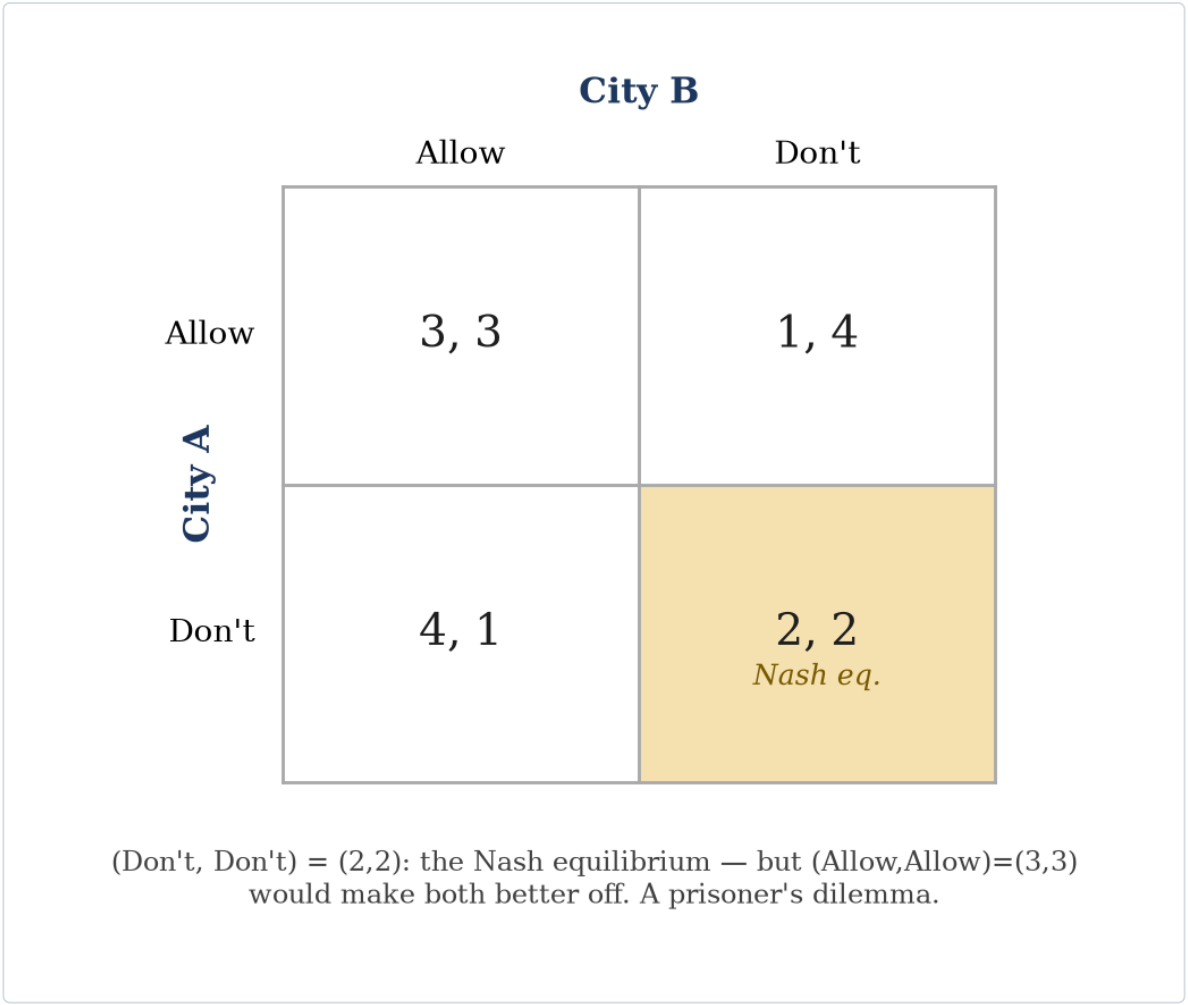
→ *The lesson:* "clean air is good" (normative) isn't enough — you need a **rule big enough that the actor chooses to comply** (rational choice). **Good intentions don't change behaviour; incentives do.**

## ★ Game theory & the Nash equilibrium

***Core:*** when **your best choice depends on what others do**, you're in a **strategic situation** — use **game theory.** Every game answers **four questions**, and the prediction is the **Nash equilibrium.**

**The four questions of a game: (1) Players** — who's involved? **(2) Strategies** — what can each do? **(3) Timing** — who moves when? **(4) Payoffs** — what does each want?

**The housing game.** A national height ban causes a housing shortage; the reform lifts it but lets **each city** choose. Will it work? Model **two cities** (A, B), each can **Allow** tall buildings or **Don't**; they move **simultaneously**; each would rather **not** have towers itself but wants homelessness solved (and cares more about avoiding towers). Ranking → payoffs (higher = better; only the order matters):




(Don't, Don't) = (2,2): the Nash equilibrium — but (Allow,Allow)=(3,3) would make both better off. A prisoner's dilemma.

**How to read it.** A picks a **row**, B a **column**; each cell is (A's payoff, B's payoff).

- Best response = your best strategy given what the other does. *If B allows,* A prefers **Don't** (4 > 3); *if B doesn't,* A still prefers **Don't** (2 > 1). So **"Don't" is best for A no matter what** (same for B).
- Nash equilibrium = a **strategy profile where every player is best-responding**, so **no one wants to change alone.** Here that's **(Don't, Don't) = (2, 2)** — the highlighted cell.
- **The recipe:** for each player, **underline the best-response payoff** in every column/row; the cell where **all** payoffs are underlined is the **Nash equilibrium.** (A game can have one, several, or none of this simple kind.)
- **Why it's a good prediction:** it's the "**no regrets**" outcome — after seeing what others did, no one wishes they'd chosen differently. Non-equilibria are **unstable** (someone would switch). *(Named after **John Nash**, Nobel 1994 — "A Beautiful Mind.")*

→ **So will the reform fix the shortage?** No — both cities rationally choose **Don't**, and the towers never get built.

## ★ The prisoner's dilemma

***Core:*** the housing game and the trade war are both a **prisoner's dilemma** — the signature result where **individually rational choices lead to a collectively bad outcome.**

- **The structure:** each player has a strong individual reason to pick the "selfish" option (**Don't / Tariff**); when **everyone** does, **everyone ends up worse off.**

- **The trade war** (same matrix): two countries choose **Free trade** or **Tariff**; the Nash equilibrium is **(Tariff, Tariff) = (2,2)**, though **(Free trade, Free trade) = (3,3)** is better for both. *Real life, 2025:* the US and China escalated tariffs to **145% / 125%**, then agreed a 90-day truce cutting them to **30% / 10%** — an attempt to climb back to the top-left cell.
- **Link to Lecture 4.1:** the equilibrium **(2,2) is *not* Pareto efficient** — moving to **(3,3)** would make *everyone* better off, with no loser. So a **Pareto** welfarist condemns the equilibrium; a **utilitarian** too (total 4 < 6); and the puzzle "**how do groups escape this trap?**" is **next lecture** (collective action).

## Criticisms of rational choice (and why use it anyway)

***Core:*** rational choice is a **model** — deliberately simplified. Know its limits, and why it's still worth using.

**Criticisms:**

- **Bounded rationality (Herbert Simon):** people have **limited time & information**, so they use **shortcuts** and settle for "good enough" (*satisficing*), not optimising.
- **Psychology — loss aversion (Kahneman & Tversky):** people weigh **losses about twice as heavily as equal gains**, so they **defend the status quo.** *Politics:* cutting an existing benefit causes **more anger** than never giving it — a **status-quo bias** rational choice misses.
- **Where do preferences come from?** Rational choice **takes them as given** (the *Ideas & Identity* lecture opens that box).
- **Too simple?** Real situations have **many** players and options.

**Why use it anyway:** it makes **assumptions explicit** (who wants what, what constrains them); produces **testable predictions** (more inspections → more compliance); helps **design policy** (the housing reform looked good on paper — a simple game showed why it fails); and **explains surprising outcomes** (rational individuals, bad collective results). *Treat the model as a **map**: it leaves things out precisely so it can be useful.*

## Key terms

| Term | Meaning |
|---|---|
| Rational choice | outcomes emerge from actors pursuing goals under constraints |
| Preferences | an actor's **ranking of outcomes** (x > y = prefers x to y) |
| Complete | the actor can compare any two outcomes |
| Transitive | if x > y and y > z then x > z (consistent ranking) |
| Constraint | what limits feasible options: resources · institutions · information |
| Incentive | anything that changes the costs/benefits of an outcome |
| Expected value | probability × payoff (how to compare choices under risk) |
| Strategic situation | your best choice depends on what others do |
| Payoff matrix | table of outcomes & payoffs for a 2-player simultaneous game |
| Best response | your best strategy given what the others do |
| Nash equilibrium | a profile where everyone best-responds → no one deviates |
| Prisoner's dilemma | individually rational choices → collectively worse (non-Pareto) outcome |
| Bounded rationality | limited info/time → shortcuts & "good enough" (Simon) |
| Loss aversion | losses loom larger than equal gains → status-quo bias (Kahneman & Tversky) |

## Exam pointers

- **Set up any analysis** with the three building blocks — actors, preferences, constraints — and state your simplifying assumptions.
- **Define rationality** precisely (complete + transitive) and say what it is **not.**
- **Compute an expected value** and use it to show when a firm cheats — and **which lever** (fine size vs inspection rate) flips the choice.
- **Solve a 2×2 game:** underline best responses, find the **Nash equilibrium**, and explain why it's a good prediction.
- **Identify a prisoner's dilemma** and connect it to Lecture 4.1: the equilibrium is **not Pareto efficient.**
- **Name two critiques** (bounded rationality; loss aversion) and the "model as map" defence.

## ★ Fun facts & memorable details (Tools 4.2: Rational Choice)

> The sticky bits from the rational-choice lecture.

- **"Rational" doesn't mean selfish or smart.** It only means your preferences are **consistent** (complete + transitive). A selfless, ideological, mistaken person can be perfectly "rational."
- **Your vote won't decide the election — 1 in 60 million.** Yet most people vote. The resolution: voting is about **expression and duty**, not just the result — and that's a real preference, not a mistake.
- **"Clean air is good" changes nothing.** A rule only works if actors **choose** to obey it — so you need a fine big enough (or inspections frequent enough) that the **expected** cost beats the gain.
- **A good policy that fails on purpose.** The height-ban reform looked sensible, but a simple 2×2 game shows every city rationally picks "Don't" — the shortage survives. Models earn their keep by catching this.
- **The trade war is a prisoner's dilemma.** US–China 2025: both slapped on tariffs (the Nash equilibrium) even though mutual free trade would make both richer. Individually rational, collectively poorer.
- **Losses hurt twice as much as gains feel good.** Kahneman & Tversky — which is why cutting a benefit enrages people more than never granting it, and why the status quo is so sticky.
- **Treat the model as a map.** A map is useful *because* it leaves things out. Rational choice is wrong in the details and right about the shape — that's the point.

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